UNITED INDEPENDENT SCHOOL DISTRICT

FOR CHILDREN

2018 2019 2022 2023 2024 2025

26 27

STUDENT CODE OF CONDUCT

- STUDENT HANDBOOK
- BUS RIDER'S HANDBOOK
- TECHNOLOGY USE GUIDE

2026 - 2027 Academic Calendar

UNITED INDEPENDENT SCHOOL DISTRICT
FOR CHILDREN
2018 2019 2022 2023 2024 2025

- New Employee Orientation
- First Day of Class
- Staff/Student Holiday
- Professional Development/ PLC Day
- Teacher Work-day
- Early Release Elementary/Middle School
- Early Release High School
- STAAR Elementary/Middle School
- STAAR Secondary/High School
- Bad Weather Make Up Day

2026-2027 STAAR Academic Calendar

Dec. 2	STAAR/EOC U.S. History
Dec. 2	STAAR/EOC Biology
Dec. 3	STAAR/EOC Algebra I
Dec. 8	STAAR/EOC English I & II
April 13	STAAR/EOC English I & II
April 21	STAAR/EOC Biology
April 21	STAAR/EOC U.S. History
April 28	STAAR/EOC Algebra I

April 7	STAAR Grades 5th Reading
April 8	STAAR Grades 3rd & 4th Reading
April 13	STAAR Grades 6th - 8th ELAR
April 14	STAAR Grades 8th Science
April 20	STAAR Grades 5th Science

April 21	STAAR Grades 5th Math
April 21	STAAR Grades 8th Soc. Studies
April 22	STAAR Grades 3rd & 4th Math
April 27	STAAR Grades 6th & 7th Math
April 28	STAAR Grades 8th Math & Algebra I

Grading Period 6-Weeks
Aug. 12 - Sep. 18 (27);
Sep. 21 - Oct. 30 (28);
Nov. 2 - Dec. 16 (28);
Jan. 6 - Feb. 18 (32);
Feb. 23 - April 9 (27);
April 12 - May 26 (32)

Grading Period 9-Weeks
Aug. 12 - Oct. 8 [41];
Oct. 13 - Dec. 16 [42];
Jan. 6 - Mar. 19 [46];
Mar. 22 - May 26 [45]

First Semester 83
Second Semester 91
174

It is the policy of United ISD not to discriminate on the basis of race, color, national origin, sex, handicap in its programs, services or activities as required by Title VI of the Civil Rights Act of 1964, as amended; Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972; and Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973, as amended.

Board approved December 17, 2025. 6/17/26

High School Graduations

At the Sames Arena

Wednesday, May 26, 2027
L. B. Johnson High
9:00 A.M.

Wednesday, May 26, 2027
John B. Alexander High
2:00 P.M.

Thursday, May 27, 2027
United South High
9:00 A.M.

Thursday, May 27, 2027
United High
2:00 P.M.

JULY 2026

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AUGUST 2026

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OCTOBER 2026

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NOVEMBER 2026

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FEBRUARY 2027

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MARCH 2027

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APRIL 2027

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MAY 2027

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JUNE 2027

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UNITED INDEPENDENT SCHOOL DISTRICT

FOR CHILDREN

Board of Trustees

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President
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Rodolfo "Rudy" Gonzalez, Jr.
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District 3

Ramiro Veliz, III
Parliamentarian
District 4

Michelle Molina
Secretary
District 6

Dianelle Martinez
Member
District 7

Gerardo Cruz, PhD
Superintendent

201 Lindenwood Drive
Laredo, Texas 78045
Phone: (956) 473-6355
Facsimile: (956) 728-8691

July 13, 2026

Dear UISD Parents, Guardians, and Families,

On behalf of the Board of Trustees and the more than 6,000 employees of United ISD, I welcome you with much enthusiasm to the 2026-2027 school year. We are very excited to welcome you back to our schools and look forward to continuing our tradition of academic excellence. Our school district's employees are energized and eager to meet your child and share their talents and experience in order to equip our students with the knowledge and skills needed to thrive.

At United ISD, our primary goal is to ensure the delivery of a high-quality educational program where all students are valued, included, and respected in a safe and supportive environment that fosters learning, curiosity, and creativity. Campus administration, along with our district leadership teams, are working diligently to ensure the safety of our students and staff. At United ISD, we understand the importance of maintaining a safe and secure learning environment, and we will work diligently to provide our students with a setting free of any disruption that may interfere with their educational process.

The Student Code of Conduct ("Code") is the district's response to the requirements of Chapter 37 of the Texas Education Code. The law requires the district to define misconduct that may or must result in a range of specific disciplinary consequences, including removal from a regular classroom or campus, out-of-school suspension, placement in a disciplinary alternative education program (DAEP), or expulsion from school. This Code has been adopted by the United ISD Board of Trustees. Please note that the information is updated annually, and that additional policies may be adopted during the school year.

Our goal with the Student Code of Conduct is to inform all students and parents of their rights and responsibilities as well as United ISD's expectations regarding behavior and conduct. To help us meet this goal, please read and review the 2026-2027 Student Code of Conduct and take a few minutes to discuss the handbook with your child. An electronic copy of this handbook is also available on the district website at uisd.net under the "Parent" tab. You can also find this information posted on each campus webpage and available for review at the campus principal's office.

Parental engagement is a fundamental component to a child's success. In order to ensure your child is fully benefiting from the academic environment, I encourage collaboration between educators and parents. We welcome parents, guardians, and families to get involved and actively participate in campus and district events/activities, open houses, and/or teacher conferences.

If you have any questions regarding any of the information in this handbook, do not hesitate to ask your child's teacher or the campus administrator(s).

Thank you for your partnership and support of United ISD. It is a privilege and honor to educate your child, and I look forward to a successful 2026-2027 school year.

Sincerely,

Dr. Gerardo Cruz
Superintendent of Schools

UNITED INDEPENDENT SCHOOL DISTRICT

BOARD OF TRUSTEES



Javier Montemayor, Jr.
President - District 5



Aliza Flores Oliveras
Vice-President - District 3



Michelle Molina
Secretary - District 6



Ramiro Veliz, J.J.J.
Parliamentarian - District 4



Gilbert Aguilar, Jr.
Member- District 1



Rodolfo "Rudy" Gonzalez, Jr.
Member - District 2



Dianelle "Dianely" Martinez
Member - District 7

BOARD OF TRUSTEES MEETINGS

Board Workshop meets on the 2nd Wednesday of the Month at 6:00 p.m. in the Boardroom located at 201 Lindenwood. Regular Board Meetings are held on the 3rd Wednesday of the Month at 6:00 p.m. in the Student Activity Complex Auditorium located on 5208 Santa Claudia Lane Laredo, Texas 78043.

UNITED INDEPENDENT SCHOOL DISTRICT
FOR CHILDREN
2018 2019 2022 2023 2024 2025



Dr. Gerardo Cruz
Superintendent of Schools

SUPERINTENDENT'S OFFICE

(956) 473-6355 & 473-6465

ADMISSIONS/ATTENDANCE/DROPOUT RECOVERY/PLANNING (956) 473-6349

ATHLETICS (956) 473-7100

BILINGUAL/ESL/DUAL FOREIGN LANGUAGE (956) 473-6259

BUSINESS & FINANCE (956) 473-6474

CHILD NUTRITION DEPARTMENT (956) 473-6556

CURRICULUM & INSTRUCTION (956) 473-2000

DISCIPLINE MANAGEMENT (956) 473-6463

ELEMENTARY SCHOOL INSTRUCTION (956) 473-2023

FEDERAL/STATE PROGRAMS (956) 473-6259

FINE ARTS PROGRAMS (956) 473-7121

HEALTH SERVICES (956) 473-6264

HIGH SCHOOL INSTRUCTION (956) 473-2010

HUMAN RESOURCES (956) 473-6254

MIDDLE SCHOOL INSTRUCTION (956) 473-2000

POLICE (956) 473-6361

SAFETY & CRISIS (956) 473-6400

SPECIAL EDUCATION (956) 473-2047

TECHNOLOGY (956) 473-6370

TRANSPORTATION EAST (956) 473-1950

TRANSPORTATION NORTH (956) 473-6330

TRANSPORTATION SOUTH (956) 473-5230

WE ARE UNITED

INDEPENDENT SCHOOL DISTRICT

201 Lindenwood , Laredo, TX 78045 • Phone (956) 473-6201 • Fax: (956) 473-7771

United Independent School District

Acknowledgement of Receipt of the 2026-2027 Student Code of Conduct, Technology Use Guide, Bus Rider's Handbook, and Student Handbook

I have **received a paper copy of the** Student Code of Conduct, Technology Use Guide, Bus Rider's Handbook, and Student Handbook.

I am responsible for reading the rules, expectations, and other information contained herein and signing and returning this Acknowledgement of Receipt form. I will be held accountable for my behavior and will be subject to the disciplinary consequences outlined in the Student Code of Conduct. Failure to read the Student Code of Conduct and Handbook does not excuse me from any consequences if I am in violation of the Student Code of Conduct and Student Handbook.

Any questions regarding the Student Code of Conduct or Student Handbook should be directed to my child's school principal.

**In the space(s) below, please list all your children attending a UISD school*.

Student's Name: (Please print)	SCHOOL:	ID#:	Grade:	D/O/B:
				/ /
				/ /
				/ /
				/ /
				/ /
				/ /
				/ /
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				/ /

Parent/Guardian's Name:_____ Signature:_____
(Please print) (Date)

PLEASE COMPLETE AND RETURN THIS PAGE TO YOUR CHILD'S SCHOOL.

Form A

UNITED ISD

EFFECTIVE 8/12/26

2026-2027 Standardized Dress Code Guidelines

Leggings are allowed for Elementary School students.

Leggings are prohibited for Middle School and High School students.

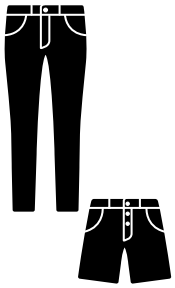
TOPS



ELEMENTARY & MIDDLE SCHOOL STUDENTS	HIGH SCHOOL STUDENTS	ALL PK3-12 STUDENTS
Approved colors: Solid white, black, navy blue, baby blue, or gray. Approved styles: Long or short-sleeved blouses, shirts with or without collars (polo style, button style, or t-shirt style), or dresses with sleeves. Turtlenecks shall be allowed.	Approved colors and styles: Any color, pattern or material for shirts, dresses, and blouses (including undershirts). All tops must have sleeves and cover the midriff.	All shirts and blouses must have sleeves and must cover the midriff. Any clothes that are suggestive or indecent, or which cause distraction, are prohibited including, tank/cami tops, muscle shirts, halter-tops, tube tops, spaghetti straps, exposed backs or midriffs, and any sheer garments.

ALL PK3-12 STUDENTS SPIRIT SHIRT: Students in all grade levels shall be permitted to wear school spirit/club/organization shirt (with or without a collar) with their **designated school name/mascot any day of the week** provided the shirt corresponds to the school the student attends. The spirit shirt (with or without a collar) **must have sleeves**. Students must also conform to the other standardized dress code requirements listed below and in the Student Code of Conduct and Student Handbook.

BOTTOMS



ELEMENTARY & MIDDLE SCHOOL STUDENTS	HIGH SCHOOL STUDENTS	ALL PK3-12 STUDENTS
Approved colors: Solid khaki, navy blue, gray, or black. Approved styles: Trousers, pants, shorts, skirts, *jeggings, joggers, skorts, capris, skinny pants, cargo, carpenter, velour, denim fabric (excluding jeans), sweat pants, and jumpers. Tights shall be allowed under attire that meets standardized dress specifications. Tights shall only be solid navy, black, or white. No embellishments shall be allowed. **Elementary School and Middle School students are allowed to wear jean pants only on Fridays. Leggings are allowed for Elementary School students. Leggings are prohibited for Middle School students.**	**Approved colors and styles:** Any color, pattern, or material for trousers, pants, denim fabric, shorts, skirts, joggers, skorts, capris, skinny style pants, cargo, carpenter, *jeggings, velour, sweat pants, and jumpers. **Students are allowed to wear jean pants any day of the week. Leggings are prohibited.**	All bottoms must be fully zippered up, buttons closed, fit well and not be oversized or undersized. Attire must fit at the waist and must not sag. Oversized, baggie, loose-fitting or wide-leg styled pants, boxers/bike shorts, overalls, and pajama pants shall not be worn to school. **A garment may be no shorter than 3 inches above the knee**. A slit can be no more than 3 inches above the knee. A skirt with a slit cannot be 3 inches above the knee AND have a 3-inch slit.

ATTENTION: *Jeggings have elasticity and resemble pants with stitching, fake pockets and fake fly front. Leggings are stretchy skin-tight bottoms, resembling thicker tights and are typically used for athletic activities, e.g., yoga pants.

OUTERWEAR



ALL PK3-12 STUDENTS Any color, pattern, or material as long as outerwear (i.e., sweaters, jackets, coats, sweatshirts, v-neck, cardigans, crew-neck, vests, and letterman jackets) is worn over an approved dress, shirt, blouse, spirit shirt, or turtleneck top. Outerwear must comply with the additional dress code guidelines below. Students shall not be allowed to wear any type of hood including a hood attached to a sweatshirt inside the school building. For purposes of maintaining school safety, long coats extending below mid-thigh, including but not limited to trench coats, shall not be permitted. Heavy, full-length outerwear, such as "dusters and trench coats," are prohibited. Any outerwear garment shall be appropriately sized at the shoulders, sleeves, and length. Shirts, blouses, and tops are not considered outerwear garments and cannot be worn over approved standardized dress shirts/blouses.

FOOTWEAR



ALL PK3-12 STUDENTS Students are required to wear shoes with soles. Students are **prohibited** from wearing **house/pajama slippers, steel-toed boots/shoes, stilettos**, and **skate shoes** (shoes with wheels). Shoes which may pose a hazard/safety concern (for PE or stairways, etc.) may be prohibited by the campus (i.e. athletic slides, flip flops, open-toe/open-heel, crocs, etc.).

ADDITIONAL DRESS CODE GUIDELINES FOR ALL STUDENTS

In addition to the above dress code guidelines, all students must conform to the dress code requirements below:

1. The District **prohibits pictures, emblems, or writings on clothing that are lewd, offensive, vulgar, or obscene, advertise or depict tobacco** products, **politics, weapons/ammunition, alcoholic beverages, drugs,** or any other substance prohibited under FNCF (LEGAL).
2. **Indecent/inappropriate** patches, **writings, or drawings** on clothing, purses, bag, backpacks, personal belongings, or on the body **are prohibited**. Clothing and accessories with inappropriate advertising or statements that are lewd, offensive, vulgar, obscene, or defamatory (i.e., alcoholic beverages, sex, tobacco, politics, drugs, gangs, weapons/ammunition, etc.) are also prohibited.
3. **No headgear** (i.e. hats, caps, skullcaps, scarves, bandanas) of any kind are to be worn or brought to school unless approved by the school principal for a special occasion, program, or unless there is a medical or religious justification.
4. **No torn or ripped** clothing of any kind is allowed.
5. **No sunglasses** are to be worn in the building.
6. **Belts** are **recommended** but not required.
7. **Body piercing jewelry**/accessories is **prohibited**. Ear piercing is acceptable. Mouth grills are not allowed.
8. Students shall cover private areas of the body by **wearing** appropriate **undergarments**. Undergarments should not be visible.
9. All exposed/visible **tattoos shall be covered** at all times.
10. **Dangling chains prohibited.** This includes chains attached to wallets, purses, footwear and backpacks.
11. The District **prohibits gang-related attire**, or attire that is determined by the school's Principal or designee to be gang-related or, in reasonable probability, would be considered as gang-related.

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United I.S.D. Board Policies are available in the Principals', Executive Directors', and Superintendent's Offices or at the District's Web site at **www.uisd.net**

In its efforts to promote nondiscrimination and as required by law, the District does not discriminate on the basis of race, religion, color, national origin, gender, sex, disability, age, or any other basis prohibited by law in providing education services, activities, and programs, including Career and Technical Education (CTE) programs. The District provides equal access to the Boy Scouts and other designated youth groups. In accordance with Title IX, the District does not and is required not to discriminate on the basis of sex in its educational programs or activities. The requirement not to discriminate extends to admission and employment.

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United I.S.D. Board policies are available online at **http://www.uisd.net**

STUDENT CODE OF CONDUCT

The District is proud of all students and recognizes that continued cooperation is essential to the District educational mission and to provide our students a safe, supportive and positive learning environment. The Student Code of Conduct (Code) partners with the District-wide implementation of Positive Behavior Interventions & Supports (PBIS) to foster student academic and behavioral success. United ISD operates using PBIS as its model for promoting a positive learning culture for students. PBIS is a school wide behavior system designed to support school rules and policies in a consistent positive manner. The Student Code of Conduct is the District's response to the requirements of Chapter 37 of the Texas Education Code. The Code provides methods and options for managing students in the classroom and on school grounds, disciplining students, and preventing and intervening in student discipline problems. The schools shall strive to provide for the basic welfare, educational opportunity, and safety of all students. Student conduct in the schools shall be supervised in an attempt to provide for reasonable order, courtesy and the recognition of student rights and responsibilities. The law requires the District to define misconduct that may—or must—result in a range of specific disciplinary consequences including, removal from a regular classroom or campus, suspension, placement in a disciplinary alternative education program (DAEP), placement in a juvenile justice education program (JJAEP), or expulsion from school. School authorities shall give clear guidance to staff members concerning discipline procedures, teacher authority, and limitations as to personal actions.

The Student Code of Conduct has been adopted by the United Independent School District Board of Trustees (Board) and developed with the advice of the District-level committee which includes campus administrators, parents and students. The Student Code of Conduct provides information to parents and students regarding standards of conduct, consequences of misconduct, and procedures for administering discipline. It will provide guidance to both the District and its students in their joint endeavor to achieve a meaningful and successful educational experience. Throughout the Student Code of Conduct and discipline policies, the term "parents" includes parent, legal guardian, or other person having lawful control of the child. Because the Student Code of Conduct is adopted by the District's Board of Trustees, it has the force of policy; therefore, in case of conflict between the Student Code of Conduct and the student handbook, the Student Code of Conduct shall prevail.

All students enrolled in United ISD, regardless of age or grade level, shall abide by this Student Code of Conduct. United ISD adheres to a zero tolerance policy for drugs and weapons. **If you find any item, that is not yours in your belongings or if someone asks you to hold a prohibited item, say no and report it immediately to a teacher, administrator, police, or security officer.** ***Students are also discouraged from possessing or consuming beverages, food, or any item belonging to another student.***

SECTION I—GENERAL

School District Authority and Jurisdiction:

Campus Behavior Coordinator: As required by law, a single person at each campus must be designated to serve as the campus behavior coordinator (CBC). The designated person may be the principal of the campus or any other campus administrator selected by the principal. The CBC is primarily responsible for maintaining student discipline. The District shall post on its website and campus websites the email address and telephone number of the person serving as CBC. Contact information may be found at www.uisd.net.

School rules and the authority of the District to administer discipline apply whenever the interest of the District is involved, on or off school grounds, in conjunction with or independent of classes and school-sponsored activities.

The District has disciplinary authority over a student:

1. During the regular school day and while the student is going to and from school or a school-sponsored or school-related activity on District transportation;
2. While students are going to and from school;
3. While the student is in attendance at any school-related activity (including a virtual learning environment), regardless of time or location;
4. During a school or District closure required by state, federal, or local action that has caused the District to modify instruction to a virtual learning environment and when the student is participating or was scheduled to participate in said virtual learning environment;
5. During lunch in which a student is allowed to leave campus;
6. For any school-related misconduct, regardless of time or location;
7. When retaliation against a school employee, board member, or volunteer occurs or is threatened, regardless of time or location;
8. When criminal mischief is committed on or off school property or at a school-related event;
9. For certain offenses committed within 300 feet of school property as measured from any point on the school's real property boundary line;
10. For certain offenses committed while on school property or while attending a school-sponsored or school-related activity of another school district in Texas;
11. When a student engages in certain criminal conduct described by the Texas Education Code;
12. When the student commits a felony, as provided by Texas Education Code Sections §§37.006 or 37.0081;
13. When a student engages in cyberbullying, as provided by Texas Education Code §37.0832; and
14. When the student is required to register as a sex offender.

Students shall comply with the Student Code of Conduct at all times while they are under the jurisdiction of the District.

The District has the right to search a vehicle driven to school by a student and parked on school property whenever there is reasonable cause to believe it contains articles or materials prohibited by the District.

Unauthorized Persons: In accordance with Texas Education Code §37.105, a school administrator, school resource officer (SRO), or District police officer shall have the authority to refuse entry or eject a person from District property if the person refuses to leave peaceably on request and: (1) the person poses a substantial risk of harm to any person; or (2) the person behaves in a manner that is inappropriate for a school setting, and the person persists in the behavior after being given a verbal warning that the behavior is inappropriate and may result in refusal of entry or ejection. Appeals regarding refusal of entry from District property may be filed in accordance with FNG (Local) or GF (Local), as appropriate.

School Facilities: Certain areas of the school will be accessible to students before and after school for specific purposes. Students are required to remain in the area where their activity is scheduled to take place. After dismissal of school in the afternoon, and unless involved in an activity under the supervision of a teacher, students must leave campus immediately.

Student Parking and Parking Areas: The student parking lot is off limits immediately following arrival to school and during the school day. A student must have administrative approval to visit the parking areas during the school day. Teachers are not allowed to issue passes to parking areas. This rule applies equally to bicycles, motorcycles, and any other type of privately owned vehicle. Students are not to loiter in the parking lots upon arrival. Electric motorized recreational vehicles, go-carts, mopeds, scooters, hover board (i.e. segway), etc., are strictly prohibited on District property.

Conduct Before and After School: Teachers and administrators have full authority over student conduct before, during, and after school, or activities on District premises and at school-sponsored events off District premises, such as play rehearsal, club meetings, athletic practice, and special study groups or tutorials. Students are subject to the same rules of conduct that apply during the instructional day and will be subject to consequences established by the Student Code of Conduct or any stricter extracurricular code of conduct established by the sponsor in accordance with Board policy. Violations of the extracurricular standards of behavior that are also violations of the Student Code of Conduct may result in additional disciplinary actions.

Certain areas of the school will be accessible to students before and after school for specific purposes. Students are required to remain in the area where their activity is scheduled to take place. Unless the teacher or sponsor overseeing an activity gives permission, a student shall not be permitted, or go to another area of the building or campus. After dismissal of school in the afternoon, unless a student is involved in activity under the supervision of a teacher or other authorized employee or adult, or unless students are granted permission to remain on campus, students must leave campus immediately.

Between Classes: Loitering or standing in the halls between classes is not permitted. During class time, a student must have a hall pass to be outside the classroom for any purpose. Failure to obtain a pass will result in disciplinary action.

Report Crime in Your School: Students, parents and community members may report illegal activities or violations of the Student Code of Conduct to **UISD Police** at **(956) 473-6361** or **Campus Crime Stoppers at 727-TIPS (8477).** The school administrators will report crimes as required by law and will call local law enforcement when an administrator suspects that a crime has been committed on campus.

Alert! If you "find" or "see" a weapon or "drugs" DO NOT PICK "IT" UP! You should make a report immediately to a teacher, administrator, security guard or police officer! Students are encouraged to self-report the fact that he or she has a prohibited item on school campus, and in such a situation, campus administration may take into consideration the context and nature of the self-reporting when determining intent or lack of intent at the time the student engaged in the conduct.

Posting and Distribution of Student Code of Conduct: At the beginning of the school year and throughout the school year as necessary, the Student Code of Conduct shall be: 1. Posted and prominently displayed at each campus or made available for review in the principal's office; and 2. Made available at the District's website at www.uisd.net, and/or as hard copy to students, parents, teachers, administrator and to others on request. Once the Student Code of Conduct is promulgated, any subsequent changes or amendments must be approved by the UISD Board of Trustees and made available promptly to students, parents, teachers, and others. Each school year, a paper copy of the handbook will be available to parents in the administrative office of your child's school or it can be electronically accessed at www.uisd.net. Each student, teacher, and parent annually shall sign a statement that they have been offered the option to obtain a paper copy of the United ISD Student Code of Conduct, Technology Use Guide, Bus Rider's Handbook, and Student Handbook, or to electronically access it at www.uisd.net. Please visit your child's school to obtain the most recent paper copy of the Student Code of Conduct. Failure to read and sign the Student Code of Conduct does not excuse the student from any consequences if they are in violation of the Student Code of Conduct.

Lost, Damaged, or Stolen Personal Items: Students are responsible for their own personal belongings while on campus or at a school-related or school-sponsored event. Students should be discouraged from bringing or wearing expensive clothing (e.g., winter coats), sunglasses, or jewelry/watches to school. UISD is not responsible for personal items that are lost, damaged, or stolen.

Corporal Punishment: The Board prohibits the use of corporal punishment in the District. Students shall not be spanked, paddled, or otherwise physically discipline for violations of the Student Code of Conduct by an employee, parent and/or legal guardian, or patron of the District while on District property or at a school sponsored event.

Applicability of School Rules and Discipline: To achieve the best possible learning environment for all of our students, UISD rules and discipline will apply whenever the interest of the District is involved, on or off school grounds, in conjunction with or independent of classes and school-sponsored activities. The District has disciplinary authority over a student.

As required by law, the District has developed and adopted a Student Code of Conduct that prohibits certain behaviors and establishes standards of acceptable behavior—both on and off campus—and consequences for violation of the standards. Students need to be familiar with the standards set out in the Student Code of Conduct, as well as campus and classroom rules. During any periods of instruction during the summer months, the Student Code of Conduct and Handbook in place for the year immediately preceding, the summer period shall apply, unless the District amends either or both documents for the purposes of summer instruction. It remains in effect during summer

school and at all school-related events and activities outside the school year until an updated version adopted by the board becomes effective for the next school year.

Manners and Civility: At all times on District property and at school-sponsored or related events outside of District property, and while coming to and from school, students shall exhibit good manners and civility demanded of a civilized nation. Failure to act accordingly may subject a student to penalty.

Rights and Responsibilities of Students: All students are entitled to enjoy the basic rights of citizenship recognized and protected by law for persons of their age and maturity. District schools shall foster a climate of mutual respect for the rights of others. Each student is expected to respect the rights and privileges of other students, teachers, and District staff. Students shall exercise their rights responsibly and in compliance with rules established for the orderly conduct of the District's educational mission. The District's rules of conduct and discipline are established to achieve and maintain order in the school. These rules apply regardless of whether a student commits an offense on his/her home campus, on another UISD campus, or away from any UISD campus while at a school-related function. Students who violate the rights of others, or who violate District or school rules, shall be subject to disciplinary measures designed to correct the misconduct and to promote adherence by all students to the responsibilities of citizens in the school community.

Standards for Student Conduct: Each student is responsible for achieving a positive learning environment at school or school-related activities in order for students to take advantage of available learning opportunities and to be productive members of our campus community. Students are expected to:

1. Develop good habits, such as
   - attending school daily.
   - arriving to classes punctually.
   - working well independently.
   - using appropriate language.
   - maintaining good health habits.
2. Assume responsibility for their actions by
   - keeping their parents informed of school activities, of credits earned and required, of supplies needed, and of communications sent home.
   - being self- disciplined.
   - making their own decisions despite peer pressure.
   - accepting the consequences for their behavior including penalties for inappropriate behavior.
   - using time wisely.
   - completing work on time.
   - having good study habits.
   - practicing neatness.
   - doing all assigned work.
   - supervising backpacks and/or personal belongings at all times.
   - paying required fees and fines, unless these are waived.
3. Maintain a positive attitude by
   - being proud of personal accomplishments.
   - being trustworthy.
   - having academic integrity.
4. Respect the rights of others by
   - allowing others to concentrate on their work.
   - allowing others to assume responsibility for their own actions.
   - learning to resolve differences in appropriate ways.
   - realizing that their behavior will directly affect others.
   - respecting others' property including District property and facilities.
5. Treat others with respect by
   - working and interacting well with others.
   - being courteous.
   - being polite and helpful.
   - caring for others.
   - displaying affection appropriately.
   - appreciating others' accomplishments.
6. Treat teachers and school staff with respect by
   - being cooperative.
   - being attentive.
   - listening to teachers.
   - being polite.
7. Respect the authority of teachers and other school staff by
   - listening to them.
   - following their directions.
   - questioning the classroom teacher appropriately.
   - seeking changes in school rules and policies in an appropriate and responsible manner through approved channels.
8. Obey all school and classroom rules and procedures, such as
   - being in the appropriate seat and ready when the bell rings.
   - being prepared for each class with appropriate materials and assignments.
9. Participate in assigned academic activities, such as
   - attending all classes.
   - bringing supplies as required for classroom work.
   - talking when it is appropriate.
   - following instructions.
   - doing all assignments.
10. Assume responsibility for maintaining the learning environment, such as
   - coming to school well groomed and dressed appropriately.
   - walking quietly in the school hallways.
   - staying in the classroom seat as required.
   - take care of District equipment in school and/or at home.
11. Take care of the school, such as
   - helping keep it clean.
   - keeping it free from destruction.
   - cooperating with school staff on vandalism cases.
   - cooperating with and assist school staff in maintaining safety, order, and discipline.
   - helping keep the school a safe place to be.
   - cooperating with staff in investigation of disciplinary cases, and volunteering information within the student's knowledge relating to an offense.

The District may impose campus or classroom rules in addition to those found in the Student Code of Conduct. These rules may be listed in the Student Handbook or posted in classrooms, and violations of such rules may or may not constitute violations of the Student Code of Conduct.

Parent and/or Guardian Responsibility: Parents have the responsibility to:

1. Ensure that their child complies with District and school policies, rules and regulations.
2. Assist their child to attend school well-groomed and dressed appropriately.
3. Communicate regularly with the school concerning their child's academic progress and conduct.
4. Provide for the physical needs of the child.
5. Participate in parent-teacher conferences and other activities in which their child is involved.
6. Cooperate with and support teachers and school administrators in their efforts to achieve and maintain a quality school system.
7. Discuss report cards and classroom assignments with their child.
8. Inform the school of any problems or conditions in the home, which affect their child.

9. Provide a work area free of interruption where their child may study and do homework.
10. Maintain up-to-date home, work, and emergency telephone numbers at the school.
11. Prepare the child emotionally and socially to be receptive to learning and discipline.
12. Encourage the child to develop proper study habits at home.
13. Send their child to school regularly and on time.
14. Teach their child to respect authority.
15. Insist that the child spend a minimum period of time studying/reading each day.
16. Assist the child to assume responsibility for appropriate behavior and to accept the consequences of inappropriate behavior.
17. Cooperate with the school in assisting their child to grow into a self-disciplined, mature, and responsible individual.

SECTION II—STANDARDIZED DRESS CODE GUIDELINES: Pre-K3 through 8th Grade

The District's standardized dress code is established to teach grooming and hygiene, instill discipline, prevent disruption, avoid safety hazards, and teach respect for authority. Students shall be dressed and groomed in a manner that is clean and neat and that will not be a health or safety hazard to themselves or others. The District prohibits any clothing or grooming that in the principal's or other administrator's judgment may reasonably be expected to cause disruption of or interference with normal school operations.

The student and parent may determine the student's personal dress and grooming standards, provided that they comply with the general guidelines set out above and with the student standardized dress code outlined in the Student Code of Conduct and Student Handbook.

In an effort to improve student learning and to facilitate a safe learning environment, the District shall mandate student standardized dress code for students in prekindergarten–grade 8. Student standardized dress code shall ensure that campuses are able to easily identify their students to better secure the campus.

All clothing must adhere to the standards set out below. All garments must be in an approved color as per the guidelines established in this policy. Students shall wear the approved school standardized dress unless the parent/guardian has filed and been granted an exemption in accordance FNCA (LEGAL) / (LOCAL).

Standardized dress is defined in this policy as one or more specific kinds of articles of clothing commonly available at a variety of retail outlets that are required to be worn by prekindergarten 3-grade 8 during normal school hours.

Standardized Dress Code (Pre-K3 – 8) specifications are as follows and must also comply with the section below entitled "Standardized Dress Code Guidelines (All Students PK3-12)".

1. TOPS: Approved colors are solid white, black, navy blue, baby blue, and gray. The approved styles are long or short-sleeved blouses, shirts with or without collars (polo style, button style, or t-shirt style) or dresses with sleeves. Turtlenecks shall be allowed. All tops must comply with the section "Standardized Dress Code Guidelines (All Students PK3-12)".
2. BOTTOMS: Approved colors are solid khaki, navy blue, gray, and black. Approved styles are trousers, shorts, skirts, jeggings, joggers, skorts, capris, skinny pants, cargos, carpenter, velour, denim fabric (excluding jeans), sweatpants, and jumpers. **Jeggings** have elasticity and resemble pants with stitching, fake pockets and fake fly front. Leggings are stretchy skin-tight bottoms, resembling thicker tights and are typically used for athletic activities, e.g., yoga pants. ***Leggings are prohibited for Middle & High School students. Leggings are allowed for Elementary students.*** Administrators shall have discretion to determine if a bottom classifies as a "legging" or "jegging." Elementary and Middle School students are allowed to wear jean pants only on Fridays. All bottoms must comply with the section entitled "Standardized Dress Code Guidelines (All Students PK3-12)". Tights shall be allowed under attire that meets standardized dress specifications. Tights shall only be solid navy, black, or white. No embellishments shall be allowed.
3. OUTERWEAR: All outerwear (i.e. sweaters, jackets, coats, sweatshirts, V-neck cardigans, crew-neck, vests, and letterman jackets) must be worn over an approved standardized dress, shirt/blouse (polo style, button style, or t-shirt style) and comply with the section "Standardized Dress Code Guidelines (All Students PK3-12)".

High School Student Dress Code below AND must also comply with the section "Standardized Dress Code Guidelines (All Students PK3-12)".

1. TOPS: Shirts, dresses, and blouses (including undershirts) may be any color, pattern, or material with sleeves. All tops must cover the midriff and comply with the "Standardized Dress Code Guidelines (All Students PK3-12)".
2. BOTTOMS: Trousers, shorts, skirts, joggers, skorts, capris, skinny style pants, cargo, carpenter, jeggings, velour, denim fabric, sweatpants, and jumpers – any material, color, or pattern. **Jeggings** have elasticity and resemble pants with stitching, fake pockets and fake fly front. Leggings are stretchy skin-tight bottoms, resembling thicker tights and are typically used for athletic activities, e.g., yoga pants. ***Leggings are prohibited for Middle & High School students. Leggings are allowed for Elementary students.*** Administrators shall have the discretion to determine if a bottom classifies as a "legging" or "jegging." All clothing/attire/garments/accessories must comply with the "Standardized Dress Code Guidelines (All Students PK3-12)".
3. OUTERWEAR: Any color, pattern, or material (i.e. sweaters, jackets, coats, sweatshirts, V-neck, cardigans, crew-neck, vests, and letterman jackets) comply with the "Standardized Dress Code Guidelines (All Students PK3-12)".

STANDARDIZED DRESS CODE GUIDELINES (ALL STUDENTS PK3-12): All students must conform to the standardized dress code guidelines.

1. TOPS: All shirts and blouses must have sleeves and must cover the midriff. Any clothes that are suggestive or indecent, or which cause distraction, are prohibited, including tank/cami tops, muscle shirts, halter-tops, tube tops, spaghetti straps, exposed backs or midriffs, and any sheer garments.

2. BOTTOMS: All bottoms must be fully zippered up and button closed if equipped with zippers or buttons. Attire must fit at the waist and must not sag. Oversized, baggie, loose-fitting or wide-leg styled pants, overalls and pajama pants shall not be worn to school. A garment may be no shorter than 3 inches above the knee. A slit can be no more than 3 inches above the knee. A skirt with a slit cannot be 3 inches above the knee AND have a 3-inch slit. **Jeggings** have elasticity and resemble pants with stitching, fake pockets and fake fly front. Leggings are stretchy skin-tight bottoms, resembling thicker tights and are typically used for athletic activities, e.g., yoga pants. ***Leggings are prohibited for Middle & High School students. Leggings are allowed for Elementary students.*** Administrators shall have discretion to determine if a bottom classifies as a "legging" or "jegging."
3. OUTERWEAR: Any color/pattern/material as long as outerwear (i.e. sweaters, jackets, coats, sweatshirts, V-neck, cardigans, crew-neck, vests, and letterman jackets) is worn over an approved dress, blouse, spirit shirt, or turtleneck top. Outerwear must comply with the "Standardized Dress Code Guidelines (All Students PK3-12)". Students shall not be allowed to wear any type of hood including a hood attached to a sweatshirt inside the school building. For purposes of maintaining school safety, long coats extending below mid-thigh, including but not limited to trench coats, shall not be permitted. Heavy, full-length outwears, such as "dusters and trench coats," are prohibited. Any outerwear garment shall be appropriately sized at the shoulders, sleeves, and length.
4. FOOTWEAR: Footwear is mandatory. Students are required to wear shoes with soles. Students are prohibited from wearing house/pajama slippers, steel-toed boots/shoes, stilettos, and skate shoes (shoes with wheels). Shoes which may pose a hazard/safety concern (for PE or stairways, etc.) may be prohibited by the campus (e.g., athletic slides, flip flops, open-toe/open-heel, crocs, etc.).
5. SPIRIT SHIRT: Students in all grade levels shall be permitted to wear school spirit/club/organization shirt (with or without a collar) with their designated school name/mascot any day of the week provided the shirt correspond to the school the student attends. The spirit shirt (with or without a collar) must have sleeves. Students must also conform to "Standardized Dress Code Guidelines (All Students PK3-12)".
6. The District prohibits pictures, emblems, or writings on clothing that are lewd, offensive, vulgar, or obscene, advertise or depict tobacco products, politics, weapons/ammunition, alcoholic beverages, drugs, or any other substance prohibited under FNCF (LEGAL).
7. Indecent/inappropriate patches, writings, or drawings on clothing, purses, bag, backpacks, personal belongings**,** or on the body are prohibited. Clothing and accessories with inappropriate advertising or statements that are lewd, offensive, vulgar, obscene, or defamatory (e.g., alcoholic beverages, sex, tobacco, politics, drugs, gangs, weapons/ammunition, etc.) are also prohibited.
8. Students shall cover private areas of the body by wearing appropriate undergarments. Undergarments should not be visible.
9. No torn or ripped clothing of any kind is allowed.
10. No head gear (e.g., hats, caps, skullcaps, scarves, bandanas) of any kind are to be worn or brought to school unless approved by the school principal for a special occasion, program, or unless there is a medical or religious justification.
11. No sunglasses are to be worn in the building.
12. Dangling chains will not be permitted. This includes chains attached to wallets, purses, footwear and backpacks.
13. Body piercing jewelry/accessories is prohibited. Ear piercing is acceptable. Mouth grills are not allowed.
14. All exposed/visible tattoos shall be covered at all times.
15. The District prohibits gang-related attire, or attire that is determined by the school's principal or designee to be gang-related or, in reasonable probability, would be considered as gang-related.
16. Belts are recommended but not required.

The principal or other administrator shall notify students and parents regarding the implementation of the standardized dress policy at least 90 days prior to the effective date.

If approved by the Superintendent or designee, the principal shall be authorized to allow all or part of the student body to vary from the standardized dress requirements and establish a particular mode of attire for special occasion days or for particular school-sponsored or school-related activities (maximum one designated day per week). In extenuating circumstances, this period may be extended at the discretion of the Superintendent or designee.

Students who are new to the District shall be excused from wearing a school standardized dress for a maximum of five school days to allow them to make arrangements in acquiring the standardized dress components. In extenuating circumstances, this period may be extended at the discretion of the Superintendent or designee.

If approved by the Superintendent or designee, the principal, in cooperation with the sponsor, coach, or other person in charge of an extracurricular activity, may regulate the dress and grooming of students who participate in the activity. Students who violate dress and grooming standards established for such an activity may be removed or excluded from the activity for a period determined by the principal or sponsor, and may be subject to other disciplinary action, as specified in the Student Code of Conduct. [See FO series]

These rules apply to all UISD campuses and facilities, and to any location off-campus where UISD students are receiving classroom instruction (i.e., official class field trips, internships, or other programs hosted at facilities other than UISD). The Disciplinary Alternative Education Program (i.e. STEP Academy) may establish additional standardized dress code guidelines.

SECTION III—Managing Student Behavior and Consequences of Inappropriate Conduct

Questioning Students: Students are expected to cooperate with administrative staff in the investigation of all District matters and to volunteer information within the students' knowledge. Administrators, teachers, and other professional personnel have the right to question students regarding their conduct, or the conduct of others, and are not required to contact parents/guardians prior to interviewing students. Students may be requested to submit a written statement describing their knowledge of an incident.

Student Discipline Action Form/Skyward Referral Submission/Skyward Discipline Letter: A teacher with knowledge that a student has violated the Student Code of Conduct shall submit to the school principal or other appropriate administrator an electronic/written report **Student Discipline Action Form**, (also known as a Skyward Referral Submission), documenting the violation. The principal or other administrator may employ alternative discipline management techniques, including progressive interventions. A student may be removed from class for a behavior that violates this Student Code of Conduct to maintain effective discipline in the classroom. Once the referral has been submitted, the principal or appropriate administrator shall notify the parent/guardian by telephone, or other appropriate means, that a violation of the Student Code of Conduct has been committed by the student. If attempts to reach the parent by telephone are unsuccessful, the administrator shall provide the student with a copy of the Student Discipline Action Form/Skyward Discipline Letter which will suffice for parent notification. The principal or other appropriate administrator shall, not later than 24 hours, if possible, send a copy of the Student Discipline Action Form/Skyward Discipline Letter to the student's parents or guardians. It is the student's responsibility to provide the parent/guardian with the copy of the Student Discipline Action Form/Skyward Discipline Letter.

Parental questions or complaints regarding disciplinary measures should be addressed to the teacher, campus administration as appropriate, and in accordance with policy FNG (LOCAL). A copy of the policy may be obtained from the principal's office, central administration office, or through www.uisd.net.

Notice to Parents: The campus administrator shall promptly notify a student's parent by phone or in person of any violation that may result in in-school or out-of-school suspension, placement in a DAEP, placement in a JJAEP, or expulsion. The campus administrator shall also notify a student's parent if the student is taken into custody by a law enforcement officer under the disciplinary provisions of the Education Code. A good faith effort shall be made on the day that action was taken to provide the student written notification of the disciplinary action for delivery by the student to his/her parent/guardian.

Before the principal or appropriate administrator assigns a student under 18 to detention outside regular school hours, notice shall be given to the student's parent to inform him or her of the reason for the detention and permit arrangement for necessary transportation.

Before suspending a student, placing a student in a Disciplinary Alternative Education Program, and/or recommending a student's expulsion, the principal or designee shall conduct an informal conference at which time:

1. The student is advised of the conduct with which he or she is charged; and
2. The student is given the opportunity to explain his or her version of the incident.

In the event that a school or District is closed due to a federal, state, or local closure and the District has transitioned to a virtual learning environment, all conferences and appeals related to student discipline shall take place via a virtual platform as to not deprive a student of any rights afforded by state or federal law.

Due Process Conference: After the District makes a good faith effort to inform the student and the student's parent/guardian of the time and place of the Due Process Conference, the District may hold the Due Process Conference, regardless of whether the student, the student's parent/guardian, or another adult representing the student attends. The final decision shall be communicated promptly to the student and parent/guardian.

Videotaping of Students: For safety purposes, video/audio equipment will be used to monitor student behavior at school activities/operations, District property, buses, by/on law enforcement vehicles/personnel and in common areas on campus and District. Students will not be told when the equipment is being used. The principal, law enforcement, other administrator, or appropriate District personnel may review the tapes routinely and document student misconduct. Discipline shall be imposed in accordance with the Student Code of Conduct.

Upon request of a parent of a student who receives special education services, a staff member, or a Board member, state law requires the District to place video and audio recording equipment in a classroom in which the student spends at least 50 percent of his or her instructional day, referred to by law as a self-contained classroom. The majority of students in this type of classroom must also be students who receive special education services. Before the District places a video camera in a classroom or other setting in which your child receives special education services, the District will provide notice to you. Please speak directly with the principal for further information or to request the installation and operation of this equipment.

A parent who wants to view a videotape of the incident leading to the discipline of his or her child may request access in writing. The Superintendent/designee shall consider the request and render a decision in accordance with Board Policy FL and the Family Education Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA) (20 USCA 1232g). School officials may then share video footage with a parent only if the video does not disclose personally identifiable information regarding another student.

Bullying and Harassment Violations: United ISD prohibits conduct that consists of bullying or harassment. In addition to the penalties and consequences set forth in this Student Code of Conduct, pursuant to state law, on the request of a parent or other person with authority to act on behalf of a student who is a victim of bullying, the Board of Trustees, or the Board's designee, may transfer a student who engaged in bullying to 1) another classroom at the campus to which the victim was assigned at the time the bullying occurred; or 2) a campus in the District other than the campus which the victim was assigned at the time the bullying occurred.

The Board of Trustees, or the Board's designee, shall verify that a student has been a victim of bullying before transferring the student under this section. A review of interventions, administrative remedies, as well as their outcome, will be taken in consideration before a transfer is made under this provision. Past student behavior may be considered when identifying a bully. The determination by the Board of Trustees, or the Board's designee, is final and may not be appealed. The District is not required to provide transportation to a student who transfers to another campus. There are no hearings and appeals for a transfer due to bullying behavior. Additional responsibilities or campus restrictions may be imposed upon a student who has engaged in bullying behavior or who is transferred to another campus due to bullying behavior.

Bullying (See Glossary) is a single significant act or a pattern of acts by one or more students directed at another student that exploits an imbalance of power and involves engaging in written or verbal expression, expression through electronic means, or physical conduct that:

(1) Has the effect or will have the effect of physical harming a student, damaging a student's property, or placing a student in reasonable fear of harm to the student's person or of damage to the student's property;
(2) Is sufficiently severe, persistent or pervasive enough that the action or threat creates an intimidating, threatening, or abusive educational environment for a student;
(3) Materially and substantially disrupts the educational process or the orderly operation of a classroom or school; or
(4) Infringes on the rights of the victim at school.

Bullying includes cyberbullying. (See below) This state law on bullying prevention applies to:

(1) Bullying that occurs on or is delivered to school property or to the site of a school-sponsored or school-related activity on or off school property;
(2) Bullying that occurs on a publicly or privately-owned school bus or vehicle being used for transportation of students to or from school or a school-sponsored or school-related activity.
(3) Cyberbullying that occurs off school property or outside of a school-sponsored or school-related activity if the cyberbullying interferes with a student's educational opportunities or substantially disrupts the orderly operation of a classroom, school, or school-sponsored or school related activity.

Bullying includes, but is not limited to, hazing, threats, taunting, teasing, confinement, assault, demands for money, destruction of property, theft of valued possessions, name-calling, rumor spreading, and ostracism.

The District prohibits retaliation by a student or District employee against any person who in good faith makes a report of bullying, serves as a witness, or participates in an investigation. Examples of retaliation may include: threats, rumor spreading, ostracism, assault, destruction of property, unjustified punishments, or unwarranted grade reductions. Unlawful retaliation does not include petty slights or annoyances.

A student who intentionally makes a false claim, offers false statements, or refuses to cooperate with a District investigation regarding bullying shall be subject to appropriate disciplinary action. [FFI (LOCAL)]

Although the District respects a student's right to freedom of expression under the First Amendment, a student maybe disciplined for conduct constituting Cyberbullying as defined in this Student Code of Conduct.

While on District property or at a District-sponsored event, students are prohibited from possessing, sending, forwarding, posting, accessing, or displaying electronic messages that are abusive, obscene, sexually oriented, threatening, harassing, damaging to another's reputation, or illegal, and result in a substantial disruption to the educational environment. This prohibition also applies to conduct off school property, regardless of who the equipment's owner is if it results in a substantial disruption to the educational environment.

Cyberbullying (see Glossary) is defined as bullying that is communicated through the use of any electronic device, including through the use of a cellular or other type of telephone, a computer, a camera, electronic mail, instant messaging, text messaging, a social media application, an Internet website, or any other Internet-based communication tool.

The District will punish any student via the Student Code of Conduct if the student engages in off-campus electronic communication that causes, or can cause, a substantial disruption or substantially interferes with the individual rights of others. The student may also face punishment via the Texas Penal Code, as applicable.

Any person taking, disseminating, transferring, possessing, or sharing obscene, sexually oriented, lewd, or otherwise illegal images or other content, commonly referred to as "sexting," will be disciplined according to the Student Code of Conduct, and may be required to complete an educational program related to the dangers of this type of behavior, and, in certain circumstances, may be reported to law enforcement. Because engaging in this type of behavior can lead to bullying or harassment, as well as possibly impede future endeavors of a student, we encourage you to review the Before You Text website with your child, a state-developed program that addresses the consequences of engaging in inappropriate behavior using technology.

United ISD ensures that District employees will enforce all prohibitions against bullying, harassment, and making hit lists. Additionally, options for managing students in the classroom and on school grounds, disciplining students, and preventing and intervening in student discipline problems, including bullying, harassment, and making hit lists are included in the United ISD personnel handbook. Federal and state laws regarding the discipline of students who are enrolled in a special education program apply. See Glossary to view "Hit List" definition.

Students/Parents who believe they have been harassed by another student, or by a District employee are encouraged to report the incident to a teacher, counselor, principal, administrator, and/or Director of Employee Relations/District Title IX Coordinator. The report may also be submitted on our District web page, www.uisd.net. Parents of the alleged victim will be notified by the third business day after an alleged incident of bullying is reported. School counselors may serve as an impartial resource for interpersonal conflicts and discord including accusations of bullying involving two or more students.

Social media is a general term used to reference sites and activity on sites like Facebook, YouTube, or any other virtual hub where users interact. Other popular social media sites include, but are not limited to: Instagram, Tumblr, Snapchat, X, LinkedIn, Wikipedia, Flickr, WordPress, FourSquare, etc. Although most postings are benevolent in nature, there are times postings by individuals may misconstrue the facts of an activity, event, student or staff. For information about a posting or questions about the operations of UISD schools, activities, events, students or staff, please contact your child's school or visit the UISD webpage at uisd.net, UISD Facebook, UISD Instagram, or UISD YouTube for the latest news/notices/alerts. We request all social media users to be responsible in their posting of any contents relating to UISD, students or staff. Postings may result in disciplinary action as per the Student Code of Conduct and/or may result in a

criminal offense(s) as per the Texas Penal Code, if such postings cause, or can cause, a substantial disruption or substantially interferes with the individual rights of others. In addition, UISD complies with SB 179 David's Law, which enforces policies related to cyberbullying prevention and mediation.

Positive Behavior Facilitators: The District has Positive Behavior Facilitators to work with students. They aim to build a school culture of socially acceptable behavior by focusing on a proactive approach to prevent inappropriate behavior by introducing, modeling, and reinforcing positive social behavior. To request assistance from a Positive Behavior Facilitator, contact your child's campus principal or other administrator.

Harassment On the Basis of Race, Color, Religion, National Origin, or Disability: Students must not engage in harassing behaviors directed toward another student which are motivated by race, color, religion, national origin, gender or disability. Bullying incidents which are determined to also be harassment based on a protected class status will also be handled in accordance with District policies regarding discrimination. See Glossary to view "Harassment" definition.

A student who believes he or she has experienced bullying and/or harassment or believes that another student has experienced bullying and/or harassment by another student or by a District employee should immediately report the alleged acts to a teacher, counselor, principal, administrator and/or the Director of Employee Relations/District Title IX Coordinator. The report may also be made by the student's parent. Allegations will be investigated and addressed pursuant to FFH (LOCAL) or FFI (LOCAL). To the greatest extent possible, complaints will be treated as confidential. Limited disclosure may be necessary to complete a thorough investigation.

If the results of an investigation indicate that bullying has occurred, the administration will take appropriate disciplinary action. Disciplinary or other action may be taken even if the conduct did not rise to the level of bullying. The District will also contact the parents of the victim and of the student(s) who was found to have engaged in bullying. Available counseling options will be provided to these individuals, as well as to any students who have been identified as witnesses to the bullying.

A student or his/her parent may appeal the decision of the principal or other administrator regarding the outcome of the investigation in accordance with policy FNG (LOCAL), FFH (LOCAL), and FFI (LOCAL).

Sexual Harassment / Sexual Abuse: The District encourages parental and student support in its efforts to address and prevent sexual harassment and sexual abuse in the public schools. Students and/or parents are encouraged to discuss their questions or concerns about the expectations in this area with a teacher, counselor, principal, administrator or the Director of Employee Relations/Title IX Coordinator in the Human Resources Department, Rita Garner (956) 473-6351 for matters relating to employee-on-student harassment and/or discrimination. Contact the Student Services Manager/Title IX Coordinator Michelle Farias at (956) 473-6108, for matters relating to student-on-student harassment and/or discrimination. The District shall provide child abuse anti-victimization programs in elementary and secondary schools [Education Code 38.004(b)]. The programs will address the likely warning signs of child sexual abuse; methods for preventing child sexual abuse; actions that a child who is a victim of child sexual abuse should take to obtain assistance and intervention; and available counseling options for students affected by sexual abuse. For more information regarding the District's child abuse anti-victimization programs, or if a parent or student would like additional information, please contact the Director of Guidance and Counseling, or the school counselor at the student's home campus.

As a parent, it is important for you to be aware of warning signs that could indicate a child may have been or is being sexually abused. Sexual abuse in the Texas Family Code is defined as any sexual conduct harmful to a child's mental, emotional, or physical welfare, as well as a failure to make a reasonable effort to prevent sexual conduct with a child. Anyone who suspects that a child has been, or may be abused or neglected has a legal responsibility, under state law, for reporting the suspected abuse or neglect to law enforcement or to Child Protective Services (CPS) within 24 hours.

Possible physical warning signs of sexual abuse could be difficulty sitting or walking, pain in the genital areas, and claims of stomachaches and headaches. Behavioral indicators may include verbal references or pretend games of sexual activity between adults and children, fear of being alone with adults of a particular gender, or sexually suggestive behavior. Emotional warning signs to be aware of include withdrawal, depression, sleeping and eating disorders, and problems in school.

A child who has experienced sexual abuse should be encouraged to seek out a trusted adult. Be aware as a parent or other trusted adult that disclosures of sexual abuse may be more indirect than disclosures of physical abuse, and it is important to be calm and comforting if your child, or another child, confides in you. Reassure the child that he or she did the right thing by telling you.

As a parent, if your child is a victim of sexual abuse, the campus counselor or principal or other administrator will provide information regarding counseling options for you and your child available in your area. The following Web sites might help you become more aware of child abuse and neglect:

- https://www.childwelfare.gov/pubs/factsheets/whatiscan.pdf
- http://kidshealth.org/en/parents/child-abuse.html
- http://taasa.org/resources-2/
- https://www.texasattorneygeneral.gov/cvs/what-we-can-do-about-childabuse-1
- https://www.texasattorneygeneral.gov/cvs/what-we-can-do-about-childabuse-2

Reports may be made to the Child Protective Services (CPS) division of the Texas Department of Family & Protective Services (1-800-252-5400 or on the Web at http://www.txabusehotline.org).

Complaints: The District has designated the following individual to coordinate its efforts to comply with Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972 which pertains to sexual discrimination or sexual harassment complaints for matters relating to employee-on-student harassment and/or discrimination:

Name: Rita Garner Position: Director of Employee Relations
Address: 301 Lindenwood Drive, Laredo, Texas 78045 Telephone: (956) 473-6351 Email: rgarner@uisd.net

The District has designated the following individual to coordinate its efforts to comply with Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972 which pertains to sexual discrimination or sexual harassment complaints for matters relating to student-on-student harassment and/or discrimination:

Name: Michelle Lee Farias Position: Student Services Manager/Title IX Coordinator
Address: 201 Lindenwood Drive, Laredo, Texas 78045 Telephone: (956) 473-6108 Email: mlfarias@uisd.net

All complaints will be investigated. A substantiated complaint against a student will result in appropriate disciplinary action, depending upon the nature of the offense and according to the Student Code of Conduct.

The parent or other advisor may accompany the student throughout the complaint and investigation process. Depending upon the circumstances, the investigation shall be coordinated, if necessary, through the Texas Department of Family and Protective Services (Child Protective Services), Children's Advocacy Center of Webb County-Laredo, the Webb County District Attorney's Office, the Laredo Police Department, the UISD Police Department, other law enforcement agencies, and District Administration, according to the District's Administrative Procedures.

The student will not be required to present a complaint to a person who is the subject of the complaint.

General Guidelines for Assessing Discipline Penalties: District personnel shall adhere to the following general guidelines when imposing discipline:

1. A student shall be disciplined when necessary to improve the student's behavior, to maintain essential order, or to protect other students, school employees, or property.
2. Students shall be treated fairly and equitably. Discipline shall be based on a careful assessment of the circumstances of each case. Factors to consider shall include:
   a. Seriousness of the offense;
   b. Student's age;
   c. Grade level;
   d. Frequency of misconduct;
   e. Student's attitude;
   f. Potential effect of the misconduct on the school environment;
   g. Statutory requirements of Chapter 37 of the Education Code;
   h. A disability that substantially impairs the student's capacity to appreciate the wrongfulness of the student's conduct;
   i. District's Administrative Procedures for Discipline; and
   j. The Student Code of Conduct adopted by the Board.

Because of these factors, discipline for a particular offense may bring into consideration varying techniques and responses. In a decision to order suspension, removal to a disciplinary alternative education program, expulsion, or placement in a juvenile justice alternative education program, regardless of whether the decision concerns a mandatory or discretionary action, consideration will be given to:

1. Self-defense;
2. Intent or lack of intent at the time the student engaged in the conduct;
3. A student's disciplinary history;
4. A disability that substantially impairs the student's capacity to appreciate the wrongfulness of the student's conduct;
5. A student's status in the conservatorship of the Department of Family and Protective Services; or
6. A student's status as a student who is homeless (see Glossary).

Generally, academic sanctions shall not be used as discipline. However, when the disciplinary infraction is academically related, such as Academic Dishonesty (see Glossary), cheating or plagiarism, academic sanctions determined by the teacher may be imposed.

Discipline Management Techniques: Discipline shall be designed to improve conduct and to encourage students to adhere to their responsibilities as members of the school community. Disciplinary action will draw on the professional judgment of teachers and administrators and on a range of discipline management techniques, including restorative discipline practices. Discipline will be correlated to the seriousness of the offense, the student's age and grade level, the frequency of misbehavior, the student's attitude, the effect of the misconduct on the school environment, and statutory requirements. Because of these factors, discipline for a particular offense (unless otherwise specified by law) may bring into consideration varying techniques and responses. The District shall not engage in any "aversive technique" as defined by Texas Education Code §37.0023.

Please note: Discipline Management techniques may be applied to an individual student or a group of students such as, but not limited to, an organization, team, classroom, or students in a particular grade level and with appropriate due process to each individual student, if applicable and appropriate.

Students with Disabilities: The discipline of students with disabilities is subject to applicable state and federal law in addition to the Student Code of Conduct. To the extent any conflict exists, state and/or federal law will prevail. In accordance with the Education Code, a student who receives special education services may not be disciplined in a manner that results in a change in the student's educational placement for conduct meeting the definition of bullying, cyberbullying, harassment, or making hit lists until an ARD committee meeting has been held to review the conduct. In deciding whether to order suspension, DAEP placement, or expulsion, regardless of whether the

action is mandatory or discretionary, the District shall take into consideration a disability that substantially impairs the student's capacity to appreciate the wrongfulness of the student's conduct.

Techniques: The following discipline management techniques may be used – alone, in combination, or as part of progressive interventions – for behavior prohibited by the Student Code of Conduct or by campus or classroom rules:

1. **Verbal/written correction.**
2. **"Time-out" or Cooling-off time.** Time-out means a behavior management technique in which, to provide a student with an opportunity to regain self-control, the student is separated from other students for a limited period in a setting that is not locked and from which the exit is not physically blocked by furniture, a closed door held shut from the outside, or another inanimate object.
3. **Seating changes within the classroom.**
4. **Confiscation of items** that disrupt the educational process or items being sold/given without administrative permission. Confiscated items (i.e. perishable items) may be discarded by administration.
5. **Rewards and incentives.**
6. **Demerits.**
7. **Behavioral contracts.**
8. **Counseling by teachers, counselors, special services (i.e. Facilitator), or administrative personnel**.
9. **Participation in peer conflict resolution or mediation proceedings.**
10. **Parent-teacher conferences.**
11. **Grade reductions,** as determined by policy for cheating, plagiarism and as otherwise permitted by Board Policies EIA (LOCAL) and FO (LOCAL). Grade penalties on major projects and exams must be approved by the campus administration.
12. **Detention.** For violations of the Student Code of Conduct or other policies and regulations, teachers may detain students after school hours. Before assigning students to detention, the teacher will get approval from the campus administration for the detention to be assigned. The teacher shall inform the student of the conduct that allegedly constitutes the violation, and the student shall be given an opportunity to explain his or her version of the incident. The period of time for which a teacher assigns a student to detention shall be used for educational purposes. When detention is assigned, notice shall first be given to the student's parent or legal guardian to inform the parent of the reason for the detention and permit arrangements for the necessary transportation. Except in the case of a student who is 18 or older, the detention shall not begin until the parent has been notified. If the student uses school transportation, the student's parent/guardian, may be required to provide personal transportation when the student has been assigned to detention.
13. **Sending the student to the office or other assigned areas**.
14. **Assigned school duties other than class tasks,** including such tasks as cleaning or picking up litter.
15. **Withdrawal of privileges,** including, but not limited to, participation in extracurricular activities and **eligibility** for seeking or holding honorary positions or membership in school-sponsored clubs and organizations. Extracurricular activities include, but are not limited to, field trips, commencement exercises, prom, spring dances, or school programs as long as it is not an educational activity which would be an extension of the classroom TEKS objectives.
16. **Penalties** identified in individual student organizations' extracurricular standards of behavior.
17. **Withdrawing or restricting bus privileges.** However, transportation privileges may be taken away from a student with disabilities only if transportation is not determined to be necessary as a related service or if modification of the Individualized Education Program (IEP) by the ARD or Section 504 Committee occurs. A change in transportation services for a student with a disability for whom transportation is a related service requires ARD Committee action; likewise, a change in transportation services for Section 504 students for whom transportation is a related service requires Section 504 Committee action.
18. **School-assessed and school-administered probation.**
19. **Suspension:** Students may be suspended for any offense listed in this Code. The principal or designee shall consider reasonable alternatives, including appropriate discipline management techniques. If the principal or designee determines a suspension is the most appropriate consequence, no other disciplinary action need precede the suspension (in-school or out of school). Before being suspended a student will have an informal conference with the appropriate administrator who shall advise the student of the conduct of which he or she is accused. The student will be given the opportunity to explain his or her version of the incident before the administrator's decision is made. The number of days of a student's suspension will be determined by the appropriate administrator. The administrator will determine any restrictions on participation in school-sponsored or school-related extracurricular and co-curricular activities.

    Teachers are to inform students of the time allotted for completion of their work during a suspension. Students are responsible for obtaining the assignments and completing the work within the time allotted, and students are allowed to make up both class work and homework. Students shall receive full credit for assignments completed during Suspension. Students who are suspended will be offered an opportunity to complete coursework before the beginning of the next school year. Available methods to complete coursework include, but are not limited to, correspondence courses, distance learning, or summer school.

    a. **In-School Suspension.** Students may be placed in In-School Suspension for engaging in any Level I or Level II Offenses as described and set forth in this Student Code of Conduct. Additionally, students may be placed in In-School Suspension pending DAEP placement or expulsion. The principal or designee will make a reasonable attempt to inform parents that the student is being placed in In-School-Suspension. A school's principal or other appropriate administrator shall review the In-School Suspension of student at least once every 10 school days after the date the suspension begins to evaluate the educational progress of the student and to determine if continued In-School Suspension is appropriate. If the principal or other administrator

determines that continued In-School Suspension is appropriate, the principal or other appropriate administrator shall document the determination. A school shall provide a student subject to In-School Suspension with appropriate behavioral support services and comparable educational services as the student would receive in the classroom. If the student receives special education services under Subchapter A, Chapter 29, the student must: (1) continue to receive special education and related services specified in the student's individualized education program; and (2) continue to have an opportunity to progress in general curriculum.

b. Out-of-School Suspension: Students may not be assigned to Out-of-School Suspension for Level I (Minor) Offenses. For offenses at Level II and above, students may be assigned to Out-of-School Suspension for a maximum of 3 school days per behavior violation. Additionally, students may be suspended pending DAEP placement or expulsion. A principal or other appropriate administrator may suspend a student prior to (but not in lieu of) placement in a Disciplinary Alternative Education Program or prior to (but not in lieu of) expulsion, where a student's conduct requires such placement or expulsion.

Parents of students who have been suspended are hereby advised that it is their responsibility to provide adequate supervision for the student during the period of suspension.

Before being suspended a student shall have an informal conference with the appropriate administrator who shall advise the student of the conduct of which he or she is accused. The student shall be given the opportunity to explain his or her version of the incident before the administrator's decision is made.

The number of days of a student's suspension shall be determined by the appropriate administrator, but shall not exceed three school days per behavior violation.

The student who is assigned to Out-of-School Suspension is not allowed on the home campus or any other school campus or at any school-related activity, including but not limited to, in-town or out of town District games or events during the period of suspension. If a student violates the prohibition on District property, the student can be charged with Trespass on School Grounds, a Class C misdemeanor, pursuant to Texas Education Code §37.107.

The District shall not use Out-of-School Suspension for students in grade 2 or below or a student who is homeless (see Glossary) unless the conduct meets the requirements established in law. A student in grade 2 or below or a student who is homeless (see Glossary) shall not be placed in Out-of-School Suspension unless, while on school property or while attending a school-sponsored or school-related activity on or of school property, the student engages in: (1) conduct that contains the elements of a weapons offense, as provided in Texas Penal Code Section 46.02 or 46.05; (2) conduct that threatens the immediate health and safety of other students in the classroom; (3) documented conduct that results in repeated or significant disruption to the classroom; or (4) selling, giving, or delivering to another person or possessing, using, or being under the influence of any amount of marijuana or a controlled substance, as defined by Chapter 481, Health and Safety Code, or by 21 U.S.C. Section 801 et seq.; an alcoholic beverage, as defined by Section 1.04, Alcoholic Beverage Code; or a dangerous drug as defined by Chapter 483, Health and Safety Code.

On receiving a written request from the student's parent or person standing parental relation to the student, the principal or other appropriate administrator may at their sole discretion reassign a student in grade 2 or below placed in Out-of-School Suspension to an In-School-Suspension if the student's parent or person standing in parental relation to the student demonstrates through supporting information and documentation that the parent or person is unable to provide suitable supervision for the student during school hours during the period of the suspension. This In-School-Suspension may be used only in extenuating circumstances and may not be used as a routine placement for Out-of-School Suspension. The District shall maintain documentation of each reassignment, including the parent's or person's request, the reason for the parent's or person's unavailability, and the supporting information and documentation.

20. **Parent Shadowing.** This is when a parent escorts his/her child for a specified period of time during school hours. The parent must meet Visitor guidelines and will be processed through the District's Raptor system. (See Visitors on Campus in the Student Handbook).
21. **Placement at a Disciplinary Alternative Education program (DAEP).** The procedures in the subsequent sections on DAEP will be followed.
22. **Referral to outside agency** (i.e. school-community programs) **or legal authority** for criminal prosecution in addition to disciplinary measures imposed by the District.
23. **Referral to Police Department.** UISD has its own police force, which is in operation 24 hours a day. The officers work closely with the Laredo Police Department to assist at all UISD campuses and school-related functions. They will investigate acts of vandalism, burglary, disruption, or any act that would be considered a violation of the law or harmful to UISD schools, staff or students. The UISD police officers are commissioned and have authority to arrest violators of the law, both on and off campuses. They may also issue citations for violations of the Penal Code. When a student is arrested or receives a citation, that student may be required to appear in court and may receive other consequences imposed by the legal system as a result of these events. Certain acts of misconduct may constitute criminal offenses in addition to violations of the Student Code of Conduct. Because school discipline is independent of criminal proceedings, disciplinary consequences will not be postponed pending the outcome of any criminal proceeding or affected by the outcome of any criminal proceeding. Any person wishing to contact the UISD Police Department may call (956) 473-6361. For Police duties, please see Board Policy CKE (LOCAL).
24. **Removal from regular educational setting or reassignment to another classroom:** In addition to other discipline management techniques, misconduct may result in removal from the regular educational setting in the form of a routine referral submission or a formal removal. A teacher or administrator **may** remove a student from class for behavior that violates this Code to maintain

effective discipline in the classroom and school activity/environment. A bus driver that is transporting students to or from school, or a school-sponsored or school-related activity, may initiate a formal removal. The bus driver is allowed to send the student to the principal's or other appropriate administrator's office in order to maintain discipline on the bus. The school principal or designee will be required to respond by employing appropriate disciplinary management techniques consistent with the Student Code of Conduct. Students with disabilities may not be removed in violation of specific IEP/IAP provisions or for more than ten days without an ARD/504 Committee review.

a. Routine Referral Submission

i. A routine referral submission occurs when a teacher/school employee submits to the principal or other appropriate administrator a Student Discipline Action Form (a/k/a Skyward Referral Submission) as a discipline management technique in order to maintain effective discipline in the classroom or school activity/environment. The principal or administrator shall employ appropriate discipline management techniques, including progressive interventions consistent with this Student Code of Conduct. A teacher or administrator may remove a student from class for behavior that violates the Student Code of Conduct to maintain effective discipline in the classroom.

b. Formal Removal

i. A teacher **may** initiate a formal removal from class if:
   (1) The student repeatedly interferes with the teacher's ability to communicate effectively with the students in the class or with the student's classmates' ability to learn;
   (2) Demonstrates behavior that is unruly, disruptive, or abusive toward the teacher, another adult, or another student; or
   (3) Engages in conduct that constitutes bullying, as defined by TEC Section 37.0832.

ii. A teacher, campus behavior coordinator, or other appropriate administrator shall notify a parent or person standing in parental relation to a student of the removal of a student under this section.

iii. Subject to TEC Sections 28.002(a)(2) and (d), a teacher may remove a student from class based on a single incident of behavior described in subsection (b)(i) above.

iv. **Conference and Review Requirements for Removal Under Subsection (b):** When a student is removed from the regular classroom by a teacher under subsection (b) and a conference is pending, the principal or campus administrator may place the student in another appropriate classroom, In-School Suspension, Out-of-School Suspension, or a disciplinary alternative education program as provided by TEC Section 37.008. The student may not be returned to the regular classroom pending the conference and the teacher's written consent unless the committee established under TEC Section 37.003 determines that such placement is the best or only alternative available and not later than the third school day after the day on which the student was removed from class, a conference in which the teacher had been provided an opportunity to participate has been held in accordance with TEC Section 37.009(a). The principal may not return the student to that teacher's class unless the teacher provides written consent for the student's return or a return to class plan has been prepared for that student. The principal may only designate an employee of the school whose primary duties do not include classroom instruction to create a return to class plan. A return to class plan must be created before or at the conference. A return to class plan created before the conference must be discussed at the conference.

v. **Conference and Review Requirements for Students Removed from Class:** No later than the third class day after the day in which the student is removed from the class by the teacher under TEC Section 37.002(d), or by the principal or other appropriate administrator under TEC Section 37.006 or TEC Section 37.007, the principal or other appropriate administrator shall schedule a conference among the principal or other appropriate administrator, a parent/guardian of the student, the teacher, in the case of a removal by the teacher, and the student. At the conference, the student is entitled to written or oral notice of the misconduct, an explanation of the basis for the removal, and the consequences. The student shall have an opportunity to present his/her version of the incident. Following the conference, and whether or not all requested parties are in attendance-after valid attempts to require their attendance, the principal or other appropriate administrator shall order the placement of the student as provided by TEC Sections 37.003, 37.006, or 37.007, as applicable, for a period consistent with the Student Code of Conduct. If the period of the placement is inconsistent with the guidelines included in the Student Code of Conduct regarding how the length of placement will be determined, the order will give notice of this inconsistency.

vi. **Returning Student to Classroom:** When a student has been formally removed from class by a teacher for conduct against the teacher containing the elements of assault, aggravated assault, sexual assault, aggravated sexual assault, murder, capital murder, criminal attempt to commit murder, capital murder, or any offense listed in TEC Section 37.007(a)(2)(A) or (a)(4), the student may not be returned to the teacher's class without the teacher's written consent. The teacher may not be coerced to consent.

   When a student has been formally removed by a teacher for any other conduct, the principal or other administrator may return the student to the teacher's class, without the teacher's consent, if the Placement Review Committee determines that the teacher's class is the best or only alternative available. The terms of the removal may prohibit the student from attending or participating in school-sponsored or school-related activities.

vii. **Student Appeals:** A student may appeal the student's removal from class under this section to the school's Placement Review Committee or the campus's threat assessment and safe supportive school team established under TEC Section 37.115, in accordance with a District policy providing for such an appeal to be made to the team. The principal, campus behavior coordinator, or other appropriate administrator shall, at the conference required under TEC Section 37.009(a), notify a student who has been removed from class under this section and the parent of or person standing in parental relation to the student.

25. Expulsion: The procedures in the subsequent sections on Expulsion will be followed.

26. **Physical Restraint:** Restraint means the use of physical force or a mechanical device to significantly restrict the free movement of all or a portion of a student's body. If a student is receiving Special Education Services, then the student shall be restrained in accordance with state and federal laws. Within the scope of an employee's duties, a District employee may physically restrain a student if the employee reasonably believes restraint is necessary in order to:
    1. Protect a person, including the person using physical restraint, from physical injury or self-injury.
    2. Obtain possession of a weapon or other dangerous object.
    3. Prevent a student from fleeing.
    4. Protect property from serious damage.
    5. Remove from a specific location a student refusing a lawful command of a school employee, including from a classroom or other school property, in order to restore order or impose disciplinary measures.
    6. Control an irrational student.
27. **Other strategies and consequences** as determined by school officials including but not limited to Saturday School, Uniting Families, parenting sessions, ROPES Challenge Course, cleaning tasks, community service-in/out of school, etc.

SECTION IV—INAPPROPRIATE CONDUCT

In order to maintain effective discipline in the classroom and school activities/environment, inappropriate conduct, as mentioned in this Code, will result in the completion of a Student Discipline Action Form (also known as a Skyward Discipline Letter).

Notification: The campus administrator shall promptly notify a student's parent by phone or in person of any violation that may result in In-School Suspension or Out-of-School Suspension, placement in a DAEP, placement in a JJAEP, or expulsion. The campus administrator shall also notify a student's parent if the student is taken into custody by a law enforcement officer under the disciplinary provisions of the Education Code. A good faith effort shall be made on the day that action was taken to provide to the student for delivery to the student's parent written notification of the disciplinary action.

Before the principal or appropriate administrator assigns a student under 18 to detention outside regular school hours, notice shall be given to the student's parent to inform him or her of the reason for the detention and permit arrangement for necessary transportation.

Appeals: Parental questions or complaints regarding disciplinary measures should be addressed to the teacher, campus administration as appropriate, and in accordance with policy FNG (LOCAL). Consequences will not be deferred pending the outcome of a grievance/hearing. In the event that a school or District is closed due to a federal, state, or local closure and the District has transitioned to a virtual learning environment, all conferences and appeals related to student discipline shall take place via a virtual platform as to not deprive a student of any rights afforded by state or federal law.

Parental Involvement in Disciplinary Placements: The District offers Behavioral Agreements for students placed in DAEP all of which require parental involvement. The U FIRST program, Uniting Families parenting sessions, and a Perfect Attendance Incentive are currently some strategies to assist students in modifying their placement at DAEP. The District will consider modifying these programs to comply with the newly enacted TEC Section 37.0014 in the very near future. Certain conditions apply for a student to qualify for these programs.

LEVEL I—Minor Offenses:

The following offenses are prohibited at school or school-related activities and may be punishable by In-School Suspension, detention, Saturday school, assignment of school duties other than class tasks, withdrawal of extracurricular or honorary privileges, or any other discipline management techniques listed in Section III of this Code, as determined by the campus principal or other administrator. Students who engage in conduct as described in this section shall be subject to disciplinary action in accordance with State law and local Board policy.

Disregard for Authority:

1. Insubordination which includes failure to comply with directives given by District/school personnel.
2. Cheating or copying work of another student, plagiarism, such as, but not limited to Artificial Intelligence (AI), and unauthorized communication between students during an examination or work assigned by the teacher/administrator.
3. Without permission, not being at assigned/designated area, leaving/attempting to leave classes, leaving/attempting to leave a school sponsored activity/event or attempting to leave school grounds during instructional time.
4. Dishonesty to a Staff Member: Attempting to make a person believe as true something false which includes, but is not limited to, failing to disclose information, distorting text, images, and videos by the use of media applications, hiding/covering up information or evidence regarding oneself or others, or giving a false name or identification, documentation, or information.
5. Loitering or trespassing on school grounds before the first bell and after the last bell. Students should be on campus for an educationally related purpose, such as tutorials or extracurricular activities. Students who are waiting for a ride home shall not be considered to be loitering.
6. Refusal to cooperate in, or failure to follow health, safety, or social distancing guidelines (e.g., hand washing, wearing face mask, failure to report illness-especially an infectious or contagious disease-example COVID-19, disinfecting or cleaning work area, sanitizing equipment, etc.).

Misuse of Personal Communication/Electronic Devices:

7. Using a personal communication device on District property/facilities is prohibited and on all District campuses during school hours (first bell to last bell). **The school is not responsible if these items are lost, broken, damaged, or stolen.** Examples of personal communication devices include, but are not limited to, cellular telephones, iPads, personal computers, iPods, smart watches, smart glasses, smart rings, e-readers, tablets, chromebooks, or any other communication device which has networking and/or telecommunication or digital communication capabilities.

8. Using or exhibiting an electronic device, such as stereos, headsets, portable speakers, electronic games, iPods (without communication capabilities), Zune, MP3, or CD players, and accessories (including earbuds and/or AirPods) are prohibited during school hours (first bell to last bell). Devices and accessories must be turned off and cannot be visible. **The school is not responsible if these items are lost, broken, damaged, or stolen. Items are subject to confiscation by administration.**

Safety Transgressions:

9. Engaging in conduct that constitutes a disruption of classes or lawful assemblies, activities, or transportation.
10. Engaging in any other conduct that disrupts the school environment or educational process that the principal or designee determines is a minor offense.

Miscellaneous Offenses:

11. Engaging in inappropriate affection (e.g., kissing).
12. Violating dress code and grooming standards as communicated in the Student Code of Conduct.
13. Unless authorized by the school principal/designee, students are prohibited from bringing or possessing on campus/school activity any object, gadget, or item that has no educational purpose and/or may distract from teaching and learning (e.g., spinner, ball, yoyo, slime, sticky hands, etc.). (Exception: The object is an educational need as documented in the student's accommodation plan).
14. Distributing, selling, or trading any item on campus not authorized by the principal or providing a service/skill without proper certification/license (e.g., haircut, nails, etc.).

Possession of Prohibited Items:

15. Possessing or using matches or a lighter.

Mistreatment of Others:

16. Communicating in a non-confrontational manner with another student using profanity or vulgar language or making obscene gestures.

Confiscation of Personal Communication Devices: A "personal communication device" means a telephone, cellular phone such as a smartphone or flip phone, tablet, iPad, smartwatch, smart glasses, smart ring, radio device, paging device, or any other electronic device (e.g., personal computer, laptop, e-reader, non-district-issued Chromebook) or accessory (e.g., AirPods, wireless headphones, etc.) capable of telecommunication or digital communication. A "personal communication device" does not include an electronic device provided to a student by UISD. The use of and access to personal communication devices is prohibited on all UISD campuses, buses, and facilities during the school day as well as school-sponsored events or school-related activities that occur during the school day (first bell to last bell-read Bring Your Own Device Handbook and excerpt below for further information). In accordance with TEC §37.082(c), certain students with documented exceptions shall be allowed to be in possession of a personal communication device. While on school property during the school day, all students shall turn off and store personal communication devices in their own student backpacks. The school is not responsible if personal communication devices are lost, broken, damaged, or stolen. Use or possession of any personal communication device(s) will result in confiscation and other disciplinary actions and consequences. On the first offense, if any personal communication device is visible during the school day (e.g., being used or not stored away), the device will be confiscated until the end of the school day, the incident will be entered into Skyward, and the student must complete a behavior contract. On the second offense, if any personal communication device is visible during the school day (e.g., being used or not stored away), the device will be confiscated for one school day, the incident will be entered into Skyward, and the student will be assigned to detention. On the third and subsequent offenses, if any personal communication device is visible during the school day (e.g., being used or not stored away), the personal communication device will be confiscated and returned only after an in-person meeting with the principal, parent, and student has taken place; additionally, the incident will be entered into Skyward, and the student will be assigned up to three days of In-School Suspension (ISS) or Out-of-School Suspension (OSS) or other consequences imposed by school administration for continued refusal to follow the policy (e.g., removal of privileges, personal communication device prohibition on campus/district property for the remainder of the school year, DAEP placement, etc.). Failure to comply with confiscation protocols and refusal to surrender the personal communication device will be considered defiant behavior and subject to receiving additional and/or more severe consequences (e.g., suspension from school and/or DAEP placement) in accordance with the code of conduct. Parents shall be notified after the personal communication device has been confiscated. On the first offense, the personal communication device may be retrieved on the same day it was confiscated, but not on the same day it was confiscated for the second and subsequent offenses. Only the parent/guardian may retrieve the personal communication device from the school's administrative or designee's office after school on the designated school day stated above. If a personal communication device is not retrieved within 90 calendar days of receiving a written notice, the District may dispose of the personal communication device in accordance with the law. A personal communication device will not be disposed of prior to a parent receiving 90 calendar days' prior notice in writing of UISD's intent to dispose of that personal communication device.

Bring Your Own Device (BYOD)

UISD highly encourages students to participate in the District 1:1 Mobile Learning Device (MLD) Program to use for educational purposes in grades EC-12. Students may only use a district-issued device with their district-issued credentials with access for this device on the UISD Network during the school day. When away from district property before or after the school day, access may be secured on a personal home network/hotspot that will still connect the device to the district's secure/filtered system. Access on the district device will allow students to sign on to online curriculum, textbooks, programs, and related resources.

Effective the first day of class for the 2025-2026 school year, students are not permitted to use any personal computing and communication devices during the course of the school day including off-campus events during the school day pursuant to Texas Education Code §37.082. As such, the Bring Your Own Device (BYOD) Network will no longer be available for students nor will personal hotspots be allowed. The only authorized and allowable exemptions are for Special Education students whose use of personal communication devices is subject to approval by the Admission, Review and Dismissal (ARD) Committee and documented in their Individualized Education Programs (IEPs),

for Section 504 students with an Individualized Accommodation Plan (IAP), and/or for students with an Individualized Healthcare Plan (IHP) if such use or access is directly related to their medical condition or academic disability. Students will be expected to refrain from the use of any unauthorized personal communication device(s) or be subject to disciplinary consequences and/or confiscation of the device(s) in accordance with the District's Student Code of Conduct.

Consequently, for students whose parents are not accepting participation in the 1:1 MLD Program, they will not be allowed to use personal communication devices (e.g., laptop, cellphone/hotspot, iWatch, tablet, etc.) during the course of the school day for the commission of daily instruction and related to on- or off-campus activities during the school day. Parents/guardians are advised that opting out of the District MLD 1:1 Initiative will remove access and affect the students' use of such crucial digital instructional support as digital curriculum, instructional programs, textbooks, resources, assessments, state testing, college entrance exam prep and exams, industry certifications, dual credit courses, and college applications.

The use of personal hotspots is prohibited pursuant to Texas Education Code §37.082. Students who use personal MLDs and/or hotspots during the course of a school day or while participating in or attending a District event during the school day will be subject to corresponding disciplinary action and/or confiscation of the device(s) as delineated in the District's Student Code of Conduct.

Extenuating Circumstances with Confiscated Devices: If a personal communication device is involved in an ongoing disciplinary investigation, the device may be confiscated in order to perform a lawful search and may be held until the outcome of the investigation is finalized. In addition, the confiscated device may be turned over to law enforcement to determine whether a crime has been committed. Any searches of personal telecommunications or other personal electronic devices will be conducted in accordance with the law.

Additionally, any use of personal communication devices (including but not limited to: cellular phones, smart watches, smart glasses, smart rings, devices with AI capabilities, or any device capable of telecommunication or digital communication) during state testing or assessments can result in the invalidation of the student's test scores. The campus administration will investigate all reports of inappropriate use of these devices prior to taking any action regarding student test scores.

LEVEL II—Serious Offenses:

The following actions constitute "serious misbehavior" where that term appears in this Student Code of Conduct. These offenses are prohibited at school or school-related activities and will be punishable by Out-of-School Suspension, detention, In-School Suspension, Saturday school, assignment of duties other than class tasks, withdrawal of extracurricular or honorary privileges, or any other discipline management techniques listed in Section III of this Code, as determined by the campus principal or other administrator. These offenses are considered to be more serious than Level I Minor Offenses listed above. Thus, in most cases, the offenses listed in this section will warrant greater consequences than those listed in the Level I Minor Offenses section. (Example: serious offenses should warrant a greater number of days spent in In-School Suspension than minor offenses).

In some cases, the offenses listed in this section may also meet the definition of conduct which warrants Disciplinary Alternative Education Program (DAEP) placement. For instance, some of the offenses listed in this section also constitute "engaging in conduct that is punishable as a felony," which is a mandatory DAEP offense. Additionally, some of the offenses listed in this section (depending on the nature and severity of the incident in question) might be considered so severe that they constitute conduct that "substantially interferes with the orderly operation of the campus" or with the "teacher's ability to communicate effectively." If this occurs, the offense in question is elevated to a Level III offense, and the campus administration may consider DAEP placement. Additionally, possession of weapons or firearms, in most circumstances, is punishable under a higher-level offense. **A copy of the Disciplinary Alternative Education Program placement will be delivered to the authorized officer of the juvenile court in which the student resides as mandated by the Texas Education Code under Section 37.010(a).**

For those students who are already in the Disciplinary Alternative Education Program (DAEP), the offenses listed in this section may be grounds for expulsion.

Disregard for Authority:

1. Refusal to accept discipline management techniques assigned by District/school personnel.
2. Leaving or assisting someone in leaving campus/school grounds during instructional time by providing false information/document or by hiding, concealing, or falsifying their identity.
3. Refusal to cooperate in or interference with a search (e.g., random searches, backpack screenings, metal detector, vehicle, K-9, and/or fleeing or running away from school/district officials).
4. Intentionally engaging in conduct which may endanger someone's well-being, cause panic or fear especially during a pandemic or flu epidemic (e.g., intentionally spitting, breathing on, coughing, or touching others or their belongings which may lead them to believe you have spread germs which contain a contagious/infectious disease, COVID-19, etc.). Please note: This offense may meet the elements of a Discretionary/Mandatory DAEP Placement or Expulsion section of the Student Code of Conduct.

Property Offenses:

5. Committing or assisting in a robbery or theft or stealing on District property or while attending a school-sponsored or school-related activity on or off campus (e.g., theft that does not constitute a felony according to the Texas Penal Code).
6. Defacing or damaging a student's school assigned/designated locker (e.g., gym, athletic field house, band hall, cheer/dance studio, ROTC building, etc.) or other personal property.

Mistreatment of Others:

7. Engaging in verbal/written exchanges (e.g., name-calling, racial or ethnic slurs, or derogatory statements) that threaten the safety of another student, a District employee, or school property or that may disrupt the school environment or incite violence.

8. Fighting (including, but not limited to, mutual combat, wrestling, boxing, play fighting, or rough-and-tumble play), scuffling, committing physical abuse (e.g., spitting or urinating), or threatening physical abuse (e.g., conduct that does not meet the definition of assault in Texas Penal Code Section 22.01(a)(1)).
9. General locker room horseplay and misconduct, including, but not limited to, shaving cream fights and involuntary/mutual physical contact.
10. Engaging in inappropriate, verbal, written, physical, or sexual conduct directed toward another person, including a District student, employee, or volunteer.
11. Engaging in conduct that constitutes sexual or gender-based harassment or sexual abuse, whether by word, gesture, or any other conduct that may include requests for sexual favors or other intimidating sexual conduct directed toward another person, including a District student, employee, board member, or volunteer.
12. Engaging in conduct that constitutes dating violence, including the intentional use of physical, sexual, verbal, or emotional abuse to harm, threaten, intimidate, or control another person with whom the student has or has had a dating relationship.
13. Committing extortion, coercion, or blackmail (e.g., obtaining money or other objects of value from an unwilling person, or forcing an individual to act using force or threat of force). (Please note: This offense may meet the elements of a Discretionary/Mandatory Placement or Expulsion section of the Student Code of Conduct.)
14. Harassment (as described in the Glossary)
15. Hazing (as described in the Glossary)
16. Bullying or Cyberbullying (See Glossary)

Safety Transgressions:

17. Engages in action or group demonstration that incites violence, substantially disrupts, or materially interferes with school activities.
18. Throwing objects which may or may not cause bodily injury or damage property.
19. Using or exhibiting school supplies (e.g., pencils, pens, scissors) or any other item in a manner that threatens to inflict or actually inflicts bodily harm to another person.
20. Engaging or assisting in making threats, either verbal, written, or electronic/digital exchanges, that threaten the safety of another student, a school employee, or school property.
21. Pulling a fire alarm or discharging a fire extinguisher as a prank in a building owned or operated by UISD when there is no smoke, fire, or danger that requires evacuation. If a student pulls a fire alarm, such offense is a State Jail Felony and constitutes a mandatory DAEP offense or a discretionary expulsion.
22. Calling 911 as a prank when no real emergency exists, making false statements/claims, or perpetrating hoaxes regarding school safety.

Possession of Prohibited Items:

23. Possessing, using, giving, or selling drug paraphernalia related to any prohibited substance (including, but not limited to: roach clips, rolling papers, needles, razor blades, or pipes).
24. Possessing or using fireworks (e.g., smoke bombs, stink bombs, cherry bombs, poppers, etc.), combustibles, or other incendiary or pyrotechnic devices of any kind.
25. Possessing, or conspiring to possess, any explosive or explosive device. (Please note: This offense may meet the elements of a Discretionary/Mandatory Placement or Expulsion section of the Student Code of Conduct).
26. Possessing any device, chemical, irritant, supplement containing cannabidiol "CBD", or substance which can be used in a manner designed to cause harm, shock, physical irritation, allergic reaction or mental/physical impairment. Examples include, but are not limited to, mace, pepper spray, CBD, or "itching powder".
27. Possessing, exhibiting, or using a razor, box cutter, chain, a pocketknife or any other small knife, or any other object used in a way that threatens or inflicts bodily injury to another person or any martial arts objects (such as shuriken [throwing stars], nunchakus [nun-chucks], tonfa [wooden weapon], staff, baton [short stick], bolo [long cord with weights at each end]), to the extent that these objects are not within the definitions of location-restricted knives or prohibited weapons under TX Penal Code.
28. Possessing, displaying, or distribution of pornographic materials.
29. Any machine or other object that is used to create/imprint a tattoo is strictly prohibited.
30. Any ear/body piercing device, machine, or object that is used to create an opening, cut or break the skin, or pierce an individual's body is prohibited.
31. Using or possessing Laser Pointers for non-instructional purposes or without teacher approval.

Misuse of Personal Communication/Electronic Devices:

32. Violating any rule or law pertaining to virtual classroom setting, computers and the Internet use policies, rules, or agreements set forth in this Student Code of Conduct, Technology Use Guide, or other Agreement/Permission Forms. (For more information, refer to Technology Use Guide in this Student Code of Conduct).
33. Using a camera, video equipment, or other electronic device inappropriately, or distributing/displaying inappropriate voice recordings, pictures, video footage, or written messages as determined by campus administration.
34. Recording the voice or image of another without the prior consent of the individuals being recorded or in any way that disrupts the educational environment or invades the privacy of others. Campus administrative approval required prior to the use of a recording device. **The school is not responsible if the recording device is lost, broken, damaged, or stolen.**

Prescription and Over-the-Counter Drugs:

35. Possessing or abusing the student's own prescription drug, giving a prescription drug to another student or possessing, exhibiting, or using another person's prescription drug. (See Student Handbook-"Medicine at School" for medication procedures).

36. Abusing or giving to another student an over-the-counter drug. (See Student Handbook-"Medicine at School" for medication procedures).

Miscellaneous Offenses:

37. Engaging in minor intimate/sexual acts (including, but not limited to, necking, groping and/or fondling).
38. Falsification of records, passes, electronic records, signature, or other school-related documents.
39. Repeatedly violating other communicated campus or classroom standards of behavior (including repeated violations of the standardized dress code guidelines).
40. Participating in gang-related activities as described in the Glossary (first offense).
41. Engaging in any other conduct that disrupts the school environment or educational process, regardless if the incident originated on/off-campus.
42. Possessing, displaying or distributing published or electronic material that is designed to promote or encourage illegal behavior or that could threaten students, District personnel, or student/school safety.
43. Participating in gambling or games of chance (e.g., Dice).

Students who commit serious offenses will be assessed discipline penalties commensurate with the offense.

Gang Intervention Facilitators: The District has Gang Intervention Facilitators to work with students, staff, parents, and the community to promote gang awareness, prevention, and intervention strategies. To request assistance from a Gang Intervention Facilitator or attend a gang awareness presentation, contact your child's campus principal or other administrator.

LEVEL III—Disciplinary Alternative Education Program

Notification: The campus administrator shall promptly notify a student's parent by phone or in person of any violation that may result in In-School Suspension or Out-of-School Suspension, placement in a DAEP, placement in a JJAEP, or expulsion. The campus administrator shall also notify a student's parent if the student is taken into custody by a law enforcement officer under the disciplinary provisions of the Education Code. On the day that action is taken, a copy of the Student Discipline Action Form will be provided to the student and he/she will be instructed to deliver the Form to his/her parent/guardian. This written notification of the disciplinary incident/action is a good faith effort to inform parent/guardian of school matters.

Informal Due Process Conference: Before placing a student in a Disciplinary Alternative Education Program or recommending a student's expulsion the principal or designee shall schedule, within three school days, an Informal Due Process Conference at which the student and/or parent/guardian are:

1. Advised in writing of the Student Code of Conduct violation;
2. Provided an explanation of the basis for the removal; and
3. Given the opportunity to explain his or her version of the incident.

After the District makes a good faith effort to inform the student and the student's parent/guardian of the time and place of the Informal Due Process Conference, the District may hold the Informal Due Process Conference and make a placement decision, regardless of whether the student, the student's parent/guardian, or another adult representing the student attends the conference. The final decision shall be communicated promptly to the student and parent/guardian.

In the event that a school or District is closed due to a federal, state, or local closure and the District has transitioned to a virtual learning environment, all conferences and appeals related to student discipline shall take place via a virtual platform as to not deprive a student of any rights afforded by state or federal law.

Placement Order: After the conference, if the student is placed in the DAEP, the campus administrator will issue a placement order. A copy of the DAEP placement order will be provided to the student's parent/guardian. A copy of the Disciplinary Alternative Education Program placement order and all information required by Section 52.04 of the Family Code will be delivered to the authorized officer of the juvenile court in which the student resides as mandated by the Texas Education Code under Section 37.010(a). If the student is placed in the DAEP and the length of placement is inconsistent with the guidelines included in this Code, the placement order will give notice of the inconsistency.

Appeals: Regardless of the duration of the student's placement, the student or the student's parent/guardian is entitled to participate in a proceeding before the District's Hearing Officer or a District Committee appointed by the District's Superintendent or the Superintendent's Designee. Whether a District Hearing Officer or a District Committee presides over the Appeal shall be at the sole discretion of the Superintendent or the Superintendent's Designee. A student's parent/guardian who wishes to appeal the removal of the student to a Disciplinary Alternative Education Program may do so by appealing to the Student Relations Department. The request to appeal the student's placement at the District's Disciplinary Alternative Education Program (i.e., S.T.E.P. Academy) must be made in writing and received by the Student Relations Department within five (5) work days from the date of receipt of the Disciplinary Alternative Education Program Placement Order. Prior to the review hearing being scheduled, the student must be enrolled and attending a Disciplinary Alternative Education Program or enrolled and attending another educational institution. Disciplinary consequences will not be deferred pending the outcome of an appeal. In accordance with Texas Education Code Section 37.009(a), the decision of the District Committee or District Hearing Officer is final and may not be appealed. Only the District Committee or District Hearing Officer shall be authorized to make an audio/video recording of the Review Hearing proceedings. All other disciplinary concerns should be addressed in accordance with policy FNG (LOCAL). Disciplinary consequences shall not be deferred pending the outcome of an appeal. Any placement or expulsion decision, including DAEP or JJAEP assignments, issued by another district or educational institution is not subject to appeal within UISD.

In the event that a school or District is closed due to a federal, state, or local closure and the District has transitioned to a virtual learning environment, all conferences and appeals related to student discipline shall take place via a virtual platform as to not deprive a student of any rights afforded by state or federal law.

Elementary Students assigned to a Disciplinary Alternative Education Program must be separated from secondary students assigned to a Disciplinary Alternative Education Program. Students younger than six years of age shall only be placed in a disciplinary alternative education program in the event that the student brings a firearm, as defined by 18 U.S.C. §921, to school. For purposes of DAEP, elementary classification shall be pre-kindergarten-grade 5 and secondary classifications shall be grades 6–12. Summer programs provided by the District shall serve students assigned to a DAEP in conjunction with other students.

Duration/Term of Placement: The duration of a student's placement in the Disciplinary Alternative Education Program (D.A.E.P.) shall be determined by the campus administrator. Students with egregious offenses on/off campus or persistent/repeated violations of the rules of conduct may be subject to increasingly longer terms of placements. The student's age and grade level may also be considered when determining the duration/term of placement. The duration/term of placement at a D.A.E.P. refers to a specific number of days of successful attendance. Days or partial days absent from a DAEP shall not count towards fulfilling the total number of days required in a student's DAEP Placement Order. Students are in control of the factors (i.e. attendance, grades, and behavior) that may extend their length of placement at a DAEP. Students placed at UISD's DAEP (i.e., STEP Academy) earn their way back to their home campus. Students can only return to their home campus following the completion of all the following requirements: 1. Successful attendance for assigned number of days; 2. Passing grades (minimum of 70 or grading standards written in the students I.E.P.) in all courses; and 3. Highest Level on Behavior Point Sheet. If the student does not meet the above requirements, the duration/term of placement at the DAEP will be extended for a minimum of ten (10) days. Upon successful attendance of the additional required placement days, the student's academic and behavior progress will be reviewed. If the student has not reached the above requirements, a minimum of an additional ten (10) days will be added to the placement. The student will continue to receive a minimum of ten (10) day extensions to the DAEP placement until the requirements above are met successfully or until the end of the school year whichever occurs first. The maximum period of DAEP placement shall be one calendar year except as provided in this Student Code of Conduct.

Continued Misconduct: If during the term of a placement in a disciplinary alternative education program a student engages in additional misconduct for which placement in a disciplinary alternative education program or expulsion is required or permitted, additional proceedings may be conducted regarding that conduct and the campus administrator may extend a student's length of placement or enter an additional order as a result of those proceedings.

Placement Exceeds One Year: Before a student may be placed in a disciplinary alternative education program for more than one year, the District must determine after a review that the student is a threat to the safety of other students or to District employees.

If the period of the placement is inconsistent with the guidelines included in the Student Code of Conduct regarding how the length of the placement will be determined, the order must give notice of the inconsistency. The statutory limitations on the length of a DAEP placement do not apply to a placement resulting from the Board's decision to place a student who engaged in the sexual assault of another student so that the students are not assigned to the same campus.

Placement Exceeds School Year and Serious or Persistent Misbehavior: Students who commit offenses requiring placement in a DAEP at the end of one school year may be required to continue that placement at the start of the next school year to complete the assigned term of placement. Before the District may place a student in a DAEP for a period that extends beyond the end of the school year, the campus administrator or the Board's designee must determine that:

1. The student's presence in the regular classroom or campus presents a danger of physical harm to the student or others; or
2. The student has engaged in **serious or persistent misbehavior** that violates this Student Code of Conduct. Serious offenses are those that substantially disrupt or materially interfere with the orderly process in the classroom, transportation, the school, any school-related activity, and may include persistent misbehavior of Level II or higher misconduct. Persistent shall be defined as five or more instances of Level I misconduct or more than one instance of Level II and higher misconduct. A student who has engaged in any offense listed as an offense under Level III or Level IV constitutes a finding that the student has engaged in serious misbehavior.
    a. Persistent Misbehavior Offenses: The term "persistent misbehavior" appears in other portions of this Code of Conduct. That term, as used throughout the Code, is defined as follows:
        1. Two or more documented serious offenses; or
        2. Five or more documented minor offenses; or
        3. Serious offenses and minor offenses that the principal, campus administrator, or designee deems to interfere with the District's ability to provide an education to other students.

Placement Exceeds 60 Days: For placement in a DAEP to extend beyond 60 days or the end of the next grading period, whichever is sooner, a student's parent will be given notice and the opportunity to participate in a proceeding before the Board or Board's designee.

Restrictions during Placement: Students who are placed at a Disciplinary Alternative Education Program shall not attend/participate in school-sponsored/school-related extracurricular/co-curricular activities during the period of placement, including, but not limited to, seeking or holding honorary positions and/or membership in school-sponsored clubs and organizations. The student is not allowed on the home campus, any other school campus, any District property, or at any school-related activity, including, but not limited to, in-town or out-of-town District games or events during the period of placement. If a student violates the prohibition on District property, the student can be charged with illegal trespass, a Class C misdemeanor, pursuant to Texas Education Code §37.107.

Transportation: The District will provide transportation to students in a DAEP; however, violation of transportation "Bus Rider Guidelines" may result in this privilege being revoked.

Graduating Juniors/Seniors in Disciplinary Alternative Education Programs: When a student is placed in the DAEP during the 11th or 12th grade, UISD shall allow that student to participate in graduation ceremonies, provided that all prerequisites for graduation are met and provided that the student has successfully completed all of the days that the student was assigned to the DAEP. If the student in question has not completed his/her days in the DAEP, the student may be allowed to participate in graduation ceremonies. Any student placed in a DAEP for more than 15 days during the 9th, 10th, 11th, or 12th grade for committing an offense involving Academic Dishonesty (see Glossary) shall not be given a speaking role or recognized for any academic achievement, including but not limited to valedictorian, salutatorian, class president, or top 10 in the class, at graduation ceremonies.

Review of Student's Status for Students Placed in a DAEP for 120 Days or More: A student placed in a DAEP shall be provided a review of the student's status, including a review of the student's academic status, by the campus administrator or the Board's designee at intervals not to exceed 120 days. In the case of a high school student, the Board's designee, with the student's parent/guardian, shall review the student's progress towards meeting high school graduation requirements and the student's graduation plan. The District is not required under this subsection to provide in the District's DAEP a course not specified under Texas Education Code Section 37.008(a). At the review, the student or parent/guardian must be given an opportunity to present arguments for the student's return to the regular classroom or campus.

Withdrawal during Process: When a student violates the District's Code in a way that requires or permits the student to be placed in a DAEP, and the student withdraws from the District before a placement order is completed, the campus administrator may complete the proceedings and issue a placement order. If the campus administrator fails to issue a placement order after the student withdraws, the next district in which the student enrolls may complete the proceedings and issue a placement order.

Students who transfer out of UISD to another public or private institution, including students who withdraw from UISD for the purpose of homeschooling, and students who do not attend the DAEP for the duration of the placement for any reason, shall be required, upon return to UISD, to complete the number of days missed in the DAEP before being allowed to return to the regular campus. Any period of the placement that has been served by the student on enrollment in another district's alternative school that honors the order will be credited toward the placement.

Newly Enrolled Students: If a student transfers into UISD from another district or school in which the student was placed in a DAEP, UISD may continue the DAEP placement under the terms of the order provided by the sending district or school. If the principal or other administrator or board of the district in which the student was formerly enrolled fails to enter an order after the student withdraws, UISD may complete the proceedings and enter an order.

Emergency Placement Procedure: The principal or the principal's designee may order the immediate placement of a student in the DAEP if the principal or the principal's designee reasonably believes the student's behavior is so unruly, disruptive, or abusive that it seriously interferes with a teacher's ability to communicate effectively with the students in a class, with the ability of the student's classmates to learn, or with the operation of school or a school-sponsored activity. The principal or principal's designee may order the emergency placement in the DAEP based on a single incident of behavior by the student.

At the time of the emergency placement, the student shall be given oral notice of the reason for the action. Within a reasonable time after the emergency placement, but not later than the 10th day after the date of the placement, the student shall be offered the appropriate due process required for assignment to a DAEP. If the student subject to the emergency placement is a student with disabilities who receives Special Education services, the term of the student's emergency placement is subject to the requirements of the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act (IDEA) and its accompanying regulations.

Notice of Criminal Proceedings: The office of the prosecuting attorney shall notify the District if a student was placed in a DAEP for certain offenses and:

1. Prosecution of a student's case was refused for lack of prosecutorial merit or insufficient evidence and no formal proceedings, deferred adjudication (see Glossary), or deferred prosecution will be initiated; or
2. The court or jury found a student not guilty or made a finding that the student did not engage in delinquent conduct or conduct indicating a need for supervision, and the case was dismissed with prejudice.

The parent/guardian may provide the Discipline Management Department with written notification subject to the disposition of an offense which is subject to student's placement or expulsion.

If a student was placed in a DAEP or expelled to a JJAEP for such conduct, on receiving the notice from the parent/guardian or the prosecutor, the Superintendent or designee will review the student's placement and schedule a review with the student's parent. The student may not be returned to the regular classroom pending the review. After reviewing the notice and receiving information from the student's parent, the superintendent or designee may continue the student's placement if there is reason to believe that the presence of the student in the regular classroom threatens the safety of other students or teachers.

The student or the student's parent may appeal the Superintendent's decision to the Board. The student may not be returned to the regular classroom pending the appeal. In the case of an appeal, the Board shall, at the next scheduled meeting, review the notice from the prosecutor and receive information from the student, the student's parent, and the Superintendent or designee and confirm or reverse the decision of the Superintendent or designee. The Board shall make a record of the proceedings. If the Board confirms the decision of the Superintendent or designee, the student and the student's parent may appeal to the Commissioner of Education. The student may not be returned to the regular classroom pending the appeal.

Under the Influence: When administration has reason to believe that a student is under the influence, the student will be expected to cooperate and submit to the DIBREP (Drug Impairment and Behavior Recognition for Educators & Professionals)/DITEP (Drug Impairment Training for Educational Professionals) – Texas High School Assessment conducted by the school nurse. Refusal to submit and cooperate will create an inference that the student is under the influence of a prohibited substance.

If a student has a valid prescription for low-THC (non-intoxicating) cannabis, the parent/guardian must follow the District's policies and procedures for prescription medications in these limited circumstances and as authorized by Chapter 487 of the Health and Safety Code.

Substance Abuse: The District has Licensed Chemical Dependency Counselors (LCDC), in addition to school counselors, available to provide substance abuse information, prevention, and referrals for students. For more information or to request assistance from a Licensed Chemical Dependency Counselor, contact your child's school counselor.

Coursework: The curriculum of the DAEP shall consist of English/language arts, mathematics, science, history, self-discipline, and shall provide for the student's behavioral needs through supervision and counseling. The District shall provide for the continuing education of a student placed in a DAEP, which may include:

1. Transfer to a different campus.
2. Transfer to a school-community guidance center.
3. Transfer to a community-based alternative school.
4. Transfer to an off-campus DAEP.

The parent/guardian of a student placed in DAEP shall be given written notice of the student's opportunity to complete coursework required for graduation at no cost to the student. The notice shall include information regarding all methods available for completing the coursework.

Dual Enrollment status during DAEP Placement/Expulsion: A student who is placed or expelled may be withdrawn from the Dual Enrollment program.

Course Completion at DAEP: Texas Education Code Chapter 37 Notice to Parents: Students shall receive full credit for assignments completed in a Disciplinary Alternative Education Program. Students who are placed in the District's Disciplinary Alternative Education Program will be offered opportunities to complete coursework required for graduation, at no cost to the student. Available methods to complete course work include, but are not limited to: a) courses offered at STEP; b) online curriculum courses offered at UISD; c) teacher prepared lessons sent to STEP only for Pre-AP, AP, and some dual enrollment courses if a student is placed for 18 days or less within the currently enrolled semester; d) teacher prepared lessons sent to STEP for CTE courses; e) Summer School.
Note: Magnet students may not be able to complete the Magnet program requirements due to the limited courses offered at STEP Academy.

Notice to Teachers: The principal or designee shall inform each educator who has responsibility for or is under the direction and supervision of an educator who has responsibility for the instruction of a student who has engaged in any code of conduct violation that results in a DAEP placement or expulsion or that is required by Article 15.27(a) (1) of the Code of Criminal Procedure. Additionally, if a student placed in a DAEP in another district enrolls in UISD before the expiration of the period of placement, UISD will inform each educator who has responsibility for the instruction of the student or will be directing and/or supervising the student the contents of the placement order. Each educator shall keep the information received under this subsection confidential from any person not entitled to the information under this subsection, except that the educator may share the information with the student's parent/guardian as provided for by state or federal law. The State Board for Educator Certification may revoke or suspend the certification of an educator who intentionally violates this subsection.

Placement of Students with Disabilities in a Disciplinary Alternative Education Program: A student with a disability being served in special education may be placed in a DAEP for engaging in conduct that would warrant such action for a student without such disabilities only if the ARD committee determines that the misconduct is not a manifestation of the student's disabling condition. However, the student may be placed in an interim disciplinary alternative educational setting for a period of up to 45 days for certain drug or weapons offenses or for offenses causing serious bodily injury regardless of whether the student's behavior is linked to his or her disability. The DAEP placement applies even if the student's ARD Committee finds that the student's conduct was a manifestation of the student's disability.

A student with a disability who receives Special Education services may not be placed in a DAEP solely for educational purposes if the student has not also committed one or more of the offenses warranting placement in the DAEP.

A student who is disabled according to Section 504 shall not be placed in a DAEP unless the District first determines that the misbehavior is not a manifestation of the student's disabling condition (except when the violation involves drugs, weapons or serious bodily injury.) That determination may be made by the Section 504 Committee.

In accordance with the Education Code, a student who receives special education services may not be disciplined in a manner that results in a change in the student's educational placement for conduct meeting the definition of bullying, cyberbullying, harassment, or making hit lists until an ARD committee meeting has been held to review the conduct.

Course Credit during Disciplinary Process: Students shall receive full credit for assignments completed in a DAEP, including In-School Suspension. Students who are placed in the District's In-School Suspension or another setting other than a DAEP will be offered an opportunity to complete coursework before the beginning of the next school year for each course in which the student was enrolled at the time of the removal. Available methods to complete coursework include, but are not limited to, online coursework, correspondence courses, distance learning, or summer school. Teachers are to inform students of the time allotted for completion of the work. Students are responsible for obtaining the assignments and completing the work within the time allotted, and students are allowed to make up both class work and homework.

Assessment for Student Placed in a Disciplinary Alternative Education Program for 90 Days or More: All students placed into a DAEP for 90 days or more shall be assessed upon initial placement, and subsequently on the date that the student departs from the program, or as near to that date as possible. The assessment instrument will measure basic skills in reading and math. Students assigned to the DAEP must also take all academic skills assessments required of all public school students.

Discretionary Placement in a Disciplinary Alternative Education Program (D.A.E.P.)

The following actions constitute offenses that shall or may result in placement in the Disciplinary Alternative Education Program located at United STEP Academy. These offenses are considered to be more serious than the Level II Serious Offenses listed in this Code. The terms of a placement under this section shall prohibit the student from attending or participating in school-sponsored or school-related activities, including, but not limited to, extracurricular activities. A principal or other administrator is not prohibited from suspending a student immediately prior to the student's placement in the DAEP. If an offense meets the criteria for a Mandatory Placement/Expulsion or Discretionary Expulsion, that section of the Student Code of Conduct will supersede this Discretionary Placement.

Offenses Occurring on Campus or at School-Related Activities: A student may be placed in a DAEP if the student commits the following on campus or within 300 feet of District property or while attending a school-sponsored or school-related activity on or off campus:

Disregard for Authority:

1. Demonstrates behavior that is unruly, disruptive, or abusive toward the teacher, another adult, or another student.
2. Engages in conduct that constitutes bullying, as defined by TEC Section 37.0832.
3. Repeatedly interferes with the teacher's ability to communicate effectively with the students in the class or with the student's classmates' ability to learn.
4. Engages in offensive, sexual, intimate or provocative conduct, regardless if the conduct is consensual.
5. Engages in conduct that contains the elements of the offense of disruptive activities under TEC Section 37.123.
6. Engages in conduct that contains the elements of the offense of disruption of classes under TEC Section 37.124 [subject to TEC Section 37.006(d)(1)].

Property Offenses:

7. Engages in conduct constituting vandalism, or otherwise defacing, damaging, or tampering with the property of another and causing substantial inconvenience or pecuniary loss up to and including $2,499.99 on school property or at a school-related or school-sponsored event. The taxpayers of the community have made a sustained financial commitment for the construction and upkeep of school facilities. To ensure that school facilities can serve those for whom they are intended—both this year and in the coming years—littering, defacing, or damaging school property is not tolerated. Students will be required to pay for damages they cause and will be subject to criminal proceedings as well as disciplinary consequences in accordance with the Student Code of Conduct.

Mistreatment of Others:

8. Engages in two or more fights. Please note: a student may be placed at the DAEP on the first occurrence if the conduct causes a substantial disruption to the educational environment.
9. Engages in inappropriate physical contact against a teacher or school employee.
10. Engages in two or more bullying or hazing offenses including cyberbullying offenses (including but not limited to: catfishing (as described in the Glossary), slamming, trash talking, threatening, obscene, harassing, "pantsing", degrading/damaging to another's reputation, or encouraging self-harm or harm to others). Please note: a student may be placed at the DAEP on the first occurrence regardless if the conduct originated off school property, if the conduct causes a substantial disruption to the educational environment. Incidents may result in a criminal offense(s) as per the Texas Penal Code. (NOTE: Includes electronic communication.)
11. Possesses, records, takes pictures, displays, broadcasts, gives, sells, provides, issues, manufactures, procures, mails, delivers, transfers, distributes, circulates, disseminates, presents, exhibits, advertises, promotes, or transmits visual/audio material of a person's intimate areas, changing rooms or other areas presumed to be private, sexual conduct (actual or simulated) or otherwise invasive, abusive, offensive, sexually oriented, intimate or provocative, regardless if the material reveals the person's identity or regardless if the person created or consented to the creation of said material. This applies to conduct which originated off school property, if the conduct causes a substantial disruption to the educational environment. Incidents may result in a criminal offense(s) as per the Texas Penal Code.

Safety Transgressions:

12. Threatens or assists in making threats against a District student, employee, volunteer, or District facility/property, including off school property if the conduct causes a substantial disruption to the educational environment.
13. Engages in conduct leading to or intended to disrupt school, incite a riot, violence, disturbance, or encouraging others to disrupt school program (i.e. walkout, sit out, post/threatening school violence, smoke alarm).
14. Engages in any sort of offensive, non-verbal, physical gesture against a District student, employee, or volunteer. Such gestures include, but are not limited to: (1) throat-slicing by use of hands; and (2) using hands as a gun and pointing at a student or the perpetrator's head.
15. Making hit lists (as described in the Glossary).

Possession/Use of Prohibited Items:

16. Is found in possession of a knife or a hand instrument (e.g., brass knuckles) which may cut or cause injury to another/self. Location-restricted knives are also addressed in the Mandatory Expulsion section of the Student Code of Conduct.
17. Possession of residue (including seeds).
18. Possessing/exhibiting or using a BB gun, pellet gun, air-powered rifle/pistol or paint ball gun, stunning device or stun gun, a taser or any device that emits an electrical charge.
19. Using any device, chemical, irritant, supplement containing cannabidiol "CBD", or substance in a manner inconsistent with its intended or prescribed use, or in a manner designed to cause harm, shock, physical irritation, allergic reaction, or mental/physical impairment. Examples include, but are not limited to, mace, pepper spray, CBD, or "itching powder".
20. Possessing, selling, using, giving, abusing, or being under the influence of a look-a-like drug, low-level THC or hemp or attempting to pass item off as drugs or contraband. School-related drug offenses are also addressed in the Mandatory Placement or Expulsion section of the Student Code of Conduct.
21. Possessing, purchasing, selling, giving, delivering, accepting, smoking, or using tobacco products. The District and its staff strictly enforce prohibitions against the use of tobacco products, CBD, hemp, low-level THC by students and others on school property or at school-sponsored or school-related activities. [See the Student Code of Conduct and policy GKA.] School-related drug offenses are also addressed in the Mandatory Placement or Expulsion section of the Student Code of Conduct.
22. Possessing or using an e-cigarette, as defined by Section 161.081, Texas Health and Safety Code. If a student who possesses or uses an e-cigarette (nicotine and/or empty devices only) is not placed at the DAEP on the first occurrence under TEC Section 37.008, the student shall be placed in In-School-Suspension. A student may be revoked from In-School Suspension & placed at DAEP if noncompliant with attendance, behavior, grades, etc., while assigned to ISS.
23. Possessing a "look-alike" weapon, a toy gun, or any other instrument that is intended to be used as a weapon or could reasonably be perceived as a weapon. (See Glossary.)
24. Possessing or using unloaded firearm accessories or parts (such as a gun barrel or a gun clip).
25. Possessing of non-armor piercing ammunition (including, but not limited to, shot shells, standard copper-coated bullets, and bullets that are typically used in handguns and rifles).

Misuse of Personal Communication/Electronic Devices:

26. Using district or personal devices (e.g., computers, telephone, networks, software, Artificial Intelligence (AI), internet access, etc.) to download, display, broadcast, give, sell, provide, issue, manufacture, procure, mail, deliver, transfer, distribute, circulate, disseminate, present, exhibit, advertise, promote, transmit, live-stream, or share pirated/copyrighted material.
27. Assembles or disassembles a computer, network, printer, or other computer equipment, except as part of a class assignment or in conjunction with a job responsibility.
28. Removes any technology equipment (hardware or software) without written permission of the principal or director, or breach of computer security.
29. Using a camera cell phone in locker/shower facilities and restroom areas. Exception when used to "call" first responder during a school wide safety/emergency situation.

Prescription and Over-the-Counter Drugs:

30. Distributing, using, or placing a prohibited substance - which may cause a mental or physical impairment - in food, drink, and/or other possessions.
31. Abusing the student's own prescription drug, giving a prescription drug to another student or possessing/exhibiting or using another person's prescription drug. Please note: Following a warning, if a student fails to submit prescribed medication to the School Nurse, a student may be placed at the DAEP if he/she possesses their own prescribed medication. School-related drug offenses are also addressed in the Mandatory Placement and Expulsion section of the Student Code of Conduct. (See Student Handbook - "Medicine at School" for medication procedures.)
32. Being under the influence of student's own prescription drug or over the counter drug. School-related drug offenses are also addressed in the Mandatory Placement and Expulsion section of the Student Code of Conduct. (See Glossary for Under the Influence definition.)
33. Abusing an over-the-counter drug. (See Student Handbook - "Medicine at School" for medication procedures.)

Miscellaneous Offenses:

34. Following a warning, engages in gang activity. (See Glossary.)
35. Following a warning, engages in a public school fraternity, sorority, or secret society, including participation as a member or pledge, or coercing, inducing, or soliciting another person to become a pledge or member of a public school fraternity, sorority, gang, or secret society. (See Glossary.)
36. Engages in inappropriate exposure of private body parts including, but not limited to, breast, buttocks, and genitals. (See Mandatory DAEP for similar offenses.)

Offenses Occurring Off Campus/Not at School-Sponsored or School-Related Activities: A student may be removed and placed in the DAEP if the student commits the following conduct more than 300 feet off campus and while the student is not in attendance at a school-sponsored or school-related activity if:

37. The Superintendent or the Superintendent's designee has a reasonable belief that the student has engaged in conduct defined as a felony offense other than those offenses defined in Title 5 of the Texas Penal Code or aggravated robbery under Section 29.03

Penal Code and the presence of the student in the regular classroom threatens the safety of other students or teachers, or will be detrimental to the educational process.

38. Engages in any activity on the way to or from school that would ordinarily be grounds for disciplinary alternative education placement if the activity had occurred on campus.
39. The student is truant or absent without permission for any portion of the instructional day, and the student engages in an activity while off campus that would ordinarily be grounds for disciplinary alternative education placement or expulsion.

Offenses Occurring at Any Location: A student may be placed in a DAEP if the student engages in the following, regardless of where the conduct took place:

40. Engaging in bullying that encourages a student to commit or attempt to commit suicide; or inciting violence against a student through group bullying; or releasing or threatening to release intimate visual material of a minor or a student who is 18 years of age or older without student's consent regardless if the incident originated off-campus.
41. Student is required to register as a sex offender and IS NOT under court supervision.

Mandatory Placement in a Disciplinary Alternative Education Program (D.A.E.P.):

Offenses Occurring on Campus or at School-Related Activities: A student **must** be placed in a DAEP if the student commits the following on or within 300 feet of school property as measured from any point on the school's real property boundary line, or while attending a school-sponsored or school-related activity on or off school property:

Mistreatment of Others:

1. Engages in conduct that contains the elements of assault [Class A only and as defined by Texas Penal Code Section 22.01(a) (1)]. (see Glossary.)
2. Engages in conduct that contains the elements of the offense of retaliation under Penal Code §36.06 against any school employee or volunteer on or off school property. (Committing retaliation in combination with another expellable offense is addressed in the Expulsion section of this Code.)
3. Engages in conduct that contains the elements of the offense of harassment under Penal Code §42.07 against any school employee or volunteer on or off school property.

Drug, Alcohol, & Volatile Chemicals:

4. Sells, gives, or delivers to another person, or possesses, uses, or is under the influence of marihuana, as defined by Section 481.002, Texas Health and Safety Code, or tetrahydrocannabinol (THC), as defined by rule adopted under Section 481.003 of that code. School-related felony drug offenses are in the Expulsion section. A student with a valid prescription for low-THC cannabis as authorized by Ch. 487 of the Health and Safety Code does not violate this provision.
5. Sells, gives, or delivers an e-cigarette (nicotine or empty devices only), as defined by Section 161.081, Texas Health and Safety Code–TEC §37.006(a)(2)(C-2).
6. Sells, gives, or delivers to another person, or possesses, uses, or is under the influence of a controlled substance, as defined by Ch. 481, Texas Health and Safety Code, or by 21 U.S.C. Section 801 et seq. (non-felony level), or a dangerous drug, as defined by Chapter 483, Texas Health and Safety Code–TEC §37.006(a)(2)(C)(i) and (ii). Excludes marihuana, as defined by Section 481.002, Texas Health and Safety Code, or tetrahydrocannabinol, as defined by rule adopted under Section 481.003 Texas Health and Safety Code.
7. Sells, gives, or delivers to another person an alcoholic beverage (as defined by Section 1.04, Alcoholic Beverage Code); commits a serious act or offense while under the influence of alcohol; or possesses, uses, or is under the influence of an alcoholic beverage. School-related felony alcohol offenses are addressed in the Expulsion section.
8. Engages in conduct that contains the elements of an offense relating to an abusable volatile chemical under Sections 485.031 through 485.034, Health and Safety Code.

Safety Transgressions:

9. Engages in conduct that contains elements of terroristic threat under Texas Penal Code Section 22.07.
10. Engages in conduct involving a public school that contains the elements of the offense of false alarm or report under Texas Penal Code Section 42.06 (including a bomb threat).

Miscellaneous Offenses:

11. Except as provided by TEC Section 37.007(a), engages in conduct punishable as a felony.
12. Engages in conduct that contains the elements of the offense of public lewdness under Texas Penal Code Section 21.07 or indecent exposure under Texas Penal Code Section 21.08.
13. Engages in conduct that contains the elements of the offense of deadly conduct under Section 22.05, Texas Penal Code, including recklessly engaging in conduct that places another in imminent danger of serious bodily injury or knowingly discharging a firearm at, or in the direction of, one or more individuals or a habitation, building, or vehicle.
14. Engages in expellable conduct and is between six and nine years of age.
15. Commits a federal firearms violation and is younger than six years of age.

Offenses Occurring Off Campus/Not at School-Sponsored or School-Related Activities: In accordance with Education Code Section 37.008, a student shall be removed and placed in a DAEP or may be expelled to a JJAEP if the student:

16. Engages in conduct punishable as a felony listed under Title 5 of the Texas Penal Code or aggravated robbery under Title 7 when the conduct occurs off school property and while the student is not in attendance at a school-sponsored or school-related activity or event and:

a. The student receives deferred prosecution under Family Code, Section 53.03, for conduct defined as a felony offense under Title 5, Texas Penal Code; the offense of deadly conduct under Texas Penal Code Section 22.05; the offense of disorderly conduct involving a firearm under Texas Penal Code Section 42.01(a)(7) or (8); the offense of unlawfully carrying weapons under Texas Penal Code Section 46.02, except for an offense punishable as a Class C misdemeanor under the section; or the felony offense of aggravated robbery under Title 7, Section 29.03, Texas Penal Code;
b. A court or jury finds that the student has engaged in delinquent conduct under Family Code, Section 54.03 for conduct defined as a felony offense under Title 5, Texas Penal Code; the offense of deadly conduct under Texas Penal Code Section 22.05; the offense of disorderly conduct involving a firearm under Texas Penal Code Section 42.01(a)(7) or (8); the offense of unlawfully carrying weapons under Texas Penal Code Section 46.02, except for an offense punishable as a Class C misdemeanor under the section; or the felony offense of aggravated robbery under Title 7, Section 29.03, Texas Penal Code;
c. The Superintendent or the Superintendent's designee has a reasonable belief that the student has engaged in conduct defined as a felony offense under Title 5, Texas Penal Code; the offense of deadly conduct under Texas Penal Code Section 22.05; the offense of disorderly conduct involving a firearm under Texas Penal Code Section 42.01(a)(7) or (8); the offense of unlawfully carrying weapons under Texas Penal Code Section 46.02, except for an offense punishable as a Class C misdemeanor under the section; or the felony offense of aggravated robbery under Title 7, Section 29.03, Texas Penal Code.

In determining whether there is a reasonable belief that a student has engaged in conduct defined as a felony offense by the Texas Penal Code, the Superintendent or the Superintendent's designee may consider all available information including the information furnished under Article 15.27, Code of Criminal Procedures.

A campus administrator may, but is not required to, remove and place a student to a disciplinary alternative education program or expel to a JJAEP for off campus conduct for which removal is required by state law if the campus administrator does not have knowledge of the conduct before the first anniversary of the date the conduct occurred.

17. A student may be expelled to the JJAEP or shall be placed at the District's DAEP for the following:
    a. Received deferred prosecution for conduct defined as a Title 5 felony offense or aggravated robbery under Title 7, Section 29.03, Texas Penal Code;
    b. Charged with engaging in conduct defined as a Title 5 felony offense or aggravated robbery under Title 7, Section 29.03, Texas Penal Code;
    c. Referred to a juvenile court for allegedly engaging in delinquent conduct for conduct defined as a Title 5 felony offense or aggravated robbery under Title 7, Section 29.03, TX Penal Code;
    d. Found by a court or jury to have engaged in delinquent conduct defined as a Title 5 felony offense or aggravated robbery under Title 7, Section 29.03, Texas Penal Code;
    e. Received probation or deferred adjudication or arrested for, charged with, or convicted of a Title 5 felony offense or aggravated robbery under Title 7, Section 29.03, Texas Penal Code.

A student who is placed or expelled to an alternative setting under these circumstances will be given the opportunity for a hearing. An expulsion/placement will not be made unless the Board or the Board's designee determines that the student's presence in the regular classroom either:

1. Threatens the safety of other students or teachers;
2. Will be detrimental to the educational process; or
3. Is not in the best interest of the District's students.

The expulsion or DAEP placement may be without regard for the date or location of the offense, enrollment status of the student, or court disposition requirements imposed in connection with the conduct, and the student is subject to placement until one of the following occurs:

1. The student graduates from high school;
2. The charges are dismissed or reduced to a misdemeanor offense; or
3. The student completes the term of the placement or is assigned to another program.

This placement continues regardless of whether the student transfers to another district in the state. Students are entitled to periodic 120 day review provided for other disciplinary placements. In the event of a conflict, any provision in the Student Code of Conduct that derives from Texas Education Code §37.007 will prevail.

<u>Offenses Occurring at Any Location</u>: A student must be placed in a DAEP if the student engages in the following, regardless of where the conduct took place:

18. Student is a registered sex offender or is **UNDER** any form of court supervision including probation, community service or parole.

Students Who Are Registered Sex Offenders: Upon receipt of notification that a student is currently required to register as a sex offender, the administration must remove the student from the regular classroom and determine appropriate placement unless the court orders JJAEP placement. A decision regarding the placement of the student into a District's DAEP or the JJAEP will be made according to the following guidelines:

The placement decision will be based upon whether the student is a registered sex offender. Students who are no longer required to register as a sex offender, or who receive early termination of the obligation to register are not considered registered sex offenders. Placement into an alternative disciplinary program under this section supersedes all other legal provisions pertaining to alternative disciplinary placement. Additionally, students who are placed in an alternative setting under this provision must still maintain and comply with any other court ordered requirements relating to sex offender registrant status.

Students under Court Supervision: A student who is under any form of court supervision, including probation, community supervision, or parole, must be placed for at least one semester in the District's DAEP or in a JJAEP. If a student under court supervision is placed in the DAEP or in a JJAEP and withdraws/transfers, the student may be required to complete an additional semester in an alternative placement in the new school district without a committee conducting a placement review as described below, or the enrolling district may count the time spent by the student in the former district toward the required placement time.

Students Who Are Not Under Court Supervision: A student who is not under any form of court supervision may be placed in a DAEP or JJAEP for one semester or in the regular classroom. The placement may not be in the regular classroom if the Board's designee determines that the student's presence threatens the safety of other students or teachers; will be detrimental to the educational process; or is not in the best interests of the District's students.

Newly Enrolled Student: If a student enrolls in the District during a mandatory placement as a registered sex offender, the District may count any time already spent by the student in a placement, or may require an additional semester in an alternative placement without conducting a review of the placement.

Placement Review after One Semester: At the end of the first semester of a student's placement in an alternative educational setting and before the beginning of each school year for which the student remains in an alternative placement, the District shall convene a committee, in accordance with state law, to review the student's placement. The committee must be composed of:

1. A classroom teacher from the campus to which the student would be assigned if the student was not in the alternative program;
2. The student's parole or probation officer or a representative of the local juvenile probation department;
3. An instructor from the alternative education program to which the student is assigned;
4. A District designee selected by the Board or its designee;
5. A counselor employed by the District.

The committee must vote (majority vote) and recommend to the Board or its designee whether the student should remain in the alternative setting or be returned to the regular classroom. Absent a special finding as set forth below, the Board or its designee must honor the committee's recommendation unless one of the following:

1. Recommended regular classroom placement but Board's designee determines that the student's presence:
   a. threatens the safety of other students or teachers;
   b. will be detrimental to the educational process; or
   c. is not in the best interests of the District's student.
2. Recommended continued alternative setting but the Board's designee determines that the student's presence:
   a. does not threaten the safety of other students or teachers;
   b. will not be detrimental to the educational process; or
   c. is not contrary to the best interests of the District's students.

Student Receiving Special Education Services: A placement for a student with a disability receiving special education services must be made in compliance with The Individuals with Disabilities Education Act of 2004 (20 USC §1400 et seq.). At the end of the first semester the placement review as described above must be conducted by the student's Admission Review and Dismissal (ARD) Committee. The ARD Committee can request that a placement committee with the members described be convened in order to assist in conducting the review.

Appeal: A student or student's parent/guardian may appeal a placement as a registered sex offender by requesting a conference between the Board or its designee, the parents/guardian, and the student. This conference will be limited to the factual question of whether the student is required to register as a sex offender under Chapter 62 of the Code of Criminal Procedure. If the determination is made that the student is required to register as a sex offender, then the student is subject to placement in an alternative education program. Any decision made by the Board or its designee is final and may not be appealed.

Disciplinary Placement for Sexual Assault Occurring Off Campus: A student who commits a sexual assault against another student who at the time the offense occurs is assigned to the same campus, but regardless of whether the conduct occurs on or off school property, may be removed from class and placed in a DAEP or a JJAEP. There are no limitations on the term of placement of a student who has engaged in conduct that constitutes a sexual assault.

For purposes of the transfer and student placement provisions related to the commission of a sexual assault against another student, the student committing the assault must have: (1) been convicted of continuous sexual abuse of young child or children under §21.02, Texas Penal Code, or convicted of or placed on deferred adjudication for the offense of sexual assault under §22.011, Texas Penal Code, or aggravated sexual assault under §22.021, Texas Penal Code, committed against another student who, at the time the offense occurred, was assigned to the same campus as the student convicted or placed on deferred adjudication; (2) been adjudicated under §54.03, Texas Family Code, as having engaged in conduct described in section (1); (3) received a deferred prosecution under §53.03, Texas Family Code, for engaging in conduct described in section (1); or (4) been placed on probation under §54.04(d)(1), Texas Family Code, for engaging in conduct described in (1).

A student who is the victim of conduct described above shall receive, on the request of a parent or other person with authority to act on behalf of a student, one of the following transfers:

1. To a District campus other than the campus to which the student (victim) was assigned at the time the conduct occurred;
2. To the campus to which the student who engaged in the conduct was assigned, if the student who engaged in the conduct has been assigned to a different campus since the conduct occurred; or
3. A neighboring school district, if there is only one campus in the District serving the grade level in which the student is enrolled.

The campus or school district to which the student is transferred must be agreeable to the parent or other person with authority to act on the student victim's behalf. The District is not required to provide transportation to a student who transfers to another campus or school district.

If the student victim does not wish to transfer to another campus in the District, the victim's parent or another person with the authority to act on behalf of the victim may request that the Board transfer the offending student to another campus. The Board shall transfer the student who engaged in the conduct to a District campus other than the campus to which the student who is the victim of the conduct is assigned; or the District's DAEP or JJAEP, if there is only one campus in the District serving the grade level in which the student who engaged in the conduct is enrolled. To the extent permitted under federal law, a school district shall notify the parent, or other person with authority to act on behalf of a student who is a victim to whom Subsection (a)(2) applies, of the campus or program to which the student who engaged in conduct described by Subsection (a)(1)(A) is assigned. There are no hearings or appeals regarding this type of transfer.

LEVEL IV—EXPULSIONS:

The following actions constitute offenses that shall or may result in expulsion. These offenses are considered to be more serious than the serious offenses listed in this Code. A campus principal or other administrator is not prohibited from suspending a student or placing a student in In-School Suspension pending a complete investigation of the conduct which forms the basis for the expulsion.

Discretionary Expellable Offenses-Offenses Which May Result in Expulsion:

Any Location: A student **may** be expelled if the student engages in the following, regardless of where the conduct took place:

1. Engaging in conduct that constitutes criminal mischief, if such conduct is punishable as a felony.
2. Engaging in conduct involving a public school that contains the elements of the offense of false alarm or report (including bomb threat) under Section 42.06, Texas Penal Code, or terroristic threat under Section 22.07, Texas Penal Code. (This offense is a mandatory DAEP placement or a discretionary expulsion to JJAEP).
3. Engaging in conduct that contains the elements of the offense of breach of computer security under Section 33.02 Texas Penal Code, if the conduct involves accessing a computer, computer network, or computer system owned by or operated on behalf of a school district, and the student knowingly alters, damages, or deletes school district property information, or commits a breach of any other computer, computer network, or computer systems.
4. Engaging in bullying that encourages a student to commit or attempt to commit suicide; or inciting violence against a student through group bullying; or releasing or threatening to release intimate visual material of a minor or a student who is 18 years of age or older without the student's consent.

At School, Within 300 Feet, or at School Event: Commits any of the following offenses on or within 300 feet of school property, as measured from any point on the school's real property boundary line, or while attending a school-sponsored or school-related activity on or off school property.

5. If not punishable as a felony, sells, gives, or delivers to another person, or possesses, uses, or is under the influence of any amount of marijuana, or a controlled substance (Chapter 481, Health & Safety Code or by 21 U.S.C. Section 801 et seq.), or a dangerous drug (Chapter 483, Health & Safety Code), or an alcoholic beverage (Section 1.04, Alcoholic Beverage Code). A student with a valid prescription for low-THC cannabis as authorized by Chapter 487 of the Health & Safety Code does not violate this provision. If the conduct is punishable as a felony, see Mandatory Expulsion.
6. Engaging in conduct that contains the elements of an offense relating to an abusable volatile chemical under Sections 485.031 through 485.034, Health & Safety Code. (Examples: abusable glue or aerosol paint)
7. Engaging in conduct that contains the elements of the offense of deadly conduct under Section 22.05, Texas Penal Code, including recklessly engaging in conduct that places another in imminent danger of serious bodily injury or knowingly discharging a firearm at, or in the direction of, one or more individuals or a habitation, building or vehicle.

Within 300 Feet:

8. A student **may** be expelled for possession of a firearm, as defined by federal law, while within 300 feet of school property, as measured from any point on the school's real property boundary line.

Property of Another District:

9. Committing any offense that is a state-mandated expellable offense if the offense is committed on the property of another district in Texas or while the student is attending a school-sponsored or school-related activity of a school in another district in Texas.

While in a Disciplinary Alternative Education Program (DAEP):

10. The student, while placed in a Disciplinary Alternative Education Program (DAEP), continues to engage in documented serious misbehavior that violates this Student Code of Conduct despite documented behavioral interventions while placed in a DAEP. For purposes of discretionary expulsion from a DAEP, serious misbehavior means:
    a) Deliberate violent behavior that poses a direct threat to the health or safety of others;
    b) Extortion, meaning the gaining of money or other property by force or threat;
    c) Conduct that constitutes coercion, as defined by Section 1.07, Texas Penal Code; or
    d) Conduct that constitutes the offense of:
        1. Public lewdness under Section 21.07, Texas Penal Code;
        2. Indecent exposure under Section 21.08, Texas Penal Code;
        3. Criminal mischief under Section 28.03, Texas Penal Code;
        4. Personal hazing under Section 37.152, Texas Education Code; or
        5. Harassment under Section 42.07(a)(1), Texas Penal Code, of a student or District employee.

Offenses Which May Result in Expulsion (Conduct Unrelated to School)

The following offenses may result in expulsion regardless of when or where they occur:

11. A student may be expelled to the JJAEP or shall be placed at the District's DAEP for the following:
    a. Received deferred prosecution under Family Code §53.03 for conduct defined as a Title 5 felony offense or aggravated robbery under Title 7, §29.03, Texas Penal Code;
    b. Charged with engaging in conduct defined as a Title 5 felony offense or aggravated robbery under Title 7, §29.03, Penal Code;
    c. Referred to a juvenile court for allegedly engaging in delinquent conduct under Family Code §54.03 for conduct defined as a Title 5 felony offense or aggravated robbery under Title 7, §29.03, Penal Code;
    d. Found by a court or jury to have engaged in delinquent conduct under Family Code §54.03 for conduct defined as a Title 5 felony offense or aggravated robbery under Title 7, §29.03, Penal Code; or
    e. Received probation or deferred adjudication or arrested for, charged with, or convicted of a Title 5 felony offense or aggravated robbery under Title 7, §29.03, Penal Code.

A student who is placed in an alternative setting under these circumstances will be given the opportunity for a hearing. A placement will not be made unless the Board or the Board's designee determines that the student's presence in the regular classroom either:

1. Threatens the safety of other students or teachers;
2. Will be detrimental to the educational process; or
3. Is not in the best interest of the District's students.

The expulsion or DAEP placement may be without regard for the date or location of the offense, enrollment status of the student, or court disposition, and the student is subject to placement until one of the following occurs:

1. The student graduates from high school;
2. The charges are dismissed or reduced to a misdemeanor offense; or
3. The student completes the term of the placement or is assigned to another program.

This placement continues regardless of whether the student transfers to another district in the state. Students are entitled to periodic 120 day review provided for other disciplinary placements. In the event of a conflict, any provision in the Student Code of Conduct that derives from Texas Education Code §37.007 will prevail.

Offenses Which May Result in Expulsion (Regardless of the Location):

12. Student is a registered sex offender or is **UNDER** any form of court supervision including probation, community service or parole.

MANDATORY EXPELLABLE OFFENSES

Any Location: A student shall be expelled under federal or state law for any of the following offenses that occur on or off school property:

1. Bringing to school or possessing at school, including any setting that is under the district's control or supervision for the purpose of a school activity, a firearm, as defined by federal law. (See Glossary)

   NOTE: Mandatory expulsion under the federal Gun Free Schools Act does not apply to a firearm that is lawfully stored inside a locked vehicle, or to firearms used in activities approved and authorized by the district when the district has adopted appropriate safeguards to ensure student safety.
2. Unlawfully carrying on or about the student's person the following, in the manner prohibited by Texas Penal Code §46.02:
    a. A handgun, defined by state law as any firearm designed, made, or adapted to be used with one hand. (See Glossary.) Note: A student may not be expelled solely on the basis of the student's use, exhibition, or possession of a firearm that occurs at an approved target range facility that is not located on a school campus; while participating in or preparing for a school-sponsored, shooting sports competition or a shooting sports educational activity that is sponsored or supported by the Parks and Wildlife Department; or a shooting sports sanctioning organization working with the department. [See policy FNCG (LEGAL).]
    b. A location-restricted knife, as defined by state law. (See Glossary)
3. Possessing, manufacturing, transporting, repairing, or selling a prohibited weapon, as defined by state law. (See Glossary)
4. Engages in conduct that contains the elements of the offense of exhibiting, using, or threatening to exhibit or use a firearm under TEC §37.125.
5. Behaves in a manner that contains the elements of the following offenses under Texas Penal Code:
    a. Aggravated assault (§22.02), sexual assault (§22.011), or aggravated sexual assault (§22.021)
    b. Arson (§28.02)
    c. Murder (§19.02), capital murder (§19.03), or criminal attempt to commit murder or capital murder (§15.01)
    d. Indecency with a child (§21.11)
    e. Kidnapping (§20.03)
    f. Aggravated kidnapping (§20.04)
    g. Burglary (§30.02), robbery (§29.02), or aggravated robbery (§29.03)
    h. Manslaughter (§19.04)
    i. Criminally negligent homicide (§19.05)
    j. Continuous sexual abuse of a young child or disabled individual (§21.02).
6. If punishable as a felony, sells, gives, or delivers to another person, or possesses, uses, or is under the influence of a controlled substance, as defined by Chapter 481, Texas Health & Safety Code, or by 21 U.S.C. §801 et seq., excluding marihuana, as defined by §481.002, Texas Health & Safety Code, or tetrahydrocannabinol, as defined by rule adopted under §481.003, Texas

Health & Safety Code, or a dangerous drug, as defined by Chapter 483, Texas Health & Safety Code – TEC §37.006(a)(2)(C)(i) and (ii).

7. Engages in conduct that contains the elements of assault [Penal Code §22.01(a)(1)] against a school employee or volunteer as defined by TEC §22.053.

Expulsion of Students Under Ten (10) Years of Age: Students younger than age 10 who commit expellable offenses shall be placed in the DAEP.

Expulsion of Students Under Six (6) Years of Age: Students under age 6 shall not be expelled or placed in a disciplinary alternative education setting with the exception of a student under the age of 6 years old who brings a firearm, as defined by 18 U.S.C. §921, to school. In such a case, the student will be expelled under the terms set forth under TEC §37.007(e) and shall be provided educational services in a DAEP.

Emergency Expulsions: A principal or the principal's designee **may** order the immediate expulsion of a student if the principal or the principal's designee reasonably believes that action is necessary to protect persons or property from imminent harm. The principal or principal's designee may order the emergency expulsion based on a single incident of behavior by the student.

At the time of the emergency expulsion, the student shall be given oral notice of the reason for that action. Emergency expulsion must be based on a reason for which expulsion may be made on a non-emergency basis. Within a reasonable time after the emergency expulsion, but not later than the 10th day after the date of the expulsion, the student shall be accorded the appropriate due process.

If the student subject to the emergency expulsion is a student with disabilities who receives Special Education services, the term of the emergency expulsion is subject to the requirements of the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act (IDEA) and its accompanying regulations.

If the student has been removed under the emergency expulsion provision prior to assignment to home-based instruction pending the expulsion hearing, the District shall obtain the parent's written agreement if the student will be excluded from the school setting for more than ten consecutive school days before the hearing is conducted. If the parent's agreement cannot be obtained, the District shall return the student to school or ensure that the expulsion hearing is timely conducted so that the student is not excluded from school for more than 10 consecutive days without an opportunity for a due process hearing.

General Information - Expulsions:

Notification: The campus administrator shall promptly notify a student's parent by phone or in person of any violation that may result in In-School or Out-of-School Suspension, placement in a DAEP, placement in a JJAEP, or expulsion. The campus administrator shall also notify a student's parent if the student is taken into custody by a law enforcement officer under the disciplinary provisions of the Education Code. A good faith effort shall be made on the day that action was taken to provide to the student for delivery to the student's parent written notification of the disciplinary action.

Informal Due Process Conference: Before recommending a student's expulsion the principal or designee shall schedule, within three school days, an Informal Due Process Conference at which time the student and/or parent/guardian are:

1. Advised in writing of the Student Code of Conduct violation;
2. Provided an explanation of the basis for the removal;
3. Given the opportunity to explain his or her version of the incident.

In the event that a school or District is closed due to a federal, state, or local closure and the District has transitioned to a virtual learning environment, all conferences and appeals related to student discipline shall take place via a virtual platform as to not deprive a student of any rights afforded by state or federal law.

The District will make a good faith effort to inform the student and the student's parent/guardian of the time and place of the Informal Due Process Conference and will hold the Informal Due Process Conference and make a placement decision, regardless of whether the student, the student's parent/guardian, or another adult representing the student attends the conference. The final decision shall be communicated promptly to the student and parent.

Recommendation for Expulsion: After the conference, if the recommendation is to expel the student, the appropriate campus administrator will issue and present the parent with a Recommendation for Expulsion letter. A copy of the Recommendation for Expulsion letter will be provided to the student's parent/guardian. A copy of the Recommendation for Expulsion letter and all information required by Section 52.04 of the Family Code will be delivered to the authorized officer of the juvenile court in which the student resides as mandated by the Texas Education Code under Section 37.010(a). Until a hearing can be held, the principal or designee may place the student in: another appropriate classroom, In-school suspension, Out-of-School Suspension, or DAEP.

Due Process/Expulsion Hearing: If a student is believed to have committed an expellable offense, the Student Relations Department at (956) 473-6263 will schedule a hearing. At the expulsion hearing, the student may be represented by the student's parent/guardian or another adult who can provide guidance to the student. The student and student's representative shall be notified in writing of the date, time, and place of the expulsion hearing at least 72 hours prior to the hearing.

Before a student is expelled, the Board or its designee (including a District Hearing Officer or District Committee appointed by the Superintendent or the Superintendent's Designee) shall provide the student an opportunity for a hearing at which the student is afforded due process. Only the District Committee, District Hearing Officer, or Board shall be authorized to make an audio/video recording of the hearing proceedings. Consequences will not be deferred pending the outcome of a hearing. The student is entitled to:

1. Prior notice of the charges and the proposed sanctions so as to afford a reasonable opportunity for preparation.
2. Representation by the student's parent/guardian or another adult, who is not an employee of the District, who along with the parent/guardian or legal counsel can provide guidance to the student, has the right to present information, evidence and witnesses

in his/her defense (if the witness is a student, parent permission is required), and has the right to examine the available information/evidence presented by the school administration in accordance with FERPA guidelines.

3. An opportunity to request documentation which will be relied on by the UISD administration at the hearing may be available to you upon request in accordance with FERPA guidelines.
4. Fair hearing before the Board or its designee.

After the District makes a good faith effort to inform the student and the student's parent/guardian of the time and place of the hearing, the District may hold the hearing, regardless of whether the student, the student's parent/guardian, or another adult representing the student attends. The notice shall be in writing and shall advise of the nature of the incident. The decision shall be based on information/evidence reflected in the record and any information or statements presented at the hearing. The final decision shall be communicated promptly to the student and parent.

In the event that a school or District is closed due to a federal, state, or local closure and the District has transitioned to a virtual learning environment, all conferences and appeals related to student discipline shall take place via a virtual platform as to not deprive a student of any rights afforded by state or federal law.

Superintendent's or Superintendent's Designee Review of Expulsion: A student's parent who wishes to appeal the decision made at the hearing may do so by appealing to the Superintendent or the Superintendent's Designee in writing within five (5) work days from the date of receipt of the written Expulsion Order. The Superintendent or the Superintendent's Designee shall provide the student or parent/guardian written notice of the date, time, and place of the meeting at which the Superintendent or the Superintendent's Designee will review the decision.

In the event that a school or District is closed due to a federal, state, or local closure and the District has transitioned to a virtual learning environment, all conferences and appeals related to student discipline shall take place via a virtual platform as to not deprive a student of any rights afforded by state or federal law.

Board Review of Expulsion: The decision of the Superintendent or the Superintendent's Designee may be appealed in compliance with FOD (Legal). The student or parent must submit a written request to the Superintendent within five days after receipt of the written decision. If an appeal is initiated in compliance with FOD (Legal), a tape recording or transcript of the proceeding shall be made for the Board's/Board committee's review. The Superintendent or the Superintendent's Designee shall provide the student or parent/guardian written notice of the date, time, and place of the meeting at which the Board will review the decision.

The Board will review the record of the expulsion hearing in a closed meeting unless the parent requests in writing that the matter be held in an open meeting. The Board may also hear a statement from the student or parent and from the Board's designee. Consequences will not be deferred pending the outcome of the hearing.

In the event that a school or District is closed due to a federal, state, or local closure and the District has transitioned to a virtual learning environment, all conferences and appeals related to student discipline shall take place via a virtual platform as to not deprive a student of any rights afforded by state or federal law.

Expulsion Order: After the due process hearing, if the student is expelled, the Board or its designee will deliver to the student and the student's parent a copy of the order expelling the student.

Expulsion to a Juvenile Justice Alternative Education Program: Students who are expelled are referred for enrollment in the Webb County Juvenile Justice Alternative Education Program. For more information, please contact the Student Relations Department at (956) 473-6263. No fees, including entrance or supply fees, will be charged by the JJAEP for participating in the program.

Length of Expulsion: The length of expulsion will be made in accordance with the guidelines set forth under General Guidelines for Assessing Discipline Penalties found in this Student Code of Conduct. Before a student may be expelled for more than one year the District must determine, after a review that: (1) the student is a threat to the safety of other students or to District employees or (2) extended expulsion is in the best interest of the student. Students who commit offenses that require expulsion at the end of one school year may be expelled into the next school year to complete the term of expulsion.

Emergency Expulsion: When an emergency expulsion occurs, the student will be given verbal and written notice of the reason for the action. Within ten days after the date of the emergency expulsion, the student will be given appropriate due process required for a student facing expulsion.

Firearm Violations: State and federal law require a student to be expelled from the regular classroom for a period of at least one calendar year for bringing a firearm, as defined by federal law, to school. However, the Superintendent or other appropriate administrator may modify the length of the expulsion on a case-by-case basis. The District shall provide educational services to an expelled student in a Disciplinary Alternative Education Program if the student is younger than ten years of age on the date of expulsion. The District may provide services to an expelled student who is older than 10 years of age in a Disciplinary Alternative Education Program.

A student may not be expelled solely on the basis of the student's use, exhibition, or possession of a firearm that occurs:

(1) at an approved target range facility that is not located on a school campus; and
(2) while participating in or preparing for a school-sponsored shooting sports competition or a shooting sports educational activity that is sponsored or supported by the Texas Parks and Wildlife Department or a shooting sports sanctioning organization working with the department.

This does not authorize a student to bring a firearm on school property to participate in, or prepare for a school-sponsored shooting sports competition or a shooting sports educational activity as described above.

Enrollment of Expelled Students: If an expelled student from another district or school enrolls in UISD, the governing body of the district or school taking the disciplinary action shall provide to UISD or the school in which the student enrolls, at the same time other records of the student are provided, a copy of the expulsion order. UISD may continue the expulsion order as per the terms of the expulsion order by expelling the student to a JJAEP, placing the student in a DAEP for the period specified by the expulsion order, or allowing the student to attend regular classes without completing the period of expulsion.

UISD may continue the expulsion order of another school district or another state if the out-of-state district provides UISD a copy of the expulsion order and the offense resulting in the expulsion is also an expellable offense in UISD. If the principal or other appropriate administrator, or board of the district in which the student was formerly enrolled fails to enter an order after the student withdraws, UISD may complete the proceedings and enter an order. If the period of expulsion by the out-of-state district exceeds one year, and UISD continues the expulsion, UISD will reduce the period of expulsion so that the aggregate period does not exceed one year unless, after a review, UISD determines that (1) the student is a threat to the safety of other students or to District employees; or (2) extended placement in is the best interest of the student.

Withdrawal during Expulsion Process: Students who withdraw from UISD to attend another public or private institution, including students who withdraw from UISD for the purpose of homeschooling, shall be required upon return to UISD to complete the number of days assigned to the JJAEP before being allowed to return to the regular campus. Any period of the expulsion that has been served by the student on enrollment in a JJAEP or another district's alternative school that honors UISD's expulsion order will be credited toward the expulsion. When a student has violated the UISD's Code in a way that requires or permits expulsion from UISD and the student withdraws from UISD before the expulsion hearing takes place, UISD may conduct the hearing after sending written notice to the parent and student. If the campus administrator or the Board fails to issue an expulsion order after the student withdraws from UISD, the next district in which the student enrolls may complete the proceedings.

Notice of Criminal Proceedings: The office of the prosecuting attorney shall notify the District if a student was placed in a DAEP for certain offenses and:

1. Prosecution of a student's case was refused for lack of prosecutorial merit or insufficient evidence and no formal proceedings, deferred adjudication (see Glossary), or deferred prosecution will be initiated; or
2. The court or jury found a student not guilty, or made a finding that the student did not engage in delinquent conduct or conduct indicating a need for supervision, and the case was dismissed with prejudice.

The parent/guardian may provide the Discipline Management Department with written notification subject to the disposition of an offense which is subject to student's placement or expulsion.

If a student was placed in a DAEP or expelled to a JJAEP for such conduct, on receiving the notice from the parent/guardian or the prosecutor, the Superintendent or designee will review the student's placement and schedule a review with the student's parent. The student may not be returned to the regular classroom pending the review. After reviewing the notice and receiving information from the student's parent, the Superintendent or designee may continue the student's placement if there is reason to believe that the presence of the student in the regular classroom threatens the safety of other students or teachers.

Continued Misconduct While Expelled: If, during the term of an expulsion order, a student engages in additional misconduct for which placement in a DAEP or expulsion is required or permitted, additional proceedings may be conducted regarding that conduct and the campus administrator or Board, as appropriate, may enter an additional disciplinary order as a result of those proceedings.

Restrictions for Expelled Students: Expelled students are prohibited from being on District grounds or attending school-sponsored or school-related activities during the period of expulsion.

Disciplinary Placement/Expulsion for Sexual Assault Occurring off Campus: A student who commits a sexual assault against another student, who at the time the offense occurs is assigned to the same campus, but regardless of whether the conduct occurs on or off school property, may be removed from class and placed in a DAEP or a JJAEP. There are no limitations on the term of placement of a student who has engaged in conduct that constitutes a sexual assault.

For purposes of the transfer and student placement provisions related to the commission of a sexual assault against another student, the student committing the assault must have: (1) been convicted of or placed on deferred adjudication for the offense of sexual assault under Section 22.011, Texas Penal Code, or aggravated sexual assault under Section 22.021, Texas Penal Code, committed against another student who, at the time the offense occurred, was assigned to the same campus as the student convicted or placed on deferred adjudication; (2) been adjudicated under Section 54.03, Texas Family Code, as having engaged in conduct described in (1); (3) received a deferred prosecution under Section 53.03, Texas Family Code, for engaging in conduct described in (1); (4) been placed on probation under Section 54.04(d)(1), Texas Family Code, for engaging in conduct described in (1); or (5) convicted of continuous sexual abuse of a young child or disabled individual under Section 21.02 of the Texas Penal Code.

A student who is the victim of conduct described above shall receive, on the request of a parent or other person with authority to act on behalf of a student, one of the following transfers:

1. To a District campus other than the campus to which the student was assigned at the time the conduct occurred; or
2. The campus to which the student who engaged in the conduct is assigned, if the student who engaged in the conduct has been assigned to a different campus since the conduct occurred; or
3. A neighboring school district, if there is only one campus in the District serving the grade level in which the student is enrolled.

The campus or school district to which the student is transferred must be agreeable to the parent or other person with authority to act on the student victim's behalf. The District is not required to provide transportation to a student who transfers to another campus or school district. If the student victim does not wish to transfer to another campus or district, the Board shall transfer the student who engaged in the conduct to a District campus other than the campus to which the student who is the victim of the conduct is assigned, or the District's

DAEP or JJAEP if there is only one campus in the District serving the grade level in which the student who engaged in the conduct is enrolled. To the extent permitted under federal law, a school district shall notify the parent or other person with authority to act on behalf of a student who is a victim of the conduct described above of the campus or program to which the student who engaged in the conduct described above is assigned. There are no hearings or appeals regarding this type of transfer.

Students Who Are Registered Sex Offenders: This new law applies to offenses committed on or after September 1, 2007. Upon receipt of notification that a student is a registered sex offender, a decision regarding the placement of the student into a District's DAEP or the JJAEP will be made according to the following guidelines:

The placement decision will be based upon whether the student is a registered sex offender. Students who are no longer required to register as a sex offender or who receive early termination of the obligation to register are not considered registered sex offenders. Placement into an alternative disciplinary program under this section supersedes all other legal provisions pertaining to alternative disciplinary placement. Additionally, students who are placed in an alternative setting under this provision must still maintain and comply with any other court ordered requirements relating to sex offender registrant status.

Students under Court Supervision: A student who is under any form of court supervision, including probation, community supervision, or parole, must be placed for at least one semester in a DAEP or in a JJAEP. If a student under court supervision is placed in the DAEP or in a JJAEP and transfers, the student may be required to complete an additional semester in an alternative placement in the new school district without a committee conducting a placement review as described below or the enrolling district may count the time spent by the student in the former district toward the required placement time.

Students Not Under Court Supervision: A student who is not under any form of court supervision may be placed in a disciplinary program or in the regular classroom unless the Board's designee determines that the student's presence threatens the safety of other students or teachers; will be detrimental to the educational process; or is not in the best interests of the District's students.

Placement Review after One Semester: A committee must be convened after the student is placed for one semester to review the student's placement. The committee must be composed of:

1. A classroom teacher from the campus to which the student would be assigned if the student was not in the alternative program;
2. The student's parole or probation officer or a representative of the local juvenile probation department;
3. An instructor from the alternative education program to which the student is assigned;
4. A District designee selected by the Board or its designee; and
5. A counselor employed by the District.

The committee must vote (majority vote) to determine whether the student should remain in the alternative setting or be returned to the regular classroom. The recommendation must be made to the Board or its designee. The Board must honor the recommendation unless one of the following:

1. Recommended regular classroom placement but Board's designee determines that the student's presence:
    a. threatens the safety of other students or teachers;
    b. will be detrimental to the educational process; or
    c. is not in the best interests of the District's student OR
2. Recommend continued alternative setting but the Board's designee determines that the student's presence:
    a. does not threaten the safety of other students or teachers;
    b. will not be detrimental to the educational process; or
    c. is not contrary to the best interests of the District's students.

If the recommendation is to continue the alternative setting and the Board determines that this will occur, then before the beginning of each school year, the placement committee must meet and make its determination and recommendation again.

Student Receiving Special Education Services: A placement for a student with a disability receiving special education services must be made in compliance with IDEA as amended by the IDEA Improvement Act of 2004. If a student receiving special education services is placed into an alternative setting for more than one semester, the placement review as described above must be conducted by the student's Admission Review and Dismissal (ARD) Committee. The ARD Committee can request that a placement committee with the members described be convened in order to assist in conducting the review.

Appeal: A student or parent/guardian may appeal a placement as a registered sex offender by requesting a conference among the Board or its designee, the parents/guardian and the student. This conference will be limited to the factual question of whether the student is required to register as a sex offender under Chapter 62 of the Code of Criminal Procedure. If the determination is made that the student is required to register as a sex offender, the student is subject to placement in an alternative education program. This decision made by the Board or its designee is final and may not be appealed.

Graduating Juniors/Seniors in the JJAEP: When a student is expelled during the 11th or 12th grade, UISD may allow that student to participate in graduation ceremonies if the student has completed the days of expulsion at the JJAEP at the time of graduation and that all prerequisites for graduation are met. If the student in question has met all prerequisites for graduation but has not completed his/her days in the JJAEP, the student may be allowed to participate in graduation ceremonies. Any student placed in a JJAEP for more than 15 days during the 9th, 10th, 11th, or 12th grade for committing an offense involving Academic Dishonesty (see Glossary) shall not be given a speaking role or recognized for any academic achievement, including but not limited to valedictorian, salutatorian, class president, or top 10 in the class, at graduation ceremonies.

Expulsion of Special Education Students: A student with a disability being served in Special Education may be expelled for engaging in conduct that would warrant such action for a student without such disabilities only if the ARD Committee determines the misconduct is not related to the student's disabling condition or inappropriate placement.

Before an expulsion or other exclusion that constitutes a change in placement, the ARD Committee must conduct a "manifestation determination" to determine whether the student's conduct was caused by his/her disabling condition or was the direct result of the district's failure to implement the individualized education program (IEP). Such a determination should be based on current evaluations and/or assessment data and on review of the current IEP documentation. The ARD Committee shall consider whether the student's behavior indicates the need for new assessment or evaluation data. Unless the parents agree otherwise, the student must be returned to his or her placement while additional assessments are being conducted.

The ARD Committee shall determine the instructional and related services to be provided during the time of expulsion. The student's IEP shall include goals and objectives designed to assist in returning the student to school and preventing significant regression. If the ARD Committee determines that the student's disruptive behavior is related to the disabling condition or inappropriate placement, the student shall not be expelled (except when the violation involves drugs, weapons, or serious bodily injury). If the disruptive behavior on the part of the student indicates an inappropriate placement, the ARD Committee shall review the placement and recommend alternatives. If the ARD Committee determines that the behavior was related to the disabling condition, it shall either rewrite the IEP to address the student's behavioral and educational needs or, when appropriate, consider the extension of an emergency removal.

In accordance with the Education Code, a student who receives special education services may not be disciplined in a manner that results in a change in the student's educational placement for conduct meeting the definition of bullying, cyberbullying, harassment, or making hit lists until an ARD committee meeting has been held to review the conduct.

Expulsion of Section 504 Students: Students served under Section 504 are treated similar to students served under IDEA with respect to discipline. Before an expulsion or other exclusion that constitutes a significant change in placement, the Section 504 Committee must conduct a "manifestation determination" to determine whether the student's conduct was caused by his/her disabling condition. Such a determination should be based on current data.

If it is determined by the Section 504 Committee that the misconduct is not caused by the student's disabling condition, the student may be excluded from school in the same manner as similarly situated nondisabled students are excluded, but educational services may not be terminated completely during the expulsion period. Educational services should be provided to the extent necessary to prevent regression in the area of the student's disabling condition.

If the results of the Section 504 Manifestation Determination Meeting indicate that the conduct was related to the student's disability, the District may not discontinue educational services to the student (except when the violation involves drugs, weapons, or serious bodily injury). The Section 504 Committee then needs to reevaluate the student to determine if his current placement and Individual Accommodation Plan is appropriate or needs to be changed.

Course Credit during Disciplinary Process: Students shall receive full credit for assignments completed in a DAEP, including In-School Suspension. Students who are placed in the District's In-School Suspension or another setting other than a DAEP will be offered an opportunity to complete coursework before the beginning of the next school year for each course in which the student was enrolled at the time of the removal. Available methods to complete coursework include, but are not limited to, correspondence courses, distance learning, or summer school. Teachers are to inform students of the time allotted for completion of the work. Students are responsible for obtaining the assignments and completing the work within the time allotted, and students are allowed to make up both class work and homework.

Students who are placed in the Webb County Juvenile Justice Alternative Education Program following expulsion are eligible to receive credit for course work completed during the expulsion. Students with disabilities will receive educational services during expulsion as determined by the Admission, Review, and Dismissal (ARD) and/or Section 504 Committees.

SECTION V—Searches, Metal Detectors, Questioning of Students, and Taking Students into Custody

Searches: In the interest of promoting student safety and attempting to ensure that schools are safe and drug free, District officials may from time to time conduct searches. Such searches are conducted without a warrant and as permitted by law. School officials may search a student's outer clothing, pockets, or property by establishing reasonable suspicion or securing the student's voluntary consent. Vehicles on school property are also subject to search.

Areas such as lockers, which are owned by the District and jointly controlled by the District and student, may be searched by school administrators, law enforcement or other appropriate personnel may AND routinely conduct blanket locker searches. Students shall not place, keep, or maintain any article or material in school-owned lockers that is forbidden by the District, or that would lead school officials to reasonably believe that it would cause a substantial disruption on school property or at a school-sponsored function.

Students are responsible for any and all prohibited items found in their possession, in their lockers, personal belongings, or in vehicles parked on school property, and shall be subject to appropriate school disciplinary action in accordance with this Student Code of Conduct and/or prosecution.

Students' Desks and Lockers: Students' desks and lockers are school property and remain under the control and jurisdiction of the school even when assigned to an individual student. Students are fully responsible for the security and contents of the assigned desks and lockers. Students must be certain that the locker is locked, and that the combination is not available to others.

Inspections and searches of desks or lockers may be conducted at any time there is reasonable cause to believe that they contain articles or materials prohibited by the District, whether or not a student is present. The parent will be notified if any prohibited items are found in the student's desk or locker.

Vehicles on Campus: Parking is a privilege. All vehicles on campus must be registered and the parking permit sticker displayed. An application must be completed and signed by the student and parent/guardian and returned before a parking permit will be issued. Upon receipt of the application and approval of the documentation required, a parking permit will be issued and affixed inside the lower left corner of the front windshield or visible area of the motorcycle. Parking permits will be sold to students with a valid driver's license and proof of insurance. The student driver's name must be listed on the insurance. Motorcycle operators are also required to register. Parking permits will be sold until the capacity of the student lot has been reached. Parking permits are only valid during the school year purchased. Periodic random checks for proof of insurance will be conducted. Electric motorized recreational vehicles, go-carts, mopeds, scooters, hover board (i.e. segway), etc. are strictly prohibited on district property.

Students not having a current valid parking permit displayed may receive a written warning attached to vehicle, lose their parking permit and privilege, and the vehicle is subject to being towed at owner's expense. All students driving to school must display the appropriate parking permit in order to park on campus. Students shall park in the areas designated for student parking. The responsibility of finding a legal parking space rests with the motor vehicle operator. Lack of space is not considered an excuse for violation of parking regulations. Students are not permitted to park in staff, faculty, or visitor designated parking spaces at any time. Parking in unauthorized spaces or occupying more than one parking space will cause violators to lose their parking permit and/or towing of the vehicle at owner's expense.

Students shall comply with all local and state traffic regulations while operating any motor vehicle on campus. Citations will be issued for traffic and parking violations. The operator of any vehicle shall comply with the legal instructions of any campus security officer and all traffic signs.

Parking permits may be revoked for a number of reasons. These include but are not limited to:

- Leaving campus without authorization
- Taking other students off campus without authorization
- Reckless driving on or near campus or involving a school bus
- Violating safety and/or parking regulations

This shall serve as notice that United Independent School District is not liable for any vandalism to, or theft of or from, vehicles parked on District property. Furthermore, charges for towing vehicles are at the owner's expense.

Pursuant to state law effective September 1, 2007, a student who violates a provision in the student code of conduct providing for the operation and parking of vehicles on school property commits a Class C Misdemeanor. Vehicles parked on school property are under the jurisdiction of the school. The school may search any vehicle any time there is reasonable cause to do so, with or without the student's permission or presence. A student has full responsibility for the security of his or her vehicle and must make certain that it is locked and that the keys are not given to others. If a vehicle subject to search is locked, the student will be asked to unlock the vehicle. If the student refuses, the student's parent will be contacted. If a search is also refused by the student's parent, the District will turn the matter over to law enforcement. The District may, in certain circumstances, contact law enforcement even if permission to search is granted.

It is a criminal offense to intentionally exhibit, use, or threaten to exhibit or use a firearm in a manner intended to cause alarm or personal injury to another person, or to damage school property in or on any property, including a parking lot, parking garage, or other parking area that is owned by a private or public school; or any school bus being used to transport children to and from school-sponsored activities of a private or public school.

Random Drug Searches/Drug Detection Dogs: In order to ensure a drug-free learning environment, the District conducts random drug searches of school facilities. During these random drug searches, lockers, hallways, classrooms, grounds, vehicles, etc. are subject to drug checks by trained dogs at any time. If a dog alerts to a locker, a vehicle, an item in a classroom, or other common area, that locker, vehicle, or item may be searched by school officials. Trained dogs' sniffing of cars and lockers does not constitute a search under the Fourth Amendment. The alert of a trained dog to a locker or car provides reasonable cause for a search of the locker or car. (See FNF Legal).

Metal Detectors: The District does not tolerate conduct which endangers students or employees or disrupts the educational process. Accordingly, stationary and hand-held metal detectors may be used periodically to search for weapons, safeguard students and employees, and to maintain a safe environment.

All students and their possessions are subject to search by a walk-through or hand-held metal detector. Students shall be subject to the search where individualized reasonable suspicion exists that the student possesses a weapon. As necessary for efficiency purposes, students entering the school may be randomly selected for the search based on a formulaic method. All weapons which are found shall be confiscated and turned over to appropriate law enforcement agency(ies) for a determination on whether to initiate criminal prosecution.

Scanning devices shall be operated and searches shall be conducted by authorized District personnel or School Resource Officers. A District employee, volunteer or independent contractor may, within the person's scope of duties, apply physical restraint on a student in an emergency and as reasonably necessary to address the emergency and protect the safety of the student and others.

Students found in possession of a weapon or other prohibited items or contraband during the search shall be subject to appropriate disciplinary action in accordance with the Student Code of Conduct.

Questioning of Students: When law enforcement officers or other lawful authorities desire to question or interview a student at school for any purpose other than a child abuse investigation, the following guidelines shall apply:

- The principal or other appropriate administrator shall verify and record the identity of the officer or other authority and request an explanation of the need to question or interview the student at school.

- The principal or other appropriate administrator ordinarily shall make reasonable efforts to notify the student's parents or other person having lawful control of the student. If the interviewer raises what the principal or other appropriate administrator considers to be a valid objection to the notification, parents shall not be notified.
- The principal or a designee ordinarily shall be present during the questioning or interview. If the interviewer raises what the principal or other appropriate administrator considers to be a valid objection to a third party's presence, the interview shall be conducted without that person's presence.

Child Abuse Investigation: When a representative of the Department of Family and Protective Services or another lawful authority desires to question or interview a student at school as part of a child abuse investigation, the principal or other appropriate administrator shall cooperate fully with the representative's/officers' requests regarding the conditions of the interview or questioning.

Release of Child in Custody to School Campus: If a student is brought to a school campus by a law enforcement officer who request that the child will be released into the custody of the campus principal, his or her designee, or the peace officer assigned to the school campus can agree to assume responsibility for the student for the remainder of the day. A reasonable attempt to notify the parent/guardian of the circumstances under which the student was brought to school will be made; however, a school official is not required to assume such responsibility or to notify the parent/guardian of this fact**.**

Taking Students Into Custody: Law enforcement officers or other lawful authorities have the authority to question or interview a student at school. Law enforcement officers also have the authority to arrest or take a student into custody at school. [Board Policies FNF (LEGAL) and FNF (LOCAL)]. State law requires the District to permit a student to be taken into legal custody:

- To comply with an order of the juvenile court.
- To comply with the laws of arrest.
- By a law enforcement officer if there is probable cause to believe the student has engaged in delinquent conduct or conduct in need of supervision.
- By a probation officer if there is probable cause to believe the student has violated a condition of probation imposed by the juvenile court.
- To comply with a properly issued directive to take a student into custody.
- By an authorized representative of Child Protective Services, Texas Department of Protective and Regulatory Services, a law enforcement officer, or a juvenile probation officer, without a court order, under the conditions set out in the Texas Family Code relating to the student's physical health or safety.

Before a student is released to a law enforcement officer or other legally authorized person, the principal or designee shall verify the officer's identity and, to the best of his or her ability, shall verify the official's authority to take custody of the student. The principal or designee shall immediately notify the Superintendent or designee and shall notify the parents or other person having lawful control of the student. If the officer or other authorized person raises what the principal or other appropriate administrator considers to be a valid objection to notifying the parents at that time, the principal or other appropriate administrator shall not notify the parents. Since the principal or designee does not have the authority to block or delay a custody action, notification will most likely be after the fact.

Notification of Law Violations: The District is also required by state law to notify:

- All instructional and support personnel who have responsibility for supervising a student who has been arrested or referred to the juvenile court for any felony offense or for certain misdemeanors.
- All instructional and support personnel who have regular contact with a student who has been convicted or adjudicated of delinquent conduct for any felony offense or certain misdemeanors. For further information, see GRA POLICY.

GLOSSARY

The glossary provides legal definitions and locally established definitions and is intended to assist in understanding terms related to the Student Code of Conduct.

ABUSE: Improper or excessive use.

ACADEMIC DISHONESTY: Any type of cheating that occurs in relation to a formal academic exercise. It can include:

- Cheating, which includes fraud, deceit, or dishonesty in an academic assignment, or using or attempting to use materials, or assisting others in using materials that are prohibited or inappropriate in the context of the academic assignment in question.
- Plagiarism, which includes use of intellectual material, including ideas or words, produced by another person without acknowledging its source.
- False Information and Representation and Fabrication or Alteration of Information, which includes furnishing false information, failing to identify oneself honestly, fabricating or altering information and presenting it as legitimate, or providing false or misleading information to an instructor or any other District official in an academic context.
- Theft or Damage of Intellectual Property, which includes sabotaging or stealing another person's work, improper access to or electronically interfering with the property of another person or the District, or obtaining a copy of an exam or assignment prior to its approved release.
- Deception, which includes providing false information to an instructor concerning a formal academic exercise – e.g., giving a false excuse for missing a deadline or falsely claiming to have submitted work.
- Alternation of District Documents, which includes forgery of an instructor's signature, submitting an altered District document, putting one's name on another's individual work, or falsely altering a previously graded exam or assignment.

AGGRAVATED ROBBERY: As defined in part by Texas Penal Code §29.03(a), when a person commits robbery and:

1. Causes serious bodily injury to another;
2. Uses or exhibits a deadly weapon; or
3. Causes bodily injury to another person or threatens or places another person in fear of imminent bodily injury or death, if the other person is: (a.) 65 years of age or older, or b. A disabled person.

ARD: Admissions, Review, and Dismissal. An ARD Committee serves to make decisions regarding the educational program of students who qualify for Special Education services.

ARMOR-PIERCING AMMUNITION: As defined by Texas Penal Code §46.01, handgun ammunition used in pistols and revolvers and designed primarily for the purpose of penetrating metal or body armor.

ARSON: As defined in part by Texas Penal Code §28.02:

1. A crime that involves starting a fire or causing an explosion with intent to destroy or damage:
   A. Any vegetation, fence, or structure on open-space land; or
   B. Any building, habitation, or vehicle:
      1. Knowing that it is within the limits of an incorporated city or town,
      2. Knowing that it is insured against damage or destruction,
      3. Knowing that it is subject to a mortgage or other security interest,
      4. Knowing that it is located on property belonging to another,
      5. Knowing that it has located within it property belonging to another, or
      6. When the person starting the fire is reckless about whether the burning or explosion will endanger the life of some individual or the safety of the property of another;
2. A crime that involves recklessly starting a fire or causing an explosion while manufacturing or attempting to manufacture a controlled substance and the fire or explosion damages any building, habitation, or vehicle; or
3. A crime that involves intentionally starting a fire or causing an explosion and in so doing:
   A. Recklessly damages or destroys a building belonging to another, or
   B. Recklessly causes another person to suffer bodily injury or death.

ASSAULT: A person commits an offense if the person intentionally, knowingly, or recklessly causes bodily injury to another [See Texas Penal Code §22.01(a) (1)]; intentionally or knowingly threatening another with imminent bodily injury [See Texas Penal Code §22.01(a) (2)]; or as intentionally or knowingly causing physical contact with another that can reasonably be regarded as offensive or provocative [See Texas Penal Code §22.01(a) (3)].

BIP: Behavior Intervention Plan (formerly known as Behavior Management Plan). A BIP is the section on an Individual Education Plan, which documents modifications or adaptations to the School Districts disciplinary rules, which accommodate the unique needs of a student with a disability. A BIP is designed to decrease and/or ultimately eliminate inappropriate behaviors that may interfere with the student's or other students' ability to receive an education.

BODILY INJURY: Physical pain, illness, or any impairment of physical condition.

BULLYING: As defined by §37.0832 of the Texas Education Code, a single significant act or a pattern of acts by one or more students directed at another student that exploits an imbalance of power and involves engaging in written or verbal expression, expression through electronic means, or physical conduct that:

(1) Has the effect or will have the effect of physical harming a student, damaging a student's property, or placing a student in reasonable fear of harm to the student's person or of damage to the student's property;
(2) Is sufficiently severe, persistent or pervasive enough that the action or threat creates an intimidating, threatening, or abusive educational environment for a student;
(3) Materially and substantially disrupts the educational process or the orderly operation of a classroom or school; or
(4) Infringes on the rights of the victim at school.

CATFISHING: Term used when a person takes information and/or images from another person and creates a new identity for themselves to target a victim and/or deceive people for love, money or manipulation.

CHEMICAL DISPENSING DEVICE: As defined by Texas Penal Code §46.01, a device designed, made, or adapted for the purpose of dispensing a substance capable of causing an adverse psychological or physiological effect on a human being. A small chemical dispenser sold commercially for personal protection is not in this category.

CITATION (TICKET): Notice of disorderly conduct, tobacco use, or other legal violation that may be issued by school or local law enforcement personnel when a student engages in certain conduct; this is an action separate from any school disciplinary action.

CLUB: As defined by Texas Penal Code §46.01, an instrument specially designed, made, or adapted for the purpose of inflicting serious bodily injury or death. A blackjack, nightstick, mace, and tomahawk are in the same category.

CONDUCT IN NEED OF SUPERVISION: Conduct indicating a need for supervision includes the absence of a child on ten or more days or parts of days within a six-month period in the same school year or on three or more days or parts of days within a four-week period from school. Family Code 51.03(b)(2). It is an affirmative defense to prosecution for nonattendance or to an allegation of conduct in need of supervision that one or more of the absences required to be proven were excused by a school official or by the court or that one or more of the absences were involuntary, but only if there is an insufficient number of unexcused or voluntary absences remaining to constitute an offense.

CONTROLLED SUBSTANCE and DANGEROUS DRUG: Controlled substance means a substance, including a drug, adulterant, and a dilutant, listed in Schedules I through V or Penalty Group 1, 1-A, 1-B, 2, 2-A, 3, or 4 of the Texas Controlled Substances Act. The term includes the aggregate weight of any mixture, solution, or other substance containing a controlled substance. The term does not include hemp, as defined by the Agriculture Code §121.001, or the tetrahydrocannabinols (THC) in hemp. **Dangerous drug** is defined by Health and Safety Code §483.001 as a device or a drug that is unsafe for self-medication and that is not included in Schedules I through V or Penalty Groups 1 through 4 of the Texas Controlled Substances Act. The term includes a device or drug that federal law prohibits dispensing without prescription or restricts to use by or on the order of a licensed veterinarian.

CRIMINAL MISCHIEF: Without the effective consent of the owner, (a) intentionally or knowingly damaging or destroying the tangible property of the owner; (b) intentionally or knowingly tampering with the tangible property of the owner and causing pecuniary loss or substantial inconvenience to the owner or a third person; or (c) intentionally or knowingly making markings, including inscriptions, slogans, drawings, or paintings, on the tangible property of the owner.

CRIMINAL STREET GANG: Three or more persons having a common identifying sign or symbol or an identifiable leadership who continuously or regularly associate in the commission of criminal activities.

CYBERBULLYING: As defined by §37.0832 of the Texas Education Code, bullying that is done through the use of any electronic device, including through the use of a cellular or other type of telephone, a computer, a camera, electronic mail, instant messaging, text messaging, a social media application, an Internet website, or any other Internet-based communication tool.

DATING VIOLENCE: As defined by §71.0021 of the Family Code, "dating violence" means an act, other than a defensive measure to protect oneself, by an actor that:

1. is committed against a victim or applicant for a protective order:
    a. with whom the actor has or has had a dating relationship; or
    b. because of the victim's or applicant's marriage to or dating relationship with an individual with whom the actor is or has been in a dating relationship or marriage; and
2. is intended to result in physical harm, bodily injury, assault, or sexual assault or that is a threat that reasonably places the victim or applicant in fear of imminent physical harm, bodily injury, assault, or sexual assault.

For purposes of this title, "dating relationship" means a relationship between individuals who have or have had a continuing relationship of a romantic or intimate nature.

DEADLY CONDUCT: Occurs when a person recklessly engages in conduct that places another in imminent danger of serious bodily injury, such as knowingly discharging a firearm in the direction of an individual, habitation, building, or vehicle.

DEFERRED ADJUDICATION: An alternative to seeking a conviction in court that may be offered to a juvenile for delinquent conduct or conduct indicating a need for supervision.

DEFERRED PROSECUTION: May be offered to a juvenile as an alternative to seeking a conviction in court for delinquent conduct or conduct indicating a need for supervision.

DELINQUENT CONDUCT: Conduct that violates either state or federal law and is punishable by imprisonment or confinement in jail. It includes conduct that violates certain juvenile court orders, including probation orders, but does not include violations of traffic laws.

DISCIPLINARY ALTERNATIVE EDUCATION PROGRAM (DAEP): An educational program provided by the School District for students who have engaged in serious misconduct, such as assault, drug- or alcohol-related offenses, public lewdness, abuse of volatile chemicals, and unruly, disruptive, or abusive classroom behavior. DAEP's may be located on or off the regular campus. Students in DAEP's are

separated from students in the regular program. DAEP provides supervision and counseling and focuses on English language arts, mathematics, science, history, and self-discipline.

DISCRETIONARY: When something is left to or regulated by a local decision maker.

DISRUPTIONS OF SCHOOL OPERATIONS: Any disruption of school operations is not tolerated and may constitute a misdemeanor offense. As identified by law, disruptions include the following:

- Interference with the movement of people at an exit, entrance, or hallway of district building without authorization from an administrator.
- Interference with an authorized activity by seizing control of all or part of a building.
- Use of force, violence, or threats in an attempt to prevent participation in an authorized assembly.
- Use of force, violence, or threats to cause disruption during an assembly.
- Interference with the movement of people at an exit or an entrance to district property.
- Use of force, violence, or threats in an attempt to prevent people from entering or leaving district property without authorization from an administrator.
- Disruption of classes or other school activities while on district property or on public property that is within 500 feet of district property. Class disruption includes making loud noises; trying to entice a student away from, or to prevent a student from attending, a required class or activity; and entering a classroom without authorization and disrupting the activity with loud or profane language or any misconduct.
- Interference with the transportation of students in vehicles owned or operated by the district.

DISRUPTIVE ACTIVITIES (TEC §37.123):

(a) A person commits an offense if the person, alone or in concert with others, intentionally engages in disruptive activity on the campus or property of any private or public school.

(b) For purposes of this section, disruptive activity is:

(1) obstructing or restraining the passage of persons in an exit, entrance, or hallway of a building without the authorization of the administration of the school;

(2) seizing control of a building or portion of a building to interfere with an administrative, educational, research, or other authorized activity;

(3) preventing or attempting to prevent by force or violence or the threat of force or violence a lawful assembly authorized by the school administration so that a person attempting to participate in the assembly is unable to participate due to the use of force or violence or due to a reasonable fear that force or violence is likely to occur;

(4) disrupting by force or violence or the threat of force or violence a lawful assembly in progress; or

(5) obstructing or restraining the passage of a person at an exit or entrance to the campus or property or preventing or attempting to prevent by force or violence or by threats of force or violence the ingress or egress of a person to or from the property or campus without the authorization of the administration of the school.

(c) An offense under this section is a Class B misdemeanor.

(d) Any person who is convicted the third time of violating this section is ineligible to attend any institution of higher education receiving funds from this state before the second anniversary of the third conviction.

(e) This section may not be construed to infringe on any right of free speech or expression guaranteed by the constitution of the United States or of this state.

DISRUPTION OF CLASSES (TEC §37.124): A person commits an offense if the person, on school property or on public property within 500 feet of school property, alone or in concert with others, intentionally disrupts the conduct of classes or other school activities. An offense under this section is a Class C misdemeanor. In this section:

(1) "Disrupting the conduct of classes or other school activities" includes:

(A) emitting noise of an intensity that prevents or hinders classroom instruction;

(B) enticing or attempting to entice a student away from a class or other school activity that the student is required to attend;

(C) preventing or attempting to prevent a student from attending a class or other school activity that the student is required to attend; and

(D) entering a classroom without the consent of either the principal or other appropriate administrator or the teacher and, through either acts of misconduct or the use of loud or profane language, disrupting class activities.

(2) "Public property" includes a street, highway, alley, public park, or sidewalk.

(3) "School property" includes a public school campus or school grounds on which a public school is located and any grounds or buildings used by a school for an assembly or other school-sponsored activity.

DISTRICT OR SCHOOL: Includes an independent school district, a home-rule school district, a campus or campus program charter holder, or an open-enrollment charter school.

EXPLOSIVE WEAPON: As defined by Texas Penal Code §46.01, any explosive or incendiary bomb, grenade, rocket, or mine and its delivery mechanism that is designed, made, or adapted for the purpose of inflicting serious bodily injury, death, or substantial property damage, or for the principal purpose of causing such a loud report as to cause undue public alarm or terror.

E-CIGARETTE: An electronic cigarette or any other device that simulates smoking by using a mechanical heating element, battery, or electronic circuit to deliver nicotine or other substances to the individual inhaling from the device or a consumable liquid solution or other material aerosolized or vaporized during the use of an electronic cigarette or other device described by this provision. The term includes any device that is manufactured, distributed, or sold as an e-cigarette, e-cigar, or e-pipe or under another product name or description and a

component, part, or accessory for the device, regardless of whether the component, part, or accessory is sold separately from the device.

EXPULSION: An act of the school administration, which forbids a student from attending school for a period in excess of three school days. Expulsions can be for periods as long as a semester or a school year. In serious cases, an expulsion can be longer than one school year.

FALSE ALARM OR REPORT: Occurs when a person knowingly initiates, communicates, or circulates a report of a present, past, or future bombing, fire, offense, or other emergency that he or she knows is false or baseless and that would ordinarily:

1. Cause action by an official or volunteer agency organized to deal with emergencies;
2. Place a person in fear of imminent serious bodily injury; or
3. Prevent or interrupt the occupation of a building, room, or place of assembly.

FIGHT: Engaging in a struggle, conflict, quarrel, or argument involving physical contact with one or more students or staff members which does not rise to the level of assault as defined in §22.01(a)(1) of the Texas Penal Code

FIREARM: As defined by federal law (18 U.S.C. §921(a)): 1. Any weapon (including a starter gun) that will, is designed to, or may readily be converted to expel a projectile by the action of an explosive; 2. The frame or receiver of any such weapon; 3. Any firearm muffler or firearm silencer, defined as any device for silencing, muffling, or diminishing the report of a portable firearm; or 4. Any destructive device, such as any explosive, incendiary or poison gas bomb, or grenade. Such term does not include an antique firearm.

GANG: An organization composed, in whole or in part, of students, which seeks to perpetuate itself by taking in additional members from the student population on the basis of the decision of the organization's membership as a whole, rather than on the free choice of the individual student.

GANG ACTIVITIES, PUBLIC SCHOOL FRATERNITY, SORORITY, AND SECRET SOCIETIES: Students shall not become members or promise to become members of any organization composed wholly or in part of students of public schools below the rank of college or junior college which seeks to perpetuate itself by taking in additional members from the students enrolled in such school on the basis of the decision of its membership, rather than upon the free choice of any student in the school who is qualified under the rules of the school to fill the special aims of the organization. Students shall be warned against such membership and once warned, any student who continues such membership or promise shall be guilty of serious misbehavior and may be recommended for placement in a Disciplinary Alternative Education Program.

More specifically, students are prohibited from engaging in the following activities, at school, at any school-related activity, or on a school bus, which the District considers to be gang-related:

1. Wearing, possessing, using, distributing, displaying, or selling any clothing, jewelry, emblems, badges, symbols, signs, graffiti, or other affiliation in any gang;
2. Committing any act or omission, or using any speech, either verbal or non-verbal (gestures, handshakes, etc.), showing membership or affiliation in a gang;
3. Using any speech, or committing any act or omission in furtherance of interest in any gang or gang activity, including, but not limited to:
   a. Coercing, inducing or soliciting others for membership in any gang;
   b. Requesting any person to pay for protection, or otherwise intimidating or threatening any person;
   c. Inciting other students to act with physical violence upon any other person;
   d. Engaging in conduct with others in intimidating, fighting, assaulting, or threatening to assault others;
   e. Committing any other illegal acts or other violations of District policies.

Students who engage in these activities shall be subject to disciplinary action, which may include suspension, removal to a Disciplinary Alternative Education Program, or expulsion.

GRAFFITI: A person commits an offense if, without the effective consent of the owner, the person intentionally or knowingly makes markings, including inscriptions, slogans, drawings, or paintings, on the tangible property of the owner with:

1. Aerosol paint;
2. An indelible pen or marker; or
3. Etching or engraving device.

An offense under this section is a state jail felony if:

1. The marking is made on a school, an institution of higher education, a place of worship or human burial, a public monument, or a community center that provides medical, social, or educational programs; and
2. The amount of the pecuniary loss to real property or to tangible personal property is less than $20,000.

HANDGUN: As defined by Texas Penal Code §46.01, any firearm that is designed, made, or adapted to be fired with one hand.

HARASSMENT: (1) Conduct that meets the definition established in District policies DIA (Local) and FFH (Local); (2) Conduct that threatens to cause harm or bodily injury to another person, including a district student, employee, Board member, or volunteer; is sexually intimidating conduct, causes physical damage to the property of another student, subjects another student to physical confinement or restraint, or maliciously and substantially harms another student's physical or emotional health or safety, as defined in §37.001(b)(2) of the Texas Education Code; or (3) Conduct that is punishable as a crime under Texas Penal Code §42.07, including the following types of conduct if carried out with intent to harass, annoy, alarm, abuse, torment, or embarrass another: (a) Initiating communication and, in the course of the communication, making a comment, request, suggestion, or proposal that is obscene, as defined by law; (b) Threatening, in a manner reasonably likely to alarm the person receiving the threat, to inflict bodily injury on the person or to commit a felony against the person, a member of the person's family or household, or the person's property; (c) Conveying, in a manner reasonably likely to alarm the person receiving the report, a false report, which is known by the conveyor to be false, that another person has suffered death or serious bodily injury; and (d) Sending

repeated electronic communications in a manner reasonably likely to harass, annoy, alarm, abuse, torment, embarrass, or offend another; and (e) Publishing on an internet website, including a social media platform, repeated electronic communications in a manner reasonably likely to cause emotional distress, abuse, or torment to another person, unless the communications are made in connection with a matter of public concern, as described by law.

HAZING: As defined by §37.151 of the Texas Education Code, an intentional, knowing, or reckless act, on or off campus, by one person alone or acting with others, directed at a student for the purpose of pledging, initiation into, affiliation with, holding office in, or maintaining membership in an organization if the act: (A) is any type of physical brutality, such as whipping, beating, striking, branding, electronic shocking, placing of a harmful substance on the body, or similar activity; (B) involves sleep deprivation, exposure to the elements, confinement in a small space, calisthenics, or other similar activity that subjects the student to an unreasonable risk of harm or that adversely affects the mental or physical health or safety of the student; (C) involves consumption of a food, liquid, alcoholic beverage, liquor, drug, or other substance other than as described in Paragraph (E), that subjects the student to an unreasonable risk of harm or that adversely affects the mental or physical health or safety of the student; (D) is any activity that induces, causes, or requires the student to perform a duty or task that involves a violation of the Texas Penal Code; or (E) involves coercing, as defined by §1.07 of the Texas Penal Code, the student to consume: (i) a drug; or (ii) an alcoholic beverage or liquor in an amount that would lead a reasonable person to believe that the student is intoxicated, as defined by §49.01 of the Texas Penal Code. Students shall have prior approval from the principal or designee for any type of initiation rites of a school club or organization. No student shall engage in any form of hazing, nor shall any student encourage or assist any other person in hazing. It is a criminal offense if a person engages in hazing; solicits, encourages, directs, aids, or attempts to aid another in hazing; or has firsthand knowledge of an incident of hazing being planned or having occurred and fails to report this to the principal, other campus administrator, or superintendent. Acts of hazing and failure to report known hazing or planned hazing can result in criminal penalties, as well as school discipline, including, but not limited to, suspension, removal to a DAEP, or expulsion.

HIT LIST: As defined by Texas Education Code §37.001(b)(3), a list of people targeted to be harmed, using: a firearm; a knife; or any other object to be used with intent to cause bodily harm.

HOMELESS STUDENTS: As defined by 42 U.S.C. §11434a, means individuals who lack a fixed, regular, and adequate residence; and includes: (i) children and youths who are sharing the housing of other persons due to loss of housing, economic hardship, or a similar reason; are living in motels, hotels, trailer parks, or camping grounds due to the lack of alternative adequate accommodations; are living in emergency or traditional shelters; or are abandoned in hospitals; (ii) children and youth who have a primary nighttime residence that is a public or private place not designed for or ordinarily used as a regular sleeping accommodation for human beings; (iii) children and youths who are living in cars, parks, public spaces, abandoned buildings, substandard housing, bus or train stations, or similar settings; and (iv) migratory children who qualify as homeless for the purposes of this part the children are living in circumstances described in clauses (i) through (iii).

IAP: A Section 504 Individual Accommodation Plan is a written plan that describes the educational and related aids and services that a Section 504 Committee determines a student needs to receive a Free and Appropriate Public Education (FAPE). The IAP contains a set of instructions that detail specific strategies and practices that will be used to:

- Communicate to teachers what strategies and practices will be used to ensure that a student's learning needs are met
- Detail any specialized learning materials or equipment needed for the child's instruction or physical needs
- Explain any class work or homework accommodations the child will receive
- List any additional support services the child may need to benefit from education
- Explain any grading or assessment changes the student will receive
- Detail the strategies used for Behavior Intervention Plans
- Specify how the parents or guardians of a child will assist with the accommodation plan, if applicable
- Detail the child's responsibilities regarding the plan, if any.

IEP: An Individual Education Plan is developed for each student who receives Special Education Services. The IEP must include: (1) a statement of the child's present levels of educational performance; (2) a statement of measureable annual goals including academic and functional goals; (3) a description of how the child's progress toward meeting the goals will be provided; (4) a statement of the special education and related services and supplementary aids and services to be provided to the child; (5) an explanation of the extent, if any, to which the child will not participate with nondisabled children in the regular class; (6) a statement of any individual appropriate accommodations that are necessary to measure the academic achievement and functional performance of the child on State and district wide assessments; and (7) the projected dates for the beginning of the services and modifications and the anticipated frequency, location and duration of such services.

IMPROVISED EXPLOSIVE DEVICE: As defined by Texas Education Code §46.01, a completed and operational bomb designed to cause serious bodily injury, death, or substantial property damage that is fabricated in an improvised manner using nonmilitary components.

INDECENT EXPOSURE: As defined by Texas Penal Code §21.08, an offense that occurs when a person exposes his or her anus or any part of his or her genitals with intent to arouse or gratify the sexual desire of any person, and is reckless about whether another is present who will be offended or alarmed by the act.

INTIMATE VISUAL MATERIAL: As defined by Texas Civil Practices and Remedies Code §98B.001, §98B.002 and Texas Penal Code §21.16, visual material that depicts a person with the person's intimate parts exposed or engaged in sexual conduct. "Visual material" means any film, photograph, video tape, negative, or slide of any photographic reproduction or any other physical medium that allows an image to be displayed on a computer or other video screen and any image transmitted to a computer or other video screen.

JEGGINGS: Jeggings have elasticity and resemble pants with stitching, fake pockets and fake fly front. Leggings are stretchy skin-tight bottoms, resembling thicker tights and are typically used for athletic activities, e.g., yoga pants. ***Leggings are prohibited for Middle & High School students. Leggings are allowed for Elementary students.***

JURISDICTION: The sphere of authority or control; the territorial range over which any authority extends.

KNUCKLES: As defined by Texas Penal Code §46.01, any instrument consisting of finger rings or guards made of a hard substance and designed or adapted for inflicting serious bodily injury or death by striking a person with a fist enclosed in the knuckles.

LEGGINGS: Leggings are stretchy skin-tight bottoms, resembling thicker tights and are typically used for athletic activities, e.g., yoga pants. ***Leggings are prohibited Middle & High School students. Leggings are allowed for Elementary students.***

LOCATION RESTRICTED KNIFE: As defined by Texas Penal Code §46.01, a knife with a blade over five and one-half inches.

LOOK-ALIKE WEAPON: An item that resembles a weapon but it not intended to be used to cause serious bodily injury.

MACHINE GUN: As defined by Texas Penal Code §46.01, any firearm that is capable of shooting more than two shots automatically, without manual reloading, by a single function of the trigger.

MANDATORY: When something is obligatory or required because of an authority.

MANIFESTATION DETERMINATION: The purpose of this process is to determine whether or not the child's behavior that led to the disciplinary infraction is linked or not linked to his or her disability.

NICOTINE: A toxic colorless or yellowish oily liquid that is the chief active constituent of tobacco. It acts as a stimulant in small doses, but in larger amounts blocks the action of autonomic nerve and skeletal muscle cells. Nicotine is also used in insecticides.

PARAPHERNALIA: Devices that can be used for inhaling, ingesting, injecting, or otherwise introducing marijuana, a controlled substance or a dangerous drug into a human body.

PLACEMENT REVIEW COMMITTEE: Each campus will establish a three-member committee composed of two teachers chosen by the faculty and one member chosen by the principal. The purpose of this committee is to determine placement of a student when a teacher refuses the return of a student to the teacher's class and to make recommendations to the district regarding readmission of expelled students.

POSSESSION: Possession means to have an item on one's person or in one's personal property, including but not limited to clothing, purse, or backpack; a private vehicle used for transportation to or from school or school-related activities, including but not limited to an automobile, truck, motorcycle, or bicycle; telecommunications or electronic devices; or any school property used by the student, including but not limited to a locker or desk. Actual care, custody, control, or management will be taken into consideration.

PRIVILEGE: Permission or authorization to participate and/or hold membership in school-related or extracurricular activities, including, but not limited to, the following: honor and scholarship clubs/societies and activities or other school-related clubs/societies and activities; school assemblies, graduation exercises, school dances, junior-senior proms, class or group trips (other than instructional field trips which are part of the curriculum); theater organizations, plays, presentations/performances, and talent shows; student body government, class organizations, and other similar activities and organizations; and participation in field days, carnivals, or other school-related celebrations.

PROHIBITED WEAPON: As defined by Texas Penal Code §46.05(a), 1. An explosive weapon; 2. A machine gun unless registered with the U.S. Bureau of Alcohol, Tobacco, Firearms, and Explosives or classified as a curio or relic by the U.S. Department of Justice (applicable to 1 and 2); 3. Armor-piercing ammunition; 4. A chemical dispensing device; 5. A zip gun; 6. A tire deflation device; 7. An improvised explosive device.

PROHIBITION: A rule, law, order, or decree that forbids something.

PUBLIC LEWDNESS: As defined by Texas Penal Code §21.07, an offense that occurs when a person knowingly engages in an act of sexual intercourse, deviate sexual intercourse, or sexual contact in a public place or, if not in a public place, is reckless about whether another is present who will be offended or alarmed by the act.

REASONABLE BELIEF: A determination made by the superintendent or designee which reasonably suggest a violation of the Student Code of Conduct or other school/district policies or rules using all available information including the information furnished under Article 15.25 of the Code of Criminal Procedure.

RESTRAINT: Use of physical force or a mechanical device to significantly restrict the free movement of all or a portion of a student's body.

RIOT: Riot means the assemblance of seven or more persons resulting in conduct which 1. Creates an immediate danger of damage to property or injury to persons; 2. Substantially obstructs law enforcement or other governmental functions or services; or 3. By force, threat of force or physical action deprives any person of a legal right or disturbs any person in the enjoyment of a legal right.

SCHOOL DAYS: Those days students are in regular attendance (school days may vary from school to school).

SECTION 504 COMMITTEE: Committee composed of knowledgeable persons about the student, the meaning of the student's current evaluation data, and placement options. The composition of the Section 504 Committee is fluid and may change within a school year or between school years as a student's needs and services change. The Section 504 Committee makes decisions regarding the evaluation and placement of students under Section 504.

SELF-DEFENSE: The use of **minimal** force against another to the degree a person reasonably believes the force is **immediately necessary** to protect himself or herself.

SERIOUS MISBEHAVIOR: Behavior that is grounds for permissible expulsion or mandatory DAEP placement. Behavior identified by the District as grounds for Discretionary DAEP placement. In addition, for purposes of discretionary expulsion from a DAEP, serious misbehavior means:

a. Deliberate violent behavior that poses a direct threat to the health or safety of others;
b. Extortion, meaning the gaining of money or other property by force or threat;
c. Conduct that constitutes coercion, as defined by §1.07, Texas Penal Code; or
d. Conduct that constitutes the offense of:
    1. Public lewdness under §21.07, Texas Penal Code;
    2. Indecent exposure under §21.08; Texas Penal Code;
    3. Criminal mischief under §28.03, Texas Penal Code;
    4. Personal hazing under §37.152, Texas Education Code; or
    5. Harassment under §42.07(a)(1), Texas Penal Code, of a student or district employee.

SEXTING: Sending or posting electronic messages, videos, or pictures that are abusive, obscene, sexually oriented, threatening, harassing, damaging to another's reputation, or illegal.

SEXUAL HARASSMENT: Sexual harassment of a student by an employee includes any welcome or unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, and other verbal (oral or written), physical, or visual conduct of a sexual nature. It also includes such activities as engaging in sexually oriented conversations for purposes of personal sexual gratification, telephoning a student at home or elsewhere to solicit inappropriate social relationships, physical contact that would be reasonably construed as sexual in nature, and enticing or threatening a student to engage in sexual behavior in exchange for grades or other school-related benefit. Sexual harassment of a student by another student includes unwanted and unwelcome verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature, whether by word, gesture, or any other sexual conduct, including requests for sexual favors.

SHORT-BARREL FIREARM: As defined by Texas Penal Code §46.01, is a rifle with a barrel length of less than 16 inches or a shotgun with a barrel length of less than 18 inches, or any weapon made from a rifle or shotgun that, as altered, has an overall length of less than 26 inches.

SUSPENSION (Out of School): An act of the school administration taken as a disciplinary action which forbids a student from attending school for one, two, or three school days.

TERRORISTIC THREAT: As defined by Texas Penal Code §22.07, a person commits an offense if he threatens to commit any offense involving violence to any person or property with intent to: (1) cause a reaction of any type to his threat by an official or volunteer agency organized to deal with emergencies; (2) place any person in fear of imminent serious bodily injury, or (3) prevent or interrupt the occupation or use of a building; room; place of assembly; place to which the public has access; place of employment or occupation; aircraft, automobile, or other form of conveyance; or other public place; (4) cause impairment or interruption of public communications, public transportation, public water, gas, or power supply, or other public service; (5) place the public or substantial group of the public in fear of serious bodily injury; or (6) influence the conduct or activities of a branch or agency of the federal government, the state, or a political subdivision of the state (including the district).

TITLE 5 FELONIES: Crimes listed in Title 5 of the Texas Penal Code that typically involve injury to a person and may include: murder; capital murder; manslaughter; criminally negligent homicide; kidnapping; aggravated kidnapping; smuggling or continuous smuggling of persons; unlawful restraint; trafficking or continuous trafficking of persons; bestiality; continuous sexual abuse of young child or disabled individual; indecency with a child; invasive visual recording; sexual coercion; unlawful disclosure or promotion of intimate visual material; voyeurism; injury to a child, elderly individual, or disabled individual; abandoning or endangering a child, elderly individual, or disabled individual; deadly conduct; assault (felony level); aggravated assault; sexual assault; aggravated sexual assault; terroristic threat (felony level); aiding suicide; and tampering with a consumer product.

TRUANCY: Failure of a student to attend school for all or part of a school day when the student's absence has not been excused by the School District.

UNDER THE INFLUENCE: Lacking the normal use of one's mental or physical faculties, as determined by the school nurse, law enforcement, or campus administrator, considering the preponderance of the evidence. Impairment of a person's physical or mental faculties may be evidenced by abnormal or erratic behavior, the presence of abnormal physical symptoms which could be related to drug or alcohol use, or by admission. A student "under the influence" need not be legally intoxicated to trigger disciplinary action. Further, the District is not required to consider or fund an outside drug or alcohol test.

VANDALISM AND DAMAGE TO SCHOOL PROPERTY: Students shall not vandalize or otherwise damage or deface any property, including furniture and other equipment, belonging to or used by the District or District schools. Parents or guardians of students guilty of damaging school property shall be liable for damages in accordance with Texas law, and may be subject to criminal penalties.

VOLATILE CHEMICALS: Harmful chemicals such as chloroform, acetone, ketone, methanol, toluene, etc. (See Texas Health and Safety Code §484.)

ZIP GUN: As defined by Texas Penal Code §46.01, a device or combination of devices, not originally a firearm, but adapted to expel a projectile through a smooth-bore or rifled-bore barrel by using the energy generated by an explosion or burning substance.

TECHNOLOGY USE GUIDE (T.U.G.)

Chapter 620 of the Texas Government Code mandates that TikTok (or its successor application or service) is prohibited from being installed or used on District Technology Devices.

Texas Education Code § 37.082 prohibits students' use of any personal computing or communication devices during the course of the school day, including off-campus events during the school day, effective the first day of class for the 2026-2027 school year.

The Use of District Computers, Network, Internet and Electronic Mail: UISD Procedures and Technology Use Guide serve to: (a) prevent user access for transmission of inappropriate materials that are harmful to students via the Internet, electronic mail, chat rooms, and/or other forms of direct electronic communications; (b) prevent unauthorized access, including hacking and other unlawful online activity; (c) prevent unauthorized disclosure, use, and dissemination of personally identifiable information regarding students and minors; (d) ensure student safety and security when using electronic communications as well as comply with the Children's Internet Protection Act [Pub. L. No. 106-554 and 47 USC 254(h)]; and (e) educate students about cyberbullying awareness, response, and appropriate online behavior, including interacting with other individuals on social networking websites and chat rooms. *47 U.S.C. 254(h)(5)(B)(iii).*

The District defines harmful to students and minors as any picture, image, graphic image file, or other visual depiction that:

1. Taken as a whole and with respect to students and minors, appeals to a prurient interest in nudity, sex, or excretion;
2. Depicts, describes, or represents, in a patently offensive way with respect to what is suitable for students and minors, an actual or simulated sexual act or sexual contact, actual or simulated normal or perverted sexual acts, or a lewd exhibition of the genitals; and
3. Taken as a whole, lacks serious literary, artistic, political, or scientific value as to students and minors. *47 U.S.C. 254(h)(7)(G); 20 U.S.C. 7131(e)(6).*

The District is pleased to offer students access to a 1:1 Mobile Learning Devices, computer networks, the Internet, electronic mail and educational software on its network. To obtain access to all technology privileges, students must obtain parental permission via the District online registration system and sign all the required agreements: Technology Use Guide, 1:1 MLD Checkout Agreement and The Use of District Computers, Networks, Internet and Electronic Mail Parental Permission Form and User Agreement. Should a parent prefer that a student not have a device, Internet access, electronic mail, or access to web-based educational programs, it must be noted on the individual student online registration agreements. Please note that the denial of use does not include the use of devices required to complete technology-based coursework.

What are some of the benefits of having access to the Internet? Access to the Internet and electronic mail will enable students to explore thousands of libraries, databases, museums, and other repositories of information and to exchange personal communication with other Internet users around the world. Even though the District provides filtering of Internet content, families should be aware that some material accessible via the Internet might contain items that are illegal, defamatory, inaccurate, or potentially offensive. While the purposes of the school are to use Internet resources for constructive educational goals, students might find ways to access other materials. The advantages for students are to have access to the Internet in the form of information resources and opportunities for collaboration. Ultimately, parents and guardians of minors are responsible for setting and conveying the standards that their children should follow when using media and information resources.

Students whose parent/guardian do not give permission for the student to access UISD's computer network, Internet, electronic mail, educational software, and G Suite for Education Account (this includes the library software, accelerated reader, class assignments involving the Internet, and any educational software that resides on UISD's computer network) will have no access to any UISD-provided online educational resources.

What are student responsibilities with regard to the use of District issued equipment, District equipment and web-based instructional programs?
In consideration for the privilege of using the District's electronic communications system, and having access to District issued equipment (MLD's and Assistive Technology Equipment) that can be used on personal, private or public networks, parents release the District, its operators, and any institutions with which they are affiliated from any and all claims and damages of any nature arising from their child's use of, or inability to use the system, including, without limitation, the type of damage identified in this Student Code of Conduct, Student Handbook, this Technology Use Guide, and 1:1 MLD Manuals. Parents or guardians should discuss with their child/ren the responsibilities required for her/him as well as the parental responsibilities.

Students are responsible for appropriate behavior on the District's Local Area Network (LAN) just as they are in a District or virtual classroom. Communications on the network are often public in nature. General school rules for behavior and communication apply. Users shall comply with District standards and the specific rules, procedures and Technology Use Guide, 1:1 MLD Guidelines and Procedures set forth below, and the District's Student Code of Conduct. The use of the Local Area Network and any District issued device is a privilege, not a right, and may be revoked if abused. The user is personally responsible for his/her actions and cares with regard to accessing and utilizing the District's Technology Resources. The students are advised never to access, keep, or send anything that they would not want their parents or teachers to see. If a student accesses any inappropriate material they need to report it immediately to a teacher, campus behavior coordinator, and/or campus administrator. For consequences for violation(s) of guidelines and /or responsibilities outlined in the UISD Technology Use Guide and/or the Student Parent Regulations and Guidelines, please refer to Section IV of the District's Student Code of Conduct.

Are students allowed to use their own personal computing and communication devices (BYOD)?
Effective the first day of class for the 2026-2027 school year, students are not permitted to use any personal computing and communication devices during the course of the school day including off-campus events during the school day pursuant to Texas Education Code §37.082. The Bring Your Own Device (BYOD) Network will no longer be available for students nor will personal hotspots be allowed. The only authorized and allowable exemptions are for Special Education students whose use of personal communication devices is subject for approval by the Admission, Review and Dismissal (ARD) Committee and documented in their Individualized Education Programs (IEPs), for Section 504 students with an Individualized Accommodation Plan (IAP), and/or for students with an Individualized Healthcare Plan (IHP) if such use or access is directly related to their medical condition or academic disability. Students will be expected to refrain from the use of any unauthorized personal communication device(s) or be subject to disciplinary consequences and/or confiscation of the device(s) in accordance with the District's Student Code of Conduct.

What happens if a parent chooses not to allow their child to participate in the District's MLD 1:1 Initiative?
Consequently, for students whose parents are not accepting participation in the 1:1 MLD Program, they will not be allowed to use personal devices (e.g., laptop, cellphone/hotspot, iWatch, tablet, etc.) during the course of the school day for the commission of daily instruction and related to on- or off-campus activities during the school day. Parents/Guardians are advised that opting out of our District MLD 1:1 Initiative will remove their child's electronic access and affect their use of such crucial digital instructional support as digital curriculum, instructional programs, textbooks, resources, assessments, state testing, college entrance exam prep and exams, industry certifications, dual credit courses, and college applications.

What are the rules, procedures, and Technology Use Guide?
Monitoring the District's content and monitoring management software will constantly be monitoring user activity of minors and any other user's use of the Internet and any computing activity. The District has the right to and will monitor and generate reports that provide detailed user activity. If any user abuses or is suspected of abusing the privilege of Internet access, violating any guidelines, or misusing the Internet, a detailed report will be generated by the content and monitoring management software. (Technology Protection, Children's Internet Protection Act) 47 U.S.C. 254(h)(5)(B).

Use of Artificial Intelligence: If the UISD student chooses to use generative artificial intelligence (AI) tools:

- Student understands that AI should not be used to complete assignments without the express permission and guidance from the teacher.
- Student understands that under appropriate circumstances AI tools can be effectively used as a supplement to and not a replacement for traditional learning methods.
- Student understands that the expectation is to produce original work and cite any AI generated content properly.
- Student will refrain from using any personal identifiable information when using AI tools. The UISD student understands and will abide by the guidelines in the TUG. Should the student commit a violation, they understand consequences of their actions could include suspension of technology privileges, disciplinary action, and/or referral to law enforcement.

G-Suite for Education: UISD provides its students with a G Suite for Education account. Through their G Suite for Education accounts, students may access and use the following "Core Services" offered by Google such as Gmail, Calendar, Classroom, Drive, Cloud Search, Contacts, Docs, Sheets, Slides, Forms, Groups, Google Hangouts, Google Chat, Google Meet, Google Talk, Keep, and Sites. These services are all part of the District's basic agreement with Google. Please read the information below that provides answers to common questions about what Google can and can't do with your child's personal information, including:

- What personal information does Google collect?
- How does Google use this information?
- Will Google disclose my child's personal information?
- Does Google use student personal information for users in K-12 schools to target advertising?
- Can my child share information with others using the G Suite for Education account?

Google provides information about the information it collects, as well as how it uses and discloses the information it collects from G Suite for Education accounts in its G Suite for Education Privacy Notice.

What personal information does Google collect?
When creating a student account, United Independent School District may provide Google with certain personal information about the student, including, for example, a name, email address, and password. Google may also collect personal information directly from students, such as telephone numbers for account recovery or a profile photo added to the G Suite for Education account. When a student uses Google services, Google also collects information based on the use of those services. This includes:

- Device information, such as the hardware model, operating system version, unique device identifiers, and mobile network information including phone number;
- Log information, including details of how a user used Google services, device event information, and the user's Internet protocol (IP) address;
- Location information, as determined by various technologies including IP address, GPS, and other sensors; and
- Unique application numbers, such as application version numbers; and cookies or similar technologies are used to collect and store information about a browser or device, such as preferred language and other settings.

How does Google use this information?
In G Suite for Education Core Services, Google uses students' personal information to provide, maintain, and protect the services. Google does not serve ads in the Core Services or use personal information collected in the Core Services for advertising purposes. In Google Additional Services, Google uses the information collected from all Additional Services to provide, maintain, protect, and improve them, develop new ones, and protect Google and its users. Google may also use this information to offer tailored content,
such as more relevant search results. Google may combine personal information from one service with information, including personal information, from other Google services.

Does Google use student personal information for users in K-12 schools to target advertising?
No. For G Suite for Education users in primary and secondary (K-12) schools, Google does not use any user personal information (or any information associated with a G-Suite for Education Account) to target ads, whether in Core Services or in other Additional Services accessed while using a G-Suite for Education account.

Can my child share information with others using the G Suite for Education account?
We may allow students to access Google services such as Google Docs, which include features where users can share information with others or publicly. When users share information publicly, it may be indexable by search engines, including Google.

Will Google disclose my child's personal information?
Google will not share personal information with companies, organizations, and individuals outside of Google unless one of the following circumstances applies:

- With parental/guardian consent. Google may share personal information with companies, organizations, or individuals outside of Google with parental/guardian consent which would be obtained through G Suite for Education accounts.
- UISD G Suite for Education accounts, and because they are school-managed accounts, give UISD administrators access to information stored in them.
- For external processing. For example, Google may provide personal information to affiliates or other trusted businesses or persons to process it for Google, based on Google's instructions and in compliance with the G Suite for Education privacy notice and any other appropriate confidentiality and security measures.
- For legal reasons. Google will share personal information with companies, organizations, or individuals outside of Google if it has a good-faith belief that access, use, preservation, or disclosure of the information is reasonably necessary to:

- meet any applicable law, regulation, legal process, or enforceable governmental request,
- enforce applicable Terms of Service, including investigation of potential violations,
- detect, prevent, or otherwise address fraud, security, or technical issues,
- protect against harm to the rights, property, or safety of Google, Google users, or the public as required or permitted by law.

Google also shares non-personal information -- such as trends about the use of its services -- publicly and with its partners.

What choices do I have as a parent or guardian?

First, you can consent to the collection and use of your child's information by Google. If you consent to your child's use of G Suite for Education, you can access or request the deletion of your child's G Suite for Education account at any time by contacting, in writing, the School Principal. If you wish to stop any further collection or use of your child's information at any time, you can request that we use the service controls available to limit your child's access to features or services or delete your child's account entirely. You and your child can also visit https://myaccount.google.com while signing into your child's G-Suite for Education account to view and manage the personal information and settings of your child's account.

Filtering - Each District computer with Internet access has an electronic filter device and software that blocks access to visual depictions that are obscene, pornographic, inappropriate for students, or harmful to minors, as defined by the federal Children's Internet Protection Act and as determined by the Superintendent or designee. Upon approval from the Superintendent or designee, an administrator, campus behavior coordinator, supervisor, or other authorized person may disable the filtering device for bona fide research or other lawful purposes.

Privacy - You should not disclose your password to anyone else, nor should you use someone else's password. You are responsible for all activities done within or through your account. You should not attempt to circumvent passwords, access codes, or other security- related information or protection schemes nor should you attempt to uncover security loopholes or attempt to break authentication procedures or encryption protocols. The Children's Internet Protection Act prohibits unauthorized online disclosure, use, or dissemination of personal identification information of minors.

Anonymous Activity - You may not impersonate other individuals in electronic communication.

Illegal Activity - You should not use the District's electronic systems for any illegal activity. The Children's Internet Protection Act prohibits unauthorized access, including so-called 'hacking,' and other unlawful activities.

Electronic Mail Usage (Email) - Electronic mail communication is the District's official form of communication. Electronic mail facilitates and supports educational and administrative communication. Access to the District's email system by students, teachers, staff and administrators is a privilege, not a right. Users are to comply with all of the District's rules, guidelines, procedures, regulations, and policies governing the appropriate use of the electronic mail system. Email transmissions made using the District's network or email system are NOT PRIVATE and are subject to monitoring or investigation of the user's activities. Email is public information and is subject to open records requests made by the public, supervisor and parents.

Any information that is protected by the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA) transmitted via electronic mail must be encrypted prior to transmission. The District uses a 128-bit encryption standard.

Copying and/or Copyrights - For information of which the individual or the District does not hold the copyright, written permission from the copyright holder is required prior to duplication. Academic dishonesty or plagiarism in a student assignment is unethical. Suspected occurrences are referred to the student's school.

Harassment - Electronic system usage or information that is perceived by its recipient as sexual harassment as defined by the District's policy may be considered a violation. The display of offensive material in any publicly accessible area is likely to violate the District's harassment policy. The public display includes publicly accessible computer screens and printers.

Harassment is a Class B Misdemeanor; however, it is punishable up to a Class A Misdemeanor. A person commits the crime of harassment if, with intent to harass, annoy, alarm, abuse, torment, or embarrass another, the person publishes on an Internet website, including a social media platform, repeated electronic communications in a manner reasonably likely to cause emotional distress, abuse, or torment to another person, unless the communications are made in connection with a matter of public concern. TEXAS PENAL CODE §42.07.

Online impersonation is a Class A Misdemeanor; however, it is punishable up to a felony of the third degree. A person commits the crime of online impersonation if the person sends an electronic mail, instant message, text message, or similar communication that references a name, domain address, phone number, or another item of identifying information belonging to any person: (1) without obtaining the other person's consent; (2) with the intent to cause a recipient of the communication to reasonably believe that the other person authorized or transmitted the communication; and (3) with the intent to harm or defraud any person. TEXAS PENAL CODE §33.07.

Inappropriate uses, materials, and/or language - The Children's Internet Protection Act's description of inappropriate network usage includes: (a) using electronic mail other than the adopted official electronic mail supported by UISD, chat rooms, instant messaging, and other forms of direct electronic communications, as required; (b) unauthorized access, including so-called 'hacking,' and other unlawful activities; (c) the use of profane, abusive or impolite language when communicating electronically; and (d) accessing materials which are not in line with the rules of school behavior, and/or any visual depictions of material deemed obscene or child pornography, or to any material deemed harmful to students and minors while using the District's approved online and virtual platforms. Should students encounter such material by accident, they should report it to their teacher immediately. Students are not to provide any personal information online that is not directly supervised by their campus administration. Unauthorized online disclosure, use, or dissemination of personally identifiable information regarding students and minors is prohibited. UISD's authorized staff will monitor the usage of the District's online computer network and access to the Internet in accordance with CQ Local Policy and Children's Internet Protection Act.

Disclosure, Use, and Dissemination of Personal Information Regarding Minors - All personally identifiable information regarding minors is protected by FERPA. All open records requests submitted to the District must be approved by the Department of the Associate Superintendent for Administration and Operation Services or designee. Any personally identifiable information regarding minors that is transmitted using electronic mail must be encrypted a in 128-bit standard minimum prior to transmission.

Chat Rooms, Newsgroups Usage and Discussion Groups - Users are not allowed to participate in chat rooms, newsgroups or discussion groups. Approval from the Department of Curriculum & Instruction is required if participation in chat rooms, newsgroups, or discussion groups is part of

an educational project. The Department of Information Technology will establish access to the chat rooms, newsgroups or discussion groups for a set timeframe, as required by the approved educational project. The District has the right to block any abuse or violations of use, even if the chat room, newsgroup, or discussion group was approved. The Children's Internet Protection Act prohibits unauthorized online disclosure, use, and dissemination of personal identification regarding minors.

Wasting Resources - It is unethical to deliberately perform any act which will impair the operation of any electronic system or deny access by legitimate users to any electronic system. This includes the willful wasting of resources and sending of "junk mail" and "mail bombs" (This includes "chain letters" and "spam").

General District policy prohibits non-District use of District facilities. The District electronic systems may not be used for:

- solicitation not related to official District business;
- commercial gain or placing a third party in a position of commercial advantage;
- non-District related activities;
- impeding teaching and research;
- hindering the functioning of the District;
- violating an applicable license or contract; or
- damaging community relations or relations with institutions with whom we share responsibility.

What other guidelines must be followed? The following are guidelines to follow to prevent the loss of network privileges:

1. Users shall not erase, rename, or make unusable anyone else's computer files, programs, or drives.
2. Users shall not share names, log-on passwords, or files for any reason.
3. Users shall not use or try to discover another user's password, or circumvent passwords or other security-related information of the District, its students, or its employees.
4. Users shall not delete, alter or share their enrollment status while using the Online Classroom Platform.
5. Users shall not use District computers or networks for any non-instructional or non-administrative purpose (e.g., games, social media, video streaming, or websites with activities for personal profit).
6. Users shall not use a computer for unlawful purposes, such as the illegal copying or installation of software.
7. Users shall not alter, destroy, or disable District technology resources. Further, users shall not copy, change or transfer any software, documentation, or District data, the data of others, or other networks connected to the District's system, including off-school property, without written permission from the campus principal and Director of Technology.
8. Whether the users are on or off school property, they shall not upload, write, produce, generate copy, propagate, or attempt to introduce any computer code designed to self-replicate, damage, or otherwise hinder the performance of any computer's memory, file system, or software (e.g., a bug, virus, worm, Trojan Horse, or similar malware).
9. Users shall not deliberately use the Internet or a computer to annoy, threaten, or harass District students, employees, board members, or volunteers with language, images, or threats, including off-school property, if the conduct causes, or can cause, a substantial disruption to the educational environment.
10. Users shall not deliberately access or create any obscene or sexually related materials, except for curriculum-related materials and as assigned.
11. Users shall not assemble or disassemble computers, networks, printers, or other associated equipment except as part of a class assignment or in conjunction with a job responsibility.
12. Users shall not remove technology equipment (hardware or software) without written permission through United ISD Checkout Form signed by the principal and/or Information Technology Director and/or Instructional Technology Director.
13. STUDENTS WILL BE HELD ACCOUNTABLE for their actions and for the loss of privileges if the Technology Use Guide is violated.
14. Users shall not run or execute unauthorized applications from external devices (such as games, anonymizer web proxies, or hacking tools), or use pen drives and/or mapped drives.
15. Users shall not send, post, or possess electronic messages that are abusive, obscene, sexually-oriented, threatening, harassing, damaging to another's reputation, or illegal, including cyberbullying and "sexting," either on or off school property, if the conduct causes or can cause a substantial disruption to the educational environment or infringes on the right of another student at school.
16. Users shall not use the internet or other electronic communications to engage in or encourage illegal behavior or threaten school safety, including off school property, if the conduct causes, or can cause, a substantial disruption to the educational environment or infringes on the right of another student at school.
17. Users of the District's technology resources and/or network must sign and abide by the rules and guidelines defined in the UISD Mobile Learning Device: Guidelines and Procedures, the UISD Student and Parent Chromebook Manual: Regulations and Guidelines and the District's Student Code of Conduct.
18. Student Users may only use a district-issued device with their district-issued credentials with access for this device on the UISD Network during the school day. When away from district property before or after the school day, access may be secured on a personal home network/hotspot that will still connect the device to the district's secure/filtered system. Access on the district device will allow students to sign on to online curriculum, textbooks, programs, and related resources. Students found using an unauthorized personal communication device will be subject to disciplinary consequences in accordance with the Student Code of Conduct.

Parental agreements are as follows:

United Independent School District
Mobile Learning Device Replacement Agreement

Campus: _____ **Date:** _____

Student Name: _____ **ID Number:** _____ **Grade:** _____

Parent's Name: _____ **Contact Number:** _____

Current Device Serial Number: _____ **Date Issued:** _____

Reason for replacement: Current Device: ☐ **Damage** ☐ **Lost** ☐ **Stolen**

In case of theft, vandalism and other criminal acts, a police report MUST be attached to this form.

Cost Incurred: The owner of the device issued to the student is United ISD and not the student/parent.

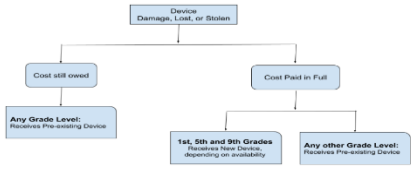
Your Mobile Learning Device has been rendered as inoperable or lost/stolen to proceed with a replacement of the device the following information must be provided. Cost is determined by the age and model of the device.

Total due: $_____ **Number of payment(s):** _____ **Amount of each Payment(s) $** _____ **monthly/weekly**

United ISD approved payment methods.

☐ **District/Campus Electronic Payment System** ☐ **Cash to Campus** ☐ **Money Order to Campus**

Replacing the device: See the chart below to determine the type of replacement device.



Replacement Device Serial Number: _____ **Date Issued:** _____

_____ _____ _____
Parent Name (Please Print) **Signature** **Date**

_____ _____ _____
Administrator's Name (Please Print) **Signature** **Date**

HOLD HARMLESS AND INDEMNIFICATION AGREEMENT FOR MLD EQUIPMENT SOLD TO STUDENTS
BETWEEN: UNITED INDEPENDENT SCHOOL DISTRICT AND PARENTS/GUARDIANS IN THE COUNTY OF WEBB
201 Lindenwood Drive, Laredo, Texas 78041

_____ _____ _____
Student Name ID# Parent/Guardian Name

_____ _____
Name of Campus Initiating Sale Number

_____ _____
Campus Phone Number Address

_____ _____
Administrator Releasing Equipment Phone Number

The United ISD Board of Trustees, in consideration of the district's approved selling of Mobile Learning Devices (MLD), agrees to the following terms and conditions regarding the sale and release of district mobile learning devices to students:

____ Sale of Chromebooks to High School Graduating Seniors or Juniors

Devices 3 years older are eligible for sale. The age of a device is determined by the district Inventory system - TipWeb. The equipment described below has been approved for sale to the parent/guardian of the high school graduating student indicated above for a fee of $20.00.

Computer Information:
☐ **DELL** ☐ **Lenovo** ☐ **Chromebook**

UISD Tag#:_____ **Serial No.:**_____

____ Sale of Devices to students whose devices are deemed irreparable by District Technology Department Staff and the total value of the device has been paid in full.

The sale of equipment checked out to the student indicated above has been deemed unrepairable by UISD IT Department Staff. Upon payment in full, the device will become eligible to be sold to the parent/guardian. The age of a device will be determined through the district Inventory system - TipWeb.
Value of device: **$**_____

☐ **DELL** ☐ **Lenovo** ☐ **Chromebook** ☐ **Apple iPad**

UISD Tag#:_____ **Serial No.:**_____

District Indemnification - Hold Harmless Statement

The student and parent/guardian agree to indemnify and hold harmless the United ISD Board of Trustees, its officers, agents, and employees from any and all liability, claims, costs, suits, causes of actions, judgments, or damages, including attorneys' fees arising out of the use of the device after the sale of said property has been completed.
Initials _____

The undersigned understands and acknowledges that this Hold Harmless and Indemnification Agreement requires that the United ISD Board of Trustees, its officers, agents, and employees be indemnified and held harmless for any and all liability, claims, costs, suits, causes of action, judgments or damages sustained by purchaser or any other person or persons who use the equipment and results in any bodily injury and for injury to or loss of property resulting from, caused by, or arising out of the use of said equipment referred to in this Agreement. ***Initials*** _____

This Hold Harmless and Indemnification Agreement shall also pertain to any such claims alleging negligence on the part of the District and the United ISD Board of Trustees. The undersigned further agrees to release any claim that they may have in the future against the United ISD Board relating to the use of the purchased equipment including claims alleging negligence on the part of the United ISD Board.

This Agreement has been read and signed by the aforementioned student, parent, or guardian and expedited on this ____ day of _____, 20___ by an authorized district/campus administrator or designee

_____ _____ _____ _____
Parent/Guardian Signature **Date** **Student's Signature** **Date**

United Independent School District
Mobile Learning Device Checkout Agreement

Campus: _____ **Date:** _____

Student Name: _____ **ID Number:** _____ **Grade:**___

Parent's Name: _____ **Cell Number:**_____

Type of Device: ❑ **IPad** ❑ **Dell Chromebook** ❑ **Lenovo Chromebook: Model/Year:** _____

Serial Number: _____ **UISD Tag:** _____

Accessories: ❑ **Case** ❑ **Charging Cable** ❑ **Other:** _____

UISD students are provided the opportunity to request individual Mobile Learning Devices (MLD). The MLD is intended to be used while in school and outside of the school facilities for assignments, projects, and research. The MLD should only be used for educational purposes. The device is owned by UISD, the student is responsible for the cost of all damages and theft/loss incurred.

_____ **I understand that the UISD Parent/Guardian MLD Procedures & Guidelines Manual is found on the UISD Website.** This manual provides parents and students with approved procedures for participating in the UISD Mobile Learning Device Program.

_____ **I accept the responsibility of a district-issued Mobile Learning Device**
- Using the device for instructional purposes only
- Basic care of the assigned device
- Following District Digital Citizenship and Usage Guidelines on the UISD Student Handbook
- Maintaining the security of the device on and off school premises
- Reporting device problems, breakage, and/or damage immediately to Campus Administration/teacher
- The repair or replacement cost is due to damage or loss. (Refer to Manual)
- To file a police report with the UISD Police Department if an incident occurred within the school district or a police report with the Laredo Police Department if an incident occurred outside the district. A copy of the report must be given to the school administrator.

_____ **I do not accept the responsibility of a district-issued Mobile Learning Device**
- My Child will be using Paper/Pencil or a home/personal computer to submit daily assignments, projects, and assessments
- My child will be using a personal Mobile Learning Device at School daily. Refer to the "Bring Your Own Device"(BYOD) section of the Student Handbook for the expectations and guidelines.

NOTE: All state exams must be taken on district-owned computer devices.

United ISD reserves the right to terminate the agreement if a student does not follow the Student Code of Conduct.

_____ _____ _____
Parent Name (Please Print) Signature Date

_____ _____ _____
Student Name (Please Print) Signature Date

District Indemnification - Hold Harmless Statement

The student and parent/guardian agree to indemnify and hold harmless the United ISD Board of Trustees, its officers, agents, and employees from any and all liability, claims, costs, suits, causes of actions, judgments, or damages, including attorneys' fees arising out of the use of the device after the sale of said property has been completed. ***Initials*** _____

The undersigned understands and acknowledges that this Hold Harmless and Indemnification Agreement requires that the United ISD Board of Trustees, its officers, agents, and employees be indemnified and held harmless for any and all liability, claims, costs, suits, causes of action, judgments or damages sustained by purchaser or any other person or persons who use the equipment and results in any bodily injury and for injury to or loss of property resulting from, caused by, or arising out of the use of said equipment referred to in this Agreement. ***Initials*** _____

This Hold Harmless and Indemnification Agreement shall also pertain to any such claims alleging negligence on the part of the District and the United ISD Board of Trustees. The undersigned further agrees to release any claim that they may have in the future against the United ISD Board relating to the use of the purchased equipment including claims alleging negligence on the part of the United ISD Board.

This Agreement has been read and signed by the aforementioned student, parent, or guardian and expedited on this ____ day of _____, 20___ by an authorized district/campus administrator or designee.

_____ _____ _____ _____
Parent/Guardian Signature **Date** **Student's Signature** **Date**

For Office Use

Fill out this section when the device and/or accessories are returned to campus.
Device: ❑In working condition ❑Damaged ❑Lost ❑Stolen
If lost or stolen, police report #_____ **Accessories**: ❑Case ❑Charging Cable
Condition: _____

Received by:(Print) _____ Sign: _____ Date: _____

United Independent School District

THE USE OF DISTRICT COMPUTERS, NETWORKS, INTERNET, ELECTRONIC MAIL, EDUCATIONAL SOFTWARE, AND GOOGLE SUITE FOR EDUCATION ACCOUNT

Parental Permission Form and User Agreement

Students requesting access to United Independent School District ("UISD") computer network, including the Internet, electronic mail, educational software, and Google Suite ("G-Suite") for Education Accounts must obtain parental permission as verified by the signatures on this form.

United Independent School District provides all students the opportunity to access the district's network, internet, web-based educational programs, and software while maintaining student safety and security using a filtering program that monitors all student usage. Every educational program and platform is monitored to comply with the Children's Internet Protection Act [Pub. L. No. 106-554 and 47 USC 254(h)]; and (e) educate students about cyberbullying awareness, response, and appropriate-online behavior, including interacting with other individuals on social networking websites and chat rooms. 47 U.S.C. 254(h)(5)(B)(iii)

UISD also provides its students with a **G-Suite for Education** account. Through their G-Suite for Education account, students may access and use the following "Core Services" offered by Google such as Gmail, Calendar, Classroom, Drive, Cloud Search, Contacts, Docs, Sheets, Slides, Forms, Groups, Google Spaces, Google Chat, Google Meet, Google Talk, Keep, and Sites.

These services are all part of the District's basic agreement with Google. Please read the information below that provides answers to common questions about what Google can and cannot do with your child's personal information:

- What personal information does Google collect?
- How does Google use this information?
- Will Google disclose my child's personal information?
- Does Google use student personal information for users in K-12 schools to target advertising?
- Can my child share information with others using the G-Suite for Education account?

Google provides information on how data is collected and used. Google discloses the data it collects in its G-Suite for Education Privacy Notice.

What personal information does Google collect?
When creating a student account, United Independent School District may provide Google with certain personal information about the student, including, for example, a name, email address, and password. Google may also collect personal information directly from students, such as telephone numbers for account recovery or a profile photo added to the G Suite for Education account. When a student uses Google services, Google also collects information based on the use of those services. This includes:

- Device information, such as the hardware model, operating system version, unique device identifiers, and mobile network information including phone number;
- Log information, including details of how a user used Google services, device event information, and the user's Internet protocol (IP) address
- Location information, as determined by various technologies including IP address, GPS, and other sensors;
- Unique application numbers, such as application version numbers; and cookies or similar technologies are used to collect and store information about a browser or device, such as preferred language and other settings.

How does Google use this information?
In G-Suite for Education Core Services, Google uses students' personal information to provide, maintain, and protect the services. Google does not serve ads in the Core Services or use personal information collected in the Core Services for advertising purposes.

In Google Additional Services, Google uses the information collected to provide, maintain, protect, improve, develop new ones, protecting Google and its users. Google may also use this information to offer tailored content, such as more relevant search results. Google may combine personal information from different services.

Does Google use student personal information from K-12 users to target advertising?
Google does not use any user personal information or any information associated with a G-Suite for Education Account to target ads, whether in Core Services or in other Additional Services accessed while using the G-Suite for Education account.

Can my child share information with others using the G-Suite for Education account?
We allow students to access Google services including features where users can share information with others or publicly such as Doc and Site. When users share information publicly, it may be indexable by search engines.

Will Google disclose my child's personal information?
Google will not share personal information with companies, organizations, and individuals outside of Google unless one of the following circumstances applies:

- With parental/guardian consent. Google may share personal information with companies, organizations, or individuals outside of Google.
- UISD G-Suite for Education accounts are school-managed accounts giving UISD administrators access to information stored in them.
- For external processing. For example, Google may provide personal information to affiliates or other trusted businesses or persons based on Google's instructions and in compliance with the G Suite for Education privacy notice and any other appropriate confidentiality and security measures.
- For legal reasons, Google will share personal information with companies, organizations, or individuals outside of Google if it has a good-faith belief that access, use, preservation, or disclosure of the information is reasonably necessary to:
  - meet any applicable law, regulation, legal process, or enforceable governmental request,
  - enforce applicable Terms of Service, including investigation of potential violations
  - detect, prevent, or otherwise address fraud, security, or technical issues,
  - protect against harm to the rights, property, or safety of Google, Google users, or the public as required or permitted by law.

Google also shares non-personal information -- such as trends about the use of its services -- publicly and with its partners.

What choices do I have as a parent or guardian?
First, you can consent to the collection and use of your child's information by Google. If you consent to your child's use of G-Suite for Education, you can access or request the deletion of your child's G Suite for Education account at any time by contacting, in writing, the School Principal. If you wish to stop any further collection or use of your child's information at any time, you can request that we use the service controls available to limit your child's access to features or services or delete your child's account entirely. You and your child can also visit https://myaccount.google.com while signing in to your child's G Suite for Education account to view and manage the personal information and settings of your child's account.

Students whose parents do not give permission for the student to access UISD's computer network, Internet, electronic mail, educational software, and G-Suite for Education Account will not have access to any UISD online educational resources. This includes library software, accelerated reader, class assignments involving the Internet, and any educational software that resides on UISD's computer network.

Rules governing student use of UISD's computer network, Internet, electronic mail, educational software, and G Suite for Education accounts are found in the Student Code of Conduct under the section entitled THE USE OF DISTRICT COMPUTERS, NETWORKS, INTERNET AND ELECTRONIC MAIL, AND GOOGLE SUITE FOR EDUCATION ACCOUNT. Students who use these services agree to comply with the above-stated rules and to use these services in an educational manner.

Please read this entire form carefully, let us know if you have any questions, and then sign below to indicate that you've read the notice and give or do not consent.

_____ I **GIVE** my child permission to access UISD's computer network.

_____ I understand that UISD has the right to monitor and generate reports that provide detailed user activity. If any user abuses the privilege of Internet access, violates any guidelines, or misuses the Internet, a detailed report will be generated by the content and monitoring management software. (Technology Protection, Children's Internet Protection Act) 47 U.S.C. 254(h)(5)(B).

_____I give consent for UISD to provide the G Suite for Education Account, for my child and for Google to collect, use, and disclose information about my child only for the purposes described in this notice.

_____I understand that I am authorizing permission for my child's participation during the school year or withdrawal from UISD. This form will be completed on an annual basis. If I need to change the permission status and/or contact information at any time, I am to contact the school Principal.

_____In consideration for the privilege of using UISD's computer network, and in having access to the public networks, I hereby release UISD, its operators, and any institutions with which they are affiliated from any and all claims and damages of any nature arising from my child's use of, or inability to use, the system, including, without limitation, the type of damage identified in the permission form for the use of computers and the internet.

_____I as a parent or guardian have discussed with my child the responsibilities required for him/her as well as the parental responsibilities involved.

_____I **DO NOT GIVE** my child permission to participate in UISD's electronic communication network system and the Google Suite for Education Account.

_____I understand my child will have no access to any UISD-provided online educational resources.

United ISD reserves the right to terminate the agreement if a student does not follow the Student Code of Conduct.

Parent Name (Print)	**Signature**	**Date**
Student Name (Print)	**Signature**	**Date**

Student ID Number:_____ **Grade Level:**_____

MANDATORY: Please sign this page where indicated and return it to your child's school within ten calendar (10) days.

UNITED INDEPENDENT SCHOOL DISTRICT

Official Notification of Unreturned District-Owned Equipment
For Students Enrolled in UISD Schools

Date:

Name of School: School's Phone Number:

Student's Name: ID #:

Parent/Guardian's Name: Address:

RE: Official Notice to Recover Unreturned United ISD Mobile Learning Device(s)

Dear Parents/Guardians,

Your child(ren)'s current Tyler Enrollment Status indicates that your child(ren) has

☐ Withdrawn from UISD or ☐ Graduated from UISD.

Our Campus Inventory Records show that your child(ren) still has District-Owned Equipment checked out.

Please be advised that the device(s) issued to your child(ren) has been disabled and can no longer be used. When a student leaves the District, the policy requires that all district-owned equipment be returned to their school in acceptable condition.

If your child(ren)'s District-issued Mobile Learning Device (MLD) is/are not returned by _____, a Police Incident Report will be filed.

Device Type: Total Cost $_____

☐ **Apple iPad** ☐ **Apple iPad Charger**
☐ **Chromebook** ☐ **Chromebook Charger**

Serial Number: **UISD Tag Number:**

Please make every effort to contact the school's librarian immediately and make arrangements to return the equipment to the following administrator:

Librarian's Name: _____ Phone Number: _____

Email address: _____

Thank you,

(Administrator's Name)
Title

It is the policy of United I.S.D. not to discriminate on the basis of race, color, national origin, sex, or handicap in its programs, services, or activities as required by Title VI of the Civil Rights Act of 1964, as amended; Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972; and Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973, as amended.

TRANSPORTATION: BUS RIDER'S HANDBOOK

Our goal in the Transportation Department is to provide safe and efficient transportation to and from school for all students attending the United Independent School District. As we enter a new school year, please take the time to read this very important Bus Rider's Handbook. It explains regulations, gives procedures, and provides useful information designed to render the best transportation service possible to your children. If you have any questions or need assistance, please contact the Transportation Department:

North Compound: (956) 473-6330 Fax: (956) 473-6260 Address: 501 Eden Lane, Laredo, Texas 78045
Danny W. Treviño – Operations Administrator of Transportation (North)
Annie T. Salinas – Transportation Planning Analyst

East Compound: (956) 473-1955 Fax: (956) 473-1992 Address: 405 E.G. Ranch Road Hwy 359, Laredo, Texas 78043
Javier Rangel – Operations Administrator of Transportation (East)

South Compound: (956) 473-5230 Fax: (956) 473-5239 Address: 5256 Cielito Lindo Blvd., Laredo, Texas 78046
David Hernandez – Operations Administrator of Transportation (South)

Transportation Hours of Operation: Every school day from 5:00 a.m. - 5:00 p.m.
Transportation Department Office Hours: Every school day from 8:00 a.m. - 5:00 p.m.
After hours emergency calls should be placed to "UISD PD Dispatch" at (956) 473-6361

All students have the right to a safe and pleasant trip to and from school or on school-sponsored trips. We believe all students can behave appropriately and safely while riding on a school bus. We cannot tolerate any student interfering with drivers, bus assistants, and other professionals doing their jobs, and we continuously work toward protecting each passenger's right to a safe ride.

Introduction: This "Bus Rider's Handbook" is designed to inform school bus riders and parents of regulations and procedures under which students are allowed to ride school buses.

To The Bus Rider: Students who have the privilege of bus transportation to and from school also have the responsibility to make the trip pleasant and safe for all. Good bus etiquette, simply stated, is good manners. You are expected to display the same good manners on the bus as you would in the classroom.

To The Parents: The school bus is a key to a better education. Riding a bus trains students in safety, responsibility, independence and courtesy. Familiarize yourself with the bus number your child rides. Please go over the "Bus Rider's Handbook" with your child so that he/she will know that you, as well as UISD, expect them to follow the simple rules outlined here. Should problems arise, feel free to discuss them with your child's principal, appropriate administrator or with the District's Transportation Department. Please call the UISD Transportation Department at (956) 473-6330 (North Compound), (956) 473-5230 (South Compound), or (956) 473-1955 (East Compound) to report unsafe drivers. Please have the bus number, date, time, and location of the incident noted when calling. Temporary use of a bus outside of a student's bus route must be approved by a campus administrator and/or Transportation Dept. and communicated to the designated Transportation dispatch location.

To The Bus Driver: United Independent School District regards student transportation to and from schools and on special trips as a serious responsibility and takes every precaution to ensure student safety. During bus rides, the driver has the same authority that a teacher has in the classroom. Riders are expected to respect this authority and to behave in such a way that the driver will not be distracted while operating the bus.

All UISD bus drivers have valid driver's licenses from the Texas Department of Public Safety. In addition, they have completed a 20-hour School Bus Driver Certification course covering first aid, passenger loading and unloading, bus upkeep and other important information, and have met UISD standards for bus drivers. Every three years, drivers are required to take an eight-hour DPS refresher course.

At The Bus Stop: The following safety tips for school bus riders are recommended:

- Leave home in time to reach the bus stop approximately ten minutes ahead of the bus. Arriving later may make you and other riders late to school. Arriving earlier exposes you unnecessarily to traffic.
- If there are no sidewalks on your route to the bus stop, walk on the left side of the street or road facing traffic. Stay as far off the road as possible.
- If you are walking with others where there are no sidewalks, walk in a single file line.
- Do not stand in the street to wait for the bus or step into the street to look for it.
- When the bus approaches, stand back at a safe distance until the bus has come to a complete halt.
- Animals and pets of any kind are not allowed on a UISD bus. Exceptions may be made for Service Animals in accordance with District procedures.
- It is the parent's/guardian's responsibility to receive student riders at their designated bus stop.
- **For Pre-K3 – Kinder students, parents/guardians are required to receive their child at the bus stop.** Otherwise, Pre-K3 – Kinder students will be returned to their school, unless the parent/guardian has made other arrangements with the Transportation Department.
- If an eligible student rider is the "only" student rider at a designated pick-up location and ceases to utilize the transportation services provided for 5 consecutive school days, then that bus stop will be temporarily/permanently removed until adequate arrangements have been made with the Transportation Department Office.

All Aboard:

- Line up with younger children first and board in a safe and orderly manner.
- Use the handrail as you go up the steps, one at a time.
- Take your assigned seat and remain in it until the bus has come to a complete halt at your school.
- Do not open or lean against windows. Some are designed to pop out under pressure in case of an emergency.
- Do not ask to leave the bus at any point other than at your school or home bus stop.
- Report any damage, such as a loose seat or window latch, to the driver as you leave.
- Move immediately away from the loading zone. Wait for friends away from the bus.
- Students are responsible for any personal belongings they bring into the bus, so please make sure you do not leave anything behind in the bus. Lost items are not the responsibility of the Transportation Department or driver.

For Safety's Sake:

- Except in an emergency situation, do not talk with the driver while the bus is in motion, especially when the bus approaches a railroad crossing, bus stop/drop-off, or a busy intersection.
- Under no circumstances shall a student ride on the outside of the bus or extend their heads, hands, arms, or any other part of the body through the bus windows or doors.
- Objects must not be thrown, inside or outside of the bus.
- Do not occupy the driver's seat or tamper with bus controls.
- Riders crossing the road after they depart the bus must pass far enough in front of the bus (about 15 feet) to be in the driver's view and must never cross behind the bus. Students should cross the road only after checking that the roadway is clear and after receiving a signal from the driver. One exception to this rule will be in urban areas where pedestrian crossings are provided; and students are instructed to cross after the bus leaves or when a traffic light indicates.

Buses and Other School Vehicles: The District makes school bus transportation available to all students living two or more miles from school. As noted on the "Student Transfer Agreement", United ISD is not responsible for providing transportation of a student on a transfer status to and from school. Parents are responsible for arranging student transportation. Bus routes and any subsequent changes are located on the District website under the Parents tab title "Bus Route Finder."

Students are expected to assist District staff in ensuring that buses remain in good condition and that transportation is provided safely. When riding school buses, students are held to behavioral standards established in this handbook and the Student Code of Conduct. Misconduct will be punished in accordance with the Student Code of Conduct and bus-riding privileges may be suspended. Vandalism of District buses, such as breaking windows, tearing a seat, drawing graffiti on seats, and similar offenses will result in a $150 fine or the total replacement charge to the identified student. The student will also be suspended from transportation services until all charges have been collected at the Transportation Department.

When students ride in a District bus, van, or passenger car, seat belts must be fastened at all times, if such equipment is available.

Special Trips:

- Parent's written permission may be required by school principals or other appropriate administrators for trips made during school hours or out of town.
- Know the point of departure and be there on time. Be sure that your parents know the time that your bus is expected to return so they can meet the bus.
- Students are responsible for any personal belongings they take on field trips. Please make sure you do not leave these items behind in the bus.

School-Sponsored Trips: Students who participate in school-sponsored trips are required to use transportation provided by the school to and from the event. The principal or other appropriate administrator, however, may make an exception. An exception may be allowed if the parent personally requests that the student be permitted to ride with the parent, or the parent presents-before the scheduled trip-a written request that the student be permitted to ride with an adult designated by the parent.

In An Emergency: Unless the driver is not available, remain seated until the driver tells you what you do. Do not panic.

- Do not touch emergency equipment or safety releases until you are told to do so.
- Let those closest to the doors exit first.
- Duck your heads as you leave the bus and wrap loose clothing around you so that it will not get caught.
- Keep your hands free; leave everything behind.
- If you must jump from the bus, bend your knees slightly as you jump.
- Move quickly away from the exit.

Rules for Riders: Riding the bus is a privilege and not a right. This privilege may be revoked for a justified cause. The privilege of being transported to and from school and on school trips depends on the rider's behavior and cooperation. This privilege may be withdrawn if the rider:

- Fails to observe proper safety rules.
- Disregards the authority of the bus driver or other adults in-charge.
- Behaves in a disorderly, distasteful (such as engaging in minor sexual acts, kissing and/or necking) or unsafe manner.
- Creates excessive noise, such as loud talking, screaming or whistling, or by playing radios, MP3 players or similar equipment.
- Abuses, defaces, destroys property, equipment, or the bus. Fines will be assessed.
- Fails to attend classes after riding the bus to school.

- Fights on the bus or at the bus stop.
- Handles the emergency equipment inside the bus (emergency doors, fire extinguisher, etc).
- Throws articles within the bus, out the windows of the bus, or at any other vehicle.
- Behaves in such a manner that he/she jeopardizes the safe operation of the bus.
- Fails to exhibit good manners toward all others on the bus through profanity, vulgar language, obscene gestures, insults, racial slurs, bullying, harassment, or other disruptive or abusive behavior.
- Cell phone recording of the voice or image of another person on the bus is strictly prohibited.
- Student jumps out of a bus using an Emergency Door Exit in a non-emergency while the bus is stopped or in motion. This violation will incur a three (3) month automatic suspension from transportation privileges.

Prohibited Items: The following items will not be allowed on school buses:

- Tobacco in any form, e-cigarettes, alcoholic beverages, drugs, or any controlled substance. Being under the influence of such things is also prohibited on the bus.
- Firearms, air guns, bb-guns, "look-a-like" guns, toy/plastic guns clubs, knives, fireworks, and other dangerous objects.
- Large or heavy objects which would obstruct the bus aisles or otherwise create a hazard, unless permission is received in advance from the principal or other appropriate administrator and approved by the Transportation Department.

It is a criminal offense to intentionally, knowingly, recklessly possess, goes with a firearm, location-restricted knife, or prohibited weapon as defined by Texas Penal Code Section 46.05(a) on the physical premises of a school or educational institution, any grounds or building on which an activity sponsored by a school or educational institution is being conducted, or a passenger transportation vehicle of a school or educational institution, whether the school or educational institution is public or private. This includes a school bus being used to transport children to or from school-sponsored activities of a private or public school.

Bus Behavior: Riding the bus is considered a "school-related" and "school-sponsored" activity where those terms appear in other sections of the Student Code of Conduct. Riding the bus is a privilege which may be temporarily suspended or permanently revoked at the discretion of the campus/transportation administrator if the conduct in question jeopardizes the safety of any individual, interferes with the safe operation of the bus, or violates the Student Code of Conduct. A bus driver that is transporting students to or from school or a school-sponsored or school-related activity may initiate a formal removal. The bus driver is allowed to refer the student to the administrator's office in order to maintain discipline on the bus. The school principal or other administrator may be required to respond by employing appropriate disciplinary management techniques consistent with the Student Code of Conduct. The campus administrator has the authority and responsibility to discipline a student for any inappropriate conduct that occurs on the school bus. Disciplinary consequences shall be administered according to the level of the offense committed, which can include restricting or revoking a student's bus riding privileges. Prior to a suspension or revocation of bus riding privileges for any student, the campus administrator may consult with and receive input from the Transportation Department regarding the proposed length of suspension or revocation. For more information about disciplinary consequences, see other sections of the Student Code of Conduct pertaining to Level I--Minor Offenses, Level II--Serious Offenses, Level III--DAEP Offenses, and Level IV--Expulsions.

When appropriate disciplinary management techniques fail to improve student behavior or when specific misconduct warrants immediate removal, the principal or other administrator may restrict or revoke a student's transportation privileges, in accordance with law. In accordance with the law, individuals (i.e. students, parents, guardians, relatives, volunteers, etc.) who interfere or disrupt transportation service may be arrested, cited, and/or fined.

- **Students with Disabilities:** Transportation privileges may be taken away from a student with disabilities only if transportation is not determined to be necessary as a related service or if modification of the Individualized Education Program (IEP) by the ARD or Section 504 Committee occurs. A change in transportation services for a student with a disability for whom transportation is a related service requires ARD Committee action; likewise, a change in transportation services for Section 504 students for whom transportation is a related service requires Section 504 Committee action.

Service Animal: UISD prohibits animals and pets on campus and all District property, including school buses. This prohibition is designed to enhance everyone's safety while providing a healthier environment for our students and users of campus and District property. **Service Animals are an exception to this prohibition of animals on campus**.

A parent of a student who requires the use of a service animal that has been trained to do work or perform tasks directly related to the student's disability must submit a request in writing to the campus principal at least twenty-one (21) calendar days before bringing said service animal onto the requested campus or school bus.

Videotaping of Students: For safety purposes, video/audio surveillance equipment will be used to monitor student behavior on buses, school activities, district property, and in common areas on campus, in accordance with the Texas Education Code Section 26.009. Students will not be told when the equipment is being used. The principal may review the tapes routinely and document student misconduct. Discipline shall be imposed in accordance with the Student Code of Conduct.

A parent who wants to view a videotape of the incident leading to the discipline of his or her child may request access in writing. The Superintendent/designee shall consider the request and render a decision in accordance with Board Policy FL and the Family Education Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA) (20 USCA 1232g). School officials may then share video footage with a parent only if the video does not disclose personally identifiable information regarding another student.

STUDENT HANDBOOK

PREFACE:

To Students and Parents:

Welcome to the start of a new school year! Education is a team effort, and we know that students, parents, teachers, and other staff members all working together can make this a wonderfully successful year for our students.

If you have difficulty accessing the information in this document because of disability, please contact: websiteassistance@uisd.net or (956) 473-6201.

The UISD Student Handbook ("Student Handbook") is designed to provide a resource for some of the basic information that you and your child will need during the school year. In an effort to make it easier to use, the handbook is divided into two sections:

Section I—REQUIRED NOTICES AND INFORMATION FOR PARENTS – with notices that the District must provide to all parents, as well as other information to assist you in responding to school-related issues. We encourage you to take some time to closely review this section of the handbook; and

Section II—INFORMATION FOR STUDENTS AND PARENTS – organized alphabetically by topic for quick access when searching for information on a specific issue.

Please be aware that the term "the student's parent" is used to refer to the parent, legal guardian, or any other person who has agreed to assume school-related responsibility for a student.

Both students and parents should become familiar with the United Independent School District Student Code of Conduct, which is a document adopted by the UISD Board of Trustees ("Board") and intended to promote school safety and an atmosphere for learning.

The Student Handbook is designed to be in harmony with Board Policy and the Student Code of Conduct. Please be aware that the Student Handbook is updated yearly, while Board Policy adoption and revision may occur throughout the year. Changes in Board Policy or other rules that affect Student Handbook provisions will be made available to students and parents through newsletters and other communications.

In case of a conflict between Board Policy, the Student Code of Conduct, and any provisions of student handbooks, the provisions of Board Policy or the Student Code of Conduct that were most recently adopted by the Board are to be followed. A copy of the UISD Board Policy Manual is available online at http://www.uisd.net.

Your child's school will request that you provide contact information, such as your current phone number and e-mail address, in order for the school to communicate items specific to your child, your child's school, or the District. To receive such information through a landline or wireless phone, please ensure that you notify the school's administration office immediately upon a change in or disconnection of your phone number. The District or school may generate automated or pre-recorded messages, text messages, or real-time phone or e-mail communication, so prompt notification of any change in contact information will be crucial to maintain timely communication with you. Standard messaging rates of your phone carrier may apply. If you have specific requests or needs related to how the District contacts you, please contact your child's principal.

After reading through the entire handbook with your child, keep it as a reference during this school year. If you or your child have questions about any of the material in this handbook, please contact the principal.

SECTION I: REQUIRED NOTICES AND INFORMATION FOR PARENTS

This section of the United Independent School District Student Code of Conduct and Student Handbook includes several notices that the district is required to provide to you, as well as other information on topics of particular interest to you as a parent.

Nondiscrimination: In its efforts to promote nondiscrimination and as required by law, the District does not discriminate on the basis of race, religion, color, national origin, gender, sex, disability, age, or any other basis prohibited by law in providing education services, activities, and programs, including Career and Technical Education (CTE) programs. The District provides equal access to the Boy Scouts and other designated youth groups. In accordance with Title IX, the District does not and is required not to discriminate on the basis of sex in its educational programs or activities. The requirement not to discriminate extends to employment. Inquiries about the application of Title IX may be referred to the District's Title IX Coordinators (see below), to the Assistant Secretary for Civil Rights of the Department of Education, or both. Other federal laws that prohibit discrimination include Title VI, Section 504, the Age Discrimination Act, the Boy Scouts Act, and Title II.

The District has designated and authorized the following employees as the Title IX Coordinators to address concerns or inquiries regarding discrimination on the basis of sex, including sexual harassment, sexual assault, dating violence, domestic violence, stalking, or gender-based harassment:

Title IX in matters relating to **employee-on-student harassment and/or discrimination** you may contact: Rita Garner, Director of Employee Relations/District Title IX Coordinator, 301 Lindenwood Dr., Laredo, Texas 78045 (956) 473-6351, rgarner@uisd.net

Title IX in matters relating to **student-on-student harassment and/or discrimination** you may contact: Michelle Lee Farias, Student Services Manager/Title IX Coordinator, 201 Lindenwood Dr., Laredo, Texas 78045, (956) 473-6108, mlfarias@uisd.net

Section 504 you may contact: Claudia Dovalina-Guzman, Executive Director for Special Education, 4410 State Highway 359, Laredo, Texas 78043, (956) 473-1862, ccdovalina@uisd.net

Reports can be made at any time and by any person, including during non-business hours, by mail, phone, or email. During District business hours, reports may also be made in person. Upon the District receiving notice or an allegation of sex-based harassment, the Title IX Coordinators will promptly respond in accordance with the process described at FFH (Local) or DIA (Local), as applicable.

For all other concerns regarding discrimination, you may contact the Superintendent's Office at 201 Lindenwood Dr., Laredo, Texas 78045, (956) 473-6219.

Parental and Family Engagement: Students are most likely to experience educational success when there is a strong partnership between home and school. The partnership thrives on good communication and interaction between parents, teachers, administrators and the Board of Trustees. Good communication between home and school regarding a child's education is more than a "plus." It's essential for the student to make the most of the opportunities provided. School communication starts with informative documents such as this handbook, progress reports and report cards and student work for parents to review and sign. School communication continues with interaction, such as messages and phone calls from teachers and school open houses or back-to-school nights.

Communication might also include requests for conferences—initiated by the school or the parent—to discuss student progress, to find out more about the curriculum and how the parent can support learning, to head off or resolve problems, etc. A parent who wants to schedule a phone or in-person conference with a teacher, counselor, or principal should call the school office for an appointment. Generally, a teacher will be able to meet with parents or return calls during his or her conference period, although other mutually convenient times might be arranged as well. Your involvement in this partnership may include:

- Encouraging your child to put a high priority on education and working with your child on a daily basis to make the most of the educational opportunities the school provides.
- Ensuring that your child completes all homework assignments and special projects and comes to school each day prepared, rested, and ready to learn.
- Reviewing the information in the Student Handbook (including the Student Code of Conduct) with your child, as well as signing, and returning the Acknowledgement and other form(s). A parent with questions is encouraged to contact the school principal.
- Becoming familiar with all of your child's school activities and with the academic programs (including special programs), offered in the District.
- Discussing with the counselor or principal any questions regarding opportunities, concerns about placement, assignment, or early graduation, and the options available to your child.
- Monitoring your child's academic progress and contacting teachers as needed.
- Attending scheduled conferences and requesting additional conferences as needed. To schedule a telephone or in-person conference with a teacher, counselor, or principal, please call the school office for an appointment. The teacher will usually return your call or meet with you during his or her conference period or before or after school.
- Reviewing the requirements of the graduation programs with your child, if your child is entering ninth grade.
- Attending Board meetings to learn more about District operations.
- Serving as a parent representative on the District level or campus-level planning committees in campus or District parent organizations. The activities are varied—ranging from band boosters to District and campus planning committees that formulate plans to improve student achievement. For further information, contact the school principal.
- Awareness of the school's ongoing bullying and harassment prevention efforts.

Parent and Family Engagement Coordinator: The Parent and Family Engagement Coordinator who works with parents of students participating in a Title I program is Laura Collins. She may be contacted at (956) 473-6473.

School and Parent Volunteer: United ISD Volunteers are parents, business or community members who are willing to donate their time and expertise in assisting with activities in one or more schools. Individuals who seek to serve as volunteers must submit an online application prior to beginning a volunteer activity through the automated volunteer management system called App-Garden. The application can be found at https://www.uisd.net/uisdvolunteer.

As part of the application process, new volunteers must attach the following documents:

1. Current Valid Picture ID (State Driver's License, State ID or Official U.S. Passport)
2. DPS Computerized Criminal History Form signed and dated
3. TB Screening Protocol Documentation and Questionnaire

Returning approved 2025-2026 volunteers must update information and attach the following two items:

1. Current Valid Picture ID (State Driver's License, State ID or Official U.S. Passport)
2. DPS Computerized Criminal History Form signed and dated

United ISD employees **must checkmark that they are** UISD employees on the application and attach only the following item:

1. Current 2026-2027 United ISD issued ID

If you have any questions, contact Family Matters Resource Center at (956) 473-6473 or email at fmrc@uisd.net.

Parental Rights

Accessing Student Records: You may review your child's student records. These records may include:

- Attendance records.
- Standardized test data, including intelligence, aptitude, interest, personality and social adjustment ratings.
- All achievement records, as determined by tests, recorded grades and teacher evaluations.
- Teaching materials and tests used in your child's classroom.
- Disciplinary records which include verified reports of serious or recurrent behavior patterns.
- Counseling records.
- Psychological records.
- Admissions data, personal data and family data, including certification of date of birth.
- Health services records, including: 1.) The results of any tuberculin tests required by the District; 2.) The findings of screening or health appraisal programs the District conducts or provides; 3.) Immunization records. (See Board Policy FFAB.)
- Other medical records.
- Teacher and counselor evaluations.
- State assessment instruments that have been administered to your child.
- Fitness testing results.

- All information in student PRC.
- All documentation regarding a student's testing history and any accelerated instruction he or she has received, including any documentation of discussion or action by a grade placement committee convened for the student.
- Records transferred from other Districts in which the student was enrolled.
- Copies of correspondence with parents and others concerned with the student.
- Records pertaining to participation in extracurricular activities.
- Information relating to student participation in special programs.
- Records of fees assessed and paid.
- Records pertaining to student and parent complaints.
- Other records that may contribute to an understanding of the student.
- Records of teacher or administrative conferences with the student or pertaining to the student
- Student questionnaires.
- Records relating to assistance provided for learning difficulties, including information collected regarding any intervention strategies used with your child, as the term intervention strategy is defined by law.

Children of Military Families: The Interstate Compact on Educational Opportunities for Military Children entitles children of military families to flexibility regarding certain District and state requirements, including immunization requirements; grade level, course, or educational program placement; eligibility requirements for participation in extracurricular activities; enrollment in the Texas Virtual School Network (TXVSN); and graduation requirements. The District will excuse absences related to a student visiting a parent, including a stepparent or legal guardian, who is called to active duty, on leave, or returning from a deployment of at least four months. The District will permit no more than five excused absences per year for this purpose. For the absence to be excused, the absence must occur no later than the 30th day after the parent's return from deployment.

Consent to Conduct a Psychological Evaluation or a Mental Health Care Service: Unless required under state or federal law, a District employee will not conduct a psychological examination, test, or treatment without obtaining prior written parental consent. However, an evaluation may be legally required under special education rules or by the Texas Education Agency for child abuse investigations and reports. The District will not provide a mental health care service to a student except as permitted by law.

The District has established procedures for providing a parent with a recommendation for an intervention for a student with early warning signs of mental health concerns or substance abuse or who has been identified as at risk of attempting suicide. The District's administration will notify student's parents within a reasonable amount of time after administration learns that a student has displayed early warning signs and a possible need for intervention and provide information about counseling options. For further information on District procedures, please see **Counseling and Guidance** on page 71.

Consent to Display a Student's Original Works and Personal Information: Teachers may display a student's work in classrooms or elsewhere on campus as recognition of student achievement without seeking prior parental consent. These displays may include artwork, special projects, photographs, original videos or voice recordings and other original works. However, the District will seek parental consent before displaying a student's work on the District's website, a website affiliated or sponsored by the District (such as a classroom or campus website), or in District publications, which may include printed materials, videos, or other methods of mass communication.

Excusing a Student from Reciting a Portion of the Declaration of Independence: You may request that your child be excused from recitation of a portion of the Declaration of Independence. State law requires students in social studies classes in grades 3–12 to recite a portion of the text of the Declaration of Independence during Celebrate Freedom Week unless (1) you provide a written statement requesting that your child be excused, (2) the District determines that your child has a conscientious objection to the recitation, or (3) you are a representative of a foreign government to whom the United States government extends diplomatic immunity.

Excusing a Student from Reciting the Pledges to the U.S. and Texas Flags: As a parent, you may request that your child be excused from participation in the daily recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance to the United States flag and the Pledge of Allegiance to the Texas flag. The request must be in writing. Each student has a right to individually, voluntarily and silently pray or meditate in school in a manner that does not disrupt instructional or other activities of the school. State law requires that one minute of silence follow recitation of the pledges. State law does not allow your child to be excused from participation in the required minute of silence or silent activity.

Granting Permission to Receive Parenting and Paternity Awareness Instruction: As a parent, if your child is under the age of 14, you must grant permission for your child to receive instruction in the District's parenting and paternity awareness program or your child will not be allowed to participate in the instruction. This program, developed by the Office of the Texas Attorney General and the State Board of Education (SBOE), is incorporated into the District's health education classes.

Granting Permission to Photograph, Video or Audio Record a Student: Pursuant to state law, the District will request written consent from a parent prior to taking a photograph, making a video or voice recording of a student for reasons other than the following:

a. Purposes of safety, including the maintenance of order and discipline in common areas of the school or on school buses;
b. A purpose related to a co-curricular or extracurricular activity;
c. A purpose related to regular classroom instruction;
d. Media coverage of the school/District; or
e. A purpose related to promotion of student safety under Education Code §29.022.

Inspecting Surveys: As a parent, you may inspect a survey created by a third party before the survey is administered or distributed to your child.

Opting out of Advanced Mathematics in Grades 6-8: UISD will automatically enroll a student in grade 6 in an advanced mathematics course if the student performed in the top 40 percent on the District's designated grade 5 mathematics assessment. The student's parent may opt the student out of automatic enrollment in an advanced mathematics course.

"Opting Out" of Surveys and Activities Surveys: UISD Notification of Rights Under the Protection of Pupil Rights Amendment (PPRA): PPRA affords parents and students who are 18 or emancipated minors ("eligible students") certain rights regarding our conduct of surveys, collection and use of information for marketing purposes and certain physical exams. These include the right to: Consent before students are required to submit to a survey that concerns one or more of the following protected areas ("protected information survey") if the survey is funded in whole or in part by a program of the U.S. Department of Education:

1. Political affiliations or beliefs of the student or student's parent;
2. Mental or psychological problems of the student or student's family;
3. Sex behavior or attitudes;
4. Illegal, anti-social, self-incriminating, or demeaning behavior;
5. Critical appraisals of others with whom respondents have close family relationships;
6. Legally recognized privileged relationships, such as with lawyers, doctors, or ministers;
7. Religious practices, affiliations, or beliefs of the student or parents; or
8. Income, other than as require by law to determine program eligibility.

Receive notice and an opportunity to opt a student out of:

1. Any other protected information survey, regardless of funding;
2. Any non-emergency, invasive physical exam or screening required as a condition of attendance, administered by the school or its agent, and not necessary to protect the immediate health and safety of a student, except for hearing, vision, or scoliosis screenings, or any physical exam or screening permitted or required under State Law; and
3. Activities involving collection, disclosure, or use of personal information obtained from students for marketing or to sell or otherwise distribute the information to others.

Inspect, upon request and before administration or use:

- Protect information surveys of students;
- Instruments used to collect personal information from students for any of the above marketing, sales, or other distribution purposes;
- Instructional material used as part of the educational curriculum.

UISD has developed and adopted policies, in consultation with parents, regarding these rights, as well as arrangements to protect student privacy in the administration of protected surveys and the collection, disclosure, or use of personal information for marketing, sales, or other distribution purposes. UISD will notify parents and eligible students of these policies at least annually at the start of each school year and after any substantive changes. UISD will also directly notify parents and eligible students, at least annually at the start of each school year of the specific or approximate dates of the following activities and provide an opportunity to opt a student out of participating in:

- Collection, disclosure, or use of personal information for marketing sales or other distribution.
- Administration of any protected information survey not funded in whole or in part by U.S. Department of Education.
- Any non-emergency, invasive physical examination or screening as described above.

Obtaining Information and Protecting Student Rights: Your child will not be required to participate without parental consent in any survey, analysis, or evaluation—funded in whole or in part by the U.S. Department of Education—that concerns:

- Political affiliations or beliefs of the student or the student's parent.
- Mental or psychological problems of the student or the student's family.
- Sexual behavior or attitudes.
- Illegal, antisocial, self-incriminating, or demeaning behavior.
- Critical appraisals of individuals with whom the student has a close family relationship.
- Relationships privileged under law, such as relationships with lawyers, physicians, and ministers.
- Religious practices, affiliations, or beliefs of the student or parents.
- Income, except when the information is required by law and will be used to determine the student's eligibility to participate in a special program or to receive financial assistance under such a program.
- You will be able to inspect the survey or other instrument and any instructional materials used in connection with such a survey, analysis, or evaluation.

Participation in Federally Required, State-Mandated, and District Assessments: In accordance with the Every Student Succeeds Act (ESSA), a parent may request information regarding any federal, state, or Board Policy related to his or her child's participation in required assessments.

Release of Student Information to Military Recruiters and Institutions of Higher Education: The District is required by federal law to comply with a request by a military recruiter or an institution of higher education for students' names, address, and telephone listings, unless parents have advised the District not to release their child's information without prior written consent. A form provided in the forms packet is available if you do not want the District to provide this information to military recruiters or institutions of higher education.

Removing a Student Temporarily from the Classroom: You may remove your child temporarily from the classroom if an instructional activity in which your child is scheduled to participate in conflicts with your religious or moral beliefs. The removal cannot be for the purpose of avoiding a test and may not extend for an entire semester. Further, your child must satisfy grade-level and graduation requirements as determined by the school and by the Texas Education Agency.

Requesting Limited or No Contact with a Student through Electronic Media: Teachers and other approved employees are permitted by the District to communicate with students who are enrolled in the District through the use of electronic media within the scope of the individual's professional extra-curricular responsibilities. In addition to texting the student, the teacher, trainer, or other employee shall also send the same text message to the parent/guardian, unless the parent/guardian does not have a cell phone. decision of Admissions, Review and Dismissal Committee regarding placement under federal special education laws or the teacher's right to remove students under state disciplinary laws. If you prefer that your child not receive any one-to-one electronic communications from a District employee, please submit a written request to

the campus principal stating this preference. The District encourages parents, students and staff to use "Remind101" and/or "Class Dojo" programs which are one-way communication tools that helps educators send notices or alerts to students and parents. Parents and students may opt-in or they may opt-out at any time. Message frequency may vary by group/class. Standard message & data rates may apply.

Requesting Notices of Certain Student Misconduct: A noncustodial parent may request in writing that he or she be provided, for the remainder of the school year, a copy of any written notice usually provided to a parent related to your child's misconduct that may involve placement in a Disciplinary Alternative Education Program (DAEP) or expulsion.

Requesting Classroom Placement of Multiple Birth Siblings: Not later than the 14th day after the first day of enrollment, the parent of multiple birth siblings may request in writing that the school place the siblings in the same or separate classrooms. A parent's request will be honored unless it requires the school to add an additional class to the grade level. However, the principal may change the classroom after the first grading period if after consultation with the teacher of each classroom the placement is deemed "disruptive to the school." This right does not affect the decision of Admissions, Review and Dismissal Committee regarding placement under federal special education laws or the teacher's right to remove students under state disciplinary laws. If you are the parent or guardian of multiple birth siblings and desire more information regarding your rights regarding classroom placement, contact the campus principal.

Requesting Professional Qualifications of Teachers and Staff: You may request information regarding the professional qualifications of your child's teachers, including whether a teacher has met state qualification and licensing criteria for the grade levels and subject areas in which the teacher provides instruction; whether the teacher has an emergency permit or other provisional status for which state requirements have been waived; and undergraduate and graduate degree majors, graduate certifications and the field of study of the certification or degree. You also have the right to request information about the qualifications of any paraprofessional who may provide services to your child.

Requesting Student Transfers – In-District (Student within the district's boundary): The parent/guardian can request an In-District Student Transfer (student lives within the boundaries of UISD) beginning on the first week of April (subject to change as per Superintendent's decision) and ending on the day before the principal's last contract day in June. The Superintendent has the authority to limit transfer approvals to any campus or grade level in a campus which are over-populated or have been determined to reach its maximum capacity. The following is the Student Transfer process:

- Parents will complete a Student District Transfer, along with any supporting documentation as required by the campus principal, directly with the campus principal where you wish your child to attend.
- Upon decision rendered and provided the Student Transfer Form to the parent, the parent will submit the form in-person to the Office of Admissions at UISD Central Office at 201 Lindenwood Dr., Portable #7.
- Student transfers are reviewed by the Office of Admissions for completeness and accuracy and to render a decision based on principal's recommendation.
- Parents will be notified on the status of their transfer request and provided with additional information, as appropriate.

Requesting Student Transfers – Out-of-District: For students residing outside the UISD boundary and requesting admission into UISD, visit the Office of Admissions at the address listed below for further instructions. At the time of the transfer request, parents are required to provide a copy of the student's records which include the most recent report card, attendance record from the start of the school year, and a disciplinary report from the current or last school of attendance, if enrolled. In addition, provide a copy of the current utility bill or lease agreement and identification (e.g., driver's license), proof of residency (e.g., utility bill or lease agreement), and proof of identification (e.g., driver's license or government-issued identification card). The district shall consider the availability of space and instructional staff in addition to a detailed review of the student's academic, disciplinary, and attendance records. The following is the Out-of-District Transfer Process:

- Apply for an Out-of-District Transfer directly with the Office of Admissions, UISD Central Office at 201 Lindenwood Dr., Portable #7.
- Transfers are reviewed for completeness. Parents are responsible to provide all required documents as stated above.
- Transfer forms are sent to the appropriate principal for their decision by email.
- Parents will be contacted once the Office of Admissions receives a decision from the campus principal. Once a decision has been made, registration information will be provided.
- All decisions are final. There are no appeals on Out-of-District Transfers.

Student Transfer Information: Parents who move during the school year may request a student transfer to continue attending the current school for the remainder of the school year; however, the student must be in good standing (academic, discipline, and attendance).

- Parents will apply for either an In-District Student or Out-of-District Transfer, based on the student's home address at the time when the student becomes a non-resident of the school boundary or the district.
- Students who were previously approved to attend a different campus due to a specific academic program (Magnet, U-STEM or Early College) and did not comply with the program's requirements will be required to enroll at their home campus based on their residential address as per the appropriate policy. Any request for a student to remain at the campus must follow normal student transfer procedures.
- In-District resident students who are considered as PK students, ages 3 and 4, are required to register at the home campus to first determine PK program eligibility. When applying for student transfer, the student must have a student ID number assigned at the time of the transfer request.
- Out of District resident students who are considered as PK students, ages 3 and 4, the requested campus principal will decide to accept the student to determine PK eligibility first before rendering a student transfer decision. If approved, the parent will receive a student transfer with the student ID number. The parent will follow the Out-of-District transfer process on Page 55.
- Parents are required to indicate on the transfer form if the reason for applying for a student transfer is to participate or enroll in a district-sponsored program or extracurricular activity and, if approved, notify the campus or the district's Athletic Department or appropriate department on any eligibility requirements or limitations.
- If a student does not enroll within the first 5 days from the start of the school year or from the date of anticipated enrollment date, then this shall be an indication that the parent "self-revoked" the student transfer or the student was considered as a "no-show" as per attendance policies. The student shall then automatically be required to attend the campus based as their designated home campus.

- Parents who have a child in a special education self-contained classroom may request a transfer for siblings to attend the same school or a school within the same attendance zone of the sibling in a special education self-contained classroom.
- The District **will not provide transportation** for transfer students unless required by law.
- A student on a transfer who remains in good academic, attendance and disciplinary standing may request a new Student Transfer when transitioning to a middle school and/or high school feeder that pertains to his or her currently enrolled school.
- Parents who are full-time UISD employees have the privilege to request a transfer for their child to attend the same campus where the parent works or the feeding campuses nearest to their own campus. Non-campus employees will utilize the location of their department as the means to designate the campus whose facility or department fall inside the applicable attendance zone. If there is no space available at the first campus requested, then the next nearest campus will be offered to apply for a student transfer.
- Student transfers expire at the highest grade level of the campus (5th and 8th). All students will be "rolled over"; that is, sent back to their home campus based on the attendance zone of the child's physical address. All in-coming 6th and 9th grade students for the following year are required (if parent wishes) to apply for a new student district transfer application.
- Students whose transfer was approved and attended the previous year and plan to attend the same school for the following year will have their transfers automatically revoked if the student was a "no show"; that is, did not meet the Texas Compensatory Attendance Requirement within the first 5 days of attendance. A new request can be requested since parent "self-revoked" the transfer application and shall register at the home campus based on the student's attendance zone.
- Admitting one student under a student transfer of a family creates no right or expectation that another student from the same family will be admitted on a transfer for current and future school year periods.
- Parents of non-resident students (living outside the boundaries of UISD) shall re-apply for a new student transfer request on an annual basis, including those that were once resident students but moved outside the district anytime during the school year. There are no appeals for Out of District transfer if the transfer was denied or revoked and the student did not meet the transfer requirements as noted in this section.
- A parent shall re-apply for a student transfer if the student moved from one district to another; that is, either left the district to establish a new residency (becoming a non-resident student) or was approved for an Out of-District Transfer but moved into a UISD school zone.
- The Texas Legislature authorized under HB 1959 for "a peace officer who is a parent of or a person standing in parental relation to a student, to transfer the student to another district campus or to another district under an agreement prescribed by statutory provisions governing the transfer of students between districts or counties." Contact the Office of Admissions at (956) 473-6349 for additional information.
- The Texas Legislature authorized under HB 2892 that "require a school district to transfer a child of a military service member to another campus within the district or to another district upon the service member's request and to the campus requested." Contact the Office of Admissions at (956) 473-6349 for additional information.

Requesting a School Safety Transfer

1. For any student who becomes a victim of a violent criminal offense, while in or on the grounds of the school the student attends, the District shall notify the parent of the victim of their right to request a transfer. The parent must submit to the Superintendent's designee an application for transfer. The Superintendent's designee shall approve or deny the request within 14 calendar days of its submission unless additional information is required or as instructed by the Superintendent or designee. Any transfer arranged for a student who was a victim of a violent crime as described in policy shall be renewed so long as the threat to the student exists at the campus to which the student would typically be assigned. For each offense, the District shall maintain the following for at least five years: documentation of the nature and date of the offense; notification to the parent of the transfer option; transfer applications submitted; action taken; and other relevant information regarding the offense.
2. To request the transfer of your child to attend a safe public school in the District if your child attends school at a **campus identified by TEA as persistently dangerous. (**See Board Policy FDE.)
3. To request the transfer of your child to another campus if your child has been the **victim of a sexual assault by another student assigned to the same campus**, whether that assault occurred on or off campus, and that student has been convicted of or placed on deferred adjudication for that assault. (See Board Policy FDE.)

Student Transfer Revocation Process: Students who transfer into the District shall follow all district and campus policies, rules, and regulations of the District, including but not limited to those involving student conduct, attendance, and academic requirements. UISD reserves the right to review and evaluate any and all transfers on an annual basis or as deemed necessary by the campus administrator, the Superintendent of Schools, or his/her designee. The following process will occur when a transfer is being considered for revocation:

- Parents will be scheduled for a due process meeting to review previous interventions on academic, attendance, and/or disciplinary concerns.
- Notify the parent that the transfer will be sent to the Superintendent or designee for revocation. If approved, the student will be sent to the home campus where the student resides.
- Students will be allowed to remain at the current campus until a decision has been made.
- The Superintendent or designee's decision is final.

Student Transfer Appeal Process for Denied Transfer Requests: If the principal denies a student transfer, parents whose children reside within the boundaries of UISD have the right to appeal the decision directly with the Office of Admissions. The parent must provide the denied transfer form along with supporting documentation. Student academic, attendance, and disciplinary records will be submitted to the Superintendent or designee for a review and render a final decision. Parents are required to register their child at the campus where the student resides until the appeal process is complete. Students on an Out-of-District residency status, will not have the right to appeal the transfer denial or revocation.

Cap/Transfer School: When the maximum number of students per grade level is reached and if the campus has a vacant classroom, a new teacher may be added. However, because of the disruption of classes the decision may be made to "cap" or close enrollment in a specific grade level or campus. When this decision is made, newly enrolling students will be transferred to a campus where space is available under a student transfer agreement. Transportation may be provided by the District, as determined by the Superintendent or designee. Transfers usually affect only new students and not returning students unless the returning students do not attend the first five days of school of the new school year. As vacancies occur, transferred students have the option to return to their home campus. The transfer date determines the order of return. The Board of Trustees and the Superintendent or Designee shall have the authority to designate students to campuses based on boundary changes or in the best interest of the District, as required by law or necessity.

Reviewing Instructional Materials: As a parent you have a right to review instructional materials including: mobile learning device (MLD), instructional materials and online resources, textbooks and other teaching aids and instructional-related materials used to support District curriculum. In addition, you have access to unsecure assessment/tests that have been administered to your child. Parents/Guardians, you also are entitled to request that the school allow your child to take home any instructional materials used by the student. If the school determines that sufficient availability exists to grant the request, the student must return the materials at the beginning of the next school day if requested to do so by the child's teacher. The District will make instructional materials available for parent review no later than 30 days before the school year begins and for at least 30 days after the school year ends. However, tests that have not yet been administered will not be made available for parent examination.

District Review of Instructional Materials: A parent may request that the District conduct an instructional material review in a math, English Language Arts, science, or social studies class in which the parent's student is enrolled to determine alignment with state standards and the level of rigor for the grade level. The district is not required to conduct an instructional material review for a specific subject area or grade level at a specific campus more than once per school year. For more information about requesting an instructional material review, contact the campus principal.

Special Programs: The District provides special programs for gifted and talented students, emergent bilingual students, migrant students, Section 504, dyslexic students and students with disabilities. The Associate Superintendent for Curriculum & Instruction or designee in charge of each program can answer questions about eligibility requirements, as well as programs and services offered in the District or by other organizations. A student or parent with questions about these programs should contact the respective program director.

Child Find and Section 504: The United Independent School District has a duty to identify, refer and evaluate any child residing in the District and if eligible, provide a free, appropriate public education to disabled students. Children eligible for Section 504 accommodations or services include those children who have a physical or mental impairment that substantially limits a major life activity. For additional information, please contact: Name: Claudia Dovalina-Guzman, Executive Director for Special Education, Address: 4410 Highway 359, Laredo, Texas 78043 Telephone: (956) 473-1862, Email: ccdovalina@uisd.net

Section 504 and Disability-Related Issues: The District designates the following individual to coordinate its efforts to comply with Title II of the Americans with Disabilities Act of 1990 (ADA) and with Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973. For complaints regarding identification, evaluation, or placement of a student receiving services under Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act, please contact: Claudia Dovalina-Guzman, Executive Director for Special Education, Address: 4410 Highway 359, Laredo, Texas 78043; Telephone: (956) 473-1862, Email: ccdovalina@uisd.net

Anyone can refer a child for evaluation under Section 504. However, while anyone can make a referral, including parents, teachers or a physician, OCR stated in a staff memorandum that "the school district must also have reason to believe that the child is in need of services under Section 504 due to a disability." (OCR Memorandum, April 29, 1993.)

To be covered under Section 504, a student must be determined to be an "individual with a disability" by a Section 504 Committee. As defined by federal law, an individual with a disability means any person who:

- has a mental or physical impairment which substantially limits one or more major life activities;
- has a record of such an impairment; or
- is regarded as having such an impairment [34 C.F.R. §104.3(j)(1)].

Once identified by the Section 504 Committee as a Section 504 student with disabilities, the student may receive supplementary aids and services to ensure that his or her individual educational needs are met as adequately as those of non-disabled students. Under Section 504, children with disabilities must be educated with their non-disabled peers "to the maximum extent appropriate." (Source: OCR-Office for Civil Rights)

Section 504 Due Process: Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973 provides the right to an impartial due process hearing if a parent wishes to contest any action of the District with regard to a child's identification, evaluation, and placement under Section 504.

A parent has the right to file a complaint through the Office of Civil Rights at any time regardless of the local resolution procedures available through UISD. The parent is not required to take part in the local resolution procedures through FFH or the due process hearing for the identification, evaluation, or placement complaints before filing a complaint with Office of Civil Rights (OCR).

The District will not start the due process hearing procedures unless a complaint based on identification, placement, or evaluation has been given to the District in accordance with Board Policy FNG (Legal). All other complaints based on Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973 should be made under FFH (Local) which can be found on the District's Website at **http://www.uisd.net.**

Service Animal: UISD prohibits animals and pets on campus and District property. This prohibition is designed to enhance everyone's safety while providing a healthier environment for our students and users of campus and District property. **Service Animals are an exception to this prohibition of animals on campus.**

A parent of a student who requires the use of a service animal that has been trained to do work or perform tasks directly related to the student's disability must submit a request in writing to the campus principal at least twenty-one (21) calendar days before bringing said service animal onto the requested campus **or District property**.

Special Education:

Aiding Students Who Have Learning Difficulties or Who Need Special Education or Section 504 Services:

For those students who are having difficulty in the regular classroom the District must consider tutorial, compensatory and other academic or behavior support services that are available to all students, including a process based on Multi-Tiered System of Supports (MTSS). The implementation of MTSS has the potential to have a positive impact on the ability of the District to meet the needs of all struggling students.

If a student is experiencing learning difficulties, his or her parents may contact the individual(s) listed below to learn about the school's overall general education referral or screening system for support services. This system links students to a variety of support options, including making a referral for a special education evaluation or for a Section 504 evaluation to determine if the student needs specific aids, accommodations, or services. A parent may request an evaluation for special education or Section 504 services at any time.

Special Education Referrals: If a parent makes a written request for an initial evaluation for special education services to the director of special education services or an administrative employee, the District must respond no later than 15 school days after receiving the request. At that time, the District must give the parent a prior written notice of whether it agrees to or refuses to evaluate the student, along with a copy of the Notice of Procedural Safeguards. If the District agrees to evaluate the student, it must also give the parent the opportunity to give written consent for the evaluation.

Please note that a request for a special education evaluation may be made verbally and does not need to be in writing. The District must still comply with all federal prior written notice and procedural safeguard requirements and the requirements for identifying, locating and evaluating children who are suspected of being a child with a disability and in need of special education. However, a verbal request does not require the District or charter school to respond within the 15-school-day timeline.

If the District decides to evaluate the student, it must complete the student's initial evaluation and evaluation report no later than 45 school days from the day it receives a parent's written consent to evaluate the student. However, if the student is absent from school during the evaluation period for three or more school days, the evaluation period will be extended by the number of school days equal to the number of school days that the student is absent.

There is an exception to the 45-school-day timeline. If the District receives a parent's consent for the initial evaluation at least 35 but less than 45 school days before the last instructional day of the school year, it must complete the written report and provide a copy of the report to the parent by June 30 of that year. However, if the student is absent from school for three or more days during the evaluation period, the June 30th due date no longer applies. Instead, the general timeline of 45 school days plus extensions for absences of three or more days will apply.

Upon completing the evaluation, the District must give the parent a copy of the evaluation report at no cost.

Additional information regarding special education is available from the District in a companion document titled Parent's Guide to the Admission, Review, and Dismissal Process.

Contact Person for Special Education Referrals: The designated person to contact regarding options for a student experiencing learning difficulties or regarding a referral for evaluation for special education services is:

Contact Person: Claudia Dovalina-Guzman, Executive Director for Special Education
Phone Number: (956) 473-1862 Email: ccdovalina@uisd.net

Section 504 Referrals: The District must have standards and procedures in place for the evaluation and placement of students in the District's Section 504 program. The District must also implement a system of procedural safeguards that includes notice, an opportunity for a parent or guardian to examine relevant records, an impartial hearing with an opportunity for participation by the parent or guardian and representation by counsel, and a review procedure.

Contact Person for Section 504 Referrals: The designated person to contact regarding options for a student experiencing learning difficulties or regarding a referral for evaluation for Section 504 services is:

Contact Person: Claudia Dovalina-Guzman, Executive Director for Special Education
Phone Number: (956) 473-1862 Email: ccdovalina@uisd.net

Additional Information: The following websites provide information and resources for students with disabilities and their families.

- Legal Framework for the Child-Centered Special Education Process http://framework.esc18.net/display/Webforms/LandingPage.aspx
- Partners Resource Network http://prntexas.org/
- Special Education Information Center http://www.spedtex.org/
- Texas Project First http://www.texasprojectfirst.org/

Student Records: Both federal and state laws safeguard student records from unauthorized inspection or use and provide parents and "eligible" students certain rights of privacy. The records custodian or designee shall use reasonable procedures to verify the requestor's identity before disclosing student records containing personally identifiable information. For purposes of student records, an "eligible" student is one who is 18 or is emancipated by a court, or re-enrolls in a postsecondary institution.

The law specifies that certain general information about UISD students is considered "directory information" and will be released to anyone who follows procedures for requesting it. Examples include:

- A student's name, address, telephone number, and date and place of birth.
- The student's photograph, participation in officially recognized activities and sports, weight, and height of members of athletic teams.
- The student's dates of attendance, grade level, enrollment status, honors and awards received in school, and most recent school attended previously.
- The student's email address.
- A student's photograph for publication in the school yearbook.
- A student's name and grade level for purposes of communicating class and teacher assignment.
- A list of student's name and birthday for generating schoolwide or classroom recognition; and
- A student's name and photograph posted on a District approved and managed social media platform.

The parent or an eligible student may prevent release of any or all directory information regarding a student. This objection must be made in writing to the principal within ten (10) school days after you have been provided the notice.

Virtually all information pertaining to student performance, including grades, test results, and disciplinary records, is considered confidential educational records and may be released to:

- The parents—whether married, separated, or divorced—who will generally have access to the records. A parent whose rights have been legally terminated will be denied access to the records if the school is given a copy of the court order terminating these rights.
- The student—Federal law requires that, as soon as a student becomes 18, is emancipated by a court, or is attending an institution of postsecondary education, the rights accorded to and consent required of parents transfer from the parents to the student. The parents may access the records if the student is a dependent for tax purposes. See Board Policy FL(Legal).
- "School Officials", including School/District staff members (such as teachers, counselors, support staff, bus drivers/monitors, and diagnosticians, school officials (such as Board members, the Superintendent, and administrators), and a person or company with whom the District has contracted or allowed to provide a particular service or function (such as an attorney, consultant, auditor, medical consultant, online service provider or therapist), or a parent serving on a school committee (i.e., LPAC), provided that these "school official(s)" have a legitimate education interest in the confidential education records. The District's criteria for determining what constitutes a legitimate education interest is as follows: A school official typically has a legitimate educational interest if the official needs to review an education record in order to fulfill his or her professional responsibility.
- Various governmental agencies, including but not limited to juvenile service providers and Child Protective Services (CPS) caseworkers or other child welfare representatives, in certain cases or individuals or entities granted access in response to a subpoena or court order.
- A school or institution of postsecondary education to which a student seeks or intends to enroll or in which he/she is already enrolled.
- To appropriate officials in connection with a health or safety emergency.
- To organizations conducting studies for, or on behalf of, the school, in order to develop, validate, or administer predictive tests; administer student aid programs; or improve instruction.
- In connection with financial aid for which a student has applied or which the student has received.

Release to any other person or agency–such as a prospective employer or for a scholarship application–will occur only with parental or student permission as appropriate.

The principal is the custodian of all records for currently enrolled students at the assigned school.

Active Records may be reviewed in person during regular school hours without charge upon written request to the records custodian. For in-person viewing, the records custodian or designee shall be available to explain the record and to answer questions. The confidential nature of both active and inactive student's records shall be maintained at all times, and records to be viewed shall be restricted to use only in the Superintendent's, principal's, or counselor's office, or other restricted area designated by the records custodian. The original copy of the record or any document contained in the cumulative record shall not be removed from the school or Records Management Department. If circumstances effectively prevent a parent or eligible student from inspecting the records, the District shall provide a copy of the requested records, or make other arrangements for the parent or student to review the requested records. The records custodian or designee for active records will respond to reasonable requests for explanation and interpretation of the records.

The Records Management Department is the custodian of all records for students who have withdrawn or graduated. All inactive records should be requested from the last school attended.

A parent (or the student if he or she is 18 or older, married, or is attending an institution of postsecondary education) may review and inspect the student's records and request a correction if the records are considered inaccurate or otherwise in violation of the student's privacy rights. Within 15 District business days of the record custodian's receipt of a request to amend records, the District shall notify the parents in writing of its decision on the request and, if the District refuses the request to amend the records, the requestor has the right to request a hearing. If a hearing is requested, it shall be held within 10 District business days after the request is received. Parents shall be notified in advance of the date, time and place of the hearing. An administrator who is not responsible for the contested records and who does not have a direct interest in the outcome of the hearing shall conduct the hearing. The parents shall be given a full and fair opportunity to present evidence and, at their own expense, may be assisted or represented at the hearing. The parents shall be notified of the decision in writing within 10 District business days of the hearing. The decision shall be based solely on the evidence presented at the hearing and shall include a summary of the evidence and reasons for the decision. If the records are not amended as a result of the hearing, the requestor has 30 school days to exercise the right to place a statement commenting on the information in the student's record. Although improperly recorded grades may be challenged, contesting a student's grade in a course is handled through the general complaint process defined by Board Policy FNG.

Copies of student records are available at a cost of 10 cents per page, payable in advance. Copies of records must be requested in writing. Parents may be denied copies of a student's records (1) after the student reaches age 18 and is no longer a dependent for tax purposes; (2) when the student is attending an institution of post-secondary education; (3) if the parent fails to follow proper procedures and pay the copying charge; or (4) when the District is given a copy of a court order terminating the parental rights. If the student qualifies for free or reduced-price meals and the parents are unable to view the records during regular school hours, upon written request of the parent, one copy of the record shall be provided at no charge.

Please note: Parents or eligible students have the right to file a complaint with the U.S. Department of Education if they believe the District is not in compliance with the law regarding student records. The District's complete policy regarding student records is available on the District's website at **http://www.uisd.net.** The address to send a complaint to is:

Family Policy Compliance Office - U.S. Department of Education - 400 Maryland Avenue-SW, Washington, DC 20202-5920

The parent's or eligible student's right of access to and copies of student records do not extend to all records. Materials that are not considered educational records–such as teachers' personal notes on a student that are shared only with a substitute teacher and records on former students after they are no longer students in the District–do not have to be made available to the parents or student. Educational records do not include records maintained by the law enforcement unit of the District that were created by that law enforcement unit for the purpose of law enforcement.

SECTION II: INFORMATION FOR STUDENTS AND PARENTS

Topics in this section of the handbook contain important information on academics, school activities, and school operations and requirements. Take a moment with your child to become familiar with the various issues addressed in this section. It is conveniently organized in alphabetical order to serve as a quick-reference when you or your child has a question about a specific school-related issue. Should you be unable to find the information on a particular topic, please contact your child's school principal.

ADMISSION REQUIREMENTS

UISD will admit into the District free of tuition all persons who are over the age of 5 and younger than 21 years of age on September 1st of the school year in which admission is sought if any of the following conditions exist:

1. The person and either parent of the person reside in the District;
2. The person does not reside in the District, but a parent of the person resides in the District and that parent is a joint managing conservator or the sole managing conservator or possessory conservator of the person;
3. The person and the person's guardian or other person having lawful control of the person under a court order resides within the District;
4. The person is under the age of 18 and has established a separate residence in the District apart from his or her parent, guardian, or other person having lawful control under an order of a court and has established that the person's presence in the District is not for the primary purpose of participation in extracurricular activities. The Board is not required to admit such person, however, if the person has:
   a. Engaged in conduct that resulted in removal to a disciplinary alternative education program or expulsion within the preceding year;
   b. Engaged in delinquent conduct or "conduct in need of supervision" (see SCOC glossary) and is on probation or other conditional release for that conduct; or
   c. Been convicted of a criminal offense and is on probation or other conditional release.
5. The person is a homeless child, as defined by 42 U.S.C. Section 11302, regardless of the residence of the person, of either parent of the person, or of the person's guardian or other person having lawful control of the person;
6. The person is a foreign exchange student placed with a host family that resides in the District by a nationally recognized foreign exchange program, unless the District has applied for and been granted a waiver by the commissioner under Subsection (e);
7. The person resides at a residential facility, as defined in Texas Education Code 5.001, located in the District. For purposes of enrollment, a person who resides in a residential facility is considered a resident of the District in which the facility is located;
8. The person resides in the school district and is 18 years of age or older or the person's disabilities of minority have been removed; or
9. The person does not reside in the District but the grandparent of the person resides in the District; and provides a substantial amount of after-school care for the person provided that space is available as per Board Policy FD (Local).

Student Entitlement to Attend School in District of Residence: The District requires evidence to be submitted by a person who is entitled to attend the public free school of the District at the time it considers an application for admission of the person. The Board or its designee shall establish minimum proof of residency acceptable to the District. Students are enrolled at the school corresponding to their place of residency, according to the official district's school boundary located on our district's website (www.uisd.net) in the Parent's section.

Acceptable documents for verifying residence include a current utility bill (mortgage statement under parent's/guardian's name, water, gas or electric), current lease/contract on apartment or house, rent receipt plus a valid Texas driver's license or military or TDPS identification. Other forms of identification may be accepted at the District's discretion and in accordance with state and federal law. Other forms such as rental receipts, cable bills, bank statements, insurance bills, cell phone bills, and SNAP letters are not acceptable proof of residency.

The district requires an acceptable proof of residency at the time of initial enrollment (new student enrollment) and for every year thereafter during the Skyward Online Registration process which commences in the Spring Semester of each academic year.

UISD is an "Open Enrollment" district which is defined as granting students that reside outside the district an opportunity to apply for our district's tuition-free education and attend a UISD school for the entire academic calendar. Authorization for enrollment is through the district's Out-of-District Transfer process which is located on the student transfer section of this handbook. This authorization for out-of-district students is on an annual basis based on availability of space and adhering to the transfer policies. Subject to availability of space, the district may offer another campus where space is available on a per-student basis.

For additional information, parents can review information regarding the admissions process and access to the Skyward Parent Portal (www.uisd.net) in the "Parents" tab or in the "Admissions, Attendance, Dropout Recovery Department" for new students into the District.

Minor Living Apart (Power of Attorney): An adult resident of the District wishing to enroll a minor student who is living separate and apart from a parent/legal guardian or other person having lawful control of him or her under court order shall be required to come to the school and complete the registration process. The District shall require the individual assuming responsibility to do so through a District Power of Attorney (POA) notarized form stating that the parent/guardian has given the resident/individual care, custody and control of the student assigning responsibility for the student in all school-related matters and to meet with a school official to complete the "Temporary Guardianship Questionnaire." The questionnaire needs to be completed prior to parent being given the POA form for notarization. POA status is valid only for the current school year and must be renewed on an annual basis. District attendance officers may verify POA residency status. The POA agreement is solely revoked between the parent and the guardian; however, it is the responsibility of the parent or guardian (POA) to notify the campus immediately on any updates to residential and/or guardianship status.

Host Family: When the student's parent(s), together with the child, reside within the District in the same home of another family, the District requires both the owner/renter of the residence and the parent, legal guardian, or other person having legal custody of the student to come to the school and complete the registration process and meet with a school official to complete the Host Residency Questionnaire. In addition, the following documentation must be provided:

- Notarized Host Family Enrollment Application Form; (UISD Form # 882-003)
- Current Identification (Driver's License or equivalent government-issued identification)
- Proof of Residency (Current Utility Bill – mortgage statement under parent's/guardian's name, water, gas, or light). Other forms such as rental receipts, cable bills, bank statements, insurance bills, cell phone bills, and SNAP letters are not acceptable proof of residency.

Host family status is valid only for the current school year and must, therefore, be renewed on an annual basis. District attendance officers, or other employees authorized by the Office of Admissions, Attendance, and Dropout Recovery, may verify Host residency status.

In addition, the host (property owner/lease holder) shall acknowledge that accepting the host agreement is meant as the family residing in the home on a full-time basis and shall report any changes of residency within 3 calendar days of knowing the change will occur. Failure to do so will require the host and/or parent to have a conference with a school administrator to discuss enrollment options. The Host agreement is solely revoked between the parent and the host; however, it is the responsibility of the parent or homeowner (Host) to notify the campus immediately on any updates to residential status.

Grandparent Care Affidavit: The parent and grandparent of a nonresident student requesting admission shall provide to the Superintendent the required information on the grandparent's residency and complete a form provided by the District describing the extent of after-school care to be provided by the grandparent.

When a grandparent who resides in the District provides a substantial amount of after-school care as noted in Board Policy FD (Local), and for a child who does not reside in the District or specific school attendance boundary, the child shall be admitted to the District free of tuition where the grandparent resides, or to the school in the attendance area provided that space is available. Employment information shall be requested from both parents of the student. The substantial amount determined by the Board is a minimum of four (4) school days per week and a minimum of three (3) hours per day. The following documentation is required:

- A notarized "Grandparent Care" affidavit form; (UISD Form # 882-004); and
- Documents that confirm residency and Identification for grandparents.
- Proof of residency and identification for parents of the student.

The grandparent shall be in the care of the student within the 3-hour period immediately from the end of the school day, including being designated as the person as an "Emergency Contact" and authorized for Early Release Authorization on the Skyward Parent Portal Online Registration. The Grandparent Care Affidavit agreement is solely revoked between the parent and the grandparent; however, it is the responsibility of the parent or grandparent to notify the campus immediately on any updates to residential status. If the grandparent is no longer residing within the attendance zone where the student is attending, then the parent needs to schedule an appointment with the campus principal immediately to request a student transfer since the student is not a resident of the school's boundary at the time when the Grandparent Care Affidavit is granted.

Transportation is only provided at the end of the school day for students whose grandparents reside within the District boundaries and only if transportation services have been designated for students attending school in the area. No new transportation routes will be created. District attendance officers will verify after-school care at said grandparent's residence during the stated hours of after-school care.

Penalties – Notice of: Texas Education Code §25.001(h) states that a person who knowingly falsifies information on a form required for enrollment of a student in a school district is liable to the district if the student is not eligible for enrollment in the district but is enrolled on the basis of the false information. The person is liable, for the period during which the ineligible student is enrolled, for the greater of (1) the maximum tuition fee the district may charge under Section 25.038; or (2) the amount the district has budgeted for each student as maintenance and operating expenses. [See Board Policy FD (Legal).]

In such circumstances, individuals who falsify information must reimburse the District $30.00 for each day an ineligible student is enrolled. Additionally, Section 37.10, Texas Penal Code states that a person commits an offense if he knowingly makes a false entry in, or false alteration of, a governmental record; makes, presents, or uses any record, document, or thing with knowledge of its falsity and with intent that it be taken as a genuine governmental record; intentionally destroys, conceals, removes, or otherwise impairs the verity, legibility, or availability of a governmental record; possesses, sells, or offers to sell a governmental record or a blank governmental record form with intent that it be used unlawfully; makes, presents, or uses a governmental record with knowledge of its falsity; or possesses, sells, or offers to sell a governmental record or a blank governmental record form with knowledge that it was obtained unlawfully. An offense under this section is a Class C misdemeanor if it is shown on the trial of the offense that the governmental record is a governmental record that is required for enrollment of a student in a school district and was used by the actor to establish the residency of the student.

It is also an offense for a person to obtain, possess, transfer, or use, with intent to harm or defraud another, the identifying information of another person without their consent or of a child younger than 18 years old.

Note: **It is the policy of this District to pursue intentional violators of the student enrollment law to the fullest extent permitted by law.**

Enrollment: Students who are at least 5 years of age (4 years for Pre-Kindergarten and 3 years for PK3 by eligibility criteria) and up to the age of 19 as of September 1st of each year must be accepted for admissions if the student lives within the boundaries of the District or has been granted special permission under an Out-of-District Student Transfer. Students are registered at the "home campus" where they reside based on the district's approved school boundaries available on our district's website "Find Your School." Although the district will designate summer registration dates, students are not denied enrollment on or after the start of the first day of school. The following items are required for registration of students:

1. Student Registration starts with one of the following methods:
    a. For current students who will be returning to UISD the following school year
        i. Parent/Guardian login into Skyward Parent Portal and updates information and fills out annual forms through the Online Registration portal
        ii. Proof of residency and parent/guardian picture ID are to be attached to the online registration submission
    b. For students who have never attended a UISD District school and do not have siblings currently attending a UISD school, the parent will use the "Register New Family" in the sign-on screen of the Skyward Parent Portal
        i. parents must upload as an attachment the following documents:

1. Proof of Residency (mortgage statement under parent's/guardian's name, utility bill, or a complete lease agreement)
2. Proof of Parent's Identification
3. Student Birth Certificate, adoption certificate, or passport
4. Student Social Security Card, if available (highly recommended to be presented for future academic records)
5. Student School Records, if applicable
6. Updated immunization records
7. Proof of legal document or court order showing guardianship for a child that is not the biological parent
8. As deemed necessary, a court order restricting a non-custodial parent from having access or possession of a child during school hours or released after the end of the school day.

c. For students who are new to the District and have siblings currently attending a UISD District school, the parent will add a new student through the online registration process.
   i. parents must upload as an attachment the following documents:
      1. Proof of Residency (utility bill or a complete lease agreement)
      2. Proof of Parent's Identification
      3. The following documents only for the new students been added:
         a. Student Birth Certificate adoption certificate or passport.
         b. Student Social Security Card, if available (highly recommended to be presented for future academic records)
         c. Student School Records, if applicable
         d. Updated immunization records

d. For students who had attended school in previous years, contact the campus registrar at the school where the child's home is zoned (school boundary) to re-activate the students' Skyward Parent Portal account

2. If a parent is unable to provide some of the items listed above, contact the campus registrar for assistance.
3. Campus registrars will review the online registration submission and proceed with registration verification and validation of information and attachments.
4. If a new student was added to the Skyward Parent Portal or created a new account under "New Student Enrollment", the parent must contact the campus where they are registering a new student so the registrar can continue the registration process.
5. On an annual basis and as authorized by the UISD Board of Trustees, the district will offer a "Tuition-Based" Pre-Kindergarten Program for four-year old children who did not qualify for the district's regular PK-Kindergarten program. This program is offered district-wide but is designated at selected campus/campuses.

Missing Child's Proof of Identification: If the parent/guardian has not furnished the school with the proper identification documentation (i.e, birth certificate) for the child at school within 30 days of the child's enrollment in school, Texas Education Code §25.002(c) requires the District to notify the Laredo Police Department or the Webb County Sheriff's Department to request a determination of whether the child has been reported as missing. This applies under extraordinary circumstances where there is evidence or a statement made that the student was not entitled to be registered by a non-parent or non-legal guardian.

A child must be enrolled by the child's parent, guardian, or other person with legal control under a court order. The District shall record the name, address, and date of birth of the person enrolling a child in accordance with Texas Education Code §25.002(f).

Legal Surname: A student must be identified by the student's legal surname as it appears on the student's birth certificate or other document suitable as proof of the student's identity, or in a court order changing the student's name.

Inconsistent Documentation: If a child is enrolled under a name other than the name that appears in the identifying documents or records, the District is required to notify the missing children and missing persons information clearinghouse of the child's name as shown on the identifying records and the name under which the child is enrolled.

Updating Student Information: If at any time during the school year any information on the student's data changes, parents are to notify the student's campus immediately of the changes. New telephone numbers, emergency contact information, change of address, parent information, etc. are examples of vital information that school officials may need to make phone contact, mail letters or at times have conferences with parents. Thus, updated information becomes vital. Additionally, in the case of students whose parents are divorced or share custody, the District requests that the most recent court order regarding custody be on file with the District. It is the parent's responsibility to provide this information to the District **within three calendar days of knowing the change will occur**. This applies for students who had a change of guardianships (POA and Parent agreements) or the Host residential status has changed. When updating Skyward Online Registration for the following school year, parents are not allowed to remove non-custodial parent information, unless the campus has a court-order on file which restricts the non-custodial parent from accessing student records via the Skyward Parent Portal or through a request of school records in person.

On or about the beginning of April of each school year, UISD begins the process for registration for the upcoming school year. Parents may update contact information for the following school year through their Parent Portal account. Actual dates for new student registration shall be posted on the District's webpage, as appropriate.

Attendance

Regular school attendance is essential for a student to make the most of his or her education—to benefit from teacher-led and school activities, to build each day's learning on the previous day's learning and to grow as an individual. Absences from class may result in serious disruption of a student's mastery of the instructional materials; therefore, the student and parent should make every effort to avoid unnecessary absences. Two state laws, one dealing with compulsory attendance and the other with how a child's attendance affects the award of a student's final grade or course credit, are of special interest to students and parents. They are discussed below:

Compulsory Attendance: Texas Education Code §25.085 requires that a student who is at least six years of age as of September 1 of the current school year, or who is younger than six years of age and has previously been enrolled in first grade and who has not yet reached the child's 19th birthday, shall attend school for the entire period the program of instruction is provided, as well as any applicable accelerated instruction program, extended year program, or tutorial session unless the student is otherwise excused from attendance or legally exempt.

Age 19 and Older: A student who voluntarily enrolls in school or voluntarily attends school after the person's 19th birthday shall attend school each school day for the entire period the program of instruction is offered. In addition, if a student 19 or older has more than five unexcused absences in a semester, the District may revoke the student's enrollment for the remainder of the school year, except that a school district may not withdraw a student from school on a day on which the student is physically present at school. The student's presence on school property thereafter would be unauthorized and may be considered trespassing.

Under IDEA, special education and related services must be available to an eligible child or adult student until he or she graduates with a regular high school diploma or exceeds the age eligibility requirements for a free appropriate public education under state law, which is age 21 in Texas or until the student's 22nd birthday. An adult student receiving special education and related services who is 21 years of age on September 1 of a school year is eligible for services through the end of that school year or until graduation with a regular high school diploma based upon meeting the curriculum standards and credit requirements applicable to students in general education, whichever comes first.

Pre-Kindergarten (PK3/PK4) and Kindergarten: Students who are enrolled in pre-kindergarten (both PK3 and PK4) or kindergarten are required to attend school and the parents are subject to the compulsory attendance requirements.

Requirements to be Considered Present: A student who is absent may be considered present for several types of absences. These include the following events: (Documentation must be provided to support the absence)

- Religious holy days;
- Required court appearances;
- Appearing at a governmental office to complete paperwork in connection with the student's application for United States citizenship;
- Taking part in the student's own US naturalization oath ceremony;
- Services as an election clerk; and
- Documented health-care appointments for the student or a child of the student, if the student begins classes or returns to classes on the same day of the appointment (a medical note from a U.S. health care provider must be submitted upon the student's arrival or return to campus).
- For students under conservatorship (custody) of the state, the exemptions include:
    - An activity required under a court ordered service plan; and
    - Any other court-ordered activity, provided it is not practicable to schedule the student's participation in the activity outside of school hours.
- A student whose absence resulting from a serious or life-threatening illness or related treatment that makes the student's attendance infeasible, if the student or the student's parent or guardian provides a certification from a U.S. physician specifying the student's illness and the anticipated period of the student's absence relating to the illness or treatment.
- A junior or senior student who misses school for the purpose of visiting an institution of higher education accredited by a generally recognized accredited organization. An absence of up to two days is allowed.
- A student 17 years of age or older is pursuing enlistment in a branch of the U.S. armed services or Texas National Guard, provided the absence does not exceed four days during the period the student is enrolled in high school and the student provides verification to the District of these activities.
- A student missing school for purpose of visiting a driver license office to obtain a driver's license or learner permit. The student must be 15 years of age or older. The student is only allowed one day of school during the period the student is enrolled in high school for each purpose. The student must provide verification of the visit to the driver's license office.

Students in Homeschooling: To homeschool legally in Texas, parents/legal guardians must follow three state law requirements:

1. The instruction must be bona fide.
2. The curriculum must be in visual form (e.g., books, workbooks, video monitor) and/or distance learning format as necessary.
3. The curriculum must include the five basic subjects of reading, spelling, grammar, mathematics, and good citizenship.

When the District becomes aware that a child between the ages of 6 through 19 is living within the boundaries of UISD and the parent/guardian has elected to home school their child, the parent/guardian may provide the District a signed letter stating that the student is being homeschooled. The letter with the date homeschooling began is sufficient documentation for purposes of the Leaver Reason Code. If the District has evidence that the school-age child is not being home-schooled within legal requirements, the District may investigate further and, if warranted, shall pursue legal action to enforce the compulsory attendance law. Per federal requirement, it is not permissible for a district to document that, at the time of withdrawal, the student intended to be homeschooled. The Texas Education Agency (TEA) or District does not regulate, index, monitor, approve, register, or accredit the programs available to parents who choose to homeschool. Please note that a letter of this type is not required each year.

Failure to Comply with Compulsory Attendance: School employees must investigate and report violations of the state compulsory attendance law. A student absent from school without a justifiable reason will be considered in violation of the compulsory attendance law and subject to truancy prevention measures.

When a student incurs unexcused absences for three or more days or parts of days within a four-week period, the school will send a warning notice to the student's parent as required by law. This warning notice will inform the parent that it is the parent's duty to monitor his or her child's attendance and to require the student to attend school. The notice will also inform the parent that UISD will initiate truancy prevention measures and request a conference between the school attendance officer and the parent to discuss the absences. These measures such as implementing an attendance improvement plan, and a referral to the academic counselor will be made.

Attendance Officers by law are required to implement truancy prevention measures designed to address the student attendance issues prior to filing a complaint with a truancy court. However, if the truancy prevention measures fail to meaningfully address the student's school attendance, a complaint will be filed with a truancy court against the parent, the student or both.

A truancy court may impose penalties against a student's parents if a school-aged student is deliberately not attending school. A complaint against the parent may be filed in the appropriate court if the student is absent from school (without excuse) on ***ten or more days or parts of days within***

a six-month period in the same school year. Arriving late to school after the tardy bell rings without justification or leaving school early without justification are considered parts of a day.

Ages 19 and Older: If a student age 19 or older incurs a third unexcused absence, the District will send the student a letter, as required by law. This letter will explain that the District may revoke the student's enrollment for the remainder of the school year if the student has more than five unexcused absences in a semester. As an alternative to revoking a student's enrollment, the District may implement an attendance plan.

Attendance for Credit: Under Texas Education Code §25.092, a student in any grade level from Kindergarten through Twelfth grade may not be given credit or a final grade for a class unless the student is in attendance for at least 90 percent of the days the class is offered. The actual number of days a student must be in attendance in order to receive credit or a final grade will depend on whether the class is for a full semester or for a full year. A student who attends at least 75 percent but fewer than 90 percent of the days the class is offered may receive credit or a final grade for the class if he or she completes a plan, approved by the principal, which allows the student to fulfill the instructional requirements for the class. If a student is involved in a criminal or juvenile court proceeding, the approval of the judge presiding over the case will also be required before the student receives credit for the class. (See Board Policy FEC.)

If a student attends less than 75 percent of the days a class is offered or has not completed the plan approved by the principal, the student will be referred to the Attendance Review Committee (ARC) to determine whether there are extenuating circumstances for the absences and how the student can regain credit, if appropriate-(See Board Policy FEC.) In determining whether there were extenuating circumstances for the absences, the attendance committee will use the following guidelines:

- All absences will be considered in determining whether a student has attended the required percentage of days.
- A transfer or migrant student begins to accumulate absences only after he or she has enrolled in the District. For a student transferring into the District after school begins, including a migrant student, only those absences after enrollment will be considered.
- In reaching a decision about a student's absences, the committee will attempt to ensure that it is in the best interest of the student.
- The committee will consider the acceptability and authenticity of documented reasons for the student's absences.
- The committee will consider whether the absences were for reasons over which the student or the student's parent could exercise any control.
- The committee will consider the extent to which the student has completed all assignments, mastered the essential knowledge and skills, and maintained passing grades in the course or subject.
- The student or parent will be given an opportunity to present any information to the committee about the absences and to talk about ways to earn or regain credit.
- A temporary absence resulting from any cause acceptable to the teacher, principal, or Superintendent, including personal illness; or illness or death in the immediate family; family emergency or unforeseen/unavoidable instance requiring immediate attention.
- An absence required by state or local welfare authorities.

If the committee determines that there have been extenuating circumstances, it will decide how the credit may be regained. If the committee determines, however, that there are no extenuating circumstances, the student or parent may appeal the decision to the District's Board of Trustees by filing a written request with the Superintendent in accordance with FNG (Local).

Please note:

- A student absent from school for any reason, other than for a documented health care appointment, will not be allowed to participate in school-related activities on that day or evening.
- Class time is important. Doctor's appointments should be scheduled, if possible, at times when the student will not miss instructional time.

Official Attendance-Taking Time: The District is required to submit student attendance data to Texas Education Agency (TEA) reflecting attendance at a specific time each school day. Official attendance will be recorded daily. The following times have been designated to record the official attendance:

Elementary Schools - 9:50 a.m.
Middle Schools - 9:30 a.m.
High Schools - 10:15 a.m.

A student absent for any portion of the day, including at the official attendance-taking time, should follow the procedures below.

Parents Note after an Absence: When a student is absent from school for any portion of a school day – upon returning to school – must bring a medical note or written note signed by the parent that describes the reason for the absence. A note signed by the student, even with the parent's permission, will not be accepted unless the student is 18 years of age or older. Parents may choose ParentSquare as a means of submitting an excuse or sending an email to the attendance clerk. An unexcused absence will remain on record if the signed note or medical excuse from a health care professional is not provided within three school days. An exception to the three-day rule is if the parent or the student submits a medical excuse from a health care professional licensed to practice in the United States. Parents shall be responsible for keeping all documentation relating to reasons why students were absent. [See Board Policy FEB (Local)]

Doctor's Note after an Absence for Illness: Should the student develop a questionable pattern of absences the principal or attendance committee may require a statement from a doctor or health clinic verifying the illness or condition that caused the student's absence from school.

Tardies/Early Pick-ups/Class Period Cuts: State law requires students to attend school on a daily basis for the entire period the program of instruction is provided. Therefore, students must be in class when the bell rings at the beginning of each class period. Students are to be marked tardy if they report to class after the bell rings without a proper excuse.

Release of Students from School: The parent/guardian of a student who will need to leave school during the school day must follow the campus student sign-out procedures and present picture identification. A student will not be released from school at times other than regular dismissal hours except with permission from the principal or designee according to the campus student sign-out procedures. A student who becomes ill during the school day should, with the teacher's permission, report to the school nurse. The nurse will decide whether or not the student should

be sent home and will notify the student's parent/guardian. Once a student arrives on campus for the school day, he or she will not be permitted to leave the campus without administrative approval or by providing documentation of a medical appointment.

Parents/authorized adults are required to report to the office in person and identify themselves to pick up a child. Students will only be released to parent/guardian-approved individuals. Individuals scheduled to pick-up a child should be prepared to show picture identification.

When it is anticipated that the child's parent will not be able to pick up a child from school, the parent shall indicate the name of the person who will be picking up the child on the student information form. Authorized adults should be listed on the child's Skyward Emergency Contact List. It is recommended to contact the school registrar to update the emergency contact list for pickup anytime changes are made during the school year.

As we have no way of knowing who is calling, a child will not be released by a phone call. Exceptions to this will be at the discretion of the campus principal or his/her designee. The principal may deny the release until the matter is resolved. In all cases, the person should sign a Sign-Out log indicating that they have picked up the child noting the date, time, and reason for removal from school.

If the child will be picked up by an individual not listed on the Skyward Emergency Contact List, the parent should notify school officials in person or writing along with the date, pick-up time and relationship of the person to the family (e.g., uncle, cousin, neighbor, etc.). The person should be prepared to show a driver's license or other form of photo I.D. If questions arise, the parent/guardian may be contacted before the child is released. If the person will be picking up the child occasionally, the parent should add the name of the person to the Skyward Emergency Contact List.

Students in elementary schools whose parents/guardians request for their child to walk home after school must submit a written request to their child's campus. Any **change** to a student's after-school mode of departing from school must be submitted in writing prior to the release. Students will not be excused during school hours for private lessons of any nature.

Commercial limousines will not be allowed to pick up or drop off students at any District facility. **For the safety and well-being of our students, the use of third-party ridesharing services (e.g., HopSkipDrive, Lyft, Uber) for student drop-off or pick-up at school or any school/district related activity is prohibited on school/district property or at a school/district event/activity.** UISD cannot screen, monitor, or otherwise review or assess the safety of any ridesharing service or any ridesharing driver or vehicle. Families are required to arrange approved transportation methods for their children.

Attendance Verification - Driver License: To obtain a driver's license, a student between the ages of 16 and 18 must provide to the Texas Department of Public Safety a form obtained from the school verifying that the student is currently enrolled and has met the 90 percent attendance requirement for the semester preceding the date of application. The form shall be completed at the student's home campus.

Emergency School Closing Information: Parents are asked to complete an emergency release form to provide contact information in the event that school is dismissed early because of severe weather or another emergency, or if the campus must restrict access due to a security threat. When it becomes necessary (due to inclement weather or other emergencies) to temporarily close schools, announcements will be made over the ParentSquare system, local radio and television stations.

Withdrawal from School: A student under 19 may be withdrawn from school only by a parent/guardian. If possible, the school requests notice from the parent/guardian at least three days in advance so that records and documents may be prepared. On the student's last day, the withdrawal form must be signed by each teacher for current grade averages and book and equipment clearance; the librarian, to assure a clear library record; the counselor, for course clearance, if applicable; and finally, by a campus administrator. A copy of the signed withdrawal form will be given to the parent/guardian and a copy will be placed in the student's permanent record.

The parent is encouraged to go to the campus to initiate the withdrawal process. However, it is not necessary for the parents to make a personal appearance in order to officially withdraw their child. The parent may opt to notify school officials via a phone call or an email.

A student who is 19 years of age or older, married, or who has been declared by a court to be an emancipated minor, may withdraw without parental signature.

After School Programs: The United ISD After School Programs are for children in grades PK-8 at selected sites. Program sites operate from 3:30 pm – 6:00 pm at the elementary school level and 3:30 pm – 6:00 pm at the middle school level only on days when schools are in session according to the UISD Academic Calendar. The After School Programs provide a carefully designed schedule of activities. Our goal is to create programs that reflect our commitment to providing high standards for quality within a nurturing, friendly and safe environment.

Eligibility Requirements:

1) Parents must work full-time (After School Adventures Program) or meet eligibility criteria (Texas ACE-21st CCLC Afterschool Programs)
2) Children must be enrolled at a participating U.I.S.D. campus currently holding an afterschool program
3) Child must have independent toileting skills; and
4) Child must be able to participate in an after school program setting; varies at campus sites.

More information about our after school programs is available at www.uisd.net, After School Programs or call (956) 473-6301.

Awards and Honors

All UIL events carry an appropriate award. Awards are given in other areas such as academic achievement, athletics, and band.

Elementary "A" Honor Roll: To be eligible for this distinction on a six-week basis, a student must receive A's in all courses (i.e., English/Spanish Language Arts and Reading, Math, Science, Social Studies, and ESL/SSL). Language Arts and Reading grade will not include English as a Second Language (ESL) or Spanish as a Second Language (SSL). To be eligible for the end of the year award, a student must have all A's for every six-week grading period. Note: the cutoff date will be the 5th six-week grading period.

Dual Language Instructional Setting: The target reading-language arts grade will be recorded on the report card in order to monitor student progress in that second language but will not affect Honor Roll criteria.

Elementary "A & B" Honor Roll: To be eligible for this distinction on a six-week basis, a student must receive all A's and a maximum of one B on all courses (i.e., English/Spanish Language Arts and Reading, Math, Science, Social Studies, and ESL/SSL). Language Arts and Reading grade will not include English as a Second Language (ESL) or Spanish as a Second Language (SSL). To be eligible for the end of the year award, a student must have made the A or A&B Honor Roll for every six-week grading period. Note: the cutoff date will be the 5th six-week grading period.

Dual Language Instructional Setting: The target language arts and reading grade will be recorded on the report card in order to monitor student progress in that second language but will not affect Honor Roll criteria.

Middle School "A" Honor Roll: To be eligible for this distinction on a six-week basis, a student must receive A's in ALL courses. To be eligible for the end of the year award, a student must have all A's during the 1st through 5th six-week grading periods.

Middle School "A & B" Honor Roll: To be eligible for this distinction on a six-week basis, a student must receive all A's and a maximum of one B on all courses. To be eligible for the end of the year award, a student must receive all A's and a maximum of one B on all courses during the 1st through 5th six-week grading periods.

High School "A" Honor Roll: To be eligible for this distinction on a nine-week basis, a student must receive A's in ALL courses. To be eligible for the end of the year award, a student must have all A's during the first three nine-week grading periods.

High School "A & B" Honor Roll: To be eligible for this distinction on a nine-week basis, a student must receive all A's and a maximum of one B on all courses. To be eligible for the end of the year award, a student must receive all A's and a maximum of one B on all courses during the first three nine-week grading periods.

Perfect Attendance: The following perfect attendance guidelines are subject to change if necessary as determined by the Superintendent.
At United ISD, perfect attendance is based on the Texas Education Code section §25.085 that states "A child who is required to attend school, shall attend school each school day for the **entire period the program of instruction is provided**."

UISD defines "entire period the program of instruction is provided" from the time the morning bell rings until the release bell rings in the afternoon.

To be eligible for this distinction on a six-weeks basis for Elementary/Middle students or nine weeks basis for High School students, a student must have been present 100% of the days of the six/nine weeks in all classes.

To be eligible for the Perfect Attendance Recognition at end of the school year, a student must have been present 100% of the school days for the entire academic school year in all classes.

Graduating Seniors: Seniors who have perfect attendance from the first grade through twelfth grade will be recognized for achieving perfect attendance. To be eligible for this distinction, the student must have been enrolled at a United ISD school for the twelve academic school years and the student must have been present 100% of the school days for the entire academic school years in all classes. If the student transferred into UISD from another Texas public school district or TEA accredited charter school, the parent and student must provide official district/TEA accredited charter school proof of perfect attendance for the academic school years enrolled at the previous school district. Any special circumstance, as an appeal, will be reviewed by the Superintendent's Office for consideration and final approval.

Commended Attendance (98% Attendance): To be eligible for this distinction, for elementary schools, a student must have no more than three absences for the entire academic school year. For secondary schools, a student must have no more than three absences to include partial days (periods) for the entire academic school year.

All absences, unexcused, excused, medical and suspension will count towards determining eligibility.

NOTE: A student with A COMBINATION OF four tardies or early releases in any one class during a six weeks period will be disqualified from both perfect attendance and commended attendance purposes. A student arriving late to school or released early due to a medical appointment with a health care professional licensed to practice in the U.S. will not be affected if supporting documentation is submitted to the campus attendance office. Also, a student sent home by the school nurse will not be considered an early release.

A student who intentionally does not attend a class (i.e., skipping), will not be considered for commended attendance.

In the event that a child transferred into his/her current campus after the start of the school year, then confirmation or proof must be submitted to the current campus by the parents and the current campus will request the attendance records from the previous campus and verified by a school official. This information will be used to determine if the child is eligible for the award.

BRIDGE Academy

The United ISD BRIDGE Academy is a crucial new educational initiative designed to re-engage former students of the United Independent School District (UISD) who did not complete their high school education. Launched in August 2025, this program offers a vital second chance for individuals between the ages of 18 and 25 to return to school, earn their high school diploma, and prepare for the workforce. The program provides a flexible, supportive environment where students can complete required coursework, recover credits, and receive targeted academic assistance. By focusing on individualized learning plans, the Bridge Academy empowers students to overcome obstacles that previously prevented them from graduating, while equipping them with the skills and credentials needed to pursue college, career, or military readiness opportunities.

Cafeteria Services

The UISD Child Nutrition Department participates in the School Breakfast Program (SBP) and the National School Lunch Program (NSLP). These programs are federally assisted meal programs operating in public schools under the administration of the Texas Department of Agriculture (TDA). The following information is published as required by the USDA for participation in the National School Lunch Program: "In accordance with federal civil rights law and U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA) civil rights regulations and policies, this institution is prohibited from discriminating on the basis of race, color, national origin, sex (including gender identity and sexual orientation), disability, age, or reprisal or retaliation for prior civil rights activity. "Program information may be made available in languages other than English. Persons with disabilities who require alternative means of communication to obtain program information (e.g., Braille, large print, audiotape, American Sign Language),

should contact the responsible state or local agency that administers the program or USDA's TARGET Center at (202) 720-2600 (voice and TTY) or contact USDA through the Federal Relay Service at (800) 877-8339. "To file a program discrimination complaint, a Complainant should complete a Form AD-3027, USDA Program Discrimination Complaint Form which can be obtained online at: https://www.usda.gov/sites/default/files/documents/ad-3027.pdf, from any USDA office, by calling (866) 632-9992, or by writing a letter addressed to USDA. The letter must contain the complainant's name, address, telephone number, and a written description of the alleged discriminatory action in sufficient detail to inform the Assistant Secretary for Civil Rights (ASCR) about the nature and date of an alleged civil rights violation. The completed AD-3027 form or letter must be submitted to USDA by:

1. mail: U.S. Department of Agriculture
   Office of the Assistant Secretary for Civil Rights
   1400 Independence Avenue, SW
   Washington, D.C. 20250-9410; or
2. fax: (833) 256-1665 or (202) 690-7442; or
3. email: Program.Intake@usda.gov

This institution is an equal opportunity provider.

The responsible state agency that administers the program is the Texas Department of Agriculture (https://www.texasagriculture.gov/Home/Contact-Us), which can be reached at (800) TELL-TDA (835-5832) or (800) 735-2989 (TTY).
The local agency that administers the program is the district. See Nondiscrimination Statement on page 51 for the name and contact information for the Title IX coordinator, ADA/Section 504 coordinator, and superintendent for other concerns about discrimination.

Breakfast Program: The breakfast program must be made available for all schools that have at least 10 percent or more students eligible. The meal pattern requirement must comply with the Dietary Guidelines for Americans and the regulations from the Healthy, Hunger-Free Kids Act of 2010 which is based on recommendations from the Institute of Medicine.

Offer vs. Serve Breakfast: Offer versus serve is a serving method designed to reduce food waste and food costs in the National School Breakfast Program without jeopardizing the nutritional integrity of the breakfast served. At all grade levels, a student may choose all three food items offered (main breakfast item, fruit juice/fresh fruit and milk). At a minimum, students must choose the main breakfast item and a choice of either a fruit juice/fresh fruit or milk.

Students are encouraged to choose all menu items they will consume before leaving the serving line. If a student chooses less than the required menu items each item will be charged A la Carte. Once the student has left the serving line he/she may choose to go back for additional menu items which will be charged A la Carte. A la Carte pricing does not apply in schools that participate in the "Breakfast in the Classroom Program" where all students eat free. They still, however, need to take the required amount of menu items in order to be allowed any breakfast items and be claimed for reimbursement.

Lunch Program: By taking part in the lunch program the District receives reimbursement and donated commodities for each lunch served. However, in order to receive this, the District must meet meal pattern requirements and the meals must be offered free to all children. The meal pattern requirements must comply with the Dietary Guidelines for Americans and the regulations from the Healthy, Hunger-Free Kids Act of 2010 which are based on recommendations from the Institute of Medicine.

Offer vs. Serve Lunch: Offer versus serve is a serving method designed to reduce food waste and food costs in the National School Lunch Program without jeopardizing the nutritional integrity of the lunches served. Five food components are offered in a school lunch including Grains, Meat/Meat Alternates, Fruit, Vegetables and Milk. Students may select all five food components, but at a minimum must choose three for a meal to be considered reimbursable. In addition, one of these components is required to be either a Fruit or a Vegetable to also qualify the meal as reimbursable. A meal pattern is also followed in which a student may select up to 1 entrée, 3 different side dishes and a serving of milk. A la Carte prices will apply to any extra menu food items taken aside from an allowed meal at the point of service.

Students are encouraged to choose all menu items they will consume before being claimed. If a student chooses less than the three required menu items each item will be charged A la Carte. Once the student has left the serving line they may return to the serving line to choose additional menu items which will be charged A la Carte.

Community Eligibility Provision: Any school district that administers the National School Lunch Program or School Breakfast Program is eligible to participate in the Community Eligibility Program if forty (40) percent of the students of the district are categorically eligible. Under this program, the school district must offer both breakfast and lunch at no charge for the first meal.

A la Carte Sales: Since the Child Nutrition Program started with the Community Eligibility Provision this year the first breakfast and lunch meals are free of charge for all students, but any additional serving of the main entrée or side dish will be charged as A la Carte items.

Menu Analysis and Development: The UISD Child Nutrition Department uses a Food Based Menu Planning System to plan school breakfast and lunch menus. It requires certain food components (Grains, Meat/Meat Alternates, Fruit, Vegetables, and Milk) to be served in specific quantities on a daily and weekly basis for various grade groups. In addition to food components, menus must meet standards for calories, saturated fat and trans-fat which are calculated using a nutrition analysis software. As of the 2014-2015 School Year, menus will also be meeting a sodium restriction.

Schedule (Breakfast and Lunch): Breakfast and lunch schedules may vary from school to school and grade to grade. Please contact your child's school for specific breakfast and lunch schedules.

Special/Modified Menus: In order to provide children with disabilities the same opportunity as other children, the UISD Child Nutrition Department will modify school menus. The United States Department of Agriculture (USDA) has a nondiscrimination regulation which mandates that substitutions be made to the regular meal for children who are unable to eat school meals because of their disabilities when that need is certified by a licensed physician.

Parents can get an official "UISD Special Diet Prescription Form for Meals" at school from the Cafeteria Manager or the school nurse at any school. The form is also available through www.uisd.net under the Department Tab and Child Nutrition link. ONLY an official UISD form will

be accepted. A U.S. physician providing specific prescription of dietary needs of the student must fill out the form. The form must be filled out entirely including the statement of disability and a description of how the disability affects major life activities. Special diets prescribed by physician assistants or nurse practitioners will no longer be accepted. If the child is serviced through the Special Education Program, an ARD Committee must address the special modified menu.

USDA Smart Snacks in School: The Texas Public School Nutrition Policy will no longer be in effect after July 1, 2014. In its place, school districts across the country will be under new legislation known as USDA's *Smart Snacks in School.* The standards are part of the Healthy, Hunger-Free Kids Act of 2010 which recently imposed new regulations for the National School Breakfast and Lunch Program. *Smart Snacks in School* will set nutrition requirements for all foods sold outside the child nutrition program, on the school campus, and at any time during the school day. To view the new standards in a flyer format, please visit: http://www.fns.usda.gov/cnd/governance/legislation/allfoods_flyer.pdf. School clubs or organizations must assess any food to be used for fundraising using the Alliance for Healthier Generation Smart Snacks Product Calculator (link can be found on UISD Child Nutrition website). A report must then be submitted to the campus bookkeeper for review.

Outside Food: Students are allowed to bring their own lunch from home. To ensure the safety and well-being of all students, food drop-off (including, but not limited to, fast food, restaurant takeout, or items bought through food delivery apps such as DoorDash, Uber Eats, etc.) is not permitted at any campus. If an extenuating and infrequent circumstance arises, such as a student forgetting their lunchbox, campus staff will work with parents/guardians/emergency contacts to address the situation appropriately. If a child forgets his/her lunch, our cafeteria will have a meal available.

Note: Student birthday or other celebrations: Foods may be given to students at these types of celebrations at the discretion of the school principal. Parents/Guardians must provide at least 24-hour notice to the teacher by sending a note with the student or emailing the teacher to request bringing food for the birthday celebration. Non-food items are highly encouraged; please see the following list for ideas: Stickers, Pencils, Mini Notepads, Colorful Erasers, Bookmarks, Bubbles, Bouncy Balls, and Party Favors. This is to protect our students and staff who have severe food allergies. All food items MUST be store bought. The school will decide when and how birthday treats will be distributed.

Armed Services Vocational Aptitude Battery Test: A student in grades 10-12 will be offered an opportunity to take the Armed Services Vocational Aptitude Battery test and consult with a military recruiter. The test shall be offered at each of the four high schools. Please contact the principal or counselor for information about this opportunity.

Career and Technical Education: The District offers Career and Technical Education programs, based on campus availability, in the following Career Clusters: Agriculture, Food and Natural Resources; Architecture & Construction; Arts, A/V Technology & Communications; Business, Marketing, and Finance; Education and Training; Energy; Health Science; Hospitality and Tourism; Human Services; Information Technology; Law and Public Service; Manufacturing; Science, Technology, Engineering & Mathematics; and Transportation, Distribution & Logistics. Additionally, the District offers Work-Based Learning programs in Health Science, Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics, Hospitality and Tourism, Education and Training and Business, Marketing, and Finance Admission to these programs is based on student interest. Board Policy prohibits discrimination on the basis of race, color, national origin, sex, or handicap in its vocational programs, services, and activities, and provides equal access to the Boy Scouts and other designated youth groups, as required by Title VI of the Civil Rights Act of 1964, as amended; Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972; and Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973 as amended.

Board Policy also prohibits discrimination on the basis of race, color, national origin, sex, or handicap in its employment practices as required by Title VI of the Civil Rights Act of 1964, as amended; Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972; the Age Discrimination Act of 1975, as amended; and Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973, as amended. The District will take steps to ensure that a lack of English language skills will not be a barrier to admission or participation in any educational and career and technical programs. See Nondiscrimination Statement on page 51 for the name and contact information for the Title IX Coordinators and ADA/Section 504 coordinator, who will address certain allegations of discrimination.

Shop Safety Requirements: While in Career & Technology Workshops, for their own safety, students shall wear appropriate clothing and personal protective equipment. Appropriate clothing shall include long sleeve shirts and full-length pants or coveralls and closed toe shoes. Personal protective equipment provided by the District may include safety goggles, face shields, helmets, hearing protection, gloves and other equipment as directed by the classroom teacher.

Career and Technical Student Organizations (CTSO's): Membership in UISD CTSO's is based on student interest and program availability at the respective campuses. Students who have taken a CTE elective or who are currently taking a CTE elective are eligible to participate. All CTSO members are eligible to compete provided that they meet "No Pass, No Play" requirements. CTSO's are offered in the following program areas: HOSA, Skills USA, TAFE, BPA, and FFA.

Students who are enrolled in a coherent sequence of Career and Technical Education courses may be provided with opportunities for certification in various program areas. For further information about these certification programs, please contact the high school Career and Technical Education department chair or the District Executive Director of College, Military Readiness, and Enrichment, Dr. Angelica Sanchez, at (956) 473-2018.

Class Rank/Top Ten Percent/Highest Ranking Student: Students who are ranked in the top ten percent of their graduating class are eligible for automatic admission into four-year public universities and colleges in Texas (except The University of Texas at Austin). Students are required to demonstrate that they earned the distinguished level of achievement under the Foundation High School Program (graduate with at least one endorsement and must have taken Algebra II as one of the four required math courses) or satisfied the ACT's College Readiness Benchmarks on the ACT assessment, or earned on the SAT assessment a score of at least 1,500 out of 2,400 or the equivalent.

In addition, the student must submit a completed application for admission in accordance with the deadline established by the college or university. The University of Texas at Austin (UT) is no longer required to automatically admit applicants in excess of 75% of its enrollment capacity for first-time resident undergraduate students. Should the number of applicants who qualify for automatic admission exceed 75% of enrollment capacity, UT shall provide notice of the percentage of qualified applicants that are anticipated to be offered admission. For students who are eligible to enroll in the University during the summer or fall of their graduation year, the University will be admitting the top five percent of the high school's graduating class who meet the above requirements. Additional applicants will be considered by the University through a

holistic review process. Students and parents should contact the counselor for further information about how to apply, the deadline for application, and more detailed information. The student is ultimately responsible for ensuring that he or she meets the admission requirements of the university or college to which the student submits an application.

Class ranking shall be determined by averaging all course grades taken for high school credit, regardless of when the credit was earned, through the third quarter of the senior year. For the purpose of determining honors to be conferred during graduation activities, the District shall calculate class rank at the end of the third nine-week grading period of the senior year. The grade for the third nine-week grading period shall be used as the semester grade for this purpose. The student's weighted average (WA) shall be computed in accordance with Board Policy EIC (Local). Grade changes will not be calculated into a senior student's WA for class ranking purposes after class rankings for the third nine-week grading period have been finalized.

All students whose weighted averages comprise the top ten percent of the graduating class and who qualify for automatic admission under Texas Education Code §51.803 shall be recognized. For the purpose of applications to institutions of higher education, the District shall also calculate class ranking as required by state law. The District's eligibility criteria for local graduation honors shall apply only for local recognition and shall not restrict class ranking for the purpose of automatic admission under state law. [See Board Policy EIC (Legal).]

The valedictorian and salutatorian shall be the eligible students who have the highest and second highest ranking respectively. To be eligible for such recognition a student must: 1.) have been continuously enrolled in the same District high school for the six semesters immediately preceding graduation; 2.) have earned the distinguished level of achievement by successfully completing the curriculum requirements for the Foundation High School Program and the curriculum requirements for at least one endorsement required by the Texas Education Code, including four credits in science and four credits in mathematics to include Algebra II; and 3.) be graduating after four complete years of enrollment in high school.

The student meeting the local eligibility criteria for recognition as the valedictorian shall also be considered the highest-ranking graduate for the purpose of receiving the scholarship certificate from the State of Texas. In case of a tie, the District shall compute the weighted average to a sufficient number of decimal places until the tie is broken. [See Board Policy EIC (Local).]

To be eligible to graduate early, a student must complete all coursework and exit-level testing required of the ninth-grade class in which he or she begins high school. Students must complete the Declaration of Intent to Graduate Early Form before the last Friday in September with his or her counselor. Approval for early graduation must be granted by the campus principal and a copy of the form must be submitted to the Executive Director for Secondary Education. A student who completes the high school program requirements in fewer than four years shall be ranked in the class with which he or she actually graduates.

All high school TEA-approved state credit grades transferred as numerical averages shall be accepted at face value. Grades transferred as passing or failing shall be accepted for credit, or none, as indicated on the transcript, but shall not be calculated into class ranking, unless there is some accompanying explanatory information on the transcript. [See Board Policies EIA (Local) & (Legal).] Grades shall be computed using a combination of grades from the former school and grades earned for the time the student has been enrolled in the new school. Students who transfer a half credit earned for a full (one) credit course will need to retake the course at UISD to meet graduation requirements.

A student who transfers into a District high school shall receive similar credits counted toward the weighted average according to the list of courses offered in the District as long as the Texas Essential Knowledge and Skills (TEKS) have been met. Grades that earned weight at another district shall be given the weight as outlined in the UISD High School Course Catalog and in Board Policy EIC (Local).

Students transferring into the District shall receive the numerical grade that was earned in the courses at another school. Letter grades for eligible courses shall be recorded as follows:

Conversion Scale	
A+	98
A	95
A-	92

Conversion Scale	
B+	88
B	85
B-	82

Conversion Scale	
C+	78
C	75
C-	72

Conversion Scale	
D+	68
D	65
D-	62
F	50

For further information, see Board Policy EIC (Local).

Class Schedules: See campus counselor.

Off Campus Requirement: High school seniors must meet off campus required criteria to be enrolled in a minimum of three courses per semester. Students must be in attendance for a minimum of three classes in order to remain eligible to participate in a UIL activity. Please see the Principal or Counselor for an Off-Campus Form.

College Coursework & Dual Credit Programs: United Independent School District (UISD) provides several pathways for students to earn college credit while completing high school graduation requirements. Students may earn college/dual credit through the **House Bill 1 (ESP1) Program, GOLD Program, Early Start Pathway (ESP),** or **Early College Programs.** Note: Students must meet specific academic and enrollment criteria for all programs, including demonstrating college readiness via the Texas Success Initiative Assessment (TSIA2) or meeting state exemption standards.

Texas Legislative Guarantees: Affordability, Equity, & Transferability: UISD's dual credit policies operate in strict accordance with current Texas laws designed to support student success, ensure credit transfer, and protect parental rights:

- **Free & Capped Tuition (HB 8 - FAST Program):** Dual credit courses (including tuition, books, and fees) are completely **free** for educationally disadvantaged students who qualify for the FAST program. For all other students, Texas law mandates a strict cap on dual credit tuition.
- **Guaranteed Credit Transfer & "Texas Direct" (SB 1887):** To prevent students from taking non-transferable courses, state law requires early college and dual credit programs to align with specific "Field of Study" curricula. Students who complete the core curriculum and an approved field of study are guaranteed seamless transfer of those credits to Texas public universities and may be awarded a **"Texas Direct"** associate degree.

- **Curriculum Transparency (HB 1605):** State law guarantees parents the right to review district instructional materials via an online parent portal. *However*, dual credit courses are exempt from district-level review because they are governed by the partnering higher education institution (see Instructional Acknowledgment below).
- **Parental Rights & Syllabus Access (SB 12):** Parents are legally guaranteed access to review all dual credit course syllabi before the semester begins. Furthermore, annual written parental consent is strictly required for students to receive school-based college or mental health counseling, or to participate in university-aligned student clubs.

Enrollment, Course Equivalency, & High School Credit: Students may be granted high school credit for college courses taken to fulfill graduation requirements under the following provisions:

1. **Required Documentation & Annual Consent (SB 12):** The student must complete a **UISD Dual Credit Agreement**. In compliance with state law, this agreement must be signed by the student and parent/guardian prior to registering for a course.
    - **Instructional Acknowledgment:** Parents/guardians must understand and acknowledge that dual enrollment courses use *college-level curriculum and materials* provided by the partnering college, which may include topics designed for a college audience. These courses may address complex or controversial topics intended to foster critical thinking and academic inquiry, and are distinct from high school materials governed by HB 1605.
2. **Course Equivalency & TCCNS:** The dual credit college course must be equivalent to a minimum of **three college hours**. UISD aligns coursework with the **Texas Common Course Numbering System (TCCNS)** to comply with SB 1887 transferability requirements. Students should verify the TCCNS designation of their chosen course to ensure it satisfies high school requirements and transfers easily.
3. **Passing Grade:** The college grade earned must be a minimum of **"70"** in order to obtain high school credit.
4. **Off-Campus & Independent Study:** Students who obtain UISD approval to take eligible dual credit courses on their own must:
    - Complete a **UISD Off-Campus Dual Credit Contract**.
    - Submit an **official college transcript** with a numerical grade to their counselor immediately once the course is completed.

Transcripts & Weighted Average (WA): All approved dual credit courses will be recorded on the student's permanent records.

Impact Area	Policy Detail
High School Weighted Average	The course grade will be computed into the student's Weighted Average (WA) using the exact weighted scale found in **Board Policy EIC (Local)** for their specific cohort. **Beginning with 9th graders who entered in the 2018-2019 school year and thereafter, these dual credit courses if taken off campus will not receive additional weight**.
College Transcript (SB 1887)	The student's grade will be computed into their official college/university GPA. Completed core and field-of-study courses are legally protected for transfer to Texas public universities.

Next Steps for Students: Please visit with your respective campus counselor to access your parental consent forms, view a list of approved TCCNS transfer-guaranteed courses, check your TSIA2 status, and verify your FAST program eligibility.

Complaints and Concerns - Student and Parent: Usually student or parent complaints or concerns can be addressed by a phone call or a conference with the teacher. For those complaints and concerns that cannot be so easily handled, the District has adopted a standard complaint policy under Board Policy FNG (Local). You or your child should first discuss the complaint with the campus principal. If the concern is not resolved, a written complaint and a request for a conference should be sent to the Superintendent or designee.

Some complaints require different procedures. Additional information can also be found in the UISD Board policies available on the District's website at **http://www.uisd.net.**

Topics and Board Policies include:

- Discrimination on the basis of gender (FFH)
- Sexual abuse or sexual harassment of a student (FFH)
- Loss of credit on the basis of attendance (FEC)
- Removal of a student by a teacher for disciplinary reasons (FOA)
- Removal of a student to a disciplinary alternative education program (FOC)
- Expulsion of a student (FOD)
- Identification, evaluation, or educational placement of a student with a disability (EHBA & FB)
- Instructional materials (EFA)
- On-campus distribution of non-school materials to students (FMA)
- Complaints against District peace officers (CKE).

Computer Resources: To prepare students for a technology-driven society, the District has made a substantial investment in instructional technology that includes: Interactive Flat Panel (IFP), 1:1 mobile learning devices (MLD), assistive technology equipment, and web-based instructional resources. Use of these technology resources can be used at school, at any District-sponsored events within or outside the District or at home for the intended approved instructional purposes. Students and parents will be asked to review and sign a **Technology Use Guide** (TUG), the **MLD 1:1 Parent/Guardians and Students: Guidelines and Procedures Manual** and the UISD STUDENT/PARENT TECHNOLOGY DEVICE CHECK OUT ACKNOWLEDGEMENT/AGREEMENT FORM found on campus and District websites. A signed agreement is required prior to the checkout of any District student devices. Any violations of these agreements may result in withdrawal of privileges and other disciplinary action.

Students are responsible for securing their assigned Chromebook and charger at all times at home and on campus. They are to keep them in their person via backpack or sleeve.

Electronic transmissions and other use of the UISD Communication Network/System by students shall not be considered confidential and may be monitored at any time by designated District Staff to ensure the use of the system for appropriate instructional purposes only. Refer to the Student Code of Conduct for additional information on District technology, network, internet, and electronic mail procedures and guidelines.

Correspondence Courses: Credit toward state graduation requirements may be granted for correspondence courses only under the following conditions:

- The institution offering the course is The University of Texas at Austin, Texas Tech University, or another public institution of higher education approved by the Commissioner of Education.
- The correspondence course must include the state-required essential knowledge and skills for such a course.
- Prior to enrollment in correspondence courses, students shall make written request to the principal or designee for approval to enroll in the course. If approval is not granted prior to enrollment, the student shall not be awarded credit toward graduation.
- A student may earn a maximum of two required state credits through correspondence courses and may be enrolled in only one correspondence course at a time.
- Grades earned in correspondence courses shall be recorded on the student's academic achievement record and shall be used in the calculation of the student's grade point average.
- All high school students shall be eligible to take correspondence courses and earn credit toward graduation.
  Please refer to Board Policies EHDE (Local) & (Legal).

Counseling and Guidance:

The UISD Guidance and Counseling Mission Statement: The Guidance and Counseling Department intentionally plans, organizes, and implements a comprehensive school counseling program aligned to the Texas Model that assists all students in their personal, social, academic and career development. Professional School Counselors (PSC's) collaborate with stakeholders to meet the individual needs of each student by implementing supports aiding in student growth which further cultivates their development into global citizens.

The UISD Guidance and Counseling Program is based on the Texas Education Agency's The *Texas Model for Comprehensive School Counseling Programs, Fifth Edition (Texas Model).* The District has a comprehensive school counseling program that includes

- A guidance curriculum to help students develop their full educational potential, including the student's interests and career objectives;
- A responsive services component to intervene on behalf of any student whose immediate personal concerns or problems put the student's continued educational, career, personal, or social developments at risk;
- An individual planning system to guide a student as the student plans, monitors and manages the student's own educational, career, personal and social development of students; and
- Systems to support the efforts of teachers, staff, parents, and other members of the community in promoting the educational, career, personal and social development of students.

The District will make a preview of the program, including all materials and curriculum, available to parents to review during school hours.

Academic Counseling: Students and their parents are encouraged to talk with a school counselor, teacher, or principal to learn about course offerings, graduation requirements and plans. Each spring, students in grades 5 through 11 will be provided information on anticipated course offerings for the following year, as well as other information that will help them make the most of academic and Career and Technical Education (CTE) opportunities.

To plan for your post-secondary education at a college, university, or training school or pursuing some other type of advanced education, you should work closely with the counselor to ensure that the appropriate high school courses are taken. The counselor may also provide information about college entrance examinations and deadlines for applications, as well as information about automatic admission to state colleges and universities, financial aid, housing, scholarships, etc.

The school counselor will provide information to students and parents about college and university admissions and the importance of planning for postsecondary education, including appropriate coursework and financial aid availability and requirements. In either 7th or 8th grade, each student will receive instruction related to how the student can best prepare for high school, college, and a career.

High School Grade Levels: High school student and their parents are encouraged to talk with a school counselor, teacher, or principal to learn more about course offerings, graduation requirements and early graduation procedures.

Each year, high school students will be provided information on anticipated course offerings for the next school year, how to make the most of academic and career and technical education (CTE) opportunities and the importance of postsecondary education. The school counselor will also provide information each year a student in high school regarding:

- The importance of postsecondary education;
- The advantages of earning an endorsement and completing the foundation program with the distinguished level of achievement;
- The disadvantages of pursuing a high school equivalency exam (GED) as opposed to earning a high school diploma;
- Financial aid eligibility and how to apply for financial aid;
- The Financial Aid for Swift Transfer ("FAST") program at participating institutions of higher education, which allows students who are or have been educationally disadvantaged at any time during the four years preceding the student's enrollment in a dual credit course to enroll at no cost to the student (please note that the District will determine eligibility upon the student's enrollment in the dual credit course);
- Automatic admission to state-funded Texas colleges and universities;
- Eligibility requirements for the TEXAS Grant;
- Availability of District programs that allow students to earn college credit;
- Availability of tuition and fee assistance for postsecondary education for students in foster care; and
- Availability of college credit awarded by institutions of higher education to veterans and military service members for military experience, education and training.

Additionally, the school counselor can provide information about workforce opportunities after graduation or technical and trade school opportunities, including opportunities to earn industry-recognized certificates and licenses.

Repeating a High-School Credit Course: A parent may request in writing that a student repeat a high-school credit course in which the student was enrolled during the previous school year unless the District determines that the student has met all requirements for graduation. Before granting the request, the District may convene a retention committee to meet and discuss the request and will invite the parent to participate.

Personal Counseling: The school counselor is available to assist students with a wide range of personal concerns, including social, family, emotional, and substance abuse issues. The counselor may also provide information about community resources to address these concerns.

UISD students who seek or who are referred for counseling will receive counseling services from a school counselor unless the school counselor receives instructions designating that a student should not meet with him or her. These instructions should be in writing and received prior to the date that a referral is made; however, the request can be made at any time. Specific instructions regarding a parent or legal guardian's desire regarding specific aspects of the counseling sessions, such as notice timelines and scope session topics, may not always be able to occur. A parent or guardian making such a request will be notified if a counselor is unable to accommodate a request.

Persons who have the right to refer a student to a counselor include: parent or legal guardian, teacher, counselor, administrator, or self. Students may be taken out of class for counseling sessions, but all attempts to keep loss of class time to a minimum will be made.

Suicide Awareness and Mental Health Support: When individual students are in crisis (e.g., at risk for suicide and/or suicide ideation), trained staff must follow District procedures. Any talk of suicide shall be taken seriously and the proper attention will be provided immediately. If a student verbalizes, writes or discusses any thoughts of suicide or harming himself/herself, he or she will be immediately accompanied to the counselor, administrator or other trained staff member. As noted in this procedure, the Guidance and Counseling Department provides information on identification of the student(s) in crisis who may be in need of mental health intervention or who may be at risk of committing suicide. If you are concerned about your child, please contact your school counselor. For further information, please refer to Board Policy FFB (Legal) and the District's Suicide Prevention Procedural Manual which can be found at every campus's administrative office. In assessing whether a student may be in need of early mental health intervention or is at risk of committing suicide, the following is to be considered:

- Whether the student is, or may be, the victim or participant of bullying
- Declining academic performance
- Depression
- Anxiety
- Anger or increased irritability
- Isolation
- Sudden changes in appearance
- Unexplained changes in sleep or eating habits
- History of mental health illness and or psychiatric hospitalization(s).

The principal shall ensure that all staff is aware of the referral process to use when any student is potentially in crisis.

For further information and assistance, you may contact:

- Director of Guidance and Counseling at (956) 473-5248;
- UISD Licensed Specialist in School Psychology (LSSP) staff at (956) 473-2047;
- Director of Health Services at (956) 473-6264;
- Department of State Health Services, PHR 11 at (956) 725-5195; and/or
- Border Region Behavioral Health Center at (956) 794-3000.

Policies and Procedures that Promote Student Physical and Mental Health: The District has adopted Board Policies that promote student physical and mental health. Board Policies on the topics below can be found in the District's Board Policy manual, available at https://pol.tasb.org/home/index/1210: Food and nutrition management: CO, COA, COB; Wellness and Health Services: FFA; Physical Examinations: FFAA; Immunizations: FFAB; Medical Treatment: FFAC; Communicable Diseases: FFAD; School-Based Health Centers: FFAE, Care Plans: FFAF, Crisis Intervention: FFB, Trauma-informed Care: FFBA, Student Support Services: FFC;, Student Safety: FFF; Child Abuse and Neglect: FFG; Freedom from Discrimination, Harassment and Retaliation: FFH; and Freedom from Bullying: FFI.

Safe and Supportive School Program: The Safe and Supportive Program Team conducts behavioral threat assessments by assessing and reporting students who make threats of violence or exhibit harmful, threatening, or violent behavior as defined by TEC §37.115. In addition, the school may gather information to determine the level of risk and assign appropriate intervention(s). The team serves as a community and school safeguard by: 1. Conducting a fact based, systematic, and investigative approach to determining how likely a person is to carry out a threat of violence; 2. Identifying, assessing, and managing appropriate interventions of individuals who are at risk for violence against themselves and others; 3. Providing guidance to students and school employees on recognizing harmful, threatening, or violent behavior that may pose a threat to the community, school, or individual. When conducting this process with fidelity it leads to a positive and safe school climate. This process is not intended to be punitive or adversarial; rather, it is a way to build trust and situational awareness. For more information visit https://txssc.txstate.edu/tools/tam-toolkit/ or www.uisd.net/keepuisdsafe

On-Demand Drug Testing: UISD has developed an "On-Demand" drug testing program where parents may pick up a **free** drug kit at their child's middle school, high school and United S.T.E.P. Academy. Parents can administer this simple drug kit to their child in the privacy of their home. Upon arrival at the school, parents will be provided with:

- a Parental Release and Permission Form;
- a brochure of information;
- an instruction sheet for the drug kit; and
- an On-Demand Substance Abuse Providers list.

Two free drug kits per student per month may be provided. UISD is offering this voluntary student drug testing program as an added service to UISD parents. All information is **CONFIDENTIAL** and test results **ARE NOT** reported to the school.

Substance Abuse Prevention and Intervention: If you are worried that your child may be in danger of experimenting, using, or abusing illegal drugs or other prohibited substances, please contact the school counselor. The school counselor can provide you with a list of community resources that may be of assistance to you. The Texas Department of State Health Services (TDSHS) maintains information regarding children's mental health and substance abuse intervention services on its website: http://www.dshs.state.tx.us. Licensed Chemical Dependency Counselors are available for prevention, intervention, consultation and referral services. If you wish to meet with these counselors, you may contact your campus guidance and counseling department. For additional information, you may contact: Guidance & Counseling Department, 4410 State Highway 359, Laredo, Texas 78043 Office: (956) 473-5248 Fax: (956) 473-2098.

Course Auditing: Students will **not** be allowed to audit any courses.

Course Credit Recovery and Advancement to Remain on Cohort: Course taken as Credit Recovery are courses where credit was not obtained. Courses under the advancement criteria are courses/credits needed to graduate with cohort. *In addition, students must have completed two years in high school.* The District provides its high school General and Special Education students with access to an online curriculum program to facilitate the **recovery of credit** for a course(s) or to advance a course(s) to remain on the path toward graduation with their cohort.

A student enrolled in an online curriculum course/class is required to follow regular school attendance criteria. The student is expected to complete all coursework within the 18- and/or 9-week grading period or timeframe, depending on the course, from the date of enrollment. Campus administration and/or the ARD Committee may request an extension. This provision will be used for those students experiencing extenuating circumstances and will be determined on a case-by-case basis.

Due to semester accelerated block scheduling, UISD does not award ½ credits for full credit high school courses. A student may be allowed to complete a course by taking an A or B part only when transferring from a district and/or private or charter school on a traditional schedule and the ½ credit has been awarded by the transferring entity.

Eligibility criteria for participating in the Online Credit Recovery or Advancement Program: A high school student who is at risk of dropping out of school, which includes each student who is under 26 years of age and who meets the following criteria (taken from Board Policy EHBC (Legal) and §29.081 of the Texas Education Code):

- Was not advanced from one grade level to the next for one or more school years
- Did not perform satisfactorily on a state assessment instrument administered to student under Subchapter B, Chapter 39 of the Texas Education Code, and who has not in previous or current school year subsequently performed on that instrument or another appropriate instrument at a level equal to at least 110 percent of the satisfactory level performed on that instrument
- Is pregnant or is a parent
- Has been placed in an alternative education program under Texas Education Code §37.006 during the preceding or current school year
- Has been expelled during the preceding or current school year
- Is currently on parole, probation, deferred prosecution, or other conditional release
- Was previously reported through the Public Education Information Management System (PEIMS) to have dropped out of school
- Is a student of limited English proficiency, as defined by §29.052 of the Texas Education Code
- Is in the custody or care of the Department of Protective and Regulatory Services or has, during the current school year, been referred to the department by a school official, officer of the juvenile court, or law enforcement official
- Is homeless, as defined by 42 U.S.C. 11302 and its subsequent amendments
- Resided in the preceding school year or resides in the current school year in a placement facility in the District, including a detention facility, substance abuse treatment facility, emergency shelter, psychiatric hospital, halfway house, or foster group home

Participating students must be placed in one of the following programs: COURSE ADVANCEMENT or CREDIT RECOVERY

1. **Advancement to Remain on Cohort**
   - May enroll for a maximum of 2 credits during his/her 3rd or 4th year of high school. Course options include but not limited to:
     - Environmental Systems
     - Health
     - Lifetime Fitness & Wellness Pursuits
     - Money Matters
     - Personal Financial Literacy
     - Psychology
     - Sociology
     - Speech
     - Spanish I & II (recommendation based on *Home Language Survey*).
   - Students in a regular campus setting will be allowed to take only one (1) course at a time.
   - Students placed at a DAEP or Residential Facility will be allowed to take up to two courses simultaneously, depending on the number of days for placement and the amount of daily time a student has access to the program.
   - Students must have taken an EOC class twice before being afforded an opportunity to participate in the Online Recovery/Advancement Credit Program. The student's schedule must reflect a STAAR Remediation Course(s).
   - Students who have failed a course online must return to the classroom setting (face-to-face).
   - Student participation in Zero Hour (7:30-8:45am and/or 4:30-6:00pm) will be granted upon request and approval of the Executive Director for High School Education and Campus Principal.

OR

2. **Course Credit Recovery:** High school students must have failed a course before a request is submitted on their behalf by their respective counselor. They will be allowed to enroll in computer-assisted courses (Credit Recovery Program) if the student is at-risk of not graduating

with his/her cohort and is in his/her 3rd or 4th year of high school for the following causal factors (but not limited to the reasons listed below):

- The student completed a core or elective class but was not awarded credit due to attendance.
- Student received a grade greater than or equal to 60 but less than a 70 in a non-EOC course including Math or Science classes.
- A student who has failed an EOC course but passed the EOC Exam with an "Approaches Grade Level" or better will be afforded an opportunity to recover the credit through the online program.
- The online curriculum program is designed to assist students in graduating with their cohort when possible, not to provide opportunities to accelerate or advance in course completion for early graduation or to replace direct instruction if a student is failing a course at mid-term.

Course Retake: For courses taken for high school credit, a parent or guardian may elect for a student to repeat any course in which the student was enrolled in the previous school year. A parent or guardian may not elect for a student to repeat a course if the District determines the student has met all of the requirements for graduation. If a student retakes a course for which the student has earned credit for graduation, the course will be taken as a pass or fail course, and the grade will not be included in the weighted average calculation.

Credit by Examination: The dates on which exams are scheduled during the school year will be published in appropriate District publications and on the District's website.

…If You Have Taken the Course: Students in grades 6-12 may use credit by examination with prior instruction to demonstrate mastery, to earn, or to regain credit in selected academic courses. Prior approval by the appropriate administrator is required. Students who are eligible for this exam include the following:

1. Students who are transferring from a non-accredited school or have been homeschooled (see Board Policy FD);
2. Students who are transferring from Mexico and did not receive a grade of 70 or better on their core subject areas;
3. Students who have failed a subject or course; or
4. Students who have earned a passing grade in a subject or course but has failed to earn credit because of excessive absences. (See Board Policy FEC.)

Such examinations shall assess the student's mastery of the Texas Essential Knowledge and Skills and shall be administered according to established District procedures. To be eligible to earn credit by examination, the counselor shall verify that the student has had prior instruction in the course and obtain written approval from the parent/guardian, counselor and principal. If the student is requesting a credit by exam (CBE) for a high school course in which there is an End-of Course STAAR Exam then the CBE must be ordered from Texas Tech University. The counselor will order the credit by exam from the counseling department. To receive credit, a student must score at least 70 or above on the examination. Passing scores earned on credit by examination shall be recorded in the student's academic achievement record as a "P" for passing. The actual grade received will not be calculated into the student's Grade Point Average (GPA). The attendance review committee may also allow a student with excessive absences to receive credit for a course by passing an examination. A student may not use this examination to regain eligibility to participate in extracurricular activities. If the student elects to take a credit by examination in lieu of exercising the District's credit recovery options, the cost of taking the examination with prior instruction to earn credit or to regain credit shall be the student's or the parent's responsibility. These guidelines are subject to change to adhere to legislative decisions in observance of End of Course (EOC) assessments. Refer to Board Policy EHDB.

…If You Have Not Taken the Course: The passing score required to earn credit on an examination for acceleration is 80. A student will be permitted to take an examination to advance to a higher grade level (at the elementary level) or to earn credit for an academic course (at the secondary level) for which the student has no prior instruction. Each examination shall thoroughly test the Texas Essential Knowledge and Skills in the applicable course or grade level. The dates on which examinations are scheduled will be published by the District. No fee will be charged if taken on the days officially designated by the District.

A student planning to take an examination for acceleration (or the student's parent) must register with the counselor or designee at least 30 days prior to the scheduled testing date. Teacher Recommendation for Credit by Exam for Grade Acceleration must be submitted. The District will honor a request by a parent to administer, on some other date, a test purchased by the parent from a State Board-approved University and approved by the Board.

Placement or credit granted based on the score obtained from the assessment shall be recorded on the permanent school record for grades 1-8 and on the academic achievement record for grades 9-12. If a high school student passes the credit by exam with an 80 or better the actual grade earned shall be recorded in the student's academic achievement record (AAR) and will be calculated in the student's grade point average (GPA).

As per Board Policy EIC Local, if a student seeks course credit through credit by examination without prior instruction by taking an Advanced Placement (AP) exam or a College-Level Examination program (CLEP) exam, the grade for a passing score shall be recorded on the AAR and used in the calculation of class rank in accordance with the following chart:

Grade	AP Exam	CLEP Exam
95	5	80
90	4	70
85	3	60

The Superintendent or designee shall develop procedures to allow a child who is five years old as of September 1st to be placed initially in first grade rather than kindergarten. A parent must request the alternative placement by completing the Application of Intent to Test Credit by Exam Form before the first two weeks of school. This form may be obtained from the campus counselor. Criteria for acceleration may include:

1. Scores on District approved readiness test(s) that must be administered by appropriate District personnel;
2. Maturity of the student;
3. Chronological age and observed social and emotional development of the student; or
4. Other criteria deemed appropriate by the Principal and Superintendent.

Refer to Board Policy EHDC.

Distance Learning: The District provides students the opportunity to take high school and college courses via distance learning. Course schedules are posted at the beginning of each semester. Students enrolled in these courses have a facilitator in the classroom to assist the instructor with daily activities. Counselors can answer questions about eligibility requirements for those students interested in seeking dual or concurrent courses.

Extracurricular Activities, Clubs and Organizations: Participation in school-related activities is an excellent way for a student to develop talents, receive individual recognition and build strong friendships with other students. However, participation is a privilege, not a right. Participation in some of these activities may result in events that occur off-campus. When the District arranges transportation for these events, students are required to use the transportation provided by the District to and from the events. Exceptions to this rule may only be made with the approval of the activity's coach or sponsor.

Eligibility for participation in many of these activities is governed by state law as well as rules of Texas Education Agency (TEA) and University Interscholastic League (UIL) – a statewide association overseeing interdistrict competition. If a student is involved in an academic, athletic, musical or other activity governed by UIL, the student and parent are expected to know and follow all rules of the UIL organization. Dual enrollment in a joint high school and college course or concurrent enrollment program does not make a student ineligible for UIL competition. (For more information see College Coursework/Dual Credit Courses). The following requirements apply to all extracurricular activities:

- A student who receives, at the end of the grading period, a grade below 70 in any academic class other than a class identified as an Advanced Placement or International Baccalaureate course; an honors course; or a dual credit course in the subject areas of english language arts, mathematics, science, social studies, economics, or a language other than English may not participate in extracurricular activities for at least three school weeks.
- A student who receives special education services and fails to meet the standards in the Individual Education Plan (IEP), as determined by the Admission Review and Dismissal (ARD) Committee, may not participate for at least three school weeks.
- An ineligible student may practice or rehearse but may not participate in any competitive activity.
- A student is allowed in a school year up to 15 absences not related to post-district competition, a maximum of five absences for post-district competition, prior to state and a maximum of two absences for state competition. All extracurricular activities and public performances, whether UIL activities and other activities approved by the Board are subject to these restrictions.
- A student who misses class because of participation in an activity that has not been approved will receive an unexcused absence.

Please note: Sponsors of student clubs and performing groups such as the band, choir, cheerleading, drill and athletic teams may establish standards of behavior—including consequences for misbehavior—that are stricter than those for students in general. If a violation is also a violation of school rules, the consequences specified by the Student Code of Conduct or by local policy will apply in addition to any consequences specified by the organization's standards of behavior.

A student participating in U.I.L. sanctioned activities may be required to participate in random testing for illegal steroid use in accordance with state law and rules. For more detailed information, contact the Athletic Director at (956) 473-7104.

Exemptions from Final Exams for High Schools: Final examinations shall be scheduled for all high school students. Exemptions will only be allowed for students who meet the guidelines and submit a completed final exemptions form signed by the following: teacher, student and the parent. Grades and absences will be used as criteria for the final exam exemptions in one or more classes each semester. Grades 90 or above 18 week course no more than 3 absences; 9 week course 2 absences. Grades 80 or above 18 week course no more than 2 absences; 9 weeks no more than 1 absences. Grades 78 or above 18 week no more than 1 absences and 9 week course no absences.

In determining eligibility for exemptions from final examinations, the following general qualification shall apply:

1. In calculating absences (for the purpose of determining exemptions from final examination), four tardies from a particular class shall constitute one absence;
2. During the school year, students who are assigned to ISS (In-School Suspension), or an Alternative Placement (AEP) for disciplinary reasons shall be ineligible for final examination exemptions for the semester(s) they are assigned to ISS or AEP;
3. Any student with not more than one (1) disciplinary referral per semester per class may be exempt;
4. Absences for school-related reasons are not considered absences for final exam exemption purposes;
5. To retain exemption status, a student otherwise eligible for an exemption must report to the class on the day of the scheduled final examination; and
6. There are no exemptions for dual enrollment and HB5 prep courses.

Random Drug Testing: The random drug testing program shall apply to all District students in grades 7-12 who may choose to participate in a competitive extracurricular activity. Competitive extracurricular activity means a student extracurricular activity:

1. Which is sanctioned by the Texas University Interscholastic League; or
2. Which otherwise has its own rules and requirements for participating students which do not apply to the student body as a whole, has a faculty sponsor or coach monitoring the students for compliance with various rules dictated by the clubs and activities, and in relation to competition with other schools or districts, involves occasional off-campus travel and communal undress.

Facilities: Asbestos - The District works diligently to maintain in compliance with both federal and state laws governing asbestos in school buildings. A copy of the District's Asbestos Management Plan can be reviewed at the Energy and Environmental Management Department Offices located at 802 Gale. If you have any questions or would like to examine the District's plan in more detail, please contact the District's designated asbestos coordinator at (956) 473-7937.

Fees: Materials that are part of the basic educational program are provided with state and local funds at no charge to a student. A student, however, is expected to provide his or her own pencils, paper, erasers and notebooks as recommended by District supply lists and may be required to pay certain other fees or deposits, including:

- Costs for materials for a class project that the student will keep;
- Membership dues in voluntary clubs or student organizations and admission fees to extracurricular activities;

- Security deposits for the return of materials, supplies, or equipment;
- Personal physical education and athletic equipment and apparel;
- Voluntarily purchased pictures, publications, class rings, yearbooks, graduation announcements, etc.;
- Voluntarily purchased student accident insurance;
- Musical instrument and uniform maintenance, when uniforms and instruments are provided by the District;
- Personal apparel, used in extracurricular activities, that becomes the property of the student;
- Parking fees and student identification cards;
- Fees for lost or damaged musical instruments;
- Fees for lost, damaged or overdue library books;
- Fees for lost or damaged textbooks;
- Fees for lost or damaged district Mobile Learning Device (iPad, Chromebook, laptop, etc.);
- Fees for driver training courses, if offered; and
- Fees for optional course/s offered for credit that requires use of facilities not available on District premises. (However, fees shall not be charged, however, if parents of at least 22 students request a transfer to another school in the District to take required curriculum courses, other than fine arts or career and technical education, not offered at the original school.)

Any required fee or deposit may be waived if the student and parent are unable to pay. Applications for such a waiver may be made to the principal. For further information, see Board Policy FP.

Students in the Conservatorship of the State (Foster Care): In an effort to provide educational opportunities, the District will provide enrollment and registration assistance, as well as other educational services throughout the student's enrollment, to any student who is currently placed or newly placed in foster care (temporary or permanent custody of the state, sometimes referred to as substitute care). A student who is currently in the conservatorship (custody) of the state and who enrolls in the District after the beginning of the school year will be allowed credit-by-examination opportunities outside the District's established testing windows, and the District will grant proportionate course credit by semester (partial credit) when a student only passes one semester of a two-semester course. Please contact Isabel Stellema, the District's Foster Care Liaison, at (956) 473-1847 with any questions.

Fundraising: Fundraising activities for approved school purposes are occasionally permitted and approved by campus principals. Parent organizations must abide by the policies and procedures set forth in the UISD Parent Organization Guidelines. Student clubs must abide by the policies and procedures set forth in the Campus & Student Activity Funds Procedures Manual. ***For fundraising by outside organizations on school property***, prior approval must be obtained from the Superintendent at least 10 calendar days before the event. [See board policies GKB and GKD (Legal and Local).]

Gang-Free Zones: Certain criminal offenses, including those involving organized criminal activity such as gang-related crimes will be enhanced to the next high category of offense if they are committed in a gang-free zone. For purposes of the District, a gang-free zone includes a school bus and a location in, on, or within 100 feet of any District-owned or leased property or campus playground.

Grades: An examination or course grade issued by a classroom teacher is final and may not be changed unless the grade is arbitrary, erroneous, or not consistent with the District's grading policy applicable to the grade, as determined by the Board of Trustees of the District. Questions about grade calculation should first be discussed with the teacher; if the question is not resolved, the student or parent may request a conference with the principal. The decision of the Board of Trustees is not subject to appeal, but an appeal related to the student's eligibility to participate in extracurricular activities under Texas Education Code §33.081 is allowed.

Grade-Level Classification (Grades 9-12 Only): Students are classified according to the number of credits earned toward graduation.

Credits Earned	Classification
0 – 6.5	Grade 9 (Freshman)
7 – 13.5	Grade 10 (Sophomore)
14 – 20.5	Grade 11 (Junior)
21 +	Grade 12 (Senior)

Grading Guidelines:

Grades PK3–12th: Achievement is reported as a numerical grade. A computerized report card will be issued to every student. The report card includes basic student information, attendance information, numerical grades, and performance codes. An area for comments is also available and may be used to individualize each report card.

Promotion/Retention: A student may be promoted only on the basis of academic achievement or demonstrated proficiency of the subject matter of the course or grade level. This may also include the recommendation of the student's teacher, the score received on any criterion-referenced or state-mandated assessment, and any other necessary academic information as determined by the District. To earn credit in a course, a student must receive at least a grade of 70 based on course-level or grade-level standards.

In Grades 6-8, promotion to the next grade level shall be based on an overall average of 70 on a scale of 100, based on course-level, grade-level standards (essential knowledge and skills) for the following subject areas: ELAR, mathematics, science, and social studies. [See Board Policy EIE Local).]

A student in grades 6–8 shall be permitted to take summer school for remediation in no more than three of the following areas: ELAR, mathematics, science, and social studies.

Elementary grades: As a general practice, a student in PK3, Pre-K, or Kindergarten shall not be retained. If retention is considered, it must be for academic purposes and shall require approval of the student's parent and the Curriculum and Instruction Grade Placement Committee.

Grades 1–5: In grades 1–5, promotion to the next grade level shall be based on an overall average of 70 on a scale of 100 based on course-level, grade-level standards (essential knowledge and skills) for the following areas: reading-language arts, mathematics, science and social studies. For Emergent Bilinguals (EB), the language arts grade shall be determined by averaging the English/Spanish reading-language arts grade and the ESL grade only.

Changes in grade level classification shall be made at the beginning of the fall semester. Juniors who are graduation candidates must declare their intent to graduate early in the fall for purposes of class ranking and all other senior activities. [See Board Policy EIE (Local).]

Each campus in the District shall ensure that each student, other than a student with disabilities whose individual education plan (IEP) provides for alternative achievement standards, demonstrates mastery of the essential knowledge and skills adopted by the State Board. Promotion standards or grade level classification of special education students shall be determined by the ARD committee as appropriate.

In assessing students of limited English proficiency for mastery of the essential knowledge and skills, the District shall be flexible in determining methods to allow the students to demonstrate knowledge or competency independent of their English language skills in the following ways:

1. Assessment in the primary language;
2. Assessment using ESL methodologies; and
3. Assessment with multiple varied instruments. [(See Board Policy EHBE).]

The District recognizes that the retaining of students is not an effective strategy. Therefore, the District shall establish procedures designed to reduce retaining students at a grade level, with the ultimate goal of eliminating the practice of retaining students. (See Board Policy EHBC.)

For each student who does not perform satisfactorily on a state assessment instrument specified above for two or more consecutive school years in the same subject area, the district the student attends shall develop an accelerated education plan. Education Code 28.011(b).

Not later than the start of the subsequent school year, a district shall develop an accelerated education plan for the student that provides the necessary accelerated instruction to enable the student to perform at the appropriate grade level or course by the conclusion of the school year.

The plan must:

1. Identify the reason the student did not perform satisfactorily on the applicable assessment instrument; and
2. Require the student to be provided with no less than 30 hours, or a greater number of hours if appropriate, of supplemental instruction for each consecutive school year in which the student does not perform satisfactorily on the assessment instrument in the applicable subject area.

The plan may require that, as appropriate to ensure the student performs satisfactorily on the assessment instrument in the applicable subject area at the next administration of the assessment instrument:

1. The District expands the times in which supplemental instruction is available to the student;
2. The student be assigned for the school year to a specific teacher who is better able to provide accelerated instruction; and
3. The District provides any necessary additional resources to the student.

The accelerated education plan must be documented in writing, and a copy must be provided to the student's parent or guardian.

A Middle School Personal Graduation Plan (PGP) will be prepared for each student enrolled in middle school who did not perform satisfactorily on a state-mandated assessment or is determined by the District as not likely to earn a high school diploma before the fifth school year following enrollment in grade nine. The PGP will be designed and implemented by a guidance counselor, teacher, or other staff member designated by the principal. The plan will identify the student's educational goals; include diagnostic information, appropriate monitoring and intervention and other evaluation strategies; address the parent's educational expectations for the student; outline an intensive instruction program for the student; and provide innovative methods to promote the student's advancement, including flexible scheduling, alternative learning environments, online instruction and other interventions that are proven to accelerate the learning process and have been scientifically validated to improve learning and cognitive ability. For a student receiving special education services, the student's IEP may serve as the student's PGP and would therefore be developed by the student's ARD committee. [See Board Policy EIF (Legal).]

Report Cards, Progress Reports and Conferences: Conferences may be requested by a teacher or parent as needed. If the student receives a grade lower than 70 in any class or subject at the end of a grading period, the parent should schedule a conference with the teacher of that class or subject. Communication may be in the form of:

a) Parent conferences;
b) Open house;
c) Telephone calls;
d) Teacher notes.

In addition, progress reports for all students will be sent to parents every three weeks. Official report cards will be issued every six weeks for elementary and middle schools and every nine weeks at the high school level. The District may use an electronic program to communicate academic information about your child, including for report card and progress reporting purposes. If a school district offers tutorial services to students, state law requires a student with a grade below 70 for a reporting period to attend tutorials.

The District shall record the average numerical grades in the student permanent record file for first through twelfth grade students. The actual grades earned by the student will be recorded in the grade book and averaged. The grade shall reflect the student's relative mastery of an assignment.

- Grade penalties will not be imposed for projects requiring the purchase of additional textbooks or materials.
- The grade for make-up work after an excused absence shall not be reduced.
- The grade for make-up work after an unexcused absence shall be reduced by 30%. (See Board Policy EIA.)
- The grade for make-up work after a suspension shall not be reduced. (See Board Policy EIA.)

Reteach and Reassess for Mastery: UISD utilizes ongoing mastery assessment to determine which students are in need of remediation (re-teaching). The use of benchmark tests, teacher-made tests, performance assessments and teacher observations will assist to determine which students are not mastering instructional objectives.

- Teachers will monitor and identify students who need re-teaching.
- Teachers will provide interventions, including but not limited to, re-teaching as necessary.
- Benchmark tests, District Checkpoints and District Assessment Plan (DAP's) are excluded from retesting. [See Board Policy EIA (Local)]
- Reevaluation format may include, but is not limited to, oral examination, special assignment or a formal test.
- A student enrolled in UISD schools should be afforded the opportunity to retest on a summative test, examination, and/or project in any course he/she is taking after complying with teacher provided reteaching/interventions.

- To take a retest for any summative test, exam, and/or project, a student must have made full and reasonable efforts to complete assignments.
- A student may be required to provide documentation that he/she has made full and reasonable efforts to complete assignments and/or that extenuating circumstances made it impossible for him/her to do so.
- The teacher shall determine what additional re-teaching sessions a student must attend or what independent practice or other assignments a student must complete before being permitted to retest.
- A student must retest within five (5) days following the original test, except under extenuating circumstances as determined by the teacher and/or a designated campus administrator.
- A student may not raise his/her score higher than a seventy (70) after retesting regardless of the grades on his/her original test or retest.
- It is at the teacher's discretion whether a re-test is necessary and/or whether it should be granted.
- A student may not be retested more than once for any given original test.
- All other questions: follow grading guidelines.
- Consistent and firm standards will be enforced regarding retesting decisions. When questions arise, the principal may call a committee including the student, his/her representative, the designated counselor, the teacher and a designated administrator for input before the final decision is reached.

The following provisions shall apply to students beginning with the graduating class of 2022 and thereafter.
Weighted Grade System: The District shall categorize and weight eligible courses as Tier 1 and Tier 2 in accordance with provisions of this policy and as designated in appropriate District publications.

Categories: Tier 1-Eligible AP courses, dual credit courses completed in the District, Pre-AP, Advanced courses, and locally designated weighted courses shall be categorized and weighted as Tier 1 courses.
Tier 2-All other eligible courses, including dual credit courses not completed in the District, shall be categorized and weighted as Tier 2 courses.

Weighted Numerical Grade Average: The District shall assign weights to semester grades earned in eligible courses and calculate a cumulative weighted average in accordance with the following:

Category	Weight
AP test score of at least 3 for a corresponding AP course with final course grade of at least 70	Plus 5
Tier 1 Eligible AP and dual courses designated in the course catalog with a final course grade of at least a 70	Plus 10
Tier 2 Regular courses	Plus 0

The District shall record unweighted numerical grades on student transcripts and report cards.

Honor Graduates: Beginning with students in the graduating class of 2022 and thereafter, the District shall recognize as an honor graduate each student who has completed the Foundation High School Program with the distinguished level of achievement and one endorsement and has an overall weighted numerical grade average of at least 90. Honor graduates shall be recognized in accordance with the following:

Recognition	Weighted Numerical Grade Average
Summa Cum Laude	At least 100
Magna Cum Laude	95-99
Cum Laude	90-94

Graduation:
Graduation Requirements for a Diploma: To receive a high school diploma from the District and participate in graduation ceremonies, a student must successfully complete the required number of state and District required credits and pass statewide exit-level exams. Students will be required, with limited exceptions and regardless of graduation program, to successfully complete 5 End of Course (EOC) exams in order to graduate. The STAAR assessments will be administered in Algebra I, Biology, English I, English II, and U.S. History.

Students entering ninth grade will be required to successfully complete 5 End of Course (EOC) exams in order to graduate. The STAAR assessments will be administered in Algebra I, Biology, English I, English II, and U.S. History.

A student who has not achieved sufficient scores on the EOC assessments to graduate will have opportunities to retake the assessments. State law and state rules also provide for certain scores on norm-referenced national standardized assessments or on the state-developed assessment used for entrance into Texas public universities to substitute for the requirement to meet satisfactory performance on an applicable EOC assessment, should a student choose this option. See the school counselor for more information on the state testing requirements for graduation.

In limited circumstances, a student who fails to demonstrate proficiency on two or fewer of the required assessments may still be eligible to graduate if an individual graduation committee (IGC), formed in accordance with state law, and unanimously determines that the student is eligible to graduate.

Graduation Requirements for Students Entering 9th Grade: Students will be placed on the Foundation High School Program and the curriculum requirements for at least one endorsement and the Distinguished Level of Achievement distinction. The Distinguished Level of Achievement reflects the completion of an endorsement, including four credits in science and math to include Algebra II as one of the required advanced mathematics credits. DLA is also required to qualify for automatic college admission under the state's top 10 percent provisions.

Four Year/Personal Graduation Plans for Students under the Foundation Graduation Program: On entering ninth grade, students must indicate in writing an endorsement that the student intends to earn. This takes place during the student's 8th grade year. Each 8th grader is provided with a Four-Year Personal Graduation Plan (PGP) in which they select their endorsement and career program of study. If the 1st endorsement choice is not available, then the 2nd or 3rd choice endorsement listed on the Four-Year PGP will be considered in order of preference and availability. The student, parent and counselor must sign this Four-Year PGP form acknowledging selection of the endorsement. A student may amend his or her Four-Year PGP after this initial confirmation. The school will send written notice of any such amendment made by the student to the student's parents.

The following five endorsements will be offered at each high school: Science, Technology, Engineering, and Math (STEM), Business and Industry, Public Services, Arts and Humanities, and Multidisciplinary Studies. (EIF Local). A student may earn an endorsement by successfully completing:

• Curriculum requirements for the endorsement	• Four credits in science	• Four credits in mathematics

Performance Acknowledgments: The criteria for earning these performance acknowledgments are prescribed by state rules, and the school counselor can provide more information about these acknowledgments. A student may earn a performance acknowledgment on the student's transcript for outstanding performance:

• In a dual credit course	• In bilingualism and biliteracy	• On an AP test	• On the PSAT, the ACT-PLAN, the SAT, or the ACT
• For earning a nationally or internationally recognized business or industry certification or license			

Graduation Plans for Incoming Freshmen

Foundation High School Plan 26 Credits (EIF) Local	Foundation High School Plan with Endorsements 30 Credits (EIF) Local	Distinguished Level of Achievement with Endorsements 30 Credits (EIF) Local
4 English - English I, II, III, & IV	4 English - English I, II, III, & IV	4 English- English I, II, III, & IV
3 Mathematics - Algebra I, Geometry, and an additional Math course	4 Mathematics - Algebra I, Geometry, Math Models or Algebra II, & an additional Math course	4 Mathematics - Algebra I, Geometry, Algebra II, and an additional Math course
3 Science - Biology, IPC or Chemistry, and an additional Science course	4 Science - Biology, IPC or Chemistry, Chemistry or Physics, and an additional science course	4 Science - Biology, IPC or Chemistry, Chemistry or Physics, and an additional Science course
4 Social Studies - World Geography, World History, U.S. History, U.S. Government (.5 credit), and Economics (.5 credit)	4 Social Studies- World Geography, World History, U.S. History, U.S. Government (.5 credit), and Economics (.5 credit)	4 Social Studies - World Geography, World History, U.S. History, U.S. Government (.5 credit), and Economics (.5 credit)
2 Languages other than English	2 Languages other than English	2 Languages other than English
1 Physical Education (or substitution)	1 Physical Education (or substitution)	1 Physical Education (or substitution)
1 Fine Arts	1 Fine Arts	1 Fine Arts
1 BIM I	1 BIM I	1 BIM I
.5 Health	.5 Health	.5 Health
.5 Speech	.5 Speech	.5 Speech
6 Electives	8 Electives	8 Electives
Students may opt to Foundation-only after completing sophomore year	Electives must be specific to at least one endorsement	Electives must be specific to at least one endorsement

Foundation + Endorsement + Algebra II = Distinguished Level of Achievement

The Foundation High School Program with Distinguished Level of Achievement is the default plan for students at UISD in order to achieve the maximum post-secondary college and/or career readiness. * The *Distinguished Level of Achievement* distinction must be earned to be eligible for "Top 10%" of the class and qualify for automatic college admission.

Endorsements:

STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering, and Math)	Business & Industry	Public Service	Arts & Humanities	Multidisciplinary Studies
• Engineering • Math • Science	• Administrative & Information Support • Agricultural Mechanics • Automotive Technology# • AV Technology & Film • Computer Networking# • Culinary • Finance • Graphic Design# • Oil & Gas Production# • Refrigeration# • Tax Accounting	• Education • Health Professions # • Law Enforcement • Junior ROTC	• Art • LOTE (Languages other than English) • Social Studies • Music • Theatre Arts	• Foundation Subject Area • Advanced Placement

State Assessment Required for Graduation	Performance Acknowledgments
• English I • English II • Biology • U.S. History • Algebra I	• **Outstanding Performance:** Dual credit courses, bilingualism or biliteracy, AP or PSAT, SAT, ACT-Plan, or ACT. • **Certification/Licensure:** recognized nationally or internationally by business or industry or a Texas State agency.

This endorsement is limited due to specialized course offerings.

Certificate of Attendance: A student who has attended high school for four years and is a student receiving special education services who has not completed the student's Individualized Education Program (IEP) may receive a certificate of attendance and will be allowed to participate in the graduation ceremony with students receiving diplomas. Contact the school principal or counselor to receive specific information and assistance. A student may participate in only one graduation ceremony. This does not preclude a student from receiving a diploma. See Texas Education Code §28.025(f).

Certificates of Coursework Completion: A certificate of coursework completion will not be issued to a senior student who successfully completes state and local credit requirements for graduation but fails to perform satisfactorily on the exit-level examinations, and they will not be able to participate in any graduation ceremonies.

Graduation Credits Earned in Middle School: Qualified students may enroll in Algebra I Pre-AP in place of 8th grade Math. Algebra I Pre-AP will be awarded for high school credit if the student successfully passes the course with a 70 or better. The grade received will be calculated in their high school weighted average (WA) as a Tier 1 course.

Beginning in 2025-2026, 8th grade students will take Principles of Business, Marketing, and Finance, and starting in 2026-2027, all 8th grade students will take Entrepreneurship I. High school credit will be awarded for these courses if the student earns a 70 or better. The grade received will be calculated in their high school average as a Tier 2 course.

8th Grade Algebra I Pre-AP Guidelines: All eighth-grade students enrolled in Pre-AP Algebra I must meet an identified Scale Score set by the Secondary Instructional Coordinators at the Curriculum and Instruction Department. Students who meet the criteria will be enrolled in Mathematics-Algebra I Pre-AP for 3 weeks at the beginning of the school year to meet prerequisite course requirements for Algebra I.

Graduation Activities: The District has the right to limit a student's participation in graduation activities for violating the District's Student Code of Conduct. Participation might include a speaking role, as established by Board Policy and procedures.

Students eligible to give the opening and closing remarks at graduation shall be notified by the campus principal. Notwithstanding any other eligibility requirements, in order to be considered as an eligible student to give the opening or closing remarks, or any other speaking role, a student shall not have engaged in any misconduct in violation of the District's Student Code of Conduct resulting in removal to a DAEP or expulsion during any semester of a student's graduating year. The valedictorian and salutatorian may also have speaking roles at graduation. No student shall be eligible to have such a speaking role if he or she engaged in any misconduct in violation of the District's Student Code of Conduct resulting in a removal to a DAEP or expulsion during any semester of a student's graduating year.

Any student placed in a DAEP or JJAEP for more than 15 days **during the 9th, 10th, 11th, or 12th grade** for committing an offense involving Academic Dishonesty (See Glossary) shall not be **given a speaking role or** recognized for any academic achievement, including but not limited to valedictorian, salutatorian, or top 10 in the class, at graduation ceremonies.

Please refer to the UISD Student Code of Conduct for more information regarding **Graduating Juniors/Seniors in Disciplinary Alternative Education Programs** or **Graduating Juniors/Seniors in a JJAEP** at the time of graduation.

Graduation Expenses: Because you and your child will incur expenses in order to participate in the traditions of graduation, such as the purchase of invitations, senior ring, cap and gown, and senior picture, you and your child should monitor his or her progress toward completion of all requirements for graduation. The expenses often are incurred in the junior year or first semester of the senior year.

Request a High School Transcript – Parchment (See Transcripts)

Health-Related Matters

Illness/Communicable Disease

The district is required to provide notice of each health-related service offered at a student's campus. A parent may withhold consent for or decline a health-related service.

Student Illness: When your child is ill, please contact the school to let them know he or she will not be attending that day. It is important to remember that schools are required to exclude students with certain illnesses from school for periods of time as identified in state rules. For example, if your child has a fever over 100 degrees, he or she must stay out of school until fever-free for 24 hours without fever-reducing medications. In addition, students with diarrheal illnesses must stay home until they are diarrhea free without diarrhea-suppressing medications for at least 24 hours.

A full list of conditions which the school must exclude children can be obtained from the school nurse. If a student becomes ill during the school day, he or she must receive permission from the teacher before reporting to the school nurse. Once the nurse determines that the child should go home, the nurse will contact the parent. The Texas Administrative Code reflects the current protocols associated with exclusion from school, as well as a full list of conditions for which the school must exclude children. See 25 Texas Administrative Code §§97.1 97.2(d), 97.7(a), and Board Policy FFAD.

The District is also required to report certain contagious (communicable) diseases or illnesses to the Texas Department of State Health Services (TDSHS) and local/regional health authorities. The school nurse can provide information from TDSHS on these notifiable conditions. Contact the school nurse if you have questions or if you are concerned about whether your child should stay home.

For the latest information on reportable illnesses and guidelines on when a student should be excluded from school for health reasons, please refer to the Health Services Department website.

Emergency Procedures for Insect Bites or Allergic Reactions: United ISD will allow the school nurse to administer emergency injections to the student involved if there is a known hypersensitivity and the emergency kit is on campus. The child may give his/her own injection, only if the student has been taught. Other campus personnel, previously identified and trained on giving injections, will give the emergency injection if the nurse is absent and the child cannot give it to him/herself. The school nurse will follow physician orders received for each student and administer emergency medications as written. In the event of a student/staff member experiencing severe allergic reaction identified by the following signs and symptoms: presence of hives, respiratory distress, coughing, chest tightness, wheezing, facial swelling, nausea, vomiting, or loss of consciousness, a trained staff member may administer a prescribed or stock Epi-Pen, according to the UISD Standing Order Policy signed by our UISD medical consultant. All campuses have emergency Epi-Pens available for students and staff in case of a severe allergic reaction event.

Allergies/Anaphylaxis: The District requests to be notified when a student has been diagnosed with a food allergy, especially those allergies that could result in dangerous or possibly life-threatening reactions either by inhalation, ingestion, or skin contact with food, insect, animal, or medication. It is important to disclose the food, insect, animal, or medication to which the student is allergic to, as well as the nature of the allergic reaction. Please contact the school nurse or campus principal if your child has a known food or any type of allergy or as soon as possible after any diagnosis of a food or any other type of allergy. Forms are available in the campus nurses' offices. The District has developed and annually reviews the food allergy management plan, which addresses employee training, dealing with common food allergens, and specific strategies for dealing with students diagnosed with severe food allergies. Upon a physician medical documentation of a student's life-threatening allergy—whether triggered by food, insects, animals, or medication—the District is committed to establishing a safe and inclusive educational environment. Following this notification, the school nurse and the parent will work collaboratively to create an individualized emergency plan designed to safeguard the child within the school setting. To achieve this, an Individualized Healthcare Plan (IHP) and an Emergency Care Plan (ECP) will be developed for each at-risk student. These documents serve as proactive frameworks to mitigate exposure and provide staff with immediate, life-saving protocols. Comprehensive resources, including the Allergy Anaphylaxis Emergency Plan and Food Allergy Guidelines, can be accessed on the Health Services Department website.

Automated External Defibrillators: State law requires the District to have a defibrillator on each campus and an individual present who is trained to use the device. Selected school personnel and students will be trained in the proper use of an AED and administering cardiopulmonary resuscitation (CPR). Additionally, the State Board of Education requires instruction in CPR and AED as part of the essential knowledge and skills of the health curriculum. The District has at least one automated external defibrillator on each campus in the District. For more information regarding the equipment and rules related to automated external defibrillators on District campuses, call the Health Services Department at (956) 473-6264.

School districts are required to provide cardiopulmonary resuscitation instruction for students in grades 7 through 12 at least once before graduation. This training may be waived if the student has a disability and is unable to perform the "psychomotor skills" or Hands on Only "Family and Friends" CPR training. The District is a training site for the American Heart Association. School nurses provide this training at their respective campuses to 7th - 12th grade students, including how to use an AED and how to provide abdominal thrust to save a choking victim. In addition, this "Hands on Only" will create a safety net among our youth.

The District has placed bleeding control stations in easily accessible areas in each of the campuses. In addition, district staff have been trained by nursing staff using "The Stop the Bleed" instructional materials from the United States Department of Defense with the authorization from the American College of Surgeons. The staff mandated by the state will receive training yearly as well as, selected students 7th – 12th grade will receive an awareness training including hands on training on how to stop a bleed. The American Heart Association has included "Stop the Bleed" training within the CPR modules. Thus, everyone that takes CPR training will have training on "Stop the Bleed" when getting certified for CPR.

School districts are required provide information about Bacterial Meningitis provided by the Department of State and Health Services:

- What is meningitis? Meningitis is an inflammation of the covering of the brain and spinal cord. It can be caused by viruses, parasites, fungi and bacteria. Viral meningitis is the most common and the least serious. Meningitis caused by bacteria is the most likely form of the disease to cause serious, long-term complications. It is an uncommon disease but requires urgent treatment with antibiotics to prevent permanent damage or death.
- Bacterial meningitis can be caused by multiple organisms. Two common types are Streptococcus pneumoniae, with over 80 serogroups that can cause illness and Neisseria meningitis, with five serogroups that most commonly cause meningitis.
- What are the symptoms? Someone with bacterial meningitis will become very ill. The illness may develop over one or two days, but it can also rapidly progress in a matter of hours. Not everyone with meningitis will have the same symptoms.
- Children (over 1 year old) and adults with meningitis may have a severe headache, high temperature, vomiting, sensitivity to bright lights, neck stiffness and drowsiness or confusion. In both children and adults, there may be a rash of tiny, red-purple spots. These can occur anywhere on the body.
- The diagnosis of bacterial meningitis is based on a combination of symptoms and laboratory results.
- How serious is bacterial meningitis? If it is diagnosed early and treated promptly, most people make a complete recovery. If left untreated or treatment is delayed, bacterial meningitis can be fatal, or a person may be left with permanent disability.
- How is bacterial meningitis spread? Fortunately, none of the bacteria that cause meningitis are as contagious as diseases like the common cold or the flu, and they are not spread by simply breathing the air where a person with meningitis has been. The germs live naturally in the back of our noses and throats, but they do not live for long outside the body. They are spread when people exchange saliva (such as by kissing, sharing drinking containers, utensils, or cigarettes) or when people cough or sneeze without covering their mouth and nose.
- The bacteria do not cause meningitis in most people. Instead, most people become carriers of the bacteria for days, weeks, or even months. The bacteria rarely overcome the body's immune system and cause meningitis or another serious illness.
- How can bacterial meningitis be prevented? Vaccination - Bacterial meningitis caused by Streptococcus pneumoniae and Neisseria meningitis may be prevented through vaccination. The vaccine, which protects against Streptococcus pneumoniae, is called pneumococcal conjugate vaccine or PCV. This vaccine is recommended by the Advisory Council on Immunization Practices (ACIP)

for children in the first year of life. Neisseria meningitis is prevented through two types of vaccines. The first is a meningococcal conjugate vaccine which protects against four serogroups A, C, W, and Y and is referred to as MCV4. The second is a vaccine against Neisseria meningitis serogroup B and is referred to as MenB.

- The ACIP recommends MCV4 for children at age 11-12 years, with a booster dose at 16-18 years. In Texas, one dose of MCV4 given at or after age 11 years is required for children in 7th-12th grades. One dose of MCV4 received in the previous five years is required in Texas for those under the age of 22 years and enrolling in college. Teens and young adults (16-23 years of age) may be vaccinated with MenB. This vaccine is not required for school or college enrollment in Texas.
- Vaccines to protect against bacterial meningitis are safe and effective. Common side effects include redness and pain at the injection site lasting up to two days. Immunity develops about 1-2 weeks after the vaccines are given and lasts for five years to life depending on vaccine.
- Healthy Habits: Do not share food, drinks, utensils, toothbrushes, or cigarettes/vapes. Wash your hands. Limit the number of people you kiss. Cover your mouth and nose when you sneeze or cough. Maintaining healthy habits, like getting plenty of rest and not having close contact with people who are sick, also helps.
- Who is at risk for bacterial meningitis? Certain groups are at increased risk for bacterial meningitis caused by Neisseria meningitis. These risk factors include HIV infection, travel to places where meningococcal disease is common (such as certain countries in Africa and in Saudi Arabia) and college students living in a dormitory. Other risk factors include having a previous viral infection, living in a crowded household, or having an underlying chronic illness.
- Children ages 11-15 years have the second highest rate of death from bacterial meningitis caused by Neisseria meningitis. Also, children ages 16-23 years have the second highest rates of disease caused by *Neisseria meningitis.*
- What should you do if you think you or a friend might have bacterial meningitis? Seek prompt medical attention.
- For more information: Your school nurse, family doctor, and the staff at your local or regional health department office are excellent sources for information on all infectious diseases. You may also call your family doctor or local health department office to ask about meningococcal vaccine.
- *Additional Resources: Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC): https://www.cdc.gov/meningitis/index.html Texas Department of State Health Services (DSHS): https://www.dshs.texas.gov/immunizations/school/requirements.

Care of Students with Diabetes: Diabetes is the second most common chronic disease that impairs the body's ability to use food for energy. It is one of the most common chronic diseases in school age children, affecting 1 in every 400 children under 20 years of age. Yearly diabetic training sessions are required in Texas schools to provide consistency with the care of students with diabetes. It provides for full participation of the educational team to facilitate the collaboration and relationships needed to ensure the health and safety of students with diabetes.

At each school in which a student with diabetes is enrolled, the principal shall seek school employees, who are not health care professionals, to serve as Unlicensed Diabetes Care Assistants (UDCA), who will be trained to care for students with diabetes in the unavailability of the school nurse. A written prescription, from a diabetic student's physician licensed to practice within the State of Texas, is required for the daily and urgent management of care, including the authorization for self-care. A written consent from the parent is required to authorize the trained UDCA to care for the student with diabetes. It requires a collaborative effort between the student, parent, physician, teacher, and school nurse to develop a student's Individual Health Plan. This includes the routine treatment and care that will be available for the student as well as emergency interventions that will be provided to the student and implemented by all staff including the UDCAs.

Through the UISD Health Services Department, a three-level thorough training and annual retraining program has been developed for the unlicensed personnel (UDCA designee at each campus) and is conducted yearly to provide information and the necessary skills to manage and provide daily and urgent care as indicated in the student's individual's health plan. If you would like your child to receive assistance or support to manage diabetes as they assume increasing responsibility and independence for their disease management and to maintain wellness and prevent or delay complications, please provide the campus principal or school nurse with the needed written prescription plan from their physician.

Dietary Supplements Containing Performance Enhancing Compounds: A District employee is prohibited by state law from knowingly selling, marketing, or distributing a dietary supplement that contains performance enhancing compounds to a primary or secondary education student with whom the employee has contact as part of the employee's District duties. In addition, an employee is prohibited by state law from knowingly endorsing or suggesting the ingestion, intranasal application, or inhalation of a dietary supplement that contains performance - enhancing compounds by a primary or secondary education student with whom the employee has contact as part of the employee's school district duties. A person who violates this section commits an offense. An offense under this section is a Class C misdemeanor.

However, this section does not prohibit a District employee from providing or endorsing the use of these items by the employee's child; or the selling, marketing, or distributing of the items to a primary or secondary education student, as part of activities that do not occur on school property or at a school-related function. They are entirely separate from any aspect of the employee's employment with the District; and do not in any way involve information about or contacts with students that the employee has had access to, directly or indirectly, through any aspect of the employee's employment with the District. "Dietary supplement" has the meaning assigned by 21 U.S.C. Section 321 and its subsequent amendments.

"Performance enhancing compound" means a manufactured product for oral ingestion, intranasal application, or inhalation that contains a stimulant, amino acid, hormone precursor, herb or other botanical, or any other substance other than an essential vitamin or mineral; and is intended to increase athletic or intellectual performance, promote muscle growth, or increase an individual's endurance or capacity for exercise.

Emergency Medical Treatment: If a student should have a medical emergency at school or a school-related activity when the parent cannot be reached, the school may have to rely on written parental consent to obtain emergency medical treatment and information about allergies to medications and/or preexisting medical conditions. Therefore, parents are being asked to complete a Student Medical History via online. *It is the responsibility of the parents/guardians to keep emergency care information up to date (name of doctor, emergency phone numbers, allergies, etc.). In addition, we are encouraging all parents that have medical concerns for their children to visit with their campus nurse. It is very important to keep open communication with your school nurse to ensure your children receive the best medical/nursing care in the school setting. Medical emergencies that require an ambulance to be activated are the sole responsibility of the parent.*

Energy Drinks and Other Similar Foods and Beverages: The risks and benefits of the consumption of products that may qualify as a dietary supplement containing performance enhancing compounds by children remains a personal parental decision. Individual campus administrators may elect to prohibit items such as energy drinks from school campuses and/or from being provided by parents to their own child at campus during the school day.

Illness/Communicable Diseases: Students are expected to be free of fever (temperatures less than 100 degrees) and free of communicable diseases to attend school. Parents/guardians shall pick up their child as soon as possible if the child develops a fever (temperature greater than 100 degrees) at school. Parents/guardians are encouraged to keep their child at home until the child is fever-free for 24 hours without using anti-fever medication. This minimizes the spread of potentially contagious illnesses at school and encourages adequate rest and recuperation before the student returns to school.

Head Lice: Head lice, although not an illness or a disease, is very common among children and is spread very easily through head-to-head contact during play, sports, or nap time and when children share things like brushes, combs, hats, and headphones. If careful observation indicates that a student has head lice, the school nurse will contact the student's parent to determine whether the child will need to be picked up from school and to discuss a plan for treatment with an FDA-approved medicated shampoo or cream rinse that may be purchased from any drug or grocery store. After the student has undergone one treatment, the parent should check in with the school nurse to discuss the treatment used. The nurse can also offer additional recommendations, including subsequent treatments and how best to get rid of lice and prevent their return. State law requires notices to be sent to parents of elementary students that are in the same classroom of a student found to have head lice. This notice will be sent no later than 5 days after finding a student with head lice in the same classroom. Notices will only be provided to parents of elementary school students in the affected classroom. More information on head lice can be obtained from the TDSHS website at https://www.dshs.texas.gov/texas-school-health/skilled-procedures-texas-school-health/managing-head-lice-school.

Immunization: A student must be fully immunized against certain preventable diseases or must present, a statement for medical reasons from the child's physician or an affidavit for reasons of conscience, including a religious belief, indicating the vaccines the student will not be immunized against. For exemptions based on reasons of conscience and religious beliefs, only official forms issued by the Texas Department of State Health Services (TDSHS), Immunization Branch, can be honored by the District. This form may be obtained by writing to the TDSHS Immunization Branch (MC 1946), P.O. Box 149347, Austin, Texas 78714-9347; or online at https://www.dshs.texas.gov/immunizations/school/exemptions. The form must be notarized and submitted to the principal or school nurse within 90 days of notarization. If the parent is seeking an exemption for more than one student in the family, a separate form must be provided for each student. Affidavits will be presented at the time of registration, or the child will not be allowed to attend school. Medical exemptions are only good for one year and the **affidavit must be renewed every two years.** The immunizations required are diphtheria, tetanus, and pertussis; measles, mumps, and rubella; polio; hepatitis A; hepatitis B; varicella (chicken pox); and meningococcal. The school nurse can provide information on age-appropriate doses or on an acceptable physician-validated history of illness required by the TDSHS. Proof of immunization may be established by personal records from a licensed physician or public health clinic with a signature or rubber-stamp validation. **As a courtesy, parents/guardian will be notified at least one month prior to any immunization due dates before the student is not allowed to return to the school setting.**

Note that a child who is pregnant or who is a parent and has custody of the child can consent to his or her own immunizations. If a student should not be immunized for medical reasons, the student or parent must present a certificate signed by a U.S. registered and licensed physician stating that, in the doctor's opinion, the immunization required is medically contraindicated or poses a significant risk to the health and well-being of the student or a member of the student's family or household. This certificate must be renewed yearly unless the physician specifies a lifelong condition. As noted, entering college students must provide also, with limited exception, furnish evidence of having received a bacterial meningitis vaccination within the five years prior to enrolling in and attending classes at an institution of higher education. A student wanting to enroll in a dual credit course, taken on or off campus, may be subject to this requirement. For further information, see Board Policy FFAB (Legal) and the TDSHS website: https://www.dshs.texas.gov/immunizations/school/requirements.

Access the District's website **www.uisd.net** and click on Health Services Department tab for information regarding the following:

1. Immunizations required for admission to public school.
2. Any immunizations or vaccines recommended for public school students by the Department of State Health Services.
3. A link to the Department of State Health Services Internet website.
4. TB policy for 1st time entrants to our District and returning students.

Medicine at School: Medication that must be administered to a student during school hours must be provided by the student's parent. All medication, whether prescription or nonprescription, must be kept in the nurse's office and administered by the nurse or another authorized District employee, unless the student is authorized to possess his or her own medication because of asthma or a severe allergy as described below or as otherwise allowed by law. The District will not purchase nonprescription medication to give to a student. District employees will not give a student prescription medication, nonprescription medication, herbal substances, anabolic steroids, or dietary supplements, with the following exceptions:

Only authorized employees, in accordance with policy FFAC, may administer:

- Prescription medication, in the original, properly labeled container, provided by the parent, along with a written request and doctor's order.
- Prescription medication from a properly labeled unit dosage container filled by a registered nurse or another qualified District employee from the original, properly labeled container.
- Nonprescription medication, in the original, properly labeled container, provided by the parent along with a written request and doctor's order.
- Herbal or dietary supplements provided by the parent only if required by the student's individualized education program (IEP) or Section 504 plan for a student with disabilities and prescribed by a doctor.

A student who must take prescription medicine during school hours must have a written prescription ordered by a physician licensed to practice in the State of Texas. A signed request from their parent/guardian must also be on file in the campus nurse's office. *The campus nurse may contact the ordering physician for order clarification if needed.*

The prescribed **or nonprescription** medication must be taken to the campus nurse or principal by the parent/guardian or another responsible adult in its original, **properly labeled container.** All medication refills will be documented on the student's daily log for medication administration. The nurse or principal designee will give the medication to the student at the proper time. For the safety and protection of all students, medication will not be sent home with the student. When the period for administering the medication expires, the parent, legal guardian, or other responsible adult must pick up the medication.

To maintain a safe environment for all students, the unauthorized possession of medication is prohibited. No student may personally carry prescription or non-prescription drugs at any time. All medical needs must be coordinated through the health office in accordance with district administration guidelines. If a student must carry self-administered medication due to any pre-existing medical condition, documentation on the Self-Administration Medication Release Form (which includes parent/guardian signature and a physician's order) must be in place with the campus nurse prior to bringing the medication on campus. No control substances will be allowed to be self-administered per Board Policy. **School District personnel will not be responsible for safeguarding or monitoring self-administered medication.**

Authorized District employees may administer nonprescription medications provided by the parent/guardian **under the same provisions as for prescription medications as explained above**. For further information, see Board Policy FFAC (Legal) and FFAC (Local).

Students whose schedules provide for regular time spent outdoors, including for recess and physical education classes, should apply sunscreen before coming to school.

For students at the elementary level, the student's teacher or other District personnel will apply sunscreen to a student's exposed skin if the student brings the sunscreen to school and requests assistance with the application of the sunscreen. Nothing prohibits a student at this level from applying his or her own sunscreen if the student is capable of doing so.

For students at the secondary level, a student may possess and apply sunscreen when necessary. If the student will need assistance with this application, please address the need for assistance with the school nurse.

Whether a student is at the elementary or secondary level, if sunscreen needs to be administered to treat any type of medical condition, this should be handled through communication with the school nurse so that the District is made aware of any safety and medical issues.

A student with asthma or severe allergic reaction (anaphylaxis) may be permitted to possess and use prescribed asthma or anaphylaxis medication at school or school-related events only if he or she has written authorization from his or her parent and a physician or other licensed health-care provider. The student must also demonstrate to his or her physician or health-care provider and to the school nurse the ability to use the prescribed medication, including any device required to administer the medication.

If the student has been prescribed asthma or anaphylaxis medication for use during the school day, the student and parents should discuss this with the school nurse or principal.

In accordance with a student's individual health plan for management of diabetes, a student with diabetes will be permitted to possess and use monitoring and treatment supplies and equipment while at school or at a school-related activity. See the school nurse or principal for information. [See Board Policy FFAF (Legal).]

Physical Examinations/Health Screenings: All students entering UISD schools for the first time in any grade level or students re-enrolling to UISD shall follow the District's Board Policy to ensure a healthy and safe environment by preventing the spread of communicable disease and reducing the exposure of tuberculosis disease. A TB screening test will be conducted if necessary. The policy and procedure for screening has not changed from the state guidelines. The parent/guardian shall complete the Texas Department of State Health Services TB Questionnaire. Depending on their responses, the parent/guardian may be asked to provide evidence of having received a recent tuberculosis skin test. In accordance with public health protocols, students transitioning from the **Juvenile Justice Alternative Education Program (JJAEP)**, **Juvenile Detention Center**, or **correctional facilities**, as well as students arriving from **Mexico or any other foreign country**, must provide proof of Tuberculosis (TB) clearance prior to registration.

Students found to have a positive tuberculin reaction at time of enrollment shall be evaluated by a physician licensed to practice in the State of Texas, or provide documentation of a prior evaluation by a physician, for determination of any need for medical therapy, or future medical evaluations. The physician's recommendation shall be followed and kept as a confidential part of the student's school medical record.

Parents of students identified through any screening programs as needing treatment or future examination shall be advised of the need, and referred to appropriate health agencies or a private physician. The District may provide additional screenings as District and community resources permit. Any student that needs **to be kept out of physical education for more than 3 days will require a medical note from their physician or parent**. The school may require a medical note from a physician for frequent or long-term requests for a student to be kept out of physical education. It is of the utmost importance that school children participate in physical activity to ensure their optimal health and well-being.

Students desiring to participate in the UIL athletic and marching band competition shall annually submit a statement from a health care provider, as outlined in UIL rules, indicating that the student has been examined and is physically able to participate in the program.

In addition, high school cheerleading and dance team members shall be required to submit a statement from a health care provider, as outlined in UIL rules, indicating that the student has been examined and is physically able to participate in these activities. For further information, see Board Policy FFAA (Local).

Physical Fitness Assessment (Grades 3-12): Annually, the District will conduct a physical fitness assessment of students in grades 3-12 who are enrolled in a physical education course or a course for which physical education credit is awarded. At the end of the school year, a parent may submit a written request to Roberto Cruz, Director for Athletics, to obtain the results of his/her child's physical fitness assessment conducted during the school year.

Psychotropic Drugs: A psychotropic drug is a substance used in the diagnosis, treatment, or prevention of a disease or as a component of a medication. It is intended to have an altering effect on perception, emotion, or behavior and is commonly described as a mood- or behavior-altering substance. For further information, see policy FFAC.

Teachers and other District employees may discuss a student's academic progress or behavior with the student's parents or another employee as appropriate; however, they are not permitted to recommend use of psychotropic drugs. A District employee who is a registered nurse, an advanced nurse practitioner, a physician, or a certified or credentialed mental health professional can recommend that an appropriate medical practitioner evaluate a student.

Cell Phones: Cell phone usage is not allowed in the nurse's office to make phone calls or videotape any incident such as student experiencing seizures or any other type of medical episode. This is a violation of HIPAA (Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act) and FERPA (The Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act). Please keep all cell phones off at the nurse's office. The signage reflecting this prohibition will be placed in all nurses' clinics.

Naloxone (Narcan) is an antagonist medication to reverse the signs and symptoms of an opioid overdose. Opioid overdose occurs when the amount of opioid in the body is so great the individual becomes unresponsive to stimuli and breathing becomes inadequate. Lack of oxygen affects vital organs, including the heart and brain, leading to unconsciousness, coma and eventually death. Naloxone is indicated for the reversal of opioid overdose in the presence of respiratory depression or unresponsiveness. The District's medical consultant has signed a standing order as allowed by the state law to provide School Health Services staff with a standard by which to respond to this life-threatening event in the school setting. All campuses currently have Naloxone available as a preventive life-saving medication for a possible opioid overdose.

Emergent Bilinguals (All Grade Levels): Under 19 TAC §89, it is the policy of the state that every student who has a primary language other than English and who is identified as an Emergent Bilingual (EB) shall be provided a full opportunity to participate in a bilingual education or English as a second language (ESL) program (19 TAC §89.1201). EBs are identified by a Language Proficiency Assessment Committee (LPAC) that shall be composed of an appropriately certified bilingual and/or ESL educator, a parent of an EB participating in a bilingual or ESL program and a campus administrator (TEC §29.063); eligibility as EB is determined by the LPAC in accordance with the standardized statewide identification process (19 TAC §89.1226). The entry or placement of a student in the bilingual education or ESL program must be approved in writing by the student's parent; however, pending parental approval, the school district shall place the student in the program recommended by the LPAC (19 TAC §89.1220 (j); §89.1240). If the student qualifies for services, and once a level of proficiency has been established, the LPAC will designate instructional accommodations or additional special programs that the student will require to eventually become proficient at grade level work in English. The LPAC may reclassify the student as English Proficient and determine the student is no longer eligible for services from a bilingual or ESL program based upon the state's reclassification criteria at the end of the school year beginning in grade 1 (19 TAC §89.1226(i)).

Homeless Students – Services: A parent is encouraged to inform the District if his or her child is experiencing homelessness so that District staff may share resources that may be able to assist. Also, please check the district website (https://www.uisd.net/359014_3) for information related to **services** available in the area that can help families who are experiencing homelessness. For more information on services for homeless students, contact: Sara Hernandez, Liaison for McKinney-Vento students, (956) 473-6471, or Adriana Ramirez, Executive Director for Federal and State Programs, at (956) 473-6259.
McKinney-Vento children will be provided flexibility regarding certain District provisions, including

- Proof of residency requirements;
- Immunization requirements and TB tests;
- Educational program placement, if the student is unable to provide previous academic records, or misses an application deadline during a period of homelessness;
- Credit-by-examination opportunities;
- The award of partial credit (awarding credit proportionately when a student passes only one semester of a two-semester course);
- Eligibility requirements for participation in extracurricular activities; and
- Graduation requirements.

If a student in grade 11 or 12 is homeless and transfers to the District but does not meet the graduation requirements of the District, the student can request to receive a diploma from the previous school district if he or she meets the criteria to graduate from the previous district. Federal law also allows a homeless student to remain enrolled in what is called the "school of origin" or to enroll in a new school in the attendance area where the student is currently residing.

Homework: Homework should provide a balanced representation of the types of work completed in the course. The District shall follow the *Instructional Grading & Reporting* procedures.

Library Media Center: The mission of United ISD and the 49 School Library Media Centers is for its students to become effective global learners and users of today's information resources in its varied formats: 1.) To promote information literacy in all its formats creating a "student-centered library media program that is based on three central ideas: collaboration, leadership and information technology;" 2.) To serve its community by enabling "students to achieve their potential and fully participate" in society as active information users and lifelong learners; 3.) To enable users to create new content by navigating multiple electronic platforms of digital resources successfully and in an ethical manner; 4.) To support the UISD school curriculum, the District's library media centers will provide for a thriving learning environment that stimulates the intellect; 5.) To provide resources and activities that supply all user groups with information access in an expedient and equitable manner; and 6.) To provide on-site and remote access of the UISD Library Online Catalog to all patrons by contacting your school library media specialist to learn more about the services, library hours, and programs at your school campus.

Make-Up Work

Excused Absence	Students will be allowed to make up work missed due to any excused absence. The time allotted will be equal to one day per each day of absence. For example, a student absent for five (5) days will be allotted 5 days to complete

	the missed assignment. It is the student's responsibility to inquire about work missed during the absence. (The teacher is encouraged to use his/her discretion in allotting additional time for extenuating circumstances.)
Unexcused Absence	Make-up work/tests after an unexcused absence shall receive a maximum grade of 70. [See Board Policy EIA (Local).] The time allotted will be equal to a one day per each day of absence.

The grade for make-up work after a suspension shall not be reduced. In the event of a student's absence during the final exam, the student and/or parent must provide a doctor's excuse or other appropriate documentation of extenuating circumstances–major illnesses/catastrophic situations/death in the family, etc.–which must be verified by the campus principal before the student is permitted to take the final exam.

Please follow the District's Policy regarding homework.

- Late assignments/projects will be penalized, 10 points per day for up 3 instructional days. After the third day, students may receive a zero. After the third day, assignments will not be accepted.
- Students shall make up assignments and tests after absences. Students shall receive a zero for any assignment or test not made up within the allotted time.
- A student will be permitted to turn in projects due in any class missed because of absence. Teachers may assign a late penalty to any long-term project in accordance with timelines approved by the principal and previously communicated to students. Documentation of extenuating circumstances shall be provided to the campus principal.

Meetings of Non-Curriculum-Related Groups: Students are permitted to meet with non-curriculum-related groups during the hours designated by the principal before and after school. These groups must comply with the requirements in Board Policy FNAB.

Messages/Deliveries to Students: Messages to the classroom or to call students to the office can only be made for emergencies. Campus administration will have the responsibility for determining what an emergency is. Such requests will be made through the campus administration.

Pest Control Information: The District is required to follow integrated pest management (IPM) procedures to control pests on school grounds. Although the District strives to use the safest and most effective methods, including a variety of non-chemical control measures, pesticides may be necessary to maintain adequate pest control. Except in an emergency, signs will be posted 48 hours before indoor application. All outdoor applications will be posted at the time of treatment and signs will remain until it is safe to enter the area. All pesticides used are registered for their intended use by the United States Environmental Protection Agency and are applied only by certified pesticide applicators. Parents who want to be notified prior to pesticide application inside their child's school assignment area may contact the school principal.

Physical Activity for Students in Elementary and Middle School: The District will make available for public inspection a statement of the policy adopted to ensure that students in elementary grades engage in at least 30 minutes of moderate to vigorous physical activity per day (or 135 minutes per week) and students in grades 6-8 engage in 4 out of 6 semesters of moderate to vigorous physical activity, along with other information. For additional information on the District's requirements and programs regarding elementary, middle and high school student physical activity requirements, please see the principal.

Pregnancy, Education and Parenting (P.E.P.) Program: The mission of the Pregnancy, Education and Parenting (P.E.P.) Program is to enable school-age parents, through education, to become self-sufficient, responsible, job-oriented citizens. The Program's goal is to reduce the number of students who drop out of school due to pregnancy and/or parenthood and to recover young parents to the educational system. Support Services include:

- Counseling Services
- Technology Resources and Equipment
- Instructional Support and Tutoring Services
- Child care for the student's child(ren), as appropriate, at a child care facility in close proximity to the home or campus
- Transportation for student, and the student's child(ren), as appropriate, to and from the campus and/or child care facility
- Instruction (inside and/or outside the classroom) related to child development, parenting, and home and family living
- Health services, including the school nurse
- Case Management and Service Coordination (assistance in obtaining available services from government agencies and/or community service organizations)

Pregnancy Related Services (P.R.S.) are Support Services, including Compensatory Education Home Instruction (C.E.H.I.) – face to face and/or virtual instruction, which a pregnant student may receive during the pregnancy prenatal and postpartum periods to help her adjust academically, mentally, physically and stay in school. These services are delivered to a student when:

- the student is pregnant and attending classes on a District campus
- a valid medical necessity for confinement during the pregnancy prenatal period prevents the student from attending classes on a District campus, or
- the pregnancy postpartum period prevents the student from attending classes on a District campus.

Any pregnant and/or parenting student (teen fathers are encouraged to enroll) who is enrolled in the United Independent School District and wants to earn his/her high school diploma is eligible. **For more information, please contact your school counselor or the P.E.P. office,** 4001 Ave. Los Presidentes, Laredo, Texas 78046, at (956) 473-6510.

Published Materials or Documents – Distribution

School Materials: Publications prepared by and for the school require prior approval by the principal, sponsor or teacher before they may be posted or distributed. Such items may include school posters, brochures, flyers, murals, yearbooks, etc. All school publications are under the supervision of the teacher, sponsor and principal. See Board Policy FMA (Local).

Non-school Materials: Written materials, handbills, photographs, pictures, petitions, films, tapes, posters, or other visual or auditory materials may not be posted, sold, circulated, or distributed on any school campus by a student or a nonstudent without the prior approval of the principal. Materials displayed without authorization will be removed. If the material is not approved within two school days of the time it was submitted to the principal, it should be considered disapproved. Any student who posts material without prior approval will be subject to disciplinary action.

Disapprovals may be appealed by submitting the disapproved material to the Associate Superintendent for Curriculum & Instruction; materials not approved within three days are considered disapproved. This disapproval may be appealed to the Superintendent in accordance with Board Policy FMA (Local). Any student who posts material without prior approval will be subject to disciplinary action in accordance with the Student Code of Conduct. Materials displayed without this approval will be removed.

Safety

Accident Insurance: Under state law, the District cannot pay for medical expenses associated with a student's injury.

Insurance for Career and Technical Education (CTE) Programs: If the Board purchases accident, liability, or automobile insurance coverage for students or businesses involved in the District's CTE programs, the District will notify the affected students and parents.

Accident Prevention: Student safety on campus or at school-related events is a high priority of the District. Although the District has implemented safety procedures, the cooperation of students is essential to ensure school safety. Students are expected to:

- Avoid conduct that is likely to put them or other students or staff at risk.
- Follow the behavioral standards of this handbook and the Student Code of Conduct, as well as any additional rules for behavior and safety set by the principal, teachers, or bus drivers.
- Help secure the campus by keeping all exterior doors closed, latched, and locked unless the door is actively monitored by a District employee.
- Follow instructions from teachers and other District employees regarding classroom doors.
- Remain alert and promptly report any safety hazards to a teacher or the principal, such as intruders on campus or threats made by any person toward a student or staff member.
- Know emergency evacuation routes and procedures.
- Follow immediately the instructions of teachers, bus drivers, or other District employees who are overseeing the welfare of students.

Safety Drills: United ISD uses the Standard Response Protocols (SRP) as mandated by Texas Education Code §37.114 and the Texas Education Agency Commissioner of Education. The SRP is based on five call to action items: SECURE, LOCKDOWN, EVACUATE, SHELTER, and HOLD. In the event of an emergency, the action will be called out on the school's PA System. Students, teachers and other District employees must participate in emergency procedure drills throughout the school year. When the command is given or alarm is sounded, students and staff members need to respond promptly and in an orderly manner to the action. (Visit: https://txssc.txstate.edu/tools/srp-toolkit or www.uisd.net/keepuisdsafe for additional information.)

Reunification: Circumstances may occur at the school that require parents to pick up their students in a formalized, controlled release. This process is called a "reunification" and may be necessary due to weather, a power outage, hazmat or if a crisis occurs at the school. The Standard Reunification Method is a protocol that makes this process more predictable and less chaotic for all involved. Because a reunification is not a typical end of school day event, a reunification may occur at a different location than the school a student attends. If this location is another school, then those students may be subject to a controlled release as well. If a parent or guardian is notified that a reunification is needed, there are some expectations that parents or guardians should be aware of. First, bring identification. That will streamline things during reunification. Second, be patient. Reunification is a process that protects both the safety of the student and provides for an accountable change of custody from the school to a recognized custodial parent or guardian. For students, the school asks that students be orderly and quiet while waiting. Students may be asked to text a message to their parents or guardians. Students are also asked not to send other text messages either in or out of the school or reunification area. Keeping the cellular network usage at a minimum may be important during a reunification. For more information visit https://txssc.txstate.edu/tools/srm-toolkit/ or www.uisd.net/keepuisdsafe.

Scholarships and Grants: For information, see the counselor.

School Health Advisory Council: During the preceding school year, the District's School Health Advisory Council (SHAC) held 4 (four) meetings. The duties of the SHAC range from recommending curriculum to developing strategies for integrating curriculum into a coordinated school health program encompassing issues such as health services, counseling services, a safe and healthy school environment, and recess recommendation. The School Health Advisory Council (SHAC) is involved with the selection of course materials for human sexuality instruction. You may also choose to become more involved with the development of curriculum used for this purpose by becoming a member of the district's SHAC. Please see the campus principal for additional information.

Section 28.004 of the Texas Education Code requires that sexuality instruction in Texas schools "present abstinence from sexual activity as the preferred choice of behavior in relationship to all sexual activity for unmarried persons of school age" and "devote more attention to abstinence from sexual behavior than to any other behavior." The content of District's human sexuality instruction is consistent with this legal requirement. The curriculum of Texas Health Skills for Middle School encourages students to make healthy, personal decisions about many health subjects, including body image, nutrition, mental health, medications and drugs, and human sexuality. Texas Health Skills for Middle School separates human sexuality information from other health education topics. Districts will provide human sexuality instruction to students only when a parent or guardian has provided permission, or "opted-in."

Sexual Harassment and Sexual Abuse: The District encourages parental and student support in its efforts to address and prevent sexual harassment and sexual abuse in the public schools. Students and/or parents are encouraged to discuss their questions or concerns about the expectations in this area with a teacher, counselor, principal or designee, Rita Garner, Director of Employee Relations who serves as the District's Title IX coordinator in matters relating to employee-on-student harassment and/or discrimination or Michelle Lee Farias, Student Services Manager/Title IX Coordinator in matters relating to student-on-student harassment and/or discrimination.

To make a report of child sexual abuse, contact the Texas Department of Family and Protective Services at 1-800-252-5400 or https://www.txabusehotline.org. To obtain more information from the Texas Department of Family and Protective Services, such as recognizing signs of sexual abuse, please visit their website at http://www.dfps.state.tx.us.

The District shall provide child abuse anti-victimization programs in elementary and secondary schools in accordance with Texas Education Code §38.004. The programs will address the likely warning signs of child sexual abuse; methods for preventing child sexual abuse; actions that

a child who is a victim of child sexual abuse should take to obtain assistance and intervention; and available counseling options for students affected by sexual abuse. For more information regarding the District's child abuse anti-victimization programs or if a parent or student would like additional information, please contact Melissa Chapa Ramirez, Director of Guidance and Counseling, or the school counselor at the student's home campus.

Any person who has cause to believe that a child's physical or mental health or welfare has been adversely affected by abuse or neglect by any person shall immediately make a report as required by law under Family Code §261.101(a). Any school official or professional who has cause to believe that a child has been or may be abused or neglected shall make a report as required by law. The report must be made within 48 hours after the school official or professional first suspects abuse or neglect. A school official or professional may not delegate to or rely on another person to make the report. A "professional" is a person who is licensed or certified by the state or who is an employee of a facility licensed, certified, or operated by the state and who, in the normal course of official duties or duties for which a license or certification is required, has direct contact with children. The term includes teachers, nurses, doctors, day-care employees and juvenile detention or correctional officers.

A person commits a Class A Misdemeanor if he or she has cause to believe that a child's physical or mental health or welfare has been or may be adversely affected by abuse or neglect and knowingly fails to report it as provided by law under Family Code §261.109. Please view the District's Board Policy regarding child abuse and neglect contained in Board Policies FFG (Legal) and (Exhibit).

As a parent, it is important for you to be aware of warning signs that could indicate a child may have been or is being sexually abused. Sexual abuse in the Texas Family Code is defined as any sexual conduct harmful to a child's mental, emotional, or physical welfare as well as a failure to make a reasonable effort to prevent sexual conduct with a child. Anyone who suspects that a child has been or may be abused or neglected has a legal responsibility, under state law, for reporting the suspected abuse or neglect to law enforcement or to Child Protective Services (CPS).

Possible physical warning signs of sexual abuse could be difficulty sitting or walking, pain in the genital areas and claims of stomachaches or headaches. Behavioral indicators may include verbal references or pretend games of sexual activity between adults and children, fear of being alone with adults of a particular gender, or sexually suggestive behavior. Emotional warning signs to be aware of include withdrawal, depression, sleeping disorders, eating disorders and problems at school.

A child who has experienced sexual abuse should be encouraged to seek out a trusted adult. Be aware as a parent or other trusted adult that disclosures of sexual abuse may be more indirect than disclosures of physical abuse and it is important to be calm and comforting if your child, or another child, confides in you. Reassure the child that he or she did the right thing by telling you.

As a parent, if your child is a victim of sexual abuse, the campus counselor or principal will provide information regarding counseling options for you and your child available in your area. The following websites include resources to help increase awareness of child sexual abuse and neglect, trafficking, and other maltreatment of children:

- http://www.dfps.state.tx.us/Prevention_and_Early_Intervention/Programs_Available_In_Your_County/default.asp.
- http://www.taasa.org/resources-2/
- http://www.oag.state.tx.us/AG_Publications/txts/childabuse1.shtml
- http://www.oag.state.tx.us/AG_Publications/txts/childabuse2.shtml
- https://www.childwelfare.gov/pubs/factsheets/whatiscan.pdf
- http://kidshealth.org/en/parents/child-abuse.html

Reports may be made to the Child Protective Services (CPS) division of the Texas Department of Family and Protective Services at 1-800-252-5400 or on the Web at http://www.txabusehotline.org.

Steroids: State law prohibits students from possessing, dispensing, delivering, or administering an anabolic steroid. Anabolic steroids are for medical use only and only a physician can prescribe use. Body-building, muscle enhancement, or the increase of muscle bulk or strength through the use of an anabolic steroid or human growth hormone by a healthy student is not a valid medical use and is a criminal offense. A student participating in U.I.L. sanctioned activities will be required to participate in random testing for illegal steroid use in accordance with state law and rules. For more detailed information, contact the Athletic Director at (956) 473-7104 or the UIL Website at http://www.uiltexas.org/health/steroid-information.

Student Organization Elections and Offices: For further information, contact campus administration.

Student Speech Regarding Religion: The District will not treat a student's otherwise permissible voluntary expression of a religious viewpoint in any other manner than it treats the student's otherwise permissible expression on a secular or other viewpoint. The administration at each high school campus has information pertaining to the District's limited public forum policy governing voluntary religious expression.

Summer School--Other Than Extended Year Program: Summer School is offered at designated elementary, middle school sites on an alternating basis and at all high schools. Students meeting the criteria for summer school are invited to attend and shall be awarded credit for courses begun and successfully completed during the summer sessions adhering to the summer grading guidelines. Attendance and discipline are strictly in accordance with the Student Code of Conduct. Questions may be directed to the Director for Continuous School Improvement at (956) 473-1863. For information on Extended School Year (ESY) services visit the Special Education Website at www.uisd.net.

TESTING (STANDARDIZED):

Participation in Federally Required, State-Mandated and District Assessments: You may request information regarding any state or Board Policy related to your child's participation in assessments required by federal law, state law, or District guidelines.

STAAR End-of-Course (EOC) Assessments for Students in Grades 9–12: STAAR is an assessment designed to measure the extent to which students have learned and are able to appfaly the knowledge and skills defined in the state-mandated curriculum, the Texas Essential Knowledge and Skills or TEKS. Beginning with ninth graders in the 2011–2012 school year, end-of-course (EOC) assessments are administered for the following five (5) courses: 1.) Algebra I; 2.) Biology; 3.) United States History; 4.) English I; and 5.) English II.

All EOC assessments are administered online. Satisfactory performance on the applicable assessments will be required for graduation. If a student fails to perform satisfactorily on an EOC assessment, the District will provide remediation to the student in the content area for which the

performance standard was not met. This may require participation of the student before or after normal school hours or at time of the year outside normal school operations.

Normally, there will be three testing windows during the year in which a student may take an EOC assessment, which will occur during the fall semester, spring semester and summer months.

STAAR (State of Texas Assessments of Academic Readiness) Grades 3–8: STAAR is an assessment designed to measure the extent to which students have learned and are able to apply the knowledge and skills defined in the state-mandated curriculum, the TEKS. All grades/subjects of STAAR (English and Spanish) can be administered online. In addition to routine tests and other measures of achievement, students at certain grade levels will take the STAAR, in the following subjects:

- Mathematics, annually in grades 3–8
- Spanish Mathematics in grades 3-5
- Reading Language Arts (RLA), annually in grades 3–8
- Spanish Reading Language Arts (RLA), annually in grades 3–5
- Science in grades 5 and 8
- Social Studies in grade 8

STAAR Alternate 2: The Texas Education Agency (TEA) has developed the State of Texas Assessments of Academic Readiness (STAAR) Alternate 2 assessment to meet the federal requirements mandated under the Elementary and Secondary Education Act (ESEA), a federal education law previously known as No Child Left Behind. The Texas Education Agency (TEA) designed the STAAR Alternate 2 to assess students in grades 3–8 and high school who have significant cognitive disabilities and are receiving special education services. This will be available for eligible students, as determined by the student's ARD committee. This particular state assessment may have a different testing window than the general assessments.

Requesting Administration of STAAR/EOC Assessment in Paper Format (All Grade Levels): STAAR and EOC assessments are administered electronically. A parent or teacher may request that a STAAR or EOC be administered to a student in paper format. The District may grant this request for any single administration for up to three percent of the number of students enrolled in the District. Requests will be granted in the order in which they are received. Requests for paper format for a fall administration of a STAAR or EOC must be submitted no later than September 15 each school year. Requests for paper format for a spring administration of a STAAR or EOC must be submitted no later than December 1 each school year.

TELPAS: The Texas Education Agency has developed an assessment program for students in Texas public schools who are learning the English language. The letters in TELPAS stand for the Texas English Language Proficiency Assessment System. The Texas Education Agency (TEA) developed TELPAS to meet state and federal requirements. Texas annually assesses the English language proficiency of students who have been identified as Emergent Bilinguals (EBs) in four language domains—listening, speaking, reading, and writing. TELPAS evaluates the progress that each EL makes in becoming proficient in the use of academic English.

Participation of Emergent Bilinguals (EBs) in State Assessments requires language proficiency assessment committees (LPACs) to make assessment decisions on an individual student basis. This is in accordance with administrative procedures established by the Texas Education Agency (TEA) and in the Texas Administrative Code, Chapter 74.4.

TELPAS ALT: TEA has developed the TELPAS Alternate assessment to meet the federal requirements mandated under the Every Student Succeeds Act (ESSA), which require states to administer an alternate English language proficiency (ELP) assessment for Emergent Bilinguals (EBs) with the most significant cognitive disabilities who cannot participate in the general ELP assessment, even with allowable accommodations.

TELPAS Alternate is not a traditional test in which students answer questions. The holistic inventory contains descriptions of behaviors, called observable behaviors, for test administrators to consider regarding each student's use of the English language in each of the four domains: listening, speaking, reading and writing.

SAT/ACT (Scholastic Aptitude Test and American College Test): Many colleges require either the American College Test (ACT) or the Scholastic Aptitude Test (SAT) for admission. Students are encouraged to talk with the counselor during their junior year to determine the appropriate exam to take; these exams are usually taken at the end of the junior year.

TSIA2 (Texas Success Initiative Assessment 2.0) Guidelines: All public colleges and universities in Texas are required by law to assess the English Language Arts and Reading (ELAR) and mathematics skills of incoming freshmen. The TSIA2 assessment helps Texas institutions evaluate a student's readiness for college-level coursework and identifies any areas where additional academic support may be needed. Achieving certain benchmark scores on this assessment may also waive specific end-of-course (EOC) assessment requirements in limited circumstances.

Testing Requirements & UISD Locations: The TSIA2 Assessment must be completed before a student can enroll in any college-level coursework, including dual credit courses.

- **Pre-Assessment Activity:** Before taking the TSIA2, all students are strictly required to complete the TSIA2 Pre-Assessment Activity (PAA).
- **Cost & Locations:** United ISD provides TSIA2 testing centers at all middle and high school campuses. There is no cost for UISD students taking the exam at these locations. Testing may be done more than once based on the campus testing schedule.

High School Dual Credit & Early Start Pathway: If you are in high school, your TSIA2 scores determine your eligibility to take dual credit courses.

- **Early Start Pathway:** A passing TSIA2 score in ELAR is required to qualify for the UISD Early Start Pathway, which can begin as early as the 9th grade. To support this, the TSIA2 ELAR is offered in the 8th grade.

- **Maintaining Passing Status:** Once a student meets their TSIA2 requirements, they **must** take a college-level course while in high school to maintain their passing status. If a student fails to take a college-level course during high school, they may be required to retake the TSIA2 before entering college.

Laredo College Registration Exemptions & College Connect Program for ESP1 Consideration: For students taking high school dual credit courses through Laredo College, TSIA2 requirements and exemptions are determined by the number of college credits a student has accumulated and their enrollment in specific supplemental pathways:

- **Under 15 Semester Credit Hours (SCH):** Students who have accumulated fewer than 15 college credit hours are fully exempt from testing (**No TSI Required).**
- **Over 15 SCH & The College Connect Program:** Students who exceed 15 SCH and have *not* met the TSIA2 college readiness benchmarks in English or Math can utilize the **College Connect** program. These supplemental courses are delivered directly at the high schools by dual adjunct instructors. Upon successful completion of a College Connect course, the student is officially deemed "college ready."

College Connect Course Rollout for Dual Credit Students:

- **Spring 2026:** All **ENGL 1301** (TSI ELAR) and **MATH 1314** (TSI Math) classes will become College Connect courses.
- **Fall 2026:** Additional math courses—**MATH 1324**, **MATH 1342**, and **MATH 1332**—will be integrated into the College Connect program.

(Note: To meet TSIA2 College Ready scores without these courses, students must achieve a CRC of 945–990 with an Essay of 5–8 for ELAR, and a CRC of 950–990 for Math, or meet the specific diagnostic score alternatives).

Under **Texas Administrative Code (TAC) §4.54**, a student may be officially exempt from the TSIA2 requirement as a condition of enrollment in a higher education institution if they successfully complete a college preparatory course under **Texas Education Code §28.014**. This exemption remains valid for a period of **twenty-four (24) months (two years)** following the student's graduation from high school.

Information about Checkpoints and District Assessment Plan (DAP's): Assessments are a form of communication for students, teachers, campuses, parents, the district, etc. They are designed to measure progress before, during, and after instruction with varying levels of depth and complexity. UISD has developed local assessments called Checkpoints and District Assessment Plan (DAP's) formally known as (CBA's). These assessments use a variety of formats that are similar to the State of Texas Assessments of Academic Readiness (STAAR) formats.

Checkpoints/DAP's are instruments that are used to help demonstrate the degree to which a student has mastered the intended curriculum. These assessments are used as part of an on-going, spiraling, data-driven process to guide adjustments to instruction, determine reteach/enrichment opportunities and identify individual strengths and weaknesses. It is also important to note that these assessments are aligned with and integrated with, the curriculum (scope and sequence).

Assessments are essential to achieve student and teacher accountability. They represent the learning process, as well as the learning outcome. Therefore, Checkpoints/DAP's will be administered in every Pre-K–12th grade classroom in UISD. These assessments will be scored and graded. For more information, please see the UISD website for a copy of the program guide explaining the Checkpoints/DAP's, or contact your campus administrator.

Textbooks: State-approved textbooks are provided to students free of charge for each subject or class. Books must be covered by the student as directed by the teacher and treated with care. A student who is issued a damaged book should report that fact to the teacher. Each student, or the student's parent/guardian, is responsible for each textbook not returned by the student, regardless of whether the textbook is lost, damaged or stolen. A student who fails to return all textbooks including electronic textbooks and all technological equipment in an acceptable condition forfeits the right to free textbooks until each textbook previously issued but not returned is paid for by the student, parent or guardian. The District shall allow the student to use textbooks at school during each school day but may not allow the student to take textbooks out of the classroom until each textbook previously issued but not returned is paid for by the student, parent/guardian. If a textbook is not returned in an acceptable condition or paid for, the District may withhold the student's academic records for out-of-District requests only. The District shall not prevent a student from graduating, participating in a graduation ceremony, or receiving a diploma for failure to return a textbook.

Tobacco and E-Cigarettes Prohibited: The District and its staff strictly enforce prohibitions against the use of tobacco products, electronic cigarettes, or any other vaporizing device by students and others on school property and at school-sponsored or school-related activities. See the Student Code of Conduct and Board Policy GKA.

Transcripts – Parchment: UISD students and alumni can now conveniently request and send transcripts to colleges and universities through Parchment.com. This secure and user-friendly online platform allows students to electronically request, review, store, and mail transcripts to the institutions of their choice.

All active UISD students and alumni with a Parchment account have access to request both electronic and hard copy transcripts. Parchment has collaborated with many Texas and state colleges and universities to streamline the transcript delivery process.

How to Request a Transcript – Students requesting transcripts are encouraged to create a Parchment account by following these steps:

1. Visit www.uisd.net
2. Click on the STUDENTS tab
3. Select "PARCHMENT TRANSCRIPT REQUEST"
4. Scroll down to find and select your UISD high school mascot logo
5. Follow the prompts to create your account using your personal email address

For additional assistance, students may also contact their campus registrar or the UISD Office of Admissions at (956) 473-6318. You can also visit the office at 201 Lindenwood Drive – Portable #7 for more information.

United ConnectED: United ISD is committed to providing innovative educational environments that meet the diverse needs of today's learners. Beginning with the 2026-2027 school year we are proud to offer two distinct virtual pathways designed to empower students through flexibility, rigorous academics, and digital engagement. With the passage of Texas Senate Bill 569 in 2025, districts can now offer more flexible online

instructional models. United ConnectED was created to provide families with additional choices in how students learn, without compromising the rigorous quality of education provided by United ISD. Led by highly qualified teachers, our virtual program offers 9th-12th grade students a flexible and engaging online education option to succeed and thrive in a structured, virtual learning environment.

Vending Machines: The District has adopted and implemented the states and federal policies and guidelines for food service, including the guidelines to restrict student access to vending machines. For more information regarding these policies and guidelines, see the Director of Child Nutrition. See also, Board Policies CO and FFA.

Visitors: Parents and other visitors are welcome to visit District schools. For the safety of those within the school and to avoid disruption of instructional time, all visitors must first report to the principal's office. All school visitors will be scanned into the visitor management system (using a valid Texas driver's license or Texas ID card). The visitor's first name, last name and date of birth will be checked with the National Sex Offenders Registry. The designated staff member will issue a visitor's badge with the visitor's destination if there is no alert indicated in the database. If the visitor does not have acceptable photo identification available, the campus administrator on duty will be called to assess the situation. The visitor will return to the office to check out when they are leaving the campus. The designated staff person will check the visitor out of the system. No sex offenders will be allowed at any UISD campuses. To view more information, visit www.uisd.net/keepuisdsafe.

Visits to individual classrooms during instructional time are permitted only with approval of the principal and teacher and so long as their duration or frequency does not interfere with the delivery of instruction or disrupt the normal school environment.

Since visitors may serve as role models to students, all visitors must adhere to the highest standards of courtesy and conduct; disruptive behavior will not be permitted.

The District may invite representatives from patriotic societies listed in Title 36 of the United States Code to present information to interested students about membership in the society.

All visitors must exit the school at the primary entrance and leave all exterior doors closed, latched, and locked unless actively monitored by a District employee. Visitors may also be asked to provide identification upon request by a District employee at any time while on campus. A person who refuses to provide identification or reasonably appears to no legitimate reason to be on District property may be ejected from the property.

Unauthorized Persons: In accordance with Texas Education Code §37.105, a school administrator, school resource officer (SRO), or District police officer shall have the authority to refuse entry or eject a person from District property if the person refuses to leave peaceably on request and: (1) the person poses a substantial risk of harm to any person; or (2) the person behaves in a manner that is inappropriate for a school setting and the person persists in the behavior after being given a verbal warning that the behavior is inappropriate and may result in refusal of entry of ejection. Appeals regarding refusal of entry from District property may be filed in accordance with Board Policy FNG (Local) or GF (Local), as appropriate.

Every Student Succeeds Act (ESSA)

PARENTS RIGHT TO KNOW: As a parent of a student at U.I.S.D., you have the right to know the professional qualifications of the classroom teachers who instruct your child, and Federal law requires the school district to provide you with this information upon request. U.I.S.D. is committed to ensuring that our students receive a quality education. You have the right to request the following information about each of your child's classroom teachers:

- ✓ Whether the teacher meets the state qualifications and licensing criteria for the grades and subjects he or she teaches.
- ✓ Whether the teacher is teaching under emergency or provisional status because of special circumstances.
- ✓ Whether the teacher is currently teaching in the field of discipline of his or her certification.
- ✓ Whether instructional assistants provide services to your child and, if so, their qualifications.

If you would like to receive any of this information, please contact the campus principal.

APPENDIX I: Freedom From Bullying Policy

Note that Board policies may be revised at any time. For legal context and the most current copy of the local policy, visit http://pol.tasb.org/Policy/Code/1210?filter=FFI. Below is the text of United Independent School District's Board Policy FFI (Local) as of the date that this handbook was finalized for this school year.

STUDENT WELFARE: FREEDOM FROM BULLYING FFI (LOCAL) — Adopted on July 19, 2022

Note: This policy addresses bullying of District students. For purposes of this policy, the term bullying includes cyberbullying. For provisions regarding discrimination and harassment involving District students, see Board Policy FFH. Note that Board Policy FFI shall be used in conjunction with Board Policy FFH for certain prohibited conduct. For reporting requirements related to child abuse and neglect, see Board Policy FFG.

Bullying Prohibited: The District prohibits bullying, including cyberbullying, as defined by state law. [See Board Policy FFI (Legal).] Retaliation against anyone involved in the complaint process is a violation of Board Policy and is prohibited.

Definition: Bullying is defined in §37.0832 of the Texas Education Code as a single significant act or a pattern of acts by one or more students directed at another student that exploits an imbalance of power and involves engaging in written or verbal expression, expression through electronic means, or physical conduct that:

(1) Has the effect or will have the effect of physically harming a student, damaging a student's property, or placing a student in reasonable fear of harm to the student's person or of damage to the student's property;
(2) Is sufficiently severe, persistent, or pervasive enough that the action or threat creates an intimidating, threatening, or abusive educational environment for a student;
(3) Materially and substantially disrupts the educational process or the orderly operation of a classroom or school; or
(4) Infringes on the rights of the victim at school.

Bullying includes cyberbullying. (See below) This state law on bullying prevention applies to:

(1) Bullying that occurs on or is delivered to school property or to the site of a school-sponsored or school-related activity on or off school property;
(2) Bullying that occurs on a publicly or privately owned school bus or vehicle being used for transportation of students to or from school or a school-sponsored or school-related activity.
(3) Cyberbullying that occurs off school property or outside of a school-sponsored or school-related activity if the cyberbullying interferes with a student's educational opportunities or substantially disrupts the orderly operation of a classroom, school, or school-sponsored or school-related activity.

Examples: Bullying of a student could occur by physical contact or through electronic means and may include hazing, threats, taunting, teasing, confinement, assault, demands for money, destruction of property, theft of valued possessions, name-calling, rumor spreading, or ostracism.

Minimum Standards: In accordance with law, the Superintendent shall develop administrative procedures to ensure that minimum standards for bullying prevention are implemented.

Retaliation: The District prohibits retaliation by a student or District employee against any person who in good faith makes a report of bullying, serves as a witness, or participates in an investigation.

Examples: Examples of retaliation may include threats, rumor spreading, ostracism, assault, destruction of property, unjustified punishments, or unwarranted grade reductions. Unlawful retaliation does not include petty slights or annoyances.

False Claim: A student who intentionally makes a false claim, offers false statements, or refuses to cooperate with a District investigation regarding bullying shall be subject to appropriate disciplinary action.

Timely Reporting: Reports of bullying shall be made as soon as possible after the alleged act or knowledge of the alleged act. A failure to immediately report may impair the District's ability to investigate and address the prohibited conduct.

Reporting Procedures—Student Report: To obtain assistance and intervention, any student who believes that he or she has experienced bullying or believes that another student has experienced bullying should immediately report the alleged acts to a teacher, school counselor, principal, or other District employee. The Superintendent shall develop procedures allowing a student to anonymously report an alleged incident of bullying.

Employee Report: Any District employee who suspects or receives notice that a student or group of students has or may have experienced bullying shall immediately notify the campus principal (if the employee works at a campus), his/her supervisor (if the employee does not work at a campus), or designee.

Report Format: A report may be made orally or in writing. Employees and students shall be provided a District form to reduce any oral report to writing. If the student refuses to reduce his/her oral report to writing on the District form provided, the principal or designee shall reduce the oral report to writing on the District form or other written documentation.

Initial Assessment: Upon receipt or notice of a report of bullying, the principal or designee shall determine whether the allegations, if proven, would constitute bullying as defined by state law. If so, the principal or designee shall immediately undertake an investigation as dictated by this policy. If the principal or designee determines that the allegations, if proven, would not constitute bullying as defined by state law, the investigation shall be concluded with no further action required by the campus administration; however, if the alleged conduct is a violation of the District Student Code of Conduct, appropriate disciplinary action shall be taken against the perpetrator as dictated by the District's Student Code of Conduct.

Notice of Report: When an allegation of bullying is reported and after the initial assessment determines that bullying may have occurred, the principal or designee shall notify a parent of the alleged victim on or before the third business day after the incident is reported. The principal or

designee shall also notify a parent of the student alleged to have engaged in the conduct within a reasonable amount of time after the incident is reported.

Prohibited Conduct: The principal or designee shall determine whether the allegations in the report, if proven, would constitute prohibited conduct as defined by policy FFH, including dating violence and harassment or discrimination on the basis of race, color, religion, sex, gender, national origin, or disability. If so, the District shall proceed under policy FFH. If the allegations could constitute both prohibited conduct and bullying, the investigation under FFH shall include a determination on each type of conduct.

Investigation of Report: The principal or designee shall conduct an investigation based on the allegations in the report. The principal or designee shall promptly take interim action calculated to prevent bullying during the course of an investigation, if appropriate.

Concluding the Investigation: Absent extenuating circumstances, the investigation should be completed within 14 business days from the date of the initial report alleging bullying; however, the principal or designee shall take additional time if necessary to complete a thorough investigation. The principal or designee shall prepare written documentation pertaining to the investigation. The written documentation shall include information as to whether bullying occurred, and if so, whether the victim used reasonable self-defense. A copy of the written documentation shall be sent to the Superintendent or designee.

Notice to Parents: If an incident of bullying is confirmed after investigation, the principal or designee shall promptly notify the parents of the victim and of the student who engaged in bullying.

Periodic Monitoring: The Superintendent shall periodically monitor the reported counts of bullying incidents, and that declines in the count may represent not only improvements in the campus culture because bullying declines but also declines in the campus culture because of a decline in openness to report incidents.

District Action Bullying: If the results of an investigation indicate that bullying occurred, the District shall promptly respond by taking appropriate disciplinary action in accordance with the District's Student Code of Conduct and may take corrective action reasonably calculated to address the conduct. The District may notify law enforcement in certain circumstances.

Discipline: A student who is a victim of bullying and who used reasonable self-defense in response to the bullying shall not be subject to disciplinary action. The discipline of a student with a disability is subject to applicable state and federal law in addition to the Student Code of Conduct.

Corrective Action: Examples of corrective action may include a training program for the individuals involved in the complaint, a comprehensive education program for the school community, follow-up inquiries to determine whether any new incidents or any instances of retaliation have occurred, involving parents and students in efforts to identify problems and improve the school climate, increasing staff monitoring of areas where bullying has occurred, and reaffirming the District's Board Policy against bullying.

Transfers: The principal or designee shall refer to FDB for transfer provisions.

Counseling: The principal or designee shall notify the victim, the student who engaged in bullying, and any students who witnessed the bullying of available counseling options.

Improper Conduct: If the investigation reveals improper conduct that did not rise to the level of prohibited conduct or bullying, the District may take action in accordance with the Student Code of Conduct or any other appropriate corrective action.

Confidentiality: To the greatest extent possible, the District shall respect the privacy of the complainant, persons against whom a report is filed, and witnesses. Limited disclosures may be necessary in order to conduct a thorough investigation.

Appeal: A student or parent who is dissatisfied with the outcome of the investigation may appeal through FNG (Local), beginning at the appropriate level.

Records Retention: Retention of records shall be in accordance with CPC (Local).

Access to Policy and Procedures: This policy and any accompanying procedures shall be distributed annually in the employee and student handbooks. Copies of the policy and procedures shall be posted on the District's website, to the extent practicable, and shall be readily available at each campus and the District's administrative offices.